

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה

LESHEM SHVO V'ACHLAMA

*Introductions and Gates · An Annotated English
Translation*

Volume Two · Gates Five and Six

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Volume Two of 3 · Gates Five and Six

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G A T E

*Shaar 5 — The five general Divine
revelations*

Chapter 1 — Two varieties of the five revelations: one above the other and one within the other.

Sha'ar 5 Chapter 1

Various ways of picturing the relationships between the Revelations

הַחֲמִשָּׁה גְּלוּיִם שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ בְּשַׁעַר ד'

Of the five revelations discussed in Sha'ar 4,¹

הֵנָּה בְּעֵינֵינוּ מֶה שֶׁנוֹגֵעַ מִזֶּה לָזֶה יֵשׁ בָּזֶה ב' בְּחִי'

two aspects of the relationship between one revelation and the another² are relevant here:

א' מֶה שֶׁהֵם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה; ב' מֶה שֶׁהֵם מְתַבְּשָׁטִים וּמְתַלַּבְּשִׁים
זֶה בָּזֶה

1. That they are completely one above the other³

2. They flow into and become clothed within one another.

Now these two points appear to contradict each other – if the higher one is completely above the lower one, how do they flow into and become clothed one in the other? The answer is –

וְהֵיינוּ כִּי בְּעֶקֶר עֲצֻמוֹת הַגְּלוּי דכ"א

That is to say, in the primary essential revelation of each of them,

הֵנָּה הֵם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה לְגַמְרִי, אַךְ בְּהֶאָרְתָּם הֵם מְתַלַּבְּשִׁים זב"ז
[זֶה בָּזֶה].

one transcends the other completely, with no overlap, but their *radiances* are clothed one within the other i.e. they flow into and become clothed one in the other,

כי מתפשט הארה מכל עליון ויורד ומתלבש בהתחתון כמו
שיתבאר למטה פ"ב.

since a radiance from every **higher** level descends and becomes
clothed in the lower level**, as will be explained below, chapter
2.**

אבל בעקר מציאותם ומדרגתם הנה הם זה למעלה מזה לגמרי.

**But as regards their primary existence and level, one
transcends the other completely,**

כי ישנו לכ"א בחי' מקום ומעון בפני עצמו

because each of them has a separate sacred space⁴ and abode
exclusive to it,

ואינו נכנס כל תחתון בגבול העליון מאומה.

**and the lower level does not enter the border of the higher level
at all.**

כי הנה אור אין סוף ית"ש שהוא הגלוי הראשון הנה הוא למעלה
מהכל

**The *Ohr Ein Sof* is the first revelation and transcends
everything else.**

וכן הוא ג"כ מבחוץ להכל כי הוא מקיף לכל העולמות כלם מכל
סביבותיהם

**Furthermore, it also envelops everything from the outside since
it surrounds all the worlds on every side**

והם כלם למטה ממנו במדרגה ואין שום עולם שיקנס במחצתו
מאומה.

**so that all of them are below it in terms of their level, and no
World can enter into its parameters at all.**

וַיִּשְׁנוּ גַם בְּחִי' שָׁפָה וּפְרָגוּד לְהַפְסִיק בֵּינוּ לְבֵין כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת

There is also an edge and a barrier, so to speak, separating it from all the worlds

וַכְּמוֹ שֶׁמֵּתְבָּאֵר בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּעֵגְלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עָנָף ב'.

as will be explained in exposition in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*.

וְאַחֲרָיו הוּא הָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי.

The subsequent level is the world of the kav and the tzimtzum, which constitute the second revelation.

וְהִנֵּה הַצִּמְצוּם הוּא כְּעֵין אֲוִיר וּמְקוֹם פְּנוּי אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹכוֹ נִמְצָאוּ
וְנַעֲשׂוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כְּלָם

Now the tzimtzum forms something like an empty space and a void in which all of the worlds are found and made

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא אֲוִיר הַקְּדָמוֹן כִּנ"ל שֶׁע"ד פ"ג

And that is why it is referred to as *Avir Kadmon*, as mentioned previously in *Sha'ar 4* chapter 3.

כִּי הוּא כְּעֵין חֶלֶל וְאַוִיר פְּנוּי וְהוּא קְדָמוֹן לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת.

Because it is like a void and empty space that precedes all of existence.

כִּי קִדָּם הַכָּל הָאֲצִיל הַמֵּאֲצִיל ית"ש מְקוֹם לְהַמְצִיאוֹת

Because, first and foremost, the Emanator emanated a space for existence

וְהוּא הַנוֹשֵׂא בְּתוֹכוֹ אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלּוּ.

that sustains the entire existence within it.

וְעָלָיו רִמְזֵי הַתּוֹרָה מ"ש הִנֵּה מְקוֹם אֶתִי.

**This is what the Torah is hinting to in the verse (Exodus 33:21),
"There is a sacred space with Me..."**

אֲמַנָם אוֹתוֹ הַמָּקוֹם הַנֶּה הוּא אֵינוֹ פָּנוּי מִמָּשׁ וּבִבְחִי רִיקְנִי וְהַעֲדָר
ח"ו

**However, that sacred space is not literally void and empty,
from which everything is negated, heaven forfend,**

כִּי אֵין רִיקְנִי כָּלֵל וְכַמ"ש הָרַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ מֵהַר"י ג [הָרַב יוֹסֵף
גִּיקָטִילִיא] בְּסֵפֶר גִּנַּת אֶגֶז ח"ב שְׁאִין רִיקוֹת בְּעוֹלָם.

**for there is no 'emptiness' at all, as Rabbi Joseph Gikatilla
(1238-1410) writes in his *Ginat Egoz*, part II – that there is no
vacuum in the spiritual universe.**

וְכֵן כָּתַב ג"כ רַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ הָרַמ"ק ז"ל בְּאַלְמִימָה מ"א תָּמַר ב' פ' י"ז

**Our holy rabbi, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero (1522-1570) writes
similarly in his *Elimah, ma'ayan 1, tamar 2* chapter 17**

שְׁאִין רִיקוֹת וְהַעֲדָר ח"ו וְכֵן אָמַר הָרַמְבַּ"ם בְּמוֹרָה ח"א ר"פ ע"ב וְה'
ע"ג וּבַח"ב פ"ל.

**that there is no vacuum and void, heaven forfend. And so
writes the Rambam Maimonides in his *Moreh Nevuchin*, part 1,
chapters 72, 73 and in part 2, chapter 30.**

אֲמַנָם מָה שֶׁקָּרָאנוּ אוֹתוֹ בְּשֵׁם מָקוֹם כִּי הֵנָּה שֵׁם הוּא שְׁפָעַת כָּחוֹ
יִתְבָּרֵךְ

**However, the fact that we refer to it as '*makom*' 'place' or 'sacred
space' is because that is to where His power flows –**

הַנוֹשָׂא אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כְּלוּ, וְהַרִי הוּא הַמָּקוֹם לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת.

**the power that sustains all of existence, and constitutes the
sacred space or the boundary conditions for the entire existence.**⁵

וְאָמַר הָאֲרִיז"ל בְּסֵפֶר שַׁעַר הַקְּדָמוֹת דָּךְ ט' סע"ד

The Arizal stated in the work *Sha'ar haHakdamot* 9d

כי המקום הוא יותר זך ומעולה וגדול במעלה ומדרגה מן העולם עצמו.

that the space in which the universe is contained is more refined, and loftier in quality and level, than the world itself.

ולכן נקרא הקב"ה מקומו של עולם

And therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, is called the 'Place' of the universe,

וכמו שאמרו רז"ל ברוך המקום שנתן תורה לישראל עד כאן לשוננו.

as our Sages declared⁶, "Blessed is the 'Place' who gave the Torah to the Jewish people" end quote,

וע' בראשית רבה פרשה ס"ח סימן ט' ע"ש.

and see Bereishit Rabba 68:9.⁷

והוא מה שכתוב (איוב כ"ו) "תולה ארץ על בלי מה" שהוא בלי מהות משג

This is as the verse (Job 26:7) states: "He suspends the earth upon nothingness" – i.e. an incomprehensible essence –

כי הוא שפעת כחו יתברך הנשא את כל העולמות וכלם עומדים עליו.

since it is the outflow of His blessed power that sustains all the worlds, and everything is based upon it,

והרי הם תלויים ועומדים בכחו של הקב"ה שהוא בלי מהות משג.

and all of them are dependent upon, and are based upon, the power of the Holy One, blessed be He, which cannot be comprehended.

וְהוּא הָאָוִיר קַדְמוֹן אֲשֶׁר בְּהַצְמָצוֹם הַנִּזְ' הַנוֹשֵׂא אֶת כָּל:

This power is the *Avir Kadmon* that results from the *tzimtzum* mentioned, and this is what sustains everything.

וְהִנֵּה פְּשׁוּט הַדָּבָר כִּי אוֹתוֹ הַכֹּחַ הַנוֹשֵׂא אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת

Now it is obvious that the power that sustains all of the worlds

הֵנָּה הוּא נִבְחָן בַּחֲלָקֶת מִדְּרָגוֹת רַבּוֹת,

can be categorized into many levels,

וְהוּא לְפִי עֶרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַנִּשְׁוֹא עָלָיו.

according to the nature of each world that is sustained thereby.⁸

כִּי אֵינוֹ דוֹמָה קִדְשֵׁת הַשֹּׁפֵעַ וְהַכֹּחַ שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְיָצִילוֹת

For the holiness of the flow and the power in the sacred space of Atzilut is not at all similar

לְקִדְשֵׁת הַשֹּׁפֵעַ וְהַכֹּחַ שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה.

to the holiness of the flow and the power in the sacred space of the World of Beriah.

וְכֵן אֵינוֹ דוֹמָה קִדְשֵׁת הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְבְּרִיאָה לְקִדְשֵׁת הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְיָצִירָה

Similarly, the holiness of the sacred space of Beriah is not at all similar to the holiness of the sacred space of Yetzirah.

וְכֵן הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְיָצִירָה לְהַמָּקוֹם דְּעֵשְׂיָה

And so too, the sacred space of Yetzirah is not at all similar to the holiness of the sacred space of Asiyah.

וְנִבְחָן קִדְשֵׁת הַמָּקוֹם דַּכ"א לְפִי עֶרֶךְ מַעֲלֵת הַמְּצִיאוֹת וְהָעוֹלָם
שְׁבִתּוֹכוֹ

The holiness of the sacred space of each of them is distinct, commensurate with its existential level and the world within it,

ואינו נכנס כל תחתון בגבול המקום דהעליון מאומה.

so that no lower level ever enters the boundaries of the higher level.

והוא ע"ד שאמרו רז"ל ב"ב ע"ה א' שהקב"ה עושה לכל צדיק וצדיק חופה לפי כבודו

This is comparable to what our Sages said in Tractate *Bava Batra* 75a – that the Holy One, blessed is He, makes a canopy over each and every righteous person according to His⁹ honor,

וכל אחד ואחד נכזה מחפתו של חברו.

and "each of them is scalded by the canopy of his friend."

This is not out of jealousy, which is a despicable trait, but rather out of a recognition that each person is rewarded according to his achievements, and the fact that someone else managed to achieve what he didn't causes the person to burn with regret.¹⁰

וזהו ג"כ מה שנאמר במשה רבנו ע"ה מאחז פני כסא פרשז עליו עננו (איוב כ')

This is also the intention of the verse (Job 26:9) said regarding Moshe our Teacher, peace be upon him: "He grasped the front of the Throne; He spread out His radiance¹¹ over him."

ואמרו רז"ל סכה ה' א' אשתרבוני אשתרבוני ליה כסא ונקט ביה,

Our Sages declared (*Sukkah* 5a) "The Throne was drawn down for him, and he (Moses) took hold of it."¹²

כי הכסא הוא עולם הבריאה ושם היה השגת משה רבנו ע"ה

For the 'Throne' is the World of Beriah, and it was to there that our Teacher Moshe's grasp extended

בְּהִיבֵל קֹדֶשׁ הַקִּדְּשִׁים דְּבְרִיָּאָה כַּמ־שׁ הָאֲרִיזָ"ל בְּלִקוּטֵי שֵׁ"ס בְּרָכוֹת
(הוֹבָא בְּסֵפֶר אוֹר עֵינַיִם)

- Specifically to the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah, as the Arizal states in *Likutei Shas, Berachot* (cited in the work *Ohr Einayim*).

וְהָיָה מְקוֹמוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה גַּם בְּהִיּוּתוֹ בַּעוֹה"ז הַמְּקוֹם
דְּהִבְרִיָּאָה מִמֶּשׁ

So Moshe's sacred space, even when he was in this world, was actually the sacred space of Beriah.

(וְעַ' בְּסֵפֶר אֵילָמָה לַהֲרַמ"ק ז"ל מ"א ת"א פ' כ"ב דף ט' ע"ב)

(See Ramak's *Eilimah, ma'ayan 1, tamar 1, chapter 22 p. 9b*).

וּלְכֵן נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ כִּי הַמְּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר אַתָּה עוֹמֵד עָלָיו אֲדַמַּת קֹדֶשׁ הוּא

Therefore, regarding him the verse (Exodus 3:5) states, "The place upon which you stand is holy ground,"

כִּי לַעוֹלָם הוּא הַמְּקוֹם לְפִי עֶרֶךְ מְדֻרְגָּת הַמְּצִיאוֹת שֶׁעוֹמֵד בּוֹ.

for it is always so that the sacred space is distinguished according to that which resides in it.

Accordingly, since Moshe Rabbeinu was on the level of the World of Beriah, the place upon which he stood became holy ground.

וְכַשֵּׁם שֶׁנִּבְדָּל כ"א מִחֲבֵרוֹ בְּמְצִיאוֹתוֹ כֵּן נִבְדָּל כ"א מִחֲבֵרוֹ בְּמְקוֹמוֹ.

And just as every person is separated from another as a fact of simple existence, so is he separated from him in terms of sacred space.

וּבְכָל מְקוֹם שֶׁהוּא מְקוֹמוֹ עִמּוֹ, וְאִינוּ נִכְנָס כָּל אֶחָד בְּמְקוֹם חֲבֵרוֹ
מֵאוֹמָה

And wherever he is, his sacred space is with him, and no person can enter into the sacred space of his friend at all.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּעֵינֵינוּ בְּעֵינֵי הַצְמָצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי.

And so too is it as regards our subject – the idea of the *tzimtzum*, which is the second revelation:

הַגֵּם שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם הַכּוֹלֵל בְּתוֹכּוֹ אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

Even though it is the sacred space that includes within it all of the worlds,

וְכָל הַמְצִיאוּיוֹת אֲשֶׁר מֵעוֹלָם וְעַד עוֹלָם הֵנָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּתוֹכּוֹ שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם לְכֻלָּם.

and all the forms of existence from world to world – all of them are within it, for it is the sacred space of them all –

עכ"ז הֵנָּה הוּא נִבְחַן לְכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם וּלְכָל מְצִיאוֹת וּמְצִיאוֹת שֶׁבּוֹ לְמָקוֹם בַּפֶּנִּי"ע

nevertheless, it is distinct for each and every world, and for every existing entity within it, as its own discrete sacred space,

חֲלוּק בַּמַּדְרָגָה וְנִבְדָּל מִזּוּלָּתוֹ.

with its own separate spiritual level, and distinct from any other entity.

וְלֹא עוֹד אֵלָּא שֶׁעֵקֶר הַצְמָצוּם גּוֹפֶה בְּמָה שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי

Furthermore, the primary characteristic of the *tzimtzum* itself, since it is the second revelation,

הֵנָּה הוּא בְּאֵמֶת לְמַעַלָּה מִכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

is that it transcends *all* of the worlds.

כִּי הֵנָּה אִמְרָנוּ שֶׁהַצְמָצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם

For we stated that the *tzimtzum* is sacred space

הנה הוא הכח הנושא את כל המציאות והוא שפע נשפע ממנו
ית"ש וכנ"ל.

**which is the power that sustains all of existence; and it is an
outflow from Him, may His Name be blessed, as explained
above.**

ויש לכל שפע התחלה וראשית שממנו מתפשט ומתגלה.

**Now every outflow has a beginning and a starting point from
which it emerges and is revealed.**

ואותו התחלה וראשית הוא שרשו והוא גבוה ונעלם

**And this beginning and starting point is the root of the outflow,
and it is lofty and concealed in this particular case,**

כי הוא יציאתו מהמאציל א"ס ית"ש.

since it emerges from the Emanator, the blessed *Ein Sof*.

ואותו השרש הוא העולם דקו וצמצום עצמו שהוא למעלה מהכל

**This root is the world of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* itself, which
transcends everything,**

והוא אשר נקרא בשם אור הקדמון וטהירו עלאה

**and is called the *Avir Kadmon* primordial space and *Tehiru*
Ila'ah the supernal purity.**

כי שם הוא תקף האור דא"ס ועליו נאמר הנה מקום אתי כנ"ל

**For that is where the potency of the *Ohr Ein Sof* is manifested,
and it is in reference to this that the verse states "There is a
sacred space with Me..." as mentioned above.**

כי הוא רק עם המאציל עצמו למעלה מהכל.

**For it is only with the Emanator Himself, transcending
everything.**

It cannot be said to be *with* anything else, since it is incomparably loftier than any other emanated or created entity.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּמְכַשׁ"כ [בְּמַכְלֵל שְׁכֵן] בְּעֵנֶן אֹר הַקוֹ אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִכְנָס
בְּתוֹךְ הַצִּמְצוּם

And similarly, but all the more so, regarding the light of the *kav* that spreads forth and enters into the *tzimtzum* – this is called the *reishit hakav* that 'touches' the *Ein Sof* and transcends the *tzimtzum* at its top end, and terminates in the void at its bottom
end**13** –

וּמִמֶּנּוּ יֵצֵא וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם.

and from it from the *kav* all of the worlds emerge and are made.

הִנֵּה עֶקֶר אֹר הַקוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הוּא עוֹמֵד לְמַעַל מֵהַכָּל

Thus the primary aspect of the light of the *kav* stands above everything.

וְהוּא עִם הַצִּמְצוּם הַמְּקִיפוֹ עוֹלָם גָּמוּר בִּפְנֵי עַ

And so the *kav*, together with the *tzimtzum*, constitute a complete discrete world.

כִּי הֵם כְּלוּלִים מֵעוֹלָם מָלֵא וְהוּא עוֹמֵד בְּכָל עֶקֶר לְמַעַל מֵהַכָּל

For they comprise a full world, which in its primary nature transcends everything,

ר"ל לְמַעַל גַּם מֵאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

meaning to say, above even Adam Kadmon.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא בִּשְׁם בִּפְנֵי עַ שֶׁהוּא בִּשְׁם קוֹ וְצִמְצוּם כִּי הוּא עוֹלָם
בִּפְנֵי עַ וְהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי בִּפְנֵי עַ:

And this is why the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* are referred to as being 'discrete,' because they are a distinct world. This is the

second revelation.

וְהִנֵּה בְּתַחֲתִיתוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּתַחֲתִית הַקּוֹ בְּהִקְצָה הַתַּחֲתוֹן שְׁלוֹ

The above was regarding the beginning and starting point of the outflow. **But the endpoint** of the initial outflow, **which is the bottom part of the *kav*, at its bottom end,**

הִנֵּה שֵׁם מִתְחִיל אָדָם קַדְמוֹן וְכִמוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוּ בְּעֵגְלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עָנָף ב'

that is where Adam Kadmon begins, as we explained in *Igulim v'Yosher, anaf* 2.¹⁴

וְנִמְשָׁךְ וַיּוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ בְּכָל הָעֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת שֶׁבּוֹ שֶׁהֵם מִכְתָּר עַד
הַמַּלְכוּת

It Adam Kadmon is drawn down from and emerges from it from the *kav* once it enters into the *chalal* with all its ten levels – from *keter* to *malchut* –

וְעוֹמֵד כָּל אָדָם קַדְמוֹן לְמַטָּה מֵעֵקֶר הַקּוֹ כֻּלּוֹ.

so that all of Adam Kadmon is situated below the primary aspect of the entire *kav*.

וְהִנֵּה הָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן הַגָּם כִּי בְּעֶרְךָ עֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה הִנֵּה הוּא עוֹלָם
מָלֵא וְשָׁלֵם

Now Adam Kadmon, although it is in itself is a full and complete world,

מִכָּל בְּחִי' הִי' סִפִּי' כֻּלָּם אָמֵנָם בְּעֶרְךָ הָאֲצִילוּת

comprising all the ten *sefirot*, nevertheless, in comparison to Atzilut,

הִנֵּה נִבְחַן כָּל הִי"ס [הָעֵשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת] דָּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן רַק לְבְּחִי' הַג' ר'
[ג' רָאשִׁין]

all the ten *sefirot* of Adam Kadmon are regarded as the three 'head' *sefirot* –

שֶׁהֵם הַכַּח"ב לְבַד וְכָל הָעֶשְׂרָה הַסְּפִי שָׁבוּ הֵם הָעֶשֶׂר הַסְּפִירוֹת
אֲשֶׁר בַּהַכַּח"ב גּוֹפָה

***keter, chochmah, binah* only, and all ten *sefirot* therein in Adam Kadmon are the ten *sefirot* of *k'cha"b* [*keter, chochmah, binah*] itself**

כִּי כ"א הוּא כָּלּוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר כְּנוֹדָע

since each of them each of those *sefirot* is comprised of all ten, as is known,

וְכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא נִבְחַן כְּנִגְדּוֹ רַק לְבַחֲי הַזֵּה תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת

whereas all of Atzilut is regarded in comparison as merely the seven lower *sefirot*

שֶׁהֵם ז"א וּמַלְכוּת הַכְּלָלִיִּים.

which are *ze'ir anpin* comprising the six *sefirot* from *chesed* to *yesod* and *malchut* in a macro sense.

וְהַא"ק הוּא בְּעֶרְךָ הָאֲצִילוֹת בְּבַחֲי א"א [אַרִּיךְ אֲנָפִין] וְאו"א [אֲבָא וְאִמָּא] הַכְּלָלִיִּים

Thus A"K Adam Kadmon compared to Atzilut is the aspect of the macro-level *Arich Anpin*, the lowest aspect of *keter*, and *Abba chochmah* and *Imma binah*,

וְכִמּוֹ שִׁיתִּבְאָר עֲנִינוֹ הַפְּרָצוּפִים לְקִמּוֹ שְׁעַר ז'.

as will be explained later in Sha'ar 7 regarding the *partzufim* the clusters of interacting *sefirot*.

וְהִנֵּה מִתְחִיל הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא ז"א וּמַלְכוּת

Now the World of Atzilut, which is primarily *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* (whereas the ten *sefirot* of A"K are regarded as only *keter*,

chochmah, binah in the macro-sense, as just explained) **begins**

מתחת עקרו דהא"ק לגמרי שהוא מתחת דא"א ואו"א.

below the primary aspect of Adam Kadmon, i.e. below *arich anpin, abba and imma* (the *partzufim* of *keter, chochmah, binah*, as just explained).

אמנם הוא כי הנה אותן הא"א ואו"א

Indeed it is the case that *arich anpin, abba and imma*

הנה הם מתפשטים בהנה"י שלהם שהוא מבחי' הטבור ולמטה
שבהם,

extend downward into their *nh"i netzach, hod, yesod*, which is from the aspect of their 'navel' and below,

In Kabbalah, based on the verse (Genesis 1:26), "Let us make man in Our image, in Our likeness," the human form is used as an analogy for understanding the structure and the dynamics of the spiritual worlds, as we know. As the author will soon explain, the 'navel' represents a dividing point between the upper half of Adam Kadmon and its lower half.

Now although the primary aspects of *arich anpin, abba and imma* end at the dividing line, the 'navel,' nevertheless when it arose in His will to reveal them somewhat, then *arich anpin, abba and imma* extended as a radiance into their *nh"i* which then become clothed within Atzilut, as will be explained.

ומתלבשים בהז"א ומלכות שהוא האצילות.

and they *nh"i* then become clothed in macro-level *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* of A"K, which is Atzilut.

כי כן הוא הסדר לעולם שכל תחתון נעשה ויוצא מהנה"י דהעליון

For this is always the order – every lower level is made by, and emerges from, the *nh"i* of the higher level,

ומתלבש הנה"י דהעליון בהתחתון ונעשה בו לעצם מעצמיו ובשר
מבשרו

and the *nh"i* of the higher level is clothed in the lower level, becoming 'bone of its bone and flesh of its flesh' – paraphrasing Genesis 2:23 (regarding the creation of Eve from Adam). However, the intention here may be to translate עצם here as 'essence,' rather than 'bone.' Thus the *nh"i* of the higher level becomes the essence (and outer layer, the 'flesh') of the lower level.

וע"י זה הנה נחשב הא"ק עם האצילות לבחי' פרצוף אחד

Accordingly, A"K and Atzilut can be thought of as a single *partzuf*,

אלא שמטבורו ולמעלה נקרא בשם א"ק ומטבורו ולמטה נקרא
בשם אצילות.

except that from the 'navel' and above is called A"K, and from the navel and down is called Atzilut.

אך עכ"פ הוא כי עקר הא"ק עצמו הוא למעלה מהאצילות לגמרי

But nevertheless the primary aspect of A"K itself transcends Atzilut completely,

ואינו מתחיל האצילות אלא רק למטה מעקרו דהא"ק שהוא
למטה מהטבור שבו.

so that Atzilut doesn't even begin until below the primary aspect of A"K, i.e., below its 'navel.'

וכן הוא עד"ז במכש"כ בהעולמות בי"ע

The same is true, and all the more so, regarding the worlds of BiY"A –

כי הנה אחר שמסתיים האצילות שהוא כלו אלהות גמור

because only after Atzilut, which is all Godliness, is complete

הָנָה נַעֲשֶׂה שָׁם מָסַךְ וּמַחֲצֵה.

then a screen (*masach*) and a 'fence' is made to separate Atzilut from BiY" A.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר עֲנִינוּ הַמָּסַךְ בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסִפּוֹר הַכָּלָלִים כָּלֵל י"ט.

The concept of a *masach* is explained in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 19.

וְעִי"ז נִתֵּן אֶפְשָׁרוֹת לְמַצִּיאת הַנִּבְרָאִים מִשָּׁם וּלְמַטָּה,

It is via this *masach* that the existence of created beings, and from thereon down, is made possible.

וְתַחַת הַמָּסַךְ מִתְחִיל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה

The World of Beriah begins below this *masach*,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ כָּל שִׁפְעַת מְצִיאוֹתוֹ וְהַתְּהוּוֹתוֹ רַק דֶּרֶךְ הַמָּסַךְ,

and all of the flow animating its existence and its coming into being is exclusively through the *masach*,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ עִי"ז רַק תְּמַצִּית הָאֶרֶה לְבַד מִהֶאֱצִילוֹת

and only a distillation of the radiance from Atzilut is drawn down through it.

אֲמָנָם בְּאוֹתוֹ הַתְּמַצִּית הָאֶרֶה נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּלוּ.

Nevertheless, from that distillation of the radiance from Atzilut, filtering through the *masach*, the entire World of Beriah is produced.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל הַסֵּדֶר וְהַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּהֶאֱצִילוֹת

And it is fashioned according to the entire arrangement and the details of Atzilut,

כִּי נִחָתָם מִהֶאֱצִילוֹת כְּמוֹ מַחוֹתָם לְנִחָתָם.

since it is stamped with the seal from Atzilut, as from a seal into the sealed i.e. like the seal of a signet ring pressed into wax, as explained in *Sha'ar* 4:5**.**

וכן עד"ז מבריא להיצירה כי נעשה מסך תחת עולם הבריא.

And similarly from Beriah to Yetzirah – a *masach* is fashioned beneath the World of Beriah, separating Beriah from Yetzirah

ושם תחת המסך נוצר עולם היצירה מהבריא כמו מחותם לנחתם.

and there, under the *masach*, the World of Yetzirah is formed from Beriah in the same manner as the process outlined above – as from a seal into the sealed.

אמנם כל שפעת מציאותו הוא נמשך ג"כ רק מהאצילות לעולם,

Nevertheless, the entire flow animating its existence is also always drawn exclusively from Atzilut,

אלא שהוא דרך כל עולם הבריא ודרך המסך אשר בין הבריא להיצירה.

except that this is via the World of Beriah and through the *masach* between Beriah and Yetzirah.

וכן עד"ז בהמציאות דכל עולם העשיה

And in the same way with the existence of the World of Asiyah,

כי נעשה מסך בין היצירה להעשיה

because a *masach* is made between Yetzirah and Asiyah,

ושם תחת המסך מתחיל כל עולם העשיה

and there, below the *masach*, the World of Asiyah begins

ונמשך כל שפעת מציאותה ג"כ רק מהאצילות תמיד

and the entire flow animating its existence is also always drawn exclusively from Atzilut,

אֵלָא שֶׁהוּא דֶּרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה וְדֶרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה

except that this is via the entire World of Beriah and via the entire World of Yetzirah,

וְגַם דֶּרֶךְ הַמָּסַךְ אֲשֶׁר מִתַּחַת לַהַיְצִירָה וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִי"ז כָּל עוֹלָם
הַעֲשִׂיָּה

and through the *masach* under Yetzirah. And in this way the entire World of Asiyah is made,

בְּכָל הַסֵּדֶר וְהַפְּרָטִים כְּמוֹ עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה כִּי נִחְתָּם מִהַיְצִירָה כְּמוֹ
מִחוּתָם לְנִחְתָּם.

with the entire arrangement and the details like Yetzirah, since it is sealed from Yetzirah, as from a seal into the sealed.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הִנֵּה עוֹמְדִים כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם זֶה לְמַטָּה מִזֶּה
לְגַמְרִי

Thus it turns out that all of the worlds are situated one completely below the other with no overlap –

כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא לְמַטָּה לְגַמְרִי מִהָעֲלִיוֹן שְׁעָלָיו.

every lower level is totally below the level above it.

עוֹלָם הַצְמָצוּם וְהָקוּ שֶׁהוּא הָאֵוִיר קַדְמוֹן וְהִטְהִירוּ עֲלָאָה הוּא
לְמַעְלָה מִהָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

Thus the World of the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, which is the *Avir Kadmon* and *Tehiru Ila'ah*, fully transcends Adam Kadmon,

וְאָדָם קַדְמוֹן הָעֶקְרִי הוּא לְמַעְלָה לְגַמְרִי מִהָאֲצִילוֹת

and the primary aspect of Adam Kadmon fully transcends Atzilut,

וְהָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא לְמַעַלָּה לְגַמְרֵי מֵהִבְרִיָּאָה וְהִבְרִיָּאָה הוּא לְמַעַלָּה
לְגַמְרֵי מֵהִצְרָה

**and Atzilut fully transcends Beriah, and Beriah fully
transcends Yetzirah,**

וְהִצְרָה הוּא לְמַעַלָּה לְגַמְרֵי מַעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה.

and Yetzirah fully transcends the World of Asiyah.

וְכָל אֱלוֹ הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם הָרִי בְּאָרְנוּ לְעֵיל שְׁעַר ד'

And regarding all of these worlds, we explained in *Sha'ar 4*

כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם מֵהָה' בְּחִי' גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְפָּשֵׁט מִגְּלוּי לְגְּלוּי עַד
סוֹף כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ

**that they are from the five aspects of His revelations, which
spread forth from revelation to revelation to the end of all
existence.**

וְהָרִי הֵווּ הָה' גְּלוּיָם כ"א זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה.

**Thus there are five revelations and each of them is one above
the other.**

אֲמָנָם הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם מִתְפָּשֵׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים זב"ז בְּהֶאֱרָתָם
עכ"פ.

**Nevertheless, all of them spread forth and become clothed one
in the other, at least via their radiances.**

כִּי הֵנָּה הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּבְּחִי' א"ס

**Now from the first revelation, His revelation as *Ein Sof* i.e. the
*Ohr Ein Sof***

הֵנָּה מִמֶּנּוּ עֲצָמוּ הָרִי נִמְשָׁךְ הָקוּ וְכוּ כָּל בְּחִי' הַצְמָצוּם

from this is drawn the *kav* and all the aspects of the *tzimtzum*,

הרי אִמְרָנוּ שֶׁשֶׁם הוּא הַשָּׂרֵשׁ דִּהְשַׁפֵּעַ וְכֵחַ הַנוֹשָׂא אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת
בָּלֵם

for as we said, that is where the root of the flow and power that sustains all of the worlds.

וְאוֹתוֹ הַשָּׂרֵשׁ הֵנָּה הוּא הַרְשִׁימָה אֹר שְׁנִשְׂאָר מְאוּר א"ס שֶׁהִיָּה שֶׁם
קִדָּם שְׁנִסְתַּלַּק

And that root is the *reshima* the trace of the light that remains from the *Ohr Ein Sof* that was there prior to being removed from the *chalal* via the *tzimtzum*.

וְכֵן הוּא מְשַׁפֵּעַ תָּמִיד מְאוֹתוֹ אֹר א"ס שְׁלִמְעָלָה

It the *reshima* is continuously influenced by that same *Ohr Ein Sof* above

וְקָשׁוּר וּמִיָּחָד תָּמִיד בְּמִקְוֹרוֹ.

and is always bound to and united with its source.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי כָּל הַקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי

Thus it turns out that the entire *kav* and the *tzimtzum*, which constitute the second revelation,

הֵנָּה כָּל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ הוּא הָאֶרֶת אֹר דְּאוּר א"ס עֲצֻמוֹ שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי
הָרִאשׁוֹן.

its entire existence is the radiance of the *Ohr Ein Sof* itself, which is the first revelation.

וְהָרִי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הַגִּלּוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּהִגְלִילוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי לְעוֹלָם.

Hence the first revelation always irradiates the second one,

כִּי הָרִי כָּל הַקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי

for the entire *kav* and *tzimtzum*, which constitute the second revelation,

הנה היא רק התפשטות הארה מאורו עצמו.

is merely the spreading out of a radiance from His light itself.

וכן הוא עד"ז בהגילוי השני עם השלישי שהוא אדם קדמון.

And similarly as regards the second revelation in relation to the third, which is Adam Kadmon,

כי הרי אמרנו שכל המציאות דהאדם קדמון

for as we stated the entire existence of Adam Kadmon

הנה הוא נמשך ויוצא מהקצה התחתון דהקו וממנו נעשה כל מציאותו.

is drawn down and emerges from the bottom end of the kav, from which its entire existence is produced.

והנה עומד הקצה התחתון דהקו בהא"ק לעולם ומיחד עמו

Now the bottom end of the kav is always situated within A"K and is unified with it,

כשרש עם האילן ומשפע ממנו תמיד.

like a tree-root to a tree which is continually nourished thereby.

והרי מתפשט ומתלבש הקו שהוא הגלוי השני בהאדם קדמון שהוא הגלוי השלישי לעולם.

Thus the kav, the second revelation, diffuses into Adam Kadmon, which is always the third revelation.

וכן הוא עד"ז בא"ק עם האצילות שהוא הגלוי הרביעי.

And similarly with A"K and Atzilut, which is the fourth revelation,

כי הרי אמרנו שכל האצילות הוא נחשב לחלק ממנו ממש

for as we said, the entire Atzilut is regarded as a part thereof of A"K

כי הוא המציאות אשר מהטבור ולמטה שבו.

– it is the existence that extends from the 'navel' of A"K and down –

ונחשבים שניהם לכללות פְּרָצוּף אֶחָד

so that both of them are regarded as a single macro-*partzuf*:

זה מהטבור ולמעלה וזה מהטבור ולמטה וכנ"ל.

this one A"K from the 'navel' and above, and the other one Atzilut from the 'navel' on down.

וכן הוא עד"ז ג"כ מהאצילות להעולמות בי"ע שהם מגלויי
החמישי

So too, in a similar manner from Atzilut to BiY"A, which comprise the fifth revelation.

כי הגם שאמרנו שיש מִסַּךְ ביניהם

For although we stated that there is a *masach* between them between Atzilut and BiY"A

אמנם הנה מתפשט הארת הד' תחתונות דהמלכות דאצילות

nevertheless, the four lowest *sefirot* of *malchut* of Atzilut spread forth

ויורד דרך המסך ומתלבש בהבריאָה ועומד שם לעולם

and descend, via the *masach*, to become clothed in Beriah where it is always situated,

וכמ"ש בשער כסא הכבוד ספ"א ובכ"מ.

as stated explicitly in *Sha'ar Kisei HaKavod* end of chapter 1,
and in a number of other places.

וכן הוא עד"ז מהבריאה ליצירה, ומהיצירה לעשיה

And so too, in a similar manner, from Beriah to Yetzirah, and
from Yetzirah to Asiyah,

כי נעשה כל תחתון מהד' תחתונות דהמלכות דהעליון,

for all lower levels are produced from the four lowest *sefirot* of
malchut of the higher level,

ונמשך הארת הד' תחתונות דהעליון ומתפשט ומתלבש בהתחתון

and a radiance from the four lowest *sefirot* of the higher level
diffuses into and becomes clothed in the lower level,

ונעשה בו לעצם מעצמיו ובשר מבשרו,

becoming 'bone of its bone and flesh of its flesh'

וכמו שיתבאר עוד ענין ההתלבשות למטה,

[this concept of *hitlavshut* – 'clothing' – will be explained more
below]

ועי"ז הנה הם כלם קשורים ומיוחדים זב"ז לעולם:

and in this way they are all bound together and united one with
the other forever.

והרי נתבאר לנו מכ"ז כי כל העולמות כלם

From all this it has become clear that for all the worlds,
without exception,

הנה עקרם הם זה למעלה מזה וזה למטה מזה

are arranged, in terms of their primary qualities, one above the
other, and one below the other with no overlap,

שֶׁעָקְרוּ וּמִדְרָגָתוֹ דָּכָל עָלִיוֹן הוּא לְמַעְלָה לְגַמְרֵי מֵהִתְחַתּוֹן.

so that the primary aspect and level of every higher world completely transcends the one below it.

אֲמָנָם הֵנָּה הֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים בְּהֶאֱרָתָם וּמִתְלַבְּשִׁים זָב"ז וְנִעְשִׂים עִי"ז
בְּכֶל אֶחָד,

Nevertheless, their radiances extend outward and become clothed within one another, making all of them unified thereby,

כִּי כָל הַמְצִיאוֹת דֵּהִתְחַתּוֹן וְכָל קִיּוּמוֹ וְחַיּוּתוֹ וְשִׁפְעוֹ וְכָל עֲנִיָּנוֹ הוּא
רַק מֵהֶאֱרָה דָּכָל עָלִיוֹן.

since the entire existence of the lower level, all of its continued survival, its animating force, its inflow, and all matters associated with it are merely from a radiance of the level above it.

וְהֵם כָּלָם מְכַלְלוֹת הָה' גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם מְאֻמָּתוֹ
הַנִּעְלָמָה

And all of them stem from His five macro-revelations in which He is revealed in His true concealed Being,

וְיֵרֵד וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִמִּדְרָגָה לְמִדְרָגָה שֶׁהוּא מָה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ מִגְּלוֹי לְגְלוֹי

which descends and spreads forth from level to level – i.e. what is drawn down from revelation to revelation –

מֵרוֹם מַעְלָה אֲשֶׁר בְּחִבּוּן עֵזוֹ דָּאוֹר א"ס ית"ש

from the very loftiest heights "there where His hidden strength is" (Habbakuk 3:4),

עַד גְּלוּיֵי הִתְחַתּוֹן שְׁבִהֵעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

until His revelation below in the worlds of BiY" A.

וְנִמְשָׁךְ וּמִיחָד אוֹרוֹ בְּכָלָם, וּמִזֶּה הֵם נִמְצָאִים וְנִעְשִׂים,

He draws down and merges His light into all of them, and by virtue thereof they exist and are made,

אֵלָא שְׁאוּרוֹ הַנִּמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם הוּא בִּכ"א לְפִי מִדְרָגָתוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו,

except that His light is drawn into each of them into each World according to its proper level.¹⁵

אָבֵל עַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי אוּרוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ בְּכֻלָּם בְּאַחַדוֹת אֶחָד,

But nevertheless, His light is drawn into all of them in one unified stream

וְכָלָם תְּלוּיִם בְּאוּרוֹ וְעוֹמְדִים רַק עָלָיו.

and all of them are dependent upon His light continue to stand only by virtue thereof.¹⁶

כִּי בְּזֶה הוּא מְהִירָה הַכֹּל וּמְנַהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל וְעוֹשֶׂה אֶת כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים.

For in this way He brings everything into being and guides all things, and carries out all activities.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיֵּדַעַת הַיּוֹם וְהַשַּׁבָּת אֶל לִבְבְּךָ

This is the import of the statement in the verses (Deuteronomy 4:39) "You shall know this day and take to your heart

כִּי יְהוָה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים בְּשָׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל הָאָרֶץ מִתַּחַת אֵין עוֹד,

that God is the Lord in heaven above and on earth below; there is none other."

שִׁמְעַיִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד

"Hear O Israel, God our Lord, God is One (Deuteronomy 6:4)

בְּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעֹלָם וָעֶד:

Blessed is the Name of His glorious Kingdom forever!¹⁷

Footnotes

1. Chapter 3 ff [↩](#)
2. Makover. [↩](#)
3. See *Mevo She'arim* 13a that each higher world is completely beyond the world below it. This is true as regards all three aspects – *makifim*, *igulim* and *yosher*. (*Meir HaLeshem*). [↩](#)
4. We have translated **מקום** here as 'sacred space,' to distinguish it from the usual translation as 'place,' which has only geographical connotations. [↩](#)
5. *Meir HaLeshem* (fn. 203) explains that this is the *reshimu* that remains after the *tzimtzum*, and each world that unfolds (as the *kav* descends) is sustained by a different aspect of the *reshimu*. [↩](#)
6. Pesach Hagadah, near the beginning. [↩](#)
7. *Bereishit Rabba* chap 68:9 "He is the 'place' of the world, but His world is not His place" [↩](#)
8. As noted above, *Meir HaLeshem* (fn. 203) explains that the *reshimu* that remains after the *tzimtzum* is what sustains the worlds, and each world that unfolds (as the *kav* descends) is sustained by a different aspect of the *reshimu*. [↩](#)
9. This follows Maharsha's explanation, that the honor is Hashem's, not the Tzaddik's: according to the extent that Heaven became honored through the service of the Tzaddik in this world, will his reward be in the World-to-Come. [↩](#)
10. Cf. *Mesilat Yesharim* chap. 4, 1 [↩](#)
11. here is a word made from two other words – *piresh ziv*: פרשז
He spread His radiance – the radiance of the *Shechinah* –
[↩](#) .over Moses

12. The Talmud is discussing a Beraita where R. Yose declares that the *Shechinah* never descended below (to the lower worlds), and Moshe and Eliyahu never ascended on high, based on the verse (Psalms 116:16): "The heavens are Hashem's, and the earth He gave to man" (implying that man never ascended to the heavens). The Talmud presents various Amoriam arguing against R. Yose's position, and his responses, including the one mentioned in the text above. [↩](#)
13. See *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar 1, anaf 2*: [↩](#)
14. This is rather puzzling, since the Arizal does not seem to explain it this way. See *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar 1 anaf 2* where he explains that the *kav* enters the *chalal* (the void) and then circles around the inner perimeter of the void, after which it circles again making another circle within the first one, and so on, until ten circles are complete. These are the ten sefirot of *iggulim* of *Adam Kadmon*. Accordingly, we have to assume that the author is referring to the *reishit hakav*, the first section of the *kav* before it enters the *chalal*. It is the bottom end of the *reishit hakav* that enters the *chalal*. [↩](#)
15. Makover notes that this is the 'sacred space' of each world. [↩](#)
16. This is the concept of the inter-inclusion of all the levels of light and their becoming clothed within one another (Makover). [↩](#)
17. This declaration first appears in the *Mishnah, Yoma 3:8*. Makover notes that the *Shema* and *Baruch Shem* verses correspond to the higher and lower unity mentioned in *Zohar I, 18b*. [↩](#)

Chapter 2 — Two aspects of illumination: the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent light).

Two aspects that equal four.

Multidimensional Relationships

הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ הָאֶרֶץ כָּל אֹר עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן
בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן,

This 'clothing' (*hitlavshut*) that we mentioned, where a radiance of the light of the entire upper world clothes itself in the lower world

הִנֵּה פְּרִטִּיָּהֶם הֵם רַבִּים אֵין חֶקֶר, וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר שְׂרָשֵׁי הַפְּרָטִים
בְּזֶה בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ לְקֶמֶן.

– the details thereof are so numerous as to be unfathomable, as will be explained in our discussion of the origins of the details later on.

אך כָּלֹּת הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הִנֵּה הֵם בְּבַחֲי שְׁתֵּים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע.

But in general the concept of *hitlavshut* is divided into 'two that are four.'¹

וְהַשְׁתֵּים הוּא אֶחָד מִבְּפָנִים וְאֶחָד מִבַּחוּץ,

The two main categories are one from the inside and one from the outside. In *Mishnah* 'the inside' is the private domain, such as one's house, and 'the outside' is the public domain, such as the street or the market-place. Here, however, the author uses these terms for two types of illumination, as he will explain shortly.

וּבְכָל א' מֵהֶם הוּא בְּשֵׁתֵי בַחֲי, אֶחָד לְפִי מִדְּרָגָתוֹ וְאֶחָד לְמַעְלָה
מִמִּדְּרָגָתוֹ,

And each of them is sub-divided into two aspects: one, at its level; and the other, above its level.

וְהָרִי הֵם אַרְבַּע.

Thus they are four.

וְהַשְׁתִּים אֲשֶׁר מִבְּפָנִים וּמִבַּחוּץ הוּא,

The two main aspects – from inside and from outside are:

כִּי הֵנָּה בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם וְכֵן בְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף,

in each world and in each spiritual profile (*partzuf*)

הֵנָּה יֵשׁ בּוֹ ב' מִיְּנֵי אוֹרוֹת כְּלָלִיִּים אֶחָד אֹר פְּנִימִי שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד בּוֹ
מִבְּפָנִים לְהַגּוֹף,

there are two types of light in general: the inner illumination (*ohr pnimi*) that resides inside the body,

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה פְּנִימִית שָׁבוֹ,

this is the *neshama* the soul internalized within him,

וְאֶחָד אֹר מְקִיר שְׁמַקִּיר עָלָיו מִבַּחוּץ.

and the other is the surrounding light (*ohr makif*) that envelops him from without.

וְאֵלּוּ הֵב' מִיְּנֵי אוֹרוֹת הֵנָּה מִשְׁרָשָׁם הֵם אֶחָד,

Now these two types of light are one in their root,

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר נִכְנָס וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ אֹר עוֹלָם עָלִיוֹן,

because when the light of the higher world enters and clothes itself in the lower world,

וְכֵן אֹר פְּרָצוֹף עָלִיוֹן בְּהֶעָלָם וְהַפְּרָצוֹף שְׁלֵמָה מִמֶּנּוּ לְהַנִּשְׁמָה
שָׁבוֹ,

and similarly, when the light of the upper *partzuf* the spiritual profile clothes itself in the world and the *partzuf* below it, as the *neshama* soul within it,

הנה נחלק האור לב' חלקים – חלק אחד נכנס ומתלבש מבפנים,

then the light is divided into two sections – one part enters into and is clothed inwardly,

וחלק אחד היותר גדול הוא נשאר מבחוץ ומקיפו מסביב.

and the other greater part remains outside it, enveloping it all around.

ומשום שמשרשם הם אחד חשקם הוא תמיד להדבק זה בזה,

But because in their origin they these lights are one, their desire is always to cleave to one another,

ומשלח הפנימי את הארתו מבפנים לחוץ להדבק עם האור מקיף.

so the inner aspect (the *ohr pnimi*) sends its radiance from within to the outside to cleave to the enveloping light (the *ohr makif*),

והאור מקיף משלח את הארתו מבחוץ לפנים להדבק עם האור פנימי,

and the *ohr makif* sends its radiance from outside inwards to cleave to the *ohr pnimi*.

ועל ידי זה נתמלא כל הגוף מאור העליון מבית ומבחוץ

In this way, the entire body becomes filled with supernal light, inside and out.

והוא הנשמה שבו, ונעשה על ידי זה כלו חי.

And this is the *neshama* the soul within them, by which it becomes fully alive.

וְהָרִי הֵם שְׁתֵּי בְּחִי' שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ כָּל עֲלִיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

Thus there are two aspects of clothing of any upper in the lower:

אֶחָד אוֹר פְּנִימִי וְאֶחָד אוֹר מְקִיף, וְהֵם הַשְּׁתֵּי שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ.

one is the *ohr pnimi*, and the other is the *ohr makif*.

אֲמָנָם כָּל אֶחָד מֵאלוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא נִחְלָק גַּם כֵּן לִב' וְהָרִי הֵן אַרְבַּע.

Nevertheless, each of them is subdivided into two, so that there are four aspects in total.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הֵתְלַבְּשׁוֹת דְּכָל אֶחָד הֵנָּה הוּא בְּב' בְּחִי',

That is to say, the enclothing of each of them is expressed in two aspects:

אֶחָד הוּא כִּי נִתְצַמֵּצַם עַל יְדֵי יְרִידָתוֹ בַּמָּקוֹם הַתְּחַתּוֹן לְמִדְרָגַת הַתְּחַתּוֹן עֲצָמוֹ

1) The higher level becomes reduced due to its descent to the place of the lower level itself,

וּמִתְיַחַד עֲמוֹ בְּמִדְרָגָתוֹ וְנִעְשָׂה בּוֹ לְעֶצֶם מַעֲצָמִיו וּבָשָׂר מִבָּשָׂרוֹ.

where it unites with the lower aspect on its level, becoming 'bone of its bone, and flesh of its flesh' as explained earlier.

וְהָרִי יוֹרֵד אוֹתוֹ הֵהָאֵרָה מִמִּדְרָגָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה

Thus, that radiance descends from its level above,

וְנִעְשָׂה לְמִדְרָגַת הַתְּחַתּוֹן אֲשֶׁר לְמַטָּה.

and adjusts to the level of the lower aspect.

וְהַשְּׁנִי הוּא כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ גַּם בְּהָאֵרֶת מִדְרָגָתוֹ הָעֲלִיוֹנָה אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה גַּם כֵּן.

2) The higher level permeates and becomes clothed within it within the lower aspect together with the radiance of its own level – the higher level.

ועומד אותו ההארה בהתחתון במדרגתו העליונה לעולם

And that upper radiance as it is clothed in the lower level always maintains its superior level.

ועל ידי זה הנה נתון כח ואפשרות בהתחתון לזכך את עצמו

In this way it empowers and enables the lower level to refine itself

ולהתעלה גם הוא למדרגת העליון.

and ascend to the rank of the higher level as well.

אמנם אותו החלק אור אשר עומד בהתחתון במדרגתו העליונה,

However, that aspect of the light that permeates the lower level while maintaining its own loftier rank

הנה הוא אינו עומד בו במצב אחד לעולם,

does not remain in the same state forever,

כי לפעמים נתעלם ואינו נכר אורו כלל, שאינו מתגלה בהתחתון מאומה,

because sometimes its light becomes concealed and is not recognizable at all, since it does not become revealed at all in the lower level, i.e. in the terms of the lower level

ועומד אז התחתון על מדרגתו לבד.

so that the lower level then remains alone at its level and is not affected by the illumination hidden within it.

ולפעמים הוא מאיר בו ומתגלה ומתעלה אז התחתון כלו על ידו.

But at other times the light of the higher level illuminates it the lower level and becomes revealed, and then all of the lower level ascends thereby.

וְהַגְלוּי הַזֶּה הוּא אֵינוֹ בְּשֹׁעוֹר קָצוֹב.

Now this illumination is not in a preset measure –

כִּי לִפְעָמִים מִתְרַבֶּה וְלִפְעָמִים מִתְמַעֵט וְכֵן מִתְנַהֵג תָּמִיד בְּחֹסֶר וְיֵתֵר,

at times it waxes and at other times it wanes. This is the manner of its conduct, always decreasing or increasing,

שֶׁלִּפְעָמִים יִחְסַר וְלִפְעָמִים יַעֲדִיף,

so that sometimes it is depleted and at other times, brimming over.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִמְשָׁךְ תְּהִלּוּכוֹת כָּל אֶחָד תָּמִיד בְּעוֹלָה וְיוֹרֵד,

In this way, the life-direction of each person unfolds, constantly ascending and descending,

כִּי הוּא תְּלוּי בָּזֶה, אִם שֶׁמִּתְעַלֵּם בּוֹ הָאוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן אוֹ שֶׁמִּתְגַּלֶּה וּמֵאִיר בּוֹ.

depending upon this: whether the supernal light is concealed within them, or whether it becomes revealed and illuminates them.

וְסִבַּת סִדְרֵי הַשְּׁנוּיִים הַלָּלוּ הוּא תְּלוּי גַם כֵּן בְּב' בְּחִי'.

And the reason for the sequences of these changes

כִּי לִפְעָמִים הוּא עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים,

is that sometimes this comes about through the actions of those below,

כִּי כִשֶּׁהַתַּחְתּוֹנִים הֵם זִכָּאִים אֲזַי מִתְגַּלֶּה וּמֵאִיר בָּהֶם הָאוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן

for when those below are worthy, then the supernal light is revealed and illuminates them,

ומתעלים הם וכל העולם בלו עמם.

and they ascend, together with the entire world.

וכשהתחתונים הם חזבים, אז מתעלים מהם האור העליון

And when those below are spiritually flawed, then the supernal light becomes concealed from them,

ויורדים הם וכן העולם בלו עמם

and they sink down, dragging down with them the entire world.

אך לפעמים הנה נעשה כל השנויים הללו

But sometimes all of these changes take place

ומתנהג כל זה רק על פי כבשי דרחמנא.

in a manner that is kept a secret by the Merciful One,²

והוא בהנהגתו הנעלמה יתברך שמו המנהיג את הכל תמיד
לכונתו התכליתית

Who, in His hidden Providence, guides everything always towards its ultimate purpose

אשר יתגלה בתכלית תקון האחרון,

that will be revealed at the completion of the final *tikun*

(rectification) presumably referring to the *tikun* that will take place before (or perhaps at the beginning of) the Messianic era.

Ramchal³ explains that Moses will return then to rectify the *erev rav* (those who made the golden calf).

ונעלם סבת וטעם השנויים הללו מכל בריה,

But the cause of and reason for all these changes is concealed from every created being,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּמְצָא מֵעֲנִינִים הִלְלוּ שְׁאֹמֵר הַקְדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא לַמֶּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ
עָלָיו הַשְּׁלוֹם

just as we find regarding similar matters when the Holy One, blessed is He, said to Moshe when He questioned the need for so much suffering:

שֶׁתֵּק כָּךְ עָלָה בְּמַחֲשַׁבָּה לִפְנֵי (מִנְחוֹת כט, ב).

"Silent! It arose thus in thought before Me" (*Tractate Menachot 29b*)

וְכֵן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּמַדָּה טוֹבָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַחֲנַנִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אֲחֹן
וְרַחֲמֵתִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אֲרַחֵם (בְּרָכוֹת ז, א)

A similar response applies to a benevolent quality, as it states "I will show grace to whom I choose to show grace, and I will be compassionate to those whom I choose to be compassionate" (*Berachot 7a*)

אִף עַל פִּי שְׂאִינוּ כִּדְאִי וְהִגּוֹן לָכֶּךָ.

even if the person is not worthy thereof.

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ שָׁם עַל זֶה בְּשִׁמוֹת רַבָּה (סוֹף פְּרָשָׁה מ"ה): אוֹצֵר גָּדוֹל שֶׁל
מִתְּנַת חֲנָם יֵשׁ לוֹ לְהַקְדֹּשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא,

And similarly the Sages declare in Midrash *Shemot Rabba* (*parsha 45, end*): The Holy One, blessed be He, has a giant storehouse of free gifts

שְׁמִי שְׂאִין לוֹ בְּשִׁכְרוּ עוֹשֶׂה לוֹ חֲנָם וְנוֹתֵן לוֹ מִזֶּה,

from which they give a free handout to a person who did not earn his reward.

וְנִעְשָׂה עֲנִינִים כְּאֵלוֹ הַרְבֵּה תָּמִיד בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר,

Many such instances are found in every generation throughout time.

וְהֵם מִכְבָּשֵׁי דִּוְחָמָנָא אֲשֶׁר נֶעְלַם סִבְתָּם מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה.

These are of the secrets of the Merciful One, the reasons for which are hidden from every created being.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ וּבָא מֵהַחֶלֶק הָעֶלְיוֹן דְּהַתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הָאוֹר

And all of this is drawn down from and originates in the upper aspect of the clothing of the light.

אֲשֶׁר הוּא לֹא נִתְצַמָּצֵם לְמַדְרַגַּת הַתְּחִתּוֹן כְּנִזְכָּר, וְלָכֵן הוּא מֵתְנַהֵג לְמַעְלָה מִן הַמַּדָּה,

From the aspect that is not reduced to the level of the lower entity, as mentioned above, and therefore its conduct transcends limitations –

שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִכָּל הַחֻקִּים וּגְבוּלִים דְּהַתְּחִתּוֹן, כִּי הוּא כָּלוּ רַק מֵאוֹר שֶׁל מַעְלָה,

it surpasses the laws and limitations of the lower aspect, since it is entirely from the supernal light,

וְלָכֵן נֶעְלַם סִבְתָּם מֵהַתְּחִתּוֹן לְגַמְרִי.

which is why it remains completely concealed from the lower beings.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאָר עַל כָּל פָּנִים כִּי הִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הָעֶלְיוֹן אֲשֶׁר בְּהַתְּחִתּוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא בִּשְׁתֵּים שֶׁהֵן אֲרָבַע,

Thus, in any event, we have explained that the 'enclothing' of the upper in the lower is 'two that are four' –

אֶחָד מִבְּפָנִים וְאֶחָד מִבַּחוּץ, וְהֵם אוֹר פְּנִימִי וְאוֹר מְקִיף

one from the inside, and one from the outside, i.e. the *ohr pnimi* and the *ohr makif*.

וְכָל אֶחָד מֵהֶם עוֹמֵד בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּב' בְּחִי',

And each of them manifests within the lower entity in two ways:

אֶחָד בְּצִמְצוּם וְאֶחָד שֶׁלֹּא בְּצִמְצוּם,

one where the light is reduced, and one where it is not reduced.

וּבִזְהָ הִנֵּה מִתְנַהֵּג כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן עַל יְדֵי הָעֲלִיוֹן.

In this manner every lower entity is steered by the higher aspect,

אִם בְּמִדָּה אִם לְמַעַלָּה מִן הַמִּדָּה וְכִנּוּזָּה.

whether in a limited manner, or in an unlimited manner, as mentioned.

וְנוֹדַע הוּא שֶׁכָּל אוֹר וְנִשְׁמָה הִנֵּה הוּא מֵה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י

Now, as is known, the light of every soul originates in one of the five aspects of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya* or *yechida*. These are five levels of soul or five levels of consciousness, regarding which the Arizal states: The five names of the soul (found in Scripture⁴) correspond to the five *partzufim* (spiritual profiles): *nefesh* corresponds to *malchut*; *ruach* to *tiferet*; *neshama* to *binah*; *chaya* to *chochmah*; *yechida* to *keter*.⁵

וְכֻלָּם הֵם בָּאִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִלְּמַעַלָּה.

All of them come from and are drawn down from above,

וּבְכָל אֶחָד הוּא הֵתְלַבְּשׁוֹת דְּשִׁתִּים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע שְׁאֲמִרְנוּ. וְהֵם כ' בְּחִי'.

and each of them is subject to enclothing in the manner of two that are four – two aspects of *ohr pnimi* and two aspects of *ohr makif* – as we stated. Thus there are twenty aspects in all.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי מָה שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁהַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת הוּא בְּשָׁתִּים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע
הוּא רַק בְּכָלְלוֹת,

**Thus it turns out that our statement that the modes of
enclothing are 'two that are four' is only in a general sense,**

אֲבָל בְּפִרְטוֹת הֵם מִתְפָּרְטִים לִכ'. וּבִאֲמֶת כִּי הֵם מִתְרַבִּים לַפִּרְטִים
אִין חֶקֶר,

**but specifically they are subdivided into twenty. And in truth
these multiply into innumerable details,**

וְכִמוּ שִׁיתִּבְאָר קֶצֶת בְּזֶה לְקֶמֶן. אֲמַנָּם כִּבֵּר אִמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פֶּרֶק א'.

**as will be explained somewhat below. Nevertheless, we already
stated in chapter 1 above**

שֶׁכָּל הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת מִהָעֲלִיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מִהָאֶרֶת הָעֲלִיוֹן

**that all enclothing of the upper level in the lower is only in
terms of the radiance of the upper level**

אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ מִהֶקְצֵה הַתְּחַתּוֹן שָׁבוּ.

**that spreads out and is drawn down from its the upper level's
lowest extremity.**

זֶה לְבַד הוּא אֲשֶׁר מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָיו וְקִיּוּמוֹ וְכָל
הַנְּהָגָתוֹ בְּנִזְכָּר,

**And it is this alone that becomes clothed in the being and the
sustained existence and conduct of the lower level, as
mentioned.**

אֲבָל עֲקֻרוֹ דְּכָל עוֹלָם עֲלִיוֹן וְכָל פְּרָצוּף עֲלִיוֹן

**Whereas the primary aspect of every higher world and
supernal spiritual profile (*partzuf*)**

הֵנָּה הוּא לְמַעֲלָה לְגִמְרֵי מִהִתְחַתּוֹן כָּלוּ וְכִנְזָכָר לְעִיל פֶּרֶק א':

completely transcends the lower aspect, as explained in chapter 1.

Footnotes

1. This is a fairly common Talmudic expression of categorizing various items Cf. *Mishnah Shvu'ot* 1:1; *Shabbat* 1:1 [↩](#)
2. See Tractate *Berachot* 10a (*Meir HaLeshem*). [↩](#)
3. See Ramchal's *Megillat S'tarim, Shiv'im panim* ch. 4. [↩](#)
4. See *Bereishit Rabba* 14:9. [↩](#)
5. *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar* 6, chapter 5. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The enclothing and overlapping of the levels of the heikhalot (Divine palaces), physical bodies, and the neshama.

The matter of enclothing of levels.

A cosmic mystery.

הנה מה שאמרנו לעיל פ"ב מההתלבשות העליון בהתחתון

That which we stated above (chapter 2) regarding the upper level 'clothing' itself in the lower level

הוא אינו מהעליון הסמוך אליו לבד אלא שהוא מכל העליונים כלם

applies not only to the upper level closest to the lower level, but to *all* levels above any lower level.

ונמצא שבכל תחתון מתרבה ההתלבשות לפי ערך רבוי העליונים שעליו

It turns out that regarding any lower level – the *hitlavshut* (enclothing) increases the more levels there are above it,

שכל מי שהוא יותר תחתון מתרבה בו ההתלבשות

so that the lowest level is subject to multiple degrees of *hitlavshut*,

כי מספר העליונים שעליו הרי הוא יותר מרבה.

since the number of levels above it is the maximum with all the preceding levels enveloping and enclothing the lowest level, as will be explained.

וכן הוא עוד כי הנה כל עולם וכל פרצוף הרי הוא מסדר מפרטים רבים אין חקר

Furthermore, this is also because every World and every *partzuf* comprises innumerable details,

ומתלבש כל עליון וכן כל העליונים כלם בהתחתון מכל הפרטים
כלם שבכל אחד

and when a higher level, as well as all the higher levels above it, become clothed in a lower level, together with all the details of all of them all the levels above that lower level,

וכלול כל תחתון מכל העליונים כלם מכל פרטיהם.

then every lower level includes in itself all the higher levels with all of their details.

ונבאר הדבר בדרך כלל כי הפרטים עצמם הרי הם רבו לאין מספר.

Let us explain this in a general sense, since the details themselves are innumerable and cannot be described specifically.

אך בדרך כלל הנה הוא כי הנה בגנו כל עולם הוא מיסד על שני
דברים

In general the structure of each world is based on two things –

היינו האדם והעולם.

the person and the World.

ובפרטות הנה הם ד' – היינו היכלות ולבושים וגופות ונשמות.

More specifically, there are four aspects: chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וההיכלות הוא בבחי' הבתים שהאדם יושב בתוכם.

'Chambers' or *heichalot* are like the houses in which people live in the sense that they are the broadest and most inclusive category. Perhaps we can refer to this in more modern terminology as "the situational context."

וּבְכָל־לָעוֹלָם הֵנָּה הֵם הַד' יְסוּדוֹת – אֵשׁ, רוּחַ, מַיִם, עָפָר – שֶׁהֵם
הַד' יְסוּדוֹת הַתְּחִינִים

In a general sense, in the world these are the four elemental properties – fire, air, water and earth. These are the four lower elemental properties or foundations.

These four foundational properties described in medieval metaphysics seem to be of a more theoretical and classificatory nature than actual physical elements in the modern sense. In more current terminology perhaps we could say that the element of 'fire' is equivalent to temperature; 'air' – perhaps a synonym for pressure; 'water' – viscosity; and earth – density. All of them are properties of substances rather than elements comprising the substances.

וְכֵן כָּל הַגִּלְגָּלִים כֻּלָּם שֶׁהֵם נִכְלָלִים גַּם כֵּן בְּד' וְהֵם הַד' יְסוּדוֹת
הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים

Similarly, all the *galgalim* often translated as 'spheres' or 'orbits' are also categorized into four – these are the four elements in a supernal sense.

The 'spheres' or 'orbits' seem to represent a basic method of classification, and therefore they are called 'orbits' in terms of their inclusivity – what they surround and include within themselves. However, elsewhere they are described as living, conscious entities of some sort, as Maimonides states in *Yesodei haTorah* (the first section of his magnum opus, *Mishneh Torah*) 3:9 – "the spheres possess a soul, knowledge, and intellect. They are alive and stand in recognition of the One who spoke and [thus brought] the world into being. According to their rank and status each one praises and glorifies their Creator ..." They are not to be confused with *sefirot*.

וְכָל זֶה הֵם בְּבַחֲיָה יִיכָלּוֹת וּבִתִּים שֶׁהָאָדָם יוֹשֵׁב בְּתוֹכָם

All the above are the category of *heichalot* 'chambers' and houses similar to those in which a person dwells, or "the situational context."

וְהֵנָּה הֵם כָּלֶם עֲגָלִים כִּי גַם הַד' יְסֻדוֹת – אֵשׁ, רוּחַ, מַיִם, עָפָר –
הַתְּחִתּוֹנִים

All of them are 'circular' in the sense that they encompass the properties of whatever they circumscribe. **Even the four elemental properties of fire, air, water and earth of this material world**

הֵם גַּם כֵּן עֲגָלִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתֵב הָרַמְבַּ"ם ז"ל בִּיסוּדֵי הַתּוֹרָה פ"ג סִימָן
י'

are also 'circular,' as Rambam writes in *Mishneh Torah, Yesodei haTorah* 3:10.

וְהֵנָּה הֵם הַהִיכָלוֹת שֶׁהוּא כָּלֶל הָעוֹלָם

And these are the *heichalot* which include the entire world within them.

וְכֵן יִשְׁנָם עֲגָלִים שֶׁהֵם הִיכָלוֹת לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף בְּפָנֵי עֲצָמוֹ וְהוּא
בְּחִי' אַחַת.

Similarly, there are *igulim* concentric spiritual orbits which are the *heichalot* for each *partzuf* individually. This is all the first aspect.

בְּחִי' ב' הוּא הַלְבוּשִׁים.

The second aspect of the classification mentioned at the beginning of this chapter (chambers, garments, bodies and souls) is 'garments.'

וְהֵנָּה הֵם הָאוֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁנָם לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף כֵּן"ל פ"ב
וַיִּתְּבֹאֵר עוֹד עֲנִין הַמְּקִיפִים לְקֶמֶן שַׁעַר ו'.

These are the 'encompassing lights' *makifim* from here on associated with each and every *partzuf*, as mentioned above in chapter 2. These will be explained further in *Sha'ar* 6.

The 'encompassing lights' are Divine emanations or illuminations of an order that cannot be confined within limited creatures. Thus are said to encompass or envelop them in a pervasive and transcendent manner, as the author will explain.

וְהָאוֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים הֵם מִבְחוּץ לַהֲגוּף וְאֵינָם דְּבוּק עִמּוֹ כֹּל כֶּךָ וְלָכֵן
הֵם בְּבַחֲיִנַת לְבוּשִׁים.

These lights envelop the body i.e. the entities they 'adorn' from the outside, and are not so close-fitting so to speak. Therefore they are called 'garments.'

וְאַחֵר כֶּךָ הוּא הֲגוּף עִם הַנֶּשְׁמָה שֶׁהוּא עֶקֶר הָאָדָם וְהַפְּרָצוּף

Next in the classification system mentioned above is the body, together with the soul *neshama* which is the primary aspect of a person and a *partzuf*.

וְהֵרִי הֵם ד' בְּחִי' הִיכָלוֹת וְלְבוּשִׁים וְגוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת.

****Thus there are four aspects altogether – chambers–*heichalot*, garments–*levushim*, bodies–***gufim* and souls–*neshamot*.**

וְהֵנָּה אֵלּוּ הֵד' בְּחִי' הֵם שְׁתֵּים כְּנֶגֶד שְׁתֵּים

Now these four aspects are arranged in parallel pairs:

כִּי הַגּוֹפּוֹת עִם הַנִּשְׁמוֹת הֵרִי הֵם מְחֻבָּרִים וּמִיחָדִים זֶה בְּזֶה –

bodies and souls are connected and unified one with the other –

שֶׁהַנִּשְׁמוֹת הוּא בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹפִים וְהֵם אֶחָד.

souls within bodies form a single entity;

וְכֵן הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה הַלְבוּשִׁים שֶׁהֵם הָאוֹר מְקִיף עִם הַהִיכָלוֹת

****and similarly with garments–***levushim* which are encompassing light – and *heichalot***

שֶׁהֵם הָעֵגְלִים הֵם גַּם כֵּן מְחֻבָּרִים יַחַד.

which are the *igulim*. They too are connected,

כי האור מקיף הוא עומד לעולם בתוך העגלים – האור מקיף
מבפנים והעגלים מבחוץ.

**since the encompassing light is always situated within the
system of *igulim* – the encompassing light inside them, and the
igulim surrounding them on the outside.**

והם שניהם מקיפים ומסבבים על הגוף ונשמה של האדם מבחוץ

**And these latter two encompass and surround the body and the
soul of a person on the outside,**

ואינם דבוקים עמו ממש כי אורם הוא גדול

and are not closely fitted to him, since their light is abundant,

ואינם מאירים להגוף אלא רק לאט לאט ובהדרגה גדולה

**and they do not illuminate the body other than to a very small
degree, and even that in many gradations, depending on the
spiritual status of the recipient.**

וכדי שלא יתבטל הגוף ממציאותו המכרח לו.

**All of this is so that the body will not become nullified in the
existence it needs in order to continue to exist.**

וכל זה הנה הוא בכל עולם ועולם

This is true of every World –

שכל עולם היא כלול מהיכלות ולבושים וגופות ונשמות

each World comprises chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וכן על דרך זה בפרטי כל פרצוף שבכל עולם

And so too, with each individual *partzuf* in each World –

הנה כלול כל פרצוף מאלו הד' בחינות

each *partzuf* is endowed with these four aspects,

וְבָהֶם מְתַלְבֵּשׁ כָּל פְּרָצוֹף עָלְיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן וְכֵן כָּל עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן
בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

and by way thereof, every higher *partzuf* clothes itself in the lower *partzuf*, and every higher World in a lower World.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאָרֶה מֵהֵיכָלוֹת דְּהָעָלְיוֹן שֶׁהוּא מְהַעֲגִלִים
שָׁבוּ¹

Meaning to say, from the *heichalot* of the upper level, from its *igulim*, a radiance spreads forth

וּמִלְבִּישׁ עַל הֵיכָלוֹת דְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּהִשְׁתִּי בְּחִינּוֹת הַנִּלְפָּנִי

and garbs both aspects of the *heichalot* of the lower level mentioned above in chapter 2 –

שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד בְּמִדְרָגָתוֹ וְאַחַת לְמַעַלָּה מִמִּדְרָגָתוֹ.

one at its level i.e. the level of the lower world, and one above its level.

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁט עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה הָאֶרֶץ הַלְבוּשִׁים דְּהָעָלְיוֹן שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹרוֹת
מִקִּיפִים שָׁבוּ

In addition, and in a similar manner, the radiance of the upper garment, i.e. the *makifim* thereof, unfurl

וּמִלְבִּישׁ עַל הָאוֹר מִקִּיף דְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

and clothe the encompassing light of the lower level.

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁט תְּמַצִּית וְהָאָרֶה מֵהַגּוֹפּוֹת דְּהָעָלְיוֹן וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַגּוֹפּוֹת
דְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

Similarly, a distillation of the light and radiance from the bodies of the higher entities percolate down to become clothed in the bodies of the lower entities.

וכן הארה מהנשמות דהעליון בהנשמות דהתחתון.

So too, a radiance from the souls of the upper level illuminates the souls of the lower level.

וסדר עמידתם דאותן ההתלבשות

The order in which the *hitlavshut* enclothing is established

הנה הוא על דרך סדר עמידתן דהמצאיות העקרי שבהם

replicates the manner in which their primary existential qualities were set in order.

כי כמו שאמרנו דכל אותן הד' בחי' שבכל אחד עצמו

Because just as we stated that all four aspects in each individual

עומד הגוף והנשמה מבפנים וההיכלות והלבושים מבחוץ.

are arranged in a manner that the body and the soul are internal, and the *heichalot* and garments are external,

כן הוא על דרך זה ההתלבשות דהעליון אשר בהתחתון

so too, regarding the garbing of the upper upon the lower,

הנה עומד ההתלבשות בהארת הלבושים והיכלות דהעליון

the radiance of the garments and the *heichalot* of the upper level garb

מבחוץ להלבושים וההיכלות דהתחתון.

the garments and the *heichalot* of the lower level externally.

וְהַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת דְּהָאֶרֶת הַגּוֹפּוֹת וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת דְּהָעָלְיוֹן

And the radiance of the bodies and souls of the upper level are vested

הֵם עוֹמְדִים מִבְּפָנִים לַהֲגוּפּוֹת וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת דְּהַתְּחִתּוֹן.

internally, within the bodies and souls of the lower level.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי כָּל תְּחִתּוֹן הוּא מְקַף מֵהָעָלְיוֹן

Thus it turns out that each lower level is enveloped by the upper level

עַל יְדֵי הָאֶרֶת הַלְּבוּשִׁים וְהַיְכָלוֹת שְׁבוּ

via the radiance of its the upper level's garments and *heichalot*

כִּי הֵם מְקִיפִים וּמְסַבְּבִים עַל הַיְכָלוֹת וְהַלְּבוּשִׁים דְּהַתְּחִתּוֹן

which envelop and surround the *heichalot* and the garments of the lower level,

וְנִעְשִׂים לְלְבוּשִׁים וְהַיְכָלוֹת אֵלָיו.

and become its garments and *heichalot* since it is via them that the upper level envelops the lower.

וְכֵן הַתְּחִתּוֹן הוּא מְקִיף לְהָעָלְיוֹן מִצַּד הָהָאֲרוֹת דְּהַגּוֹפּוֹת וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת דְּהָעָלְיוֹן שְׁעוֹמְדִין בְּפָנֵימִיּוֹתוֹ

In addition, the lower level also envelops the higher level in terms of the radiance of the bodies and souls of the upper level that are vested within it.

וְהָיָה כָּל כֹּחַ תְּחִתּוֹן בְּתוֹךְ הָהָאֲרוֹת דְּהָעָלְיוֹן שֶׁהֵם עוֹמְדִים עָלָיו

Thus every lower level is incorporated into the radiances of the upper level that supersedes it,

וּמֵאִירֵין בּוֹ מִבֵּית וּמִבְּחוּץ.

and which illuminates it internally and externally.

כי רק על ידי זה הוא כל מציאותו וקיומו וכל תהלוכותיו כנ"ל.

For it is only in this manner that it continues to exist and thrive and develop.

והנה אמרנו שההתלבשות הוא אינו מהעליון שעליו לבד

Now we stated previously that this process of enclothing the lower level is not only regarding the level immediately above,

אלא שהוא מכל העליונים כלם, ומכלם הוא על דרך שאמרנו.

but rather regarding all the preceding levels, and all operate in the same manner as we expressed.

ונבאר הדבר בפרטיות בעולם העשיה משום שהוא האחרון לכלם

Let's illustrate this in the World of Asiyah, since it is the final World,

והנה ההתלבשות בו ביותר מכלם,

and the enclothing is more there than anywhere else.

לכן נבאר בו וממילא יובן על כל העולמות שלמעלה.

Therefore, by explaining it the World of Asiyah, all the Worlds above it will be understood automatically.

הנה עולם העשיה אשר הוא למטה מכל העולמות כלם הנה הוא כלול מכלם,

Now the World of Asiyah, which is the lowest of all the worlds, is comprised of all of them –

שכל העולמות העליונים אשר למעלה למעלה הנה כלם כלולים בו

because all of the higher Worlds, even the very highest – are included therein in Asiyah.

כי לעולם הוא שכל תחתון הוא כלול מכל העליונים שעליו.

For it is always the case that every lower level includes some aspect of all the higher levels above it,

שכל העליונים אשר עליו הגם שהם למעלה לגמרי

so that all the higher levels above it – even though they completely transcend it –

על כל פנים הנה הם מתפשטים בו בהארתם בפנימיותו

nevertheless percolate down into it by way of their radiances that are absorbed within it.

וכן מסבבים ומקיפים אותו בהארתם בחיצוניותו.

In addition, radiances from above surround and envelop it externally.

ועומד כל תחתון רק בכח והארת כל העליונים המשפיעים בו

Thus every lower level endures only by virtue of the power and radiance that flow down from the higher levels,

ומאירים עליו מבית ומבחוץ.

illuminating it the lower level from within and from without.

והנה עולם העשיה אשר מקומו הוא למטה לגמרי מעולם היצירה
וכנ"ל פ"א

Now the World of Asiyah, which is situated entirely below the World of Yetzirah, i.e. with no actual overlap, as mentioned above in chapter 1,

והנה הוא מִיָּסֵד ומְסֻדָּר מִד' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם הִכָּלֹת וְלִבּוּשִׁים וְגוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת.

is based on, and arranged according to, the four aspects mentioned earlier – chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וְהַגּוּפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת הֵם מִבְּפָנִים וְהַיְכָלוֹת וּלְבוּשִׁים הֵם מִבַּחוּץ
וְכַנְזָכָר.

The effects of bodies and souls are internal, whereas the effects of chambers and garments are external.

וְהִנֵּה בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוּפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דִּהְעֵשְׂיָה בְּפָנֵימִיּוֹתָם

Now within the bodies and souls of Asiyah, internally,

הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ שָׁם הָאֶרֶת הַגּוּפוֹת וְהַנִּשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הַיְצִירָה
כָּלָה

the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Yetzirah percolates down and become vested within Asiyah, internally.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת דִּהְאֶרֶת הַגּוּפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הַבְּרִיָּאָה
כָּלָה

And within them within the bodies and souls of Yetzirah the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Beriah percolates down and becomes vested in Yetzirah.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת הַגּוּפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת
כָּלוּ

And within them within the bodies and souls of Beriah the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Atzilut percolate down and become vested in Beriah.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת בְּחִי' הַגּוּפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּאָדָם
קְדָמוֹן כָּלוּ

And within them within the bodies and souls of Atzilut the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Adam Kadmon (abbreviated as A"K) percolate down and become vested in Atzilut.

ובתוכם עומד התפשטות הארת מאור הקו דאין סוף

And within them within the bodies and souls of A"K a radiance from the light of the *kav* and the *Ein Sof*,

המתפשט ומאיר בכל העולמות כלם על ידי האדם קדמון
והאצילות.

percolates down and illuminates all of the worlds by way of A "K and Atzilut.

והרי נמצא כי כל עולם העשיה הגם שהיא בכללה למטה לגמרי
מכל העולמות כלם

So it turns out that the entire World of Asiyah, albeit in general completely below all the Worlds,

ומקומה הוא מתחת סיום עולם היצירה לגמרי,

being that it is situated well below the bottom of the World of Yetzirah,

על כל פנים הנה כלול עולם העשיה בתוכה ובפנימיותה

nevertheless, the World of Asiyah includes within itself, internally,

מכל התפשטות הארת דכל העליונים כלם אשר למעלה למעלה
עד אין סוף יתברך שמו.

all of the radiance of all the upper levels to the very highest rank – until the Infinite One, blessed is His Name.

כי יורד הארת דכל עליון על ידי התפשטותו בהעולם שתחתיו

This is because the radiance of the upper level descends by diffusing its light into the World below it,

ויורדים על דרך זה מעולם לעולם עד שמתפשט ומתלבש הארת
כלם גם בעשיה.

and in this way it descends from World to World, until a radiance from all of them extends into and becomes vested in Asiyah.

כי רק על ידי זה נעשה כל מציאותה ורק מזה היא מתקיים ומתנהג תמיד:

Because it is only in this manner that Asiyah comes into existence, and only in this fashion does it endure and is it constantly guided.

אמנם פשוט הדבר כי הגם שאמרנו שמתפשט ומתלבש בה

It is obvious that although we stated that percolating down and becoming clothed in it in Asiyah

ההארות דכל העליונים כלם על כל פנים הנה אינם שווים בה,

are the radiances of *all* the upper levels, nevertheless, they are not evenly distributed therein –

כי אינו דומה ההארה אשר מתפשט בה מהיצירה והבריאה

since the radiance of Yetzirah or Beriah that extends into it into Asiyah is not the same as

לההארה אשר מתפשט בה מהאצילות ואדם קדמון.

the radiance of Atzilut and A"K that extend into it.

כי כל היותר עליון מתמעט בהארתו בה ואינו מתפשט בה

Because the higher the level from which the radiance emerges the more its radiance is reduced, and the less it percolates down into it,

אלא רק בהארה ממעט מאד עד שמתעלם בה ואינו נכר בה כלל.

other than as a greatly diminished radiance that becomes concealed within it within Asiyah and is not recognizable in it at all.

אך על כל פנים הנה אותה המעט ממנו נחשב בה לרב והוא עקר
כח מציאותה וקיומה.

Nevertheless, the slight radiance thereof of A"K and Atzilut is regarded as the primary power energizing her Asiyah's existence and continuity.

והרי מתפשטים בה הארת כלם על כל פנים:

In any event the radiance of all levels percolate down into it into Asiyah.

והנה על דרך שאמרנו בהתפשטות ההארות דאורות הגופות
והנשמות

Now in the same manner in which we explained the spreading forth of the radiances of the bodies and souls

דכל העליונים כלם המתפשטים ומתלבשים בעולם העשיה

of all the higher levels that percolate down to become clothed in the World of Asiyah,

בפנימיותה ובפנימית פנימיותה

internally, and in the inner aspects of its interior,

כן הוא על דרך זה בהתפשטות ההארות דאורות ההיכלות שהם
העגלים

so too, regarding the spreading forth of the radiances of the light of the "chambers" which we referred to earlier as "the situational context," which are the *igulim*,

ודאורות הלבושים שהם המקיפים

and the lights of the 'garments,' which are the *makifim*:

הנה מתפשטים גם כן בהארתם בעולם העשיה מכל העליונים
כלם

the radiances from all of the upper levels also spread downwards upon the World of Asiyah.

אֲלָא שֶׁסֹּדֶר עֲמִידָתָם הוּא לְהִפְךָ מֵהָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת.

However, the order in which they are arranged is the opposite of the radiance of the lights of bodies and souls,

כִּי הָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת הֵם מִתְפַּשְּׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים מִבְּנִיִּים.

since the radiance of the lights of bodies and souls percolate down and are absorbed internally within Asiyah,

אֲבָל הָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהָעֵגְלִים וְהַמְקִיפִים

whereas the radiance of the lights of the *igulim* and the *makifim* of the higher Worlds

הֵנָּה הֵם מִתְפַּשְּׁטִים וּמִסְבָּבִים וּמְקִיפִים מִבְּחוּץ לְהָעֵגְלִים דֹּהַעֲשִׂיהָ

spread forth and envelop and surround the *igulim* of Asiyah

וְהֵם כּוֹלְלִים אֶת כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיהָ בְּתוֹכָם.

and thus subsume the entire World of Asiyah within them.

כִּי מִחוּץ לְהַלְבוּשִׁים וְהַהִיכָלוֹת שֶׁהֵם הָעֵגְלִים וְהַמְקִיפִים דֹּהַעֲשִׂיהָ עֲצָמָה

Now besides the garments and the chambers, which are the *igulim* and the *makifim* of Asiyah itself,

הֵנָּה יוֹרֵד הָאֶרֶת הָאוֹר הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֵגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה

a radiance of the light of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah also descend –

וְיוֹרְדִים מִמְּקוֹמָם וּמִתְפַּשְּׁטִים וּמִלְבִּישִׁים

coming down from their place and spreading down and enveloping

על העגלים והמקיפים העקריים דעולם העשיה

the primary *igulim* and the *makifim* of the World of Asiyah itself,

ומקיפים ומסבבים עליהם מבחוץ וכוללים את כל העשיה בתוכם.

enveloping and surrounding them externally i.e. they are not internalized *within* the *igulim* of Asiyah. Instead, the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah **include the entire Asiyah within them.**

ומחוץ להם הנה עומד ומקיף ומסבב התפשטות הארת דהמקיפים והעגלים דעולם הבריאה.

And outside of them i.e. above the lights of Yetzirah, the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Beriah encompass and surround them.

אשר ירדו ממקומם והתפשטו בהארתם להקיף ולסבב

These *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Beriah **descended from their place** in Beriah **and their radiance spread forth to encompass and surround**

על המקיפים והעגלים העקריים דעולם היצירה במקומם.

the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah in their place i.e. as they are in Yetzirah.

הנה יורד הארה מהארתם עם הארת המקיפים והעגלים דהיצירה ביחד,

Now a radiance of the radiance of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Beriah descends, together with a radiance of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Yetzirah,

וְיֵרָדִים הֵם גַּם כֵּן בְּמָקוֹם עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה.

they both descend into the space of the World of Asiyah.

וְהֵם מְקִיפִים וּמְסַבְּבִים עַל הָהָאָרָה דְּהַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֲגָלִים דְּעוֹלָם
הַיְצִירָה

**And they envelop and surround the radiance of the *makifim*
and the *igulim* of Yetzirah**

הַמְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב עַל הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֲגָלִים הָעֲקָרִיִּים דְּהָעֲשִׂיָּה עֲצָמָה.

**which in turn envelop and surround the primary *makifim* and
the *igulim* of Asiyah itself.**

וְהֵרִי נִכְלָל כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּתוֹךְ הָהָאָרוֹת דְּהַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֲגָלִים
דְּהַיְצִירָה וְדְּבִרְיָאָה.

**Thus the entire World of Asiyah is subsumed within the
radiances of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Yetzirah and Beriah.**

וּמִחוּץ לָהֶם הֵנָּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְעוֹמֵד הַתַּפְּשֻׁטוֹת הָאָרוֹת דְּהַמְקִיפִים
וְהָעֲגָלִים דְּעוֹלָם הָאֲצִילוֹת

**And outside i.e. above them, the radiances of the *makifim* and
the *igulim* of Atzilut spread out**

וְהֵיִינוּ מֵאוֹתָן הָהָאָרוֹת דְּהָאֲצִילוֹת אֲשֶׁר יָרְדוּ מִמָּקוֹמָם

**– i.e. of those radiances of Atzilut that descended from their
place**

וְהַתַּפְּשֻׁטוֹ בְּהָאֲרָתָם לְהַקִּיף וּלְסַבֵּב עַל הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֲגָלִים דְּעוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיָּאָה,

**and radiate down to envelop and surround the *makifim* and the
igulim of Beriah –**

וְעַתָּה הֵנָּה יוֹרֵד הָאָרָה מֵהֶם עַל יְדֵי הָאָרוֹת הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעֲגָלִים
דְּהַבְּרִיָּאָה וְהַיְצִירָה,

their radiance descends from them via the radiances of the *makifim* and *igulim* of Beriah and Yetzirah,

לְהַקִּיף וּלְסַבֵּב עַל הָעִגּוּלִים וְהַמְּקִיפִים הָעֲקָרִיִּים דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה

to envelop and surround the primary *igulim* and *makifim* of Asiyah,

וְעוֹמְדִים הַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגּוּלִים דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה מִבְּפָנִים.

so that the *makifim* and *igulim* of Asiyah are situated within at the center of all the *igulim*,

וְעֲלֵיהֶם וּמִבְּחוּץ לָהֶם הֵנָּה מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב הָאֶרֶת הַמְּקִיפִים
וְהָעִגּוּלִים דְּכָל הַיְצִירָה כְּלָהּ;

and above them, outside of them, is the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Yetzirah;

וְעֲלֵיהֶם וּמִבְּחוּץ לָהֶם מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב הַיְצִירָה דְּהָאֶרֶת דְּהַמְּקִיפִים
וְהָעִגּוּלִים דְּכָל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָהּ;

and above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Yetzirah and Asiyah, outside of them, is the radiance of the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Beriah;

וְעֲלֵיהֶם וּמִבְּחוּץ מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב

and above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, outside of them, enveloping and surrounding them all,

הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת דְּהָאֶרֶת דְּהַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגּוּלִים דְּכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּלוֹ.

a radiance of a radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Atzilut spreads forth.

וְכֹן עֲלֵיהֶם וּמִבְּחוּץ הֵנָּה מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב גַּם כֹּן הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת
דְּהָאֶרֶת

Similarly, above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Atzilut Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, externally, enveloping and surrounding them all, a radiance of a radiance spreads forth

דְּהַמְקִיפִים וְהַעֲגִלִים דְּכָל אָדָם קְדָמוֹן כֻּלּוֹ וְנִכְלָלוֹ בְּכֻלָּם בְּתוֹכּוֹ.

from the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire A"K, so that all the *makifim* and *igulim* of all the Worlds are subsumed into it.

וְעֲלֵיהֶם וְעַל כָּל הָנָה מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב אֹר אֵין סוֹף שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי
הָרָאוֹן הַנִּלְשָׁעַר ד' פ"ג

And above all of *them*, enveloping and surrounding all of them, is the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the very first revelation, as mentioned above *Shaar 4* chapter 3,

שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה מֵהַכֹּל וּמְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב אֶת כָּל.

since the *Ohr Ein Sof* transcends everything and envelops and surrounds everything,

כִּי כָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם הֵם עוֹמְדִים בָּלָם בְּתוֹכּוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּחָלָל
הַצִּמְצוּם שֶׁבְּתוֹכּוֹ

so that all of the Worlds are subsumed within it, in the *chalal* the void caused by the *tzimtzum* i.e. the contraction within the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

וְהוּא מְקִיף אֶת כָּלָם וְהֵם כָּלָם כְּלוּלִים בּוֹ וְתִלְוִים וְעוֹמְדִים בְּשִׁפְעוֹ
וְאוֹרוֹ תָּמִיד.

And the *Ohr Ein Sof* encompasses them all, so that all of them are subsumed within it and all are dependent upon Him and always endure only by way of His outflow of life-force and light.

וְהָיָה נִמְצָא כִּי עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהִיא בְּאֶמֶת לְמַטָּה וּמִתְחַתִּית
כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם

Thus it turns out that the World of Asiyah, although it is indeed down below, lower than all the other Worlds,

על כל פנים הנה מתפשטים ומתלבשים כלם בה בהארותם.

nevertheless, a radiance from all of them spreads forth and becomes clothed within it within Asiyah,

כי מתפשט ויורד הארת דכל אחד ממקומו

in that a radiance spreads forth and descends from its place in each World –

הן מהגופות והנשמות שבהם ומתלבשים בה בפנימיותה

from the bodies and from the souls therein, which become clothed within it within Asiyah internally,

והן מהמקיפים והעגלים שבהם ומלבישים אותה מסביב

as well as from the *makifim* and *igulim* of those Worlds, enveloping them externally.

והרי כלולה העשיה בתוך כל העולמות כלם על ידי הארת המקיפים והעגלים

Thus Asiyah is subsumed into all of the Worlds via the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim*

דכל אחד המתפשטים ממקומם להקיף אותה.

which each of them of the Worlds radiates out from their place to surround them.

וכן הם כלם כלולים בה על ידי הארת הגופות ונשמות

In addition, all of them are absorbed into it Asiyah via the radiance of the bodies and souls

דכל אחד המתפשטים ממקומם ומתלבשים בפנימיותה.

that each of them percolates down from their place to become clothed within Asiyah internally.

וְכֵן הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם.

And so too regarding every world –

As mentioned in the beginning of this chapter, the same paradigm is true of every lower level in relation to the levels above it.

כִּי הֵגַם שְׂכָל עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן הוּא לְמַעַלָּה לְגַמְרֵי מֵהָעוֹלָם הַשְּׁנִי שֶׁתַּחְתּוֹ,

for even though each higher World completely transcends the World below it,

כִּי אֵינוֹ מֵתַחִיל הַשְּׁנִי אֲלָא רַק תַּחַת סִיּוּמוֹ דְּהַעֲלִיּוֹן לְגַמְרֵי,

since the next World down does not even begin until the higher World is totally complete i.e. there is no overlap,

עַל כָּל פְּנִימֵי הֵנָּה הֵם מֵתַלְבָּשִׁים זֶה בְּזֶה וְכְלוּלִים זֶה בְּזֶה עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁבְּאֲרָנוּ בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה.

nevertheless, they become clothed one within the other in the manner we explained regarding the World of Asiyah.

וְכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ הִלְלוּ הֵנָּה הֵם מְכֻנָּגִים בְּדַבְרֵי הָרַב בְּשַׁעַר עֲגָלִים וְיֶשֶׁר עֲנָף ד'

All that we have said here is a precise restatement of the words of the Rav Rabbi Isaac Luria in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 4*,

וְכֻמוֹ שֶׁבְּאֲרָנוּ שֶׁם כָּל דְּבָרֵינוּ בְּזֶה בְּעֵמֶק וְאַרְכָּה.

as we explained comprehensively in our commentary there, in depth and at length.

וְנוֹדַע הוּא כִּמָּה שֶׁטָּרְחוּ הַמְּפַרְשִׁים שֶׁם וְהִרְבּוּ בְּקִשּׁוֹת

Now it is known the extent to which the commentators there exerted themselves in expounding the texts discussing these matters, raising numerous questions,

אבל במה שאמרנו כאן שרש הדברים בזה

but what we have stated here is the root of these concepts,

ובפרט בכל מה שכתבנו שם בארכה יתבארו כל דברי הרב באר
היטיב

and in particular our lengthy commentary there explains all the words of the Rav clearly.

ועין עוד דברינו בזה בספר הדעה חלק א' דרוש ה'.

See further our commentary on this in the work titled *Sefer haDe'ah* (*Hu Drush Olam HaTohu*, a part of *Leshem, Sh'vo v'Achlama*) **part 1, drush 5**.

Footnotes

1. This is the proper spelling (Makover). This emendation also applies to other incidences below. [↩](#)

G A T E

*Shaar 6 — How the Divine Light expands:
tsimtsum, the surrounding and inner lights,
reward and karma*

Chapter 1 — Contraction of Divine Light in the First Revelation as a means of revealing Light via a lower revelation.

Tzintzum is the agent that facilitates Revelations between worlds.

וְנַחֲזֹר מֵעַתָּה עַל דְּבָרֵינוּ הָרִאשׁוֹנִים אֲשֶׁר לָעִיל שֶׁעַר ד'

Let's now review our original statements above in *Sha'ar 4*

כִּי הִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁם מִפָּרֶק ג' וְהִלָּא שֶׁכָּלְלוֹת גְּלוּיָו יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ

where we said (chapter 3) that His revelation in general

אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ הִנֵּה נִסְדֵּר בָּה' גְּלוּיָם שֶׁהֵם ה' מְדַרְגּוֹת.

that became unveiled throughout existence is arranged in five stages of revelation, which are actually five levels – 1) The *Ohr Ein Sof*; 2) the *kav* and the *tzintzum*; 3) Adam Kadmon; 4) Atzilut; 5) the Worlds of BiY"A (Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah).

וּבָהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה מְאֻמַּתָּתוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנֶּעְלָמָה

In them in these five stages of revelation is revealed something of His true uncompounded concealed Being,

וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִגְּלוּיָ לְגְלוּיָ שֶׁהוּא מִהַגְּלוּיָ דְּאוֹר אֵין סוֹף יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ

spreading forth from revelation to revelation, from the very first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

עַד גְּלוּיָו הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁבְּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוּ בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁם.

until the very last revelation in the Worlds of BiY"A, as we explained in our elucidation there.

וְהָיָה הַתַּפְשׁוּטוֹת וַיִּצְאָתוּ מִגְּלוֹי לְגְלוֹי הָיָה עַל יְדֵי בְּחִי' צִמְצוּם
מִכָּל עֲלִיוֹן לְהַתְחַתּוֹן.

Now the light spread forth and emerged from revelation to revelation by way of the aspect of *tzimtzum* (the withdrawal or contraction of the light) between every higher level and lower level.

וְהָיָה כִּי לְצַרְךָ יִצְאָתוּ מִכָּל גְּלוֹי הַקּוֹדֶם לְגְלוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי אֲשֶׁר תַּחְתּוֹ

That is to say, any prior revelation, for the sake of the emergence of the subsequent revelation below it –

שֶׁהוּא לְמַטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ בַּמַּדְרָגָה הַנָּה נִתְצַמְצַם וְנִסְתַּלַּק

below in the sense of spiritual level, not locality – the light was constricted and withdrawn,

וְעָלָה הָאוֹר דֶּהֱגְלוֹי הָרִאשׁוֹן לְמַעְלָה,

so that **the first revelation of the light ascended** i.e. it was withdrawn to a higher level

כְּדִי לַתֵּן מְקוֹם לְגְלוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי וּכְמוֹ שִׁיתְבָּאָר.

in order to make 'space' for the second revelation, as we will explain below – that every revelation includes within itself the next revelation, so that the first one has to be withdrawn in order to make room (figuratively speaking) for the second revelation.¹

אֲמָנָם בְּעֵינֵינוּ הַגְּלוֹי הָרִאשׁוֹן דָּאִין סוֹף

However, as far as the first revelation is concerned of the *Ein Sof*, i.e. the *Ohr Ein Sof*,²

אִיךָ שֶׁיֵּצֵא בּוֹ מֵאֲמִתּוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנִּעְלָמָה,

– how it emerged from His true uncompounded concealed Being

אין לנו רשות לדבר ולהתבונן בזה מאומה כלל

we have no permission at all to discuss or even contemplate,

וכמו שכתבנו לעיל שער ד' כמה פעמים בזה.

as we wrote above in *Sha'ar 4* a number of times.

ואי אפשר לנו לדבר אלא רק מאחר שנתגלה ולמטה.

We can speak only of after that revelation the *Ohr Ein Sof* and below,

והיינו בסדר יציאתו מהגלוי הראשון לשני

that is to say, the manner in which the second revelation emerged from the first,

וכן בסדר יציאתו אשר מהשני לשלישי, ומהשלישי להרביעי, ומהרביעי לחמישי.

and similarly, the manner in which the third revelation emerged from the second, the fourth from the third, and the fifth from the fourth.

והנה יהיה יציאתו מגלוי לגלוי על ידי צמצום.

Now this emerging from revelation to revelation was via a *tzimtzum* in each case.

שהוא הסתלקות ועלית האור למעלה וכמו שיתבאר לפנינו.

This *tzimtzum* is the withdrawal and ascent of the light from its expanded state to a higher plane, as will be explained below.

והענין הוא כי הנה כל גלוי וגלוי קדם שיצא לגלוי השני שתחתיו

The idea is this: before any superior revelation extends from its place to a second revelation below it

הנה היתה נמשך אותו הגלוי העליון גם בהמקום העתיד לגלוי השני,

that superior revelation also expands into the space where the second revelation would be in the future.

וכן משם ולמטה כלו בכל אחד לפי ערכו.

Similarly from there on all the way down, each level according to its rank.

וכגון גלוי שפאצילות שהוא למעלה וקדם לגלוי שבבי"ע

For example, His revelation in Atzilut (the fourth revelation), which is higher than and precedes His revelation in BiY"A (the fifth revelation),

היה מתפשט מתחילה האור דאצילות גם בכל המקום העתיד להעולמות בי"ע כלן.

– initially the light of Atzilut expanded into the entire future space of all the Worlds of BiY"A as well.

והיה מתפשט מקדם ממקום האצילות עד סוף המקום דהבי"ע

The light that first spread forth from the 'space' of Atzilut until the outer limits of the 'space' of BiY"A,

רק מגלוי אשר מבחי' האצילות לבד.

was only the light of Atzilut, since the light of BiY"A was included in the revelation that preceded it – i.e. in the light of the World of Atzilut.

ולכן היה נצרך לצרף גלוי שבבי"ע שישתלק מאותו המקום

Accordingly, for the sake of the revelation in BiY"A, it was necessary to withdraw from that space – the future space of BiY"A

כל האור דבחי' האצילות שהיה נמשך שם,

all the light of Atzilut that was manifested there,

וַיַּעֲלֶה אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר לְמַעַלָּה בַּמָּקוֹם הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּדִי לַעֲשׂוֹת וְלַתּוֹ
מָקוֹם לְהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

**and for that light to ascend into the 'space' of Atzilut in order
to allow and make place for the Worlds of BiY"A.**

(וַעֲיִן כָּל זֶה בְּאַרְכָּה בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּל ל' ז' וְכָל ל' י"ג).

**(See in regard to all this at length in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 7 and
klal 13).**

וְכֵן הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן.

**Similarly, as regards the third revelation – the revelation of
Adam Kadmon –**

הָיָה קֶדֶם שֶׁיֵּצֵא וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט לַגְּלוּי הָרְבִיעִי, שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי אֲשֶׁר
לְאֲצִילוֹת,

**prior to emerging from A"K and extending into the fourth
revelation, the revelation of Atzilut,**

הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ הָאוֹר דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן גַּם בְּהַמָּקוֹם הָעֵתִיד לְאֲצִילוֹת.

**the light of A"K expanded into what would in the future be the
'space' of Atzilut,**

וְהָיָה שֵׁם מִקֶּדֶם רַק אוֹר דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן לְבַד שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי

**so that initially there was only the light of A"K, the third
revelation.**

וְלַמָּקוֹם הָעֵתִיד לְהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הָיָה אֵז אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן
[בְּבִחְי' הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי].

**[And as regards the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY"A, that
same light of A"K was the aspect of the second revelation]**

וְלָכֵן הָיָה נִצְרָךְ לִצְרָךְ גְּלוּיֵי דְהַאֲצִילוֹת שִׁסְתַּלֵּק וְיַעֲלֶה מֵאוֹתוֹ
הַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְאֲצִילוֹת

And therefore, for the sake of the revelation of Atzilut, it was necessary to withdraw and elevate from the space that would in the future be the space of Atzilut,

כָּל הָאוֹר דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן שֶׁהָיָה שָׁם,

all the light of Adam Kadmon that was manifested there.

וְנִסְתַּלֵּק וְיַעֲלֶה בְּעֶקְרוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה כְּדֵי לַעֲשׂוֹת וּלְתֵּן מָקוֹם

It was withdrawn and raised up to its root above in order to make space for

לְגִלּוּי הַאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרְבִיעִי,

the revelation of Atzilut, the fourth revelation,

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאָר כָּל זֶה בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל ה' ו' וְכָלֵל י"ב

as explained in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 5, 6 and klal 12.

וּלְמָקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְהִיבִי"ע הָיָה נִחָשֵׁב עַדִּין הַהֶאֱרָה הַנִּשְׁאָר מֵהָאוֹר
[הַנִּזְכָּר אַחֵר סְלוּקוֹ בְּבַחֲיַנַת הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי]

[And as regards the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY" A, that same radiance of the remaining light just mentioned, after it was withdrawn, is regarded as in the category of the third revelation].

וְכֵן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּהַגְלוּי הַשֵּׁנִי, שֶׁהוּא הִטְהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה וְאַוִּיר קַדְמוֹן,

Similarly as regards the second revelation, the *tehiru ila'a* the supernal purity and *avir kadmon* primordial space, also known as the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* (see *Sha'ar* 4 chapter 3) –

הֵנָּה קֶדֶם שֶׁיֵּצֵא וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט לְגִלּוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא אָדָם קַדְמוֹן

**prior to emerging and expanding into the third revelation,
Adam Kadmon,**

הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט הָאוֹר דְּכָל הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי גַם בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם הָעֵתִיד
לְאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

**the light of the entire second revelation expanded and spread
into what would in the future be the 'space' of Adam Kadmon.**

וְלַמָּקוֹם הָאֲצִילוֹת, וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן לְהַמָּקוֹם דְּהַבִּי"ע, הָיָה נִחְשָׁב זֶה
[בְּבַחֲיַנַּת הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן וְהִבֵּן מְאֹד].

**[And as regards the future 'space' of the World of Atzilut, and
all the more so, the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY"A, that
revelation was regarded as in the category of the first
revelation. Understand this well!]**

וְלָכֵן לְצַרֵּךְ הַגְּלוּי דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן, שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי, הָיָה נִצְרָךְ
שִׁיסְתַּלַּק כָּל הָאוֹר הָעֵקָרִי דְּהַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי לְמַעַלָּה בַּמָּקוֹמוֹ

**And therefore, for the sake of the revelation of A"K, the third
revelation, it was necessary for all the main light³ of the second
revelation to be withdrawn back into its own space above,**

וְכַדִּי לַעֲשׂוֹת וּלְתַּן מָקוֹם לְגְלוּי דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

in order to make space for the revelation of Adam Kadmon.

וְכֵן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּהַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר אֵין סוּף יִתְבָּרַךְ
שְׁמוֹ,

**And similarly the first revelation, the revelation of the *Ohr Ein Sof*,
blessed is His Name,**

שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן מֵאַמְתַּתּוֹ הַפְּשוּטָה הַנֶּעְלָמָה, וְכַנֵּ"ל שֶׁעַר ד'.

**which is the first revelation from His uncompounded true
hidden Being, as mentioned previously, *Sha'ar 4*.**

הנה קדם שיצא ממנו לגלוי השני, שהוא האור דהטהירו עלאה ואויר קדמון,

Now before the second revelation, i.e. the *tehiru ila'a* and *avir kadmon*, emerged from it from the first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

הנה היה אותו הגלוי הראשון דהאור אין סוף גם בכל המקום דהגלוי השני כלו

the entire first revelation – the *Ohr Ein Sof* – also filled the entire 'space' of the second revelation where the second revelation would be revealed in the future.

וכן משם ולמטה, והיה מאיר מתחילה בכל מקום רק אור אין סוף לבד.

So too, from there on down: from the outset, the *Ohr Ein Sof* alone illuminated all of the 'space'.

ולכן היה נצרך שישתלק ויעלה האור דאין סוף מכל אותו המקום,

And therefore it was necessary for the *Ohr Ein Sof* to be withdrawn from that entire space

כדי לתן ולעשות מקום לגלוי השני,

in order to make place for the second revelation,

וכמו שמבאר בדברי הרב בשער עגלים וישר ענף ב'

as is explained in the words of the Rabbi the Arizal in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher*, anaf number 2.

והוא הצמצום הראשון הנודע שהיה בהגלוי הראשון.

This making space for the second revelation is the well-known doctrine of *tzimtzum harishon* the initial *tzimtzum* (contraction) within the first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

וְהָרִי נִמָּצָא כִּי קִדָּם שִׁיָּצָא כָּל גָּלוּי שְׁלֵמֻטָּה,

Therefore it turns out that before any revelation appeared on a lower level,

הָיָה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ הַגָּלוּי הַקֹּדֶם בְּכָל מְקוֹם שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ וּלְמִטָּה.

The prior revelation spread out and extended from its point of origin into the entire space below.

אך לְצֶרֶךְ הַגָּלוּי שֶׁתְּחַתּוֹ נִתְצַמְצַם הַגָּלוּי הָעֶלְיוֹן וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמַעְלָה

However, for the sake of the revelation below, the higher level illumination was constricted by the *tzimtzum* and ascended to a higher plane

כְּדִי לַתֵּן מְקוֹם לְשֵׁנִי אֵלָיו, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְגַּלּוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

in order to make place for the next revelation, and in this way all the Worlds became revealed,

בְּגָלוּי אַחֵר גָּלוּי כָּל אֶחָד לְמִטָּה בַּמְדְּרָגָה מֵהָעֶלְיוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו.

through revelation after revelation, each one being on a lower level than the plane above it.

וְהַטַּעַם עַל זֶה הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל אוֹר הַיּוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ לְכָל מָה שֶׁתְּחַתּוֹ,

The reason for this for the *tzimtzum* of the higher revelation so that the lower revelation could emerge is that the higher light is in fact the root of everything below it,

וְכָלוּל בּוֹ בְּכַח וּבְהֶעָלֵם כָּל מָה שֶׁלְּמִטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ.

and the higher level encompasses within it, in a concealed manner, everything that is below it.

וְכֵן הָיָה כְּוִנַּת גְּלוּיָו מִתְחִילָה לְצַרֵּךְ כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת כְּלוּ אֲשֶׁר לְמִטָּה
הַיָּמִנִי

**Indeed, this was the intention of that revelation from the outset
– the needs of the entirety of existence below its own level,**

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ "סוּף מַעֲשֶׂה בְּמַחְשְׁבָה תְּחִלָּה".

as our Sages put it,⁴ "the final deed was first in thought".

וְלָכֵן נִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִתְחִילָה בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם דְּהַמְצִיאוֹת כְּלוּ,

**And therefore, from the outset, it spread into the entire space
of existence,**

וְכִדֵּי לְהַעֲשׂוֹת עַל יְדֵי זֶה שֶׁרֶשׁ לְכֻלָּם.

in order to become the root of everything thereby.

כִּי עַל יְדֵי יִרְדָּתוֹ וְהִתְרַחֲקוֹ מִמָּקוֹרוֹ

**Because through the descent of the light of the lower revelation⁵
and its resulting distance from its source –**

אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְצַמְצַם וְנִסְתַּלַּק הָעֲלִיוֹן שֶׁעָלִיו לְמַעְלָה

**following the *tzimtzum* and withdrawal of the superior level of
light back up to its higher state**

וַיֵּרֶד הוּא וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּמָקוֹם הָעָתִיד לְהַעֲלֹמֹת הַתְּחִתּוֹנִים,

**after it had descended and spread out in the space that would
in the future be for the lower Worlds –**

הִנֵּה נִתְצַמְצַם עַל יְדֵי זֶה וְנַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ כַּחַ וּתְכוּנָה מְאִיכוֹת הָאוֹר
הָרְאוּי לְכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם, וְנַעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי זֶה שֶׁרֶשׁ לְכֻלָּם

**now it the original light contracts, and within it there is the
potential and character of light that is suitable for each world,
and thus it becomes the source for everything.**

The explanation is this: After the first *tzimtzum* by which the *chalal* (the void) and the *tehiru ila'a* were formed, they became the source and root of all the subsequent revelations. This may allude to the idea of *reshimu* (the residue of the original *Ohr Ein Sof*) which conceals within it all of the future Worlds.⁶

ולא עוד אלא שגם אחר שנסתלק ועלה גם הוא למעלה למקומו
העקרי הראוי אליו,

Furthermore, even after it too the *Ohr Ein Sof* was withdrawn and ascended to its main place – the place most suited for it, above the *chalal*-void,

הנה הנח לכל אחד⁷ רושם אור ממנו בכל מקום ומקום לפי ערכו.

it left a residue of its light in every place for each level according to its stature.

ואותו הרשם הוא נשאר שם לעולם,

That residue remains there forever

והוא השרש הראשון והכח הפנימי לכל מציאות העתיד.

and is the first root and the inner powerhouse of the entire future existence.

ועל ידי כל זה הנה עומד גם כל מציאות היותר תחתון

And in this manner the entire existence of even the lowest level

קשור ותלוי לעולם גם בהאור היותר עליון,

Is eternally bound to, and is dependent upon, the very highest light,

ותלויים ואחודים זה בזה לעולם

such that they are dependent upon and united one with the other forever.⁸

וְכֵן אֶפְשָׁר עַל יְדֵי זֶה גַּם לְכָל יוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן לְהִתְעַלֵּה מַעְלֵי לְעֵלְיוֹ,

Furthermore, this enables even the very lowest level to ascend from level to level,

וְלַעֲלוֹת גַּם לְמַדְרַגַּת הַיּוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹן וְכִמּוֹ שִׁיְהִיָּה בְּתַכְלִית תִּקּוּן הָאַחֲרוֹן.

ascending to even the very loftiest level, as will take place with the completion of the final *tikun* rectification.

וְלָכֵן הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ מִתַּחֲלִילָה וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט כָּל גְּלוֹי הַיּוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹן

Therefore, from the outset, every higher revelation was drawn downward and expanded out

קִדְם יִצְיָאתוֹ לְגְלוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְהִמָּצִיאוֹת כָּלוּ,

prior to the emergence of the second-level revelation in the space where it would be manifested in the future.

וְכַדִּי לְהִמָּצִיא עַל יְדֵי זֶה רוֹשֶׁם וְשֹׁרֶשׁ לְכָל־מֶלֶךְ אֶת כָּל־מֶלֶךְ בּוֹ.

This was also for the purpose of producing a trace and root for everything, and including everything within it.

אֲמָנָם אַחֵר שֶׁעָשָׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בְּזֶה,

Now after producing this trace of the original light, called the *reshimu*,⁹

הָיָה חָזָר וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמָקוֹמוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו

the light was once again withdrawn and ascended to its proper place,

וְכַדִּי לַתּוֹן מָקוֹם לְכָל הַמַּדְרָגוֹת שֶׁתַּחֲתָיו,

in order to make space for the subsequent levels,

וְאִפְשָׁר לָהֶם מַעֲתָה לְצֵאת עַל מְצִיאוֹתָם גַּם כֵּן.

enabling them now to also emerge in their own manner of existence.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר עֲנִין צֶרֶךְ הַצְמָצוּם הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה בְּכָל גִּלּוּי וְגִלּוּי שֶׁבְּכָל
הַגִּלּוּיִם כָּלָם.

Thus we have explained the necessity of the *tzimtzum* of all the revelations at every level of revelation,

שֶׁהוּא כְּדֵי לִתֵּן מָקוֹם לְשֵׁנִי אֱלֹוִי

which is to make space for the revelation following it.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵצֵא כָּל חִלּוּקֵי הַמַּדְרָגוֹת כָּלָם,

And in this manner all of the different levels emerged,

שֶׁכָּל תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא בַּמַּדְרָגָה לְמַטָּה הַרְבֵּה מִהָעֶלְיוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו.

such that every lower level is on a far lower plane than the one above it.

Footnotes

1. Makover. [↩](#)

2. See Makover. [↩](#)

3. i.e. excluding the trace of light that remained. [↩](#)

4. From the *LechaDodi* hymn. [↩](#)

5. Makover. [↩](#)

6. Makover. [↩](#)

7. It seems that this should read לְכָל אֶחָד "for each..." [↩](#)

8. Since every revelation is bound to, and dependent upon, the previous revelation, it follows that *all* revelations are contained within the very first revelation and all of them are bound to, and dependent upon it (Makover). ↩

9. Makover. ↩

Chapter 2 — Concerning contraction (tsimtsum), histaklut and hitpashtut.

Tzimtzum returns to its source, filters the original light and leaves the faintest hint of it, reshimu. Role of the kav.

וְהִנֵּה עֲנִין הַצִּמְצוּם עֲצָמוּ הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל עָלִיוֹן

Now regarding the idea of the *tzimtzum* itself that takes place at every higher level in order to bring the light down to a lower level,

לְבָאָר עֲנִינוּ בְּדִיוֹק הוּא בְּאַמֶּת סוּד עֵמֶק נוֹרָא מְאֹד

– to explain precisely the concept thereof is indeed a very profound and formidable task,

וְאִין רְשׁוּת לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן בּוֹ כָּלֵל וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֵּן לְהַעֲלוֹת עַל הַכָּתֵב.

and we have no permission to even contemplate this, and all the more so to write about it.

וְעַל כֵּגוֹן זֶה וְכִיּוֹצֵא בָּזֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ז, א) בְּשֹׁכֵר 'וַיִּסְתֵּר מִשֶּׁה פָּנָיו [כִּי יֵרָא מִהִבֵּית אֶל הָאֱלֹהִים] (שְׁמוֹת ג, ו)

Regarding matters like these the Sages declared (*Berachot 7a*):
As a reward for Moses hiding his face [for he was afraid to gaze at the Almighty (Exodus 3:6)]

זָכָה לְקַלְסֵתָּ פָּנִים בְּשֹׁכֵר כִּי יֵרָא זָכָה לְוַיִּירָאוּ מִגִּשֶׁת אֱלֹיוֹ [רָאָה שְׁמוֹת לד, ל]

he merited that the divine luster shone from his face, and because 'he was afraid to gaze at...' 'they were afraid to approach him' see what the verse states in Exodus 34:30.

בְּשֹׁכֵר מִהִבֵּית זָכָה לְוַתְּמוּנָתָהּ יְבִיטָה [בַּמַּדְבָּר יב, ח]

**As a reward for not gazing earlier he was found worthy of
"upon the image of God he gazes" [Numbers 12:8].**

וְכֵן נֹאמַר מִשְׁלִי (כה, ב) כְּבֹד אֱלֹהִים הִסְתֵּר דְּבָר.

Similarly, it states in *Mishlei* (Proverbs 25:2) that: "It is the honor of God to conceal a matter," indicating that matters that are not revealed explicitly in the Torah should remain hidden.

אֲמֵנָם בְּאֶשֶׁר שָׁאִין דְּרָכֵי לִסְתֵּם אֶלֶּא לְפָרֵשׁ,

However, as it is not my approach to remain silent, but rather to expound,

כִּי כָל מָה שֶׁחֲנָנִי אֱלֹהִים מִתַּעֲלוּמוֹת חֲכָמָה הוּא רַק לְהוֹצִיאָם
לְאוֹר

for all the secrets of wisdom to which the Almighty has granted me access, is for the sole purpose of bringing them to light.

וּלְזֹאת רְמִזְתִּי גַם הָעֵנָן הַנּוֹרָא הַזֶּה גַּם כֵּן בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת מִדְּבָרֵינוּ

Therefore I have hinted to even this awesome secret in our words in a number of places,

בְּשַׁעַר עֲגוּלִים וְיִשָּׁר עֵנָף ב' וּבִסְפֵּר הַדְּעָה וּבִסְפֵּר הַכְּלָלִים

such as in our commentary on *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Iggulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*, and in *Sefer HaDe'ah* (*Drushei Olamot HaTohu*, the second part of his magnum opus *Leshem Shv'o v'Achlama*), and in *Sefer HaK'lalim*.

וְהִמְעִינוּ הָאֲמִתִּי יַעֲמֵד עֲלֵיהֶם וְיִהְיֶה רָצוֹן שְׁלֵא יִכָּשֶׁל.

One with a true interest in the matter will come to understand them, and may it be His will that he will not stumble.

וּבְאֶשֶׁר מִלְבָּאָר עֵמֶק עֲנִינוּ בְּפִרְטִיּוֹת אֵי אִפְשָׁר

But since explaining that concept in depth and in detail is impossible in the current context,

וְלִזְאֵת לֹא נִדְבֵר עֲתָה אֶלָּא בְּפִשְׁטוּת הָעֵינָן לְבַד

we will discuss it now on a superficial level only,

כִּי בְּכָל עֵינָן יֵשׁ עֲמָק וּפֶשֶׁט, נִגְלָה וְנִסְתָּר

because in every concept there is its depth and its plain meaning, its revealed and its hidden aspects,

וְהֵם מִתְאַיָּמִים זֶה עִם זֶה וּמִכְּנָוִים זֶה בְּזֶה.

and they concur with one another and parallel one another.

In other words, the superficial level and the plain meaning do not *conceal* the deeper, esoteric meaning, but parallel it precisely, so that the former reveal the contours of the latter for those who are well versed in the esoteric wisdom.

וְלֹא עוֹד אֶלָּא שֶׁהַכָּל הוֹלֵךְ אַחֵר הַפֶּשֶׁט

And furthermore, 'everything follows the plain meaning', as the Talmud (*Shabbat* 63a; *Makkot* 20b) declares regarding verses in Scripture. So that from the plain meaning it is possible to arrive at the deeper meaning.

וְלָכֵן נִדְבֵר עֲתָה בְּפִשְׁטוֹ לְבַד וְהוּא זֶה

So therefore let's now discuss the plain meaning alone, which is this:

כִּי עֵינָן הַצְמָצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַסִּתְּלָקוּת וְעֲלִיַּת הָאוֹר לְמַעַלָּה

The concept of the *tzimtzum* is the withdrawal and ascent of the light on high.

כָּבֵד אֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל שַׁעַר ה' פ"א שְׁאִין הַכּוֹנֵה שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר לַמָּטָה פָּנוּי
וְרִיקָם מְכֹל וְכֹל

We already explained above (*Sha'ar* 5:1) that this does not mean that the lower level from which the light was withdrawn remains completely empty and void,

כי לעולם הוא שאין העדר החלטי בשום מקום

**for it is invariably the case that no total absence exists
anywhere,**

ולא היה ולא יהיה לעולם העדר החלטי בשום זמן

and there was never a total absence at any time,

וכמו שכתב הרמב"ם ז"ל (מ"נ ב, ל) וכמה קדושי עליון עמו שאין
ריקות בשום מקום וכנ"ל שער ה' פ"א.

**as the Rambam states (*Moreh Nevuchin* 2:30), and a number of
distinguished holy Sages agree with him that there is no
complete void in any place, as mentioned above *Sha'ar* 5:1.**

אך ענין הצמצום הנה הוא עצמו מציאות גם כן

**Rather, the concept of the *tzimtzum* is that it itself is also an
existence and not just an absence.**

והיינו כי הנה הוא בחינת כח פרטי אחד המחשיך ומסתיר את
האור ומגבילו.

**That is to say, it the *tzimtzum* is a specific Divine power that
obscures and conceals the light and limits it,**

והוא בבחי' מסך העומד לפני האור

and it acts as a screen in front of the light.

וכאשר נסתלק ועלה האור למעלה

When the light was withdrawn and ascended on high

והאור ההוא אשר עלה הנה הוא בבחינת אין סוף

– and the light that ascended was the aspect of infinity (*ein sof*)

אשר אין להבחין בו שום בחינה גבולי כלל ושום כח פרטי כלל

in which there was absolutely no aspect of limitation, and no discrete powers at all,

כי כל אור עליון נגד התחתון הוא אין סוף בערכו

since every superior light is regarded as infinite in comparison to an inferior one,

וכן כל ה' גלויים שחשבנו לעיל שער ד'

and so too, all the five revelations listed in *Sha'ar 4* –

הנה נחשב כל עליון נגד התחתון לבחינת אין סוף

because every superior light is regarded as infinite in comparison to an inferior one,

שלא נבחן בו שום גבולי ושום כח פרטי

since no limitation and no discrete power can be discerned therein.

ובאשר עלה ונסתלק כל עליון למעלה

Now when the entire superior level of light ascended and was withdrawn on high,

הנה על ידי סלוקו ועליתו נתגלה ונאצל ממנו כח פרטי אחד

due to its withdrawal and ascent, a single discrete power was revealed and emanated

המחשיך ומסתיר את האור שעומד לפניו ונתן הרחקה אליו

that obscured and concealed the light in front of which it was placed, and it provided some distance therefrom.

ונמשך ומתפשט הכח הזה בכל המקום העתיד להמציאות כלו

This power was then drawn down and propagated throughout the future space of the entire existence,

ומחשיך ומבדיל בפני האור שעלה למעלה

obscuring the higher light and separating the lower light from it.¹

ועליו נאמר (תהלים יח, יב) ישת חשך סתרו סביבותיו סכתו

Regarding this the verse (Psalms 18:12) states "He made darkness His concealment, around Him, His shelter"

כי נעשה בפני האור כמסך ופרגוד לפניו.

because it the *tzimtzum* became like a screen and curtain before the light.

וכן נאמר עליו (תהלים צז, ב) ענן וערפל סביביו

Similarly in this regard it states in another verse (Psalms 97:2) 'Cloud and dense darkness surround Him,'

כי הוא כעין עביות העומד בפני האור.

for it is the *tzimtzum* like a dense curtain standing before the light.

והנה כל שעור המשך הכח הלז הוא נקרא בשם חלל ומקום פנוי

Now the entire span of this power of *tzimtzum* is called the *chahal* void and *makom panui* empty space

כי הוא המקום להמציאות העתיד שנעשה בו אחר כך.

for it is the place in which future existence would subsequently be fashioned.

והוא החלל דהצמצום אשר בו נעשה כל המציאות כלו

This is the void produced by the *tzimtzum* in which the entire existence is formed,

ונעשה כל המציאות מהצמצום עצמו

and indeed the entire existence is a product of the *tzimtzum* itself.

והיינו כי הנה אותו הצמצום שאמרנו שהוא כח המחשיך ובחינת עביות,

That is to say, from that very *tzimtzum* which we described as the power of darkness and the aspect of condensation or density

—

הנה ממנו נמשך ונעשה כל בחינת הגוף וכלים להמציאות שנעשה שם אחר כך

from this itself all aspects of the body and vessels were drawn and fashioned into the form of existence it would be afterwards.

כי אחר שנסתלק האור ממנו,

Because after the light was withdrawn from it from the void,

ונאצל ונעשה על ידי זה כח המחשיך ומסתיר ומגביל את האור כנזכר

through this there was emanated and produced a power of darkening and concealing that limits the light, as mentioned.

הנה אחר שעלה האור ממנו ונשארו אותו הכח למטה לבדו

Now after light ascended from it from the void with the first *tzimtzum* **all that remained below was its power** to darken and conceal

נחשך עוד יותר ונתוסף בו עבוי על עבוי

it became even darker, and layer upon layer of density was added.

ונשלם על ידי זה בכל תכונות וכחות הגבוליים ככל הנזכר

And thus were completed all the finite characteristics and powers that were necessary

להוציא ממנו ועל ידו את כל החמר והגוף דהמציאות שלמטה.

to produce from it and by it all of the material and the body of existence below.

אמנם הוא כי הנה הצמצום עצמו שהוא הפך המסתיר ומגביל את האור

Indeed, the *tzimtzum* itself, which is the power of obscuring and limiting the light,

כאשר עומד הוא לבדו הנה לא נעשה באמת עדין ממנו שום דבר כלל

were it to stand alone, nothing at all would have actually been produced thereby –

כי הוא לבדו הנה הוא רק בבחינת כח היולי העומד מוכן לקבל כל צורה

for on its own, the void is merely a preternatural potential (urpotential, primeval potential) that stands ready to receive any form,

אבל הוא גופה לא נראה בו עדין שום צורה כלל ואינו נופל עליו שם מציאות כלל

while it itself has no visible form at all, and the term 'existence' does not even apply to it.

ואדרבה הוא כי נראה שהוא היפך המציאות

On the contrary, it appears to be the *opposite* of existence,

כי הרי המציאות הראשון עלה ונסתלק

for the first 'manifestation' the *Ohr Ein Sof* ascended and withdrew,

והוא עומד לפניו ומחשיך עליו ומסתירו

and it the void stands in front of it and darkens it and conceals it.

וּמִצִּיאוֹת אַחֵר עֲדִין לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ וְאִם כֵּן הָרִי נִתֵּן לְרֹאוֹת בּוֹ כְּמוֹ
חֶלֶל וְאוֹר פָּנוּי,

And since, as yet, no other existence is made within it within the void, this permits what looks like a void and empty space to be perceived within the void.

וְלֹא נִתְגַּלָּה אוֹתוֹ הַכֹּחַ דֵּהֶצְמָצוּם בְּבַחֲיִנַת מִצִּיאוֹת

Thus the power of *tzimtzum* did not reveal any aspect of existence

אֲלָא רַק עַל יְדֵי שְׁחִזּוֹר הַמַּאֲצִיל עָלְיוֹן וְהַמְּשִׁיךְ בּוֹ אַחֵר כֵּךְ

until after the Supernal Emanator once again beamed into it

קוֹ אוֹר אֶחָד מְאוֹר הָרֵאשׁוֹן שֶׁעָלָה,

a line of light called the *kav* from the original light that ascended and became the *igul hagadol*.²

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה אֲזַי כֹּחוֹ וּפְעֻלָּתוֹ דְּכָל הַצְמָצוּם גַּם כֵּן

In this manner the power and effect of the entire *tzimtzum* was also revealed,

כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה הוּא עִם הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בּוֹ לְבַחֲיִנַת חִמְר וְצוּרָה,

since it produced, together with the light of the *kav* that spread into it into the void, the aspect of substance and form

וְהֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם מִצִּיאוֹת אֶחָת

which are a single entity – form without substance is merely potential, and substance does not manifest without form.

היינו שהם שניהם היסוד והשרש דכל העולם כלו שנעשה בו
בכלליו ופרטיו

That is to say, both of them the *kav* and the void together are the foundation and the root of the entire universe that is fashioned within it within the void generally and specifically.

What is meant by 'general' and 'specific' will be explained below.

כי כל כלל העולם וכל המציאויות הפרטיים שבו

For every general principle regarding the universe, and all the specific existing entities within it,

הנה כלם יוצאים ונעשים מאותו הצורה והחמר דהקו וצמצום

all emerge and manifest from that same form and substance of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*.

והנה פעל האור בהצמצום והצמצום בהאור כל אחד לפי כחו
ותכונתו

Now the light of the *kav* had an effect on the *tzimtzum* and the *tzimtzum* on the light of the *kav* – each according to its function and character

כי האור הנה דרכו הוא להיות מאיר ומתגלה

The nature of light is to illuminate and reveal –

שהוא להוציא ולהמציא עולם מלא ומציאויות שונות

to bring forth and produce a complete universe with all types of existences,

מכל המציאויות כלם הראוי לעולם שלם

including the entire range of existences that are suitable for a complete world,

על ידי האור העליון אשר יצא ממנו

by means of the supernal light from which it the *kav* emerged.

וּבְחִינַת הַצְמָצוּם הִנֵּה טָבְעוּ הוּא לְצַמְצֵם וְלִתֵּן גְּבוּל לְכָל דָּבָר

The nature of the *tzimtzum* is to contract and place limitations on everything,

וּלְהַסְתִּיר וּלְהַעֲלִים אֶת הָאוֹר לְהִיּוֹת לְמַסָּךְ לִפְנֵי

and to obscure and conceal the light and act as a screen before it.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הִנֵּה יוֹצֵא וְנֹעֵשֶׂה מִשְׁנֵיהֶם יַחַד מְצִיאווִיּוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת
מִפְּרָטִים רַבִּים.

In this manner, from both of them together, different types of existence with all their details, emerge and are produced.

וְהֵינּוּ לִפִּי כָּל אֵיכוֹת הַכֹּחוֹת שֶׁשָּׁנָם בְּהָאוֹר

In other words, in accordance with the qualities of the powers that there are in the light,

וּלִפִּי כָּל תְּכוּנוֹת הַכֹּחוֹת דֵּהַצְמָצוּם הַמְסַתִּירוֹ וּמַגְבִּילוֹ וְנֹעֵשֶׂה
לְמַסָּךְ לִפְנֵי.

and according to all the characteristics and powers of the *tzimtzum* that obscures and limits the light, acting as a figurative screen before it

שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת עֲבִיּוֹת וְגוֹף וְכָלִי

– this is what produces the aspect of denseness and 'body' and vessel.

וְכֵן נֹעֵשֶׂה עַל יְדֹו לְכָל פֶּרֶט וּפְרָט מִהַמְצִיאווִיּוֹת כֻּלָּם

And also due to it the *tzimtzum* every detail of all existing entities is formed.

וְהָרִי יוֹצֵא עַל יְדֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם מְצִיאוּיוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת רַבּוֹת כָּל אֶחָד בְּבַחֲיִנַת
אֹר וְכָלִי

Thus both of them together produce manifold different types of existences, all of them having the aspects of light and vessel.

שֶׁהָרִי כָּל כַּח פְּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהָאֹר הוּא מֵאִיר וּמוֹצִיא וּמְמַצִּיא מְצִיאֹת
אֶחָת לְפִי אִיכוּתוֹ

Because every individual detail in the light of the *kav* shines forth and produces and brings forth one aspect of existence, according to its particular quality,

וְכָל מָה שֶׁהוּא מוֹצִיא וּמְמַצִּיא הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּבַחֲיִנַת אֹר וּנְשָׁמָה
לְבַד

and whatever it brings forth and produces is only an aspect of light and soul.

אֲךָ כַּח הַצְמָצוּם אֲשֶׁר מְתַיַּחַד עִם הָאֹר וּמְסַבְּבוֹ מְכַל סְבִיבֵי

But the power of the *tzimtzum* that unites with the light of the *kav*, enveloping it all around,

הֵנָּה מְצַמְצָמוֹ וּמַגְבִּילוֹ וְגוֹרֵם לוֹ עֲבִיּוֹת וְנַעֲשֶׂה עָלָיו לְגוֹף וְכָלִי.

contracts and limits the light of the *kav* and causes it to 'thicken' (or 'condense') becoming a 'body' or 'vessel' for it.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵנָּה יוֹצְאִים וְנַעֲשִׂים כָּל הַמְצִיאֹיוֹת³ כֻּלָּם

In this way all entities emerge into existence and are formed

אֲשֶׁר בְּפֶרֶטוֹת וּפְרָטִי פְרָטוֹת כָּל אֶחָד מֵחֶמֶר וְצוּרָה שֶׁהוּא גּוֹף
וּנְשָׁמָה

so that every detail, and every sub-detail is comprised of substance and form, which is also body and soul.

וּמִתְגַּלִּים וּמִתְרַבֵּים הַמְצִיאֹיוֹת לְפִי כָּל הַכּחוֹת וְהָאִיכוּת שֶׁבְּהָאֹר

These entities are revealed and proliferate according to the powers and qualities inherent in the light,

ולפי כל התכונות והכחות שבהצמצום

and according to all the characteristics and powers in the *tzimtzum*.

והם בחינת קו וצמצום שהם היסוד והשרש דכל עולם

These, the light and the power of constriction, are called the *kav* and *tzimtzum*, and they are the foundation and root of every world,

והם יצאו ונעשו מכל גלוי וגלוי אחר שנסתלק כל עליון ועלה למעלה כנ"ל פ"א.

and they emerged and were manifested with each and every revelation after the higher aspect withdrew and ascended on high, as explained in chapter 1.

כי מתחילה הנה נעשה על ידי זה הצמצום ואחר כך חזר והאיר באור קו אחד

For at the outset the withdrawal of the light constitutes a *tzimtzum*, and the subsequent return to illuminate with a single line of light constitutes a revelation of the *kav*.

ומזה יצא העולם התחתון שהוא הגלוי השני

And from this emerges a lower plane, a second revelation.

והיה כל זה מכל אחד ואחד, היינו מאור אין סוף שבהטהירו עלאה ואויר קדמון לאדם קדמון

This is true at each and every level – between the *Ohr Ein Sof* of the *Tehiru Ila'a* and *Avir Kadmon* and *Adam Kadmon* there is a *tzimtzum* and *kav*,

ומאדם קדמון לאצילות ומהאצילות לבי"ע

and so too from Adam Kadmon to Atzilut, and from Atzilut to BiY" A.

כי בכל גלוי עליון היה צמצום והתפשטות קו לצורך הגלוי השני

In each case, there was a *tzimtzum* of the higher level and the extension of a line of light the *kav* for the sake of the second revelation.

שכל הגלוי השני הוא רק בבחינת קו אחד דק מהאור דהגלוי הראשון

Every subsequent revelation is only the aspect of a thin line *kav* of light from the revelation of the light of the previous level,

אשר נתגלה ונתפשט בו אחר שנסתלק, שהוא בהצמצום שנעשה בסלוקו

and becomes revealed and spreads forth after the prior withdrawal.

ועל ידי כל זה הנה ירד המציאות דהגלוי השני

By way of this entire process, the second level of revelation descends and materializes,

בירידת מדרגה הרבה ממדרגת האור העליון שהיה שם בתחלה

descending a huge step down from the higher level of light that was there initially.

וירדו על ידי זה העולמות כלם במדרגה למטה ממדרגה

And thus all the worlds descended from level to level

עד שהגיע להמציאות דעולם העשיה והעולם הזה

until the World of Asiyah and this physical world materialized

—

שאין למטה הימנה בכמותה ואיכותה.

below which there is no lower level in quality or quantity.

כָּלֵל הַיּוֹצֵא מִדְּבָרֵינוּ כִּי הָיָה בְּחִינַת צִמְצוּם וְקוּ מְכַל גְּלוּי הָעֲלִיוֹן
לְהַגְלוּי שְׁתַּחֲתִי

The fundamental principle that emerges from our analysis is that there was an aspect of *tzimtzum* and *kav* between every higher level revelation and the revelation below it,

וְאִין הַצִּמְצוּם הָעֶדֶר וְרִיקְנִי אֵלָא הוּא כַּח הַמְחָשִׁיךְ וּמִסְתִּיר אֶת
הָאוֹר וְכַח הַגְּבוּלִי

and that the *tzimtzum* is not an absence and an emptiness, but rather the power of darkening and concealing the light; it is also the power of limitation,

וְהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ דְּכָל גּוֹף וְכָלִי

and is the source for every body and vessel.

אֲמָנָם לֹא נִרְאָה וְלֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ שׁוּם דְּבָר אֵלָא עַל יְדֵי הַקּוּ דְּיוֹקָא

However, nothing is revealed or produced other than by means of the *kav*.

וְהֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם כְּמוֹ חֶמֶר וְצוּרָה

Together they the *tzimtzum* and the *kav* are comparable to substance and form,

וּמֵהֶם יֵצֵא וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל הַמְצִיאִיוֹת כְּלָם דְּכָל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹן

and from them the entire existence of the lower world emerges and is produced,

כִּי הַקּוּ וְהַצִּמְצוּם הוּא שֶׁרֶשָׁם

since the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* are their root.

וּבְכָלֵל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כְּלָם הֵנָּה הוּא הַטְּהִירוֹ עֲלֵאָה וְאוֹיר הַקִּדְמוֹן

In the general category of all Worlds, the *Tehiru Ila'ah* and the *Avir Kadmon*

שהם הקו והצמצום הראשון אשר מהגלוי הראשון שהוא האור
אין סוף

**are the original *kav* and *tzimtzum* that constricted the first
revelation – the *Ohr Ein Sof*,**

כי הם השורש דכל העולמות כלם

for they are the root of *all* the Worlds.

ועל ידי הקו והצמצום הנעשה מכל עולם עליון להעולם שתחתיו

**And it is by way of a *kav* and a *tzimtzum* that occur between
each higher World and the World below it**

ונעשה כל עולם שלמטה רק מקו אחד דק מאור העליון

**that each World below is produced from a single faint *kav*
emerging from the higher level of light.**

הנה על ידי זה ירדו העולמות במדרגה למטה ממדרגה

In this way the Worlds devolved from level to level,

עד המציאות דהעולם הזה שהיא תחתונה ולמטה מכלם

**until this world, the lowest of all the Worlds, came into
existence.**

אמנם לבאר הדבר בפרטיות בכל עולם ועולם וסדר השתלשלותם

**However, to explain this in detail regarding each of the Worlds,
and the order in which they devolved,**

הנה הם ארפים מאד והם מבארים בדברינו בספר הכללים

**would require a very lengthy treatise, and has already been
explained in our *Sefer haKlalim*,**

שהוא כלו מִיֶּסֶד עַל זֶה וְשֵׁם מִתְבָּאֵר כָּל הַדְּבָרִים הַלְלוּ בְּנִמְוָקוּ
וְטַעֲמוֹ יַעֲיִן עוֹד שָׁם.

**which is based entirely on this matter. There all of these
concepts are explained in depth and with reasons. See there.**

Footnotes

1. See Makover fn. 31. [↩](#)
2. See *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Iggulim v'Yosher sha'ar 1, anaf 2*. [↩](#)
3. This follows the version in *Meir HaLeshem*. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The kav (the funnel in tsimtsum) and the matters of the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent) lights.

Role of the kav and its attributes. Makifim: surrounding light.

הנה מה שאמרנו כי מתפשט קו אור אחד נדק

Now when we said that a single thin line of light called the *kav* spreads forth

במקום הצמצום מהאור העליון אשר נסתלק ועלה,

into the region of the *tzimtzum* from the higher light that was withdrawn and ascended,

ומאותו הקו אור נעשה כל המציאות דעולם התחתון.

and from that *kav* of light the entire existence of the lower world¹ was fashioned.

הנה ישנו באותו הקו ב' בחי'

Now in this *kav* there are two aspects:

אחד הוא כל ההתלבשות דשתיים שהן ארבע אשר אמרנו לעיל
שער ה' פ"ב ופ"ג

One, the entire process of enclothing – called *hitlavshut* – the 'two that are four' – as we explained above Sha'ar 5, chapters 2 & 3.

והיינו כי יורד ומתפשט מאור העליון וכן מכל העליונים כלם

Meaning to say, there descends and diffuses from the superior light, and from all the superior levels,

ומתלבשים בהארתם בהקו בהבחינת דשתיים שהן ארבע וכמו
שבארנו שם

a radiance that is clothed in the *kav* in the manner of 'two that are four' as explained there in *Sha'ar* 5, chapters 2 & 3**.**

וְהַשְׁנִי הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה עֶקֶר הָעֲצָמוֹת דָּאוֹר הַקּוֹ

The second aspect of the *kav* is that the primary essence of the light of the *kav*

הוּא בְּאֵמֶת זוּלָת כָּל הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הַנִּזְכָּר

is truly independent of the process of 'enclothing' mentioned previously.

אֵלָּא שֶׁהוּא מָה שֶׁשִּׁיךְ לָעֵצָם הַתַּחְתּוֹן גּוֹפָה מִשְׁרָשׁוֹ וּמַעְקָרוֹ

Instead it is related to the essence of the lower aspect itself, in terms of its root and origin.

כִּי הֵנָּה נִתֵּן מִהַמָּאֲצִיל הָעֲלִיוֹן ית"ש בְּכָל אוֹר עֲלִיוֹן

This is because the Supernal Emanator, blessed be His name, imbued every supernal light

שֶׁרֶשׁ וְרוֹשֵׁם לַהֲמָצִיאוֹת דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן

with the root and the imprint of the lower aspects of existence.

וְהוּא מִנְּחַ גִּנְזָה וְטִמְרֵי בְּאוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן וּמוֹכֵן לְעוֹלָם רַק לַהֲתַחְתּוֹן.

And this root and imprint is located in a concealed and secret manner in the supernal light, and is always primed exclusively for the lower aspects.

וּבִתְחִלָּה הֵנָּה הוּא מִשְׁרָשׁ בְּהָעֲלִיוֹן רַק בְּכֹחַ לְבַד

Initially it the imprint of the lower aspect is rooted in the upper level only in potential,²

אֲךָ עַל יְדֵי יְרִידַת כָּל אוֹר עֲלִיוֹן וְהַתְּפַשְׁטוּתוֹ בִּתְחִלָּה בְּמָקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לַהֲתַחְתּוֹן כְּנִ"ל פ"א,

but, via the descent of the supernal light and its initial diffusion below, into the place where the lower aspects would exist in the future, as explained previously (Part one)

הנה יוצא אז אותו השרש מהכח אל הפעל ומהעלם אל הגלוי

that root then emerges from potential to actual, and from concealment to revelation.

ומתגלה בו אז שהוא השרש דהתחתון.

And then it is revealed as the root of the lower aspect.

ובאשר מסתלק האור ועולה למעלה בעת הצמצום

When the light of the *Ohr Ein Sof* withdraws and ascends at the time of the *tzimtzum*

הנה מסתלק ועולה עמו אותו השרש דהתחתון ג"כ

then the root of the lower aspect ascends together with it.

והנה נתוסף לו בעליתו למעלה תוספת אור וברכה הרבה מאור
א"ס העליון

Now when it the lower light ascends above to its root in the higher light,³ abundant additional light and blessing is added to it from the supernal *Ohr Ein Sof*.⁴

כי מקדם לא היה אלא רק בחינת שרש דק וקטן וכגרעיני פרי

For initially the connection of the lower light to the higher light was only like a slender, tiny root, like tiny seeds of a fruit.

אך בעליתו למעלה הנה נתוסף בו אור וברכה מלמעלה

but after its ascent above, light and blessing was added to it,

בתוספת מרבה על העקר

an additional abundance that is greater than the initial outlay.

ונעשה ונשלם לשרש שלם וכן מתלבש בו ומתיחד עמו כל
ההתלבשות דשתיים שהן ארבע

And thus it becomes fully manifested as a complete root, and within it is clothed and integrated the entire *hitlavshut* the 'enclothing process' of two that are four,

מכל האורות העליונים בלם

as well as all the supernal lights.

ומכל זה יורד ונמשך הקו אור בהצמצום ונבנה מהם כל הבנין
דאותו העולם אשר יורד בו וכנ"ל פ"ב:

From all of this the *kav* is drawn down via the *tzimtzum* and the entire edifice of that world that descends via the *kav* is built, as we explained in chapter 2.

והרי נמצא כי הקו הנה הוא מיסד משני בחי'

So it turns out that the *kav* is in fact comprised of two elements:

אחד הוא מאור עצמותו גופה שהוא עצמות האור השיך לאותו
העולם

One is the essential light itself, which is the essence of the light appropriate for that world,

שיוורד בו אשר הוכן לו מתחלתו מהמאציל עליון

that descends with it with the *kav* and was prepared from the outset for this by the Supernal Emanator.

והוא עקרו וחלקו השיך אליו עצמו בסוף מעשה והוא במחשבה
תחלה

And this is the primary aspect and portion assigned to it as the final act of Creation that arose initially in thought.

וְהַשְׁנִי הוּא כָּל הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת דְּשִׁתִּים שֶׁהוּן אַרְבַּע מִכָּל הָאוֹרוֹת
הָעֲלִיוֹנִים כָּלָם

The second aspect is the *hitlavshut* of 'two that are four' – the two aspects of *olam* (world) and *nefesh* (person)⁵ that subdivide into chambers and garments, bodies and souls,

הַמְשִׁתְּתָפִים עִמּוֹ וּמִתְיַחֲדִים בּוֹ וְכָנָ"ל שֶׁ"ה פ"ג.

that join with it with the *kav* and are united in it, as explained above Sha'ar 5 chapter 3.

אֲמָנָם הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הָאוֹר עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר אֲמָרְנוּ שֶׁיִּשְׁנֹו בְּכָל עוֹלָם

Indeed, the essential light that is in every world, as we stated,

הִנֵּה הוּא גַם כֵּן בִּב' בְּחִינֹת אֶחָד פְּנִימִי וְאֶחָד מְקִיף

is also manifested in two aspects: one aspect that is internalized, and the other – encompassing.

כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל מְצִיאת הַקּוֹ אֲשֶׁר אֲמָרְנוּ הִנֵּה הוּא בְּבְחִינַת אוֹר וְכָלִי

For the entire character of the *kav*, as we mentioned, is that it has two aspects – 'light' and 'vessel.'

כִּי עַל יְדֵי זֶה הוּא רַק בְּבְחִינַת קוֹ דֵּק כִּי הַכָּלִי שָׁבוּ מִצִּמְצֻמוֹ
וּמִגְבִּילוֹ

And for this reason it is only a *thin* line of light – because the vessel aspect therein constricts and limits it.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ הַכָּלִי מִכֹּחַ הַצִּמְצוּם אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט בּוֹ

And the 'vessel' is formed in it by the power of the *tzimtzum* that permeates it,

כי הרי הקו הוא מתפשט בהצמצום כנ"ל.

since the *kav* extends out via the *tzimtzum*, as noted previously.⁶

ועל כל פנים הוא כי הקו הוא בבחינת אור וכלי

In any event, the *kav* is comprised of 'light and vessel,'

וכאשר נכנס האור בהכלי הנה נחלק לשנים שלא נכנס בהכלי
אלא רק חלק קטן ממנו

and when the light enters the vessel it is divided into two, since only a fraction of the light enters the vessel,

אבל החלק היותר גדול הוא נשאר מבחוץ ומקיפו מסביב

while the majority of the light remains outside of it, enveloping it on all sides.⁷

והרי לנו כי גם האור עצמותו שבכל עולם הנה הוא גם כן בב'
בחינות אחד פנימי ואחד מקיף.

Thus we have it that even the essential light in every world also presents in two aspects – one, internalized light (*ohr pnimi*), and the other, enveloping light (*ohr makif*).

והנה תועלת המקיפים הוא כי הרי האור הפנימי הנה הוא
מצמצם בהגוף וכלי

Now the superiority of the enveloping light is that the *ohr pnimi* the internalized light is constricted within a body and a vessel, whereas the *ohr makif* (the enveloping light) is not constricted by a body or vessel.

והם אינם מנגדים זה לזה לעולם אלא אדרבה שמתחדים זה בזה

Now these lights the *ohr pnimi* and the *ohr makif* do not ever oppose one another. The opposite is true – they unite with one another,

ואינו פועל כל אחד אלא ע"י חברו

and each of them has an effect via the other as will be explained below.

כי פעלת כל אור הפנימי שהוא הנשמה הרי הוא ע"י הגוף

The *ohr pnimi*, which is the soul the *neshama***, acts via the body** which comes from the *ohr makif*,

ופעלת כל הגוף הרי הוא רק בכם הנשמה שבו

and the entire body acts only by virtue of the soul within it.

ושניהם שולטים בשוה ומסתכלים זה על זה

Both of them the body and the soul are equally in control, and each looks to the other for affirmation.

כי הגוף מסתכל על הנשמה לשאב ממנה חיותה תמיד

The body looks to the soul for the life-force that it draws from the soul,

והנשמה מסתכל על הגוף שלא ליגע אותו וּשלא לפעל בו יותר מכחו

and the soul looks at the body to ensure that it is not exhausting it, and is not taxing it beyond its capabilities.

ולכן הוא כי הנה הגם שמתלבש בכל עולם ופרצוף תחתון

And therefore, although there is clothed in every lower world and *partzuf*

מכל האורות העליונים כלם וכנ"ל שע"ה פ"ג

some of all the supernal lights, as mentioned in Sha'ar 5 chapter 3,

עם כל זה הנה אינם מתגלים בו אלא במעוט היותר אפשרי

nevertheless, they are not revealed in it in that lower world more than the minimum necessary,

הַיֵּינוּ לְפִי כַח הַגּוּף וְהַכֵּלִי שִׁיּוּכָל לְקַבֵּל וְלִסְבֹּל

i.e., according to the capacity of the body to receive and withstand,

וּמִתְצַמְצָמִים כָּל הָאוֹרוֹת שֶׁמִתְלַבָּשִׁים בּוֹ לְפִי כַח הַגּוּף

and all the lights that are clothed in the body are constricted according to the capacity of the body to receive etc.

וּמַעֲלִים אוֹתוֹ וּמְצַבְכִּים אוֹתוֹ רַק לֹאט לֹאט וּבְמַעוֹט גָּדוֹל

And they the lights that are clothed in the body elevate and refine it only gradually, in a greatly reduced manner.

כִּי בְּאֵם שֶׁהֵיוּ מִתְגַּלִּים בּוֹ בְּתִקְרָא אוֹרָם הֵיךְ מִתְבַּטֵּל הַגּוּף וְכֵלִי מִכָּל
וְכָל

For if they the illuminations of the soul and likewise the supernal lights would be revealed in the body in their full power, the body and the vessel would be completely nullified,

וְאִזְ הֵיךְ חוֹזֵר גַּם כָּל הָאוֹר כֵּלָּו לְמַעְלָה וּלְשָׁרְשׁוֹ

and then all the light would then return to its source above,

כִּי אֵין לְהָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי מָקוֹם וְעִמִּידָה בְּהָעוֹלָם הַתַּחְתּוֹן

since the *ohr pnimi* has no place and standing in the lower world

אֶלָּא רַק ע"י הַגּוּף וְכֵלִי שֶׁמִתְלַבָּשׁ בּוֹ

other than by way of the body and the vessel in which it is clothed.

אֲמָנָם הָאוֹר הַמְקִיף הֵנָּה הוּא אֵינוֹ כֵּן כִּי הָרִי הוּא אֵינוֹ מִתְלַבָּשׁ
בְּהַגּוּף וְהַפְּרָצוּף כָּלֵל

However, this is not so regarding the *ohr makif* since it is not clothed in a body or a *partzuf*⁸ at all,

ולא נתצמצם באורו לפי כח הגוף

and its light is not constricted according to the capacity of the body to receive,

והנה אינו צריך הוא להשתוות את עצמו עם הגוף מאומה

and so it does not have to align itself with the body at all,

כי מה שפועל הוא הנה אינו נמשך פעלתו ע"י הגוף כלל

since the way it operates it not by way of the body at all.

וממנו הוא כל הנסים הנגלים אשר הם כלם למעלה מהטבע
לגמרי

And from it from the *ohr makif* come all the revealed miracles that completely transcend the natural order.

ומשום שלא נמשך פעלתו ע"י הגוף

And since it does not operate via the body,

ולכן אפשר לו לצאת ולהתגלה בתקף אורו למעלה מכח הגוף
לגמרי

it is possible for the *makif* light to emerge and become revealed in its full strength, completely transcending the limitations of the body,

ולעשות הפכו ועם כל זה אינו גורם שום בטול להגוף

and act the opposite of it of the body's limitations and still not cause any nullification of the body.²

אלא הוא עושה את פעלתו גם בעת שהגוף קיים ובתוך הגוף עצמו

Instead, it operates while the body continues as usual, and even in the body itself,

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינוֹ מַבְטֵל אוֹתוֹ וְאֵינוֹ מְזִיז אוֹתוֹ מִמְקוֹמוֹ כָּלֵל

yet it still does not nullify the body or move it from its proper place at all.

אֲלֵא שֶׁהַגּוֹף עוֹמֵד עַל עַמְדוֹ וְהָאוֹר עוֹשֶׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹף
עֲצוּמוֹ, הַגֵּם שֶׁהוּא הִפְכוֹ לְגַמְרִי.

The body remains as is and the *makif* light operates in the body itself, even though it is completely the opposite of the body i.e. of the body's limitations.

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁמְצִינֵנוּ הִרְבֵּה נִסִּים כִּיּוֹצֵא בּוֹ כָּגוֹן מְקוֹם הָאֲרוֹן וְהַכְּרוּבִים
שֶׁלֹא הִחְזִיקוּ מִדָּה (בָּבָא בִּתְרָא צ"ט א')

We find many miraculous events of this sort in Scripture, such as 'the Ark and the Cherubim on top of it took up no space' in the Holy Temple[10](#)** (Bava Batra 99a).**

וְכָגוֹן עוֹמְדִים צְפוּפִים וּמִשְׁתַּחֲוִים וְנוֹחִים (אַבוֹת פ"ה)

And for example the people in the Courtyard of the Temple who stood crowded together, yet when they bowed they had plenty of room (Avot 5:5),

וְנֵר שֶׁל מַעֲרָבִי שֶׁלֹא הָיָה כָּבֵה, וְאֵשׁ שֶׁל מַעֲרָכָה שֶׁהָיָה מִתְגַּבֵּר
(יוֹמָא צ"ט א'),

and the western candle did not go out but burned until it was time to relight the Candelabra in the Temple at dusk, despite the fact that it had the same measure of oil as all the other candles that did go out sometime in the morning.

וְכָגוֹן הֵינִס דְּנֵר חֲנֻכָּה,

And like the miracle of Chanukah where a single jar of oil, that was normally enough for one night only, lasted for eight days.

וְכֵן בֵּר' חֲנִינָא בֶן דּוֹסָא "מִי שֶׁאָמַר לְשֵׁמוֹ וַיִּדְלֶק יֹאמַר לַחֲמֵץ וַיִּדְלֶק"
וְהָיָה דוֹלֶק וְהוֹלֵךְ כָּל הַיּוֹם כָּלוּ (תַּעֲנִית כ"ה)

And similarly with the miracle that happened with Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa when his daughter by accident poured vinegar into the candles instead of oil and lit them. Rabbi Chanina told her not to be upset, because **the One Who said "oil shall burn, will say vinegar shall burn"** and they burned the entire day until the Sabbath was over (Talmud **Taanit 25a**).

וְכֵן בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ ע"ה וְחֲנַנְיָה מִיִּשְׁאֵל וְעֲזַרְיָה בְּכַבֵּשׁן הָאֵשׁ
(פְּסָחִים קי"ח א' וְע' זוה"ק אַחֲרֵי מוֹת נ"ז א' וּבִהְגֵּר"א בִּסְפַד"צ פ"א
דֵּה"מ דִּקְתִּיב זֶה יֹאמַר)

And similarly with our Patriarch Avraham,¹¹ **may peace be upon him, and with Chanaya, Mishaël and Azarya who were all thrown into a furnace** (see Daniel chapter 3; **Pesachim 118a; Zohar Acharei Mot 57a; GRA in Sifra d'Tzniuta chap. 1**).

וְכַיּוּצָא בְּזֶה נִסִּים הִרְבֵּה שֶׁהָיָה הֵנֶס בְּתוֹךְ הַטֶּבַע עֲצָמָה גַּם בַּעֲת
שֶׁהַטֶּבַע הָיָה עַל עֲמֻדָה

And there were many other miracles that took place clothed in natural events, while the natural order itself remained unchanged.

שֶׁהָיָה לֹא נִתְרַחֲבוּ כְּתָלֵי בֵּית קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדָשִׁים בְּשִׁבִּיל הָאָרוֹן
וְהַכְּרוּבִים

So, for example, the walls of the Holy-of-Holies did not widen for the Ark and the Cherubim,

וְכֵן לֹא נִתְרַחֲבָה הָעֲזָרָה בַּעֲת שֶׁהִשְׁתַּחֲווּ רִוְחִים

nor did the Courtyard expand when they bowed and still had plenty of room, even though the Courtyard was packed.

עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁהִגְבִּיהַ הַפֶּתַח שְׁעָרִים בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהִכְנִיס שְׁלֹמֹה אֶת אֲרוֹן
הַקֹּדֶשׁ לְבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְכַמ"ש בַּמ"ר בְּהַעֲלֹתָּ סִימֵן י"ג

However, the natural order *was* suspended **in the case where the gates lifted up when Shlomo King Solomon brought the Holy Ark into the Temple, as *Bamidbar Rabba, Beha'alotecha 13:15* states.**¹²

וְהָגַם שְׁזָה ג"כ נִס גָּדוֹל אֲךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים הָרִי נִשְׁתַּנָּה הַטֶּבַע שָׁם
וְנִתְבַּטְּלָה

Now although this too was a great miracle, nevertheless, the natural order was changed in that case and the laws of nature were temporarily nullified.

וְעַ' שֶׁבַת ל' ע"א וְכֵן בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מְזֻמּוֹר כ"ד שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם אוֹתוֹ
הַנֵּס בְּאִפְן אַחֵר

See Talmud Shabbat 30a and Midrash Tehillim 24 which describe this miracle in a different way.

אֲךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים הוּא כִּי נִתְבַּטְּלָה הַטֶּבַע שָׁם מִשָּׂא"כ בְּעֵינֵינוּ

In any event, the natural order was temporarily nullified in that case, but not in those mentioned above,¹³

הָרִי נִשְׁאָרוּ הַכֶּתֵּלִים עַל מְקוֹמָן וְהָיָה מוּעָט מִחֲזִיק אֶת הַמִּרְבֵּה

for the walls of the Holy-of-Holies and of the Courtyard remained in place, and a small area held a large number of people.

וְהוּא נִס יוֹתֵר גָּדוֹל שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר הַטֶּבַע עַל מְקוֹמָהּ וְהַנֵּס נַעֲשֶׂה מִכָּל
מְקוֹם וְלֹא בְּטֵלוּ זֶה אֶת זֶה

This is an even greater miracle, since the natural order was unchanged and the miracle nevertheless took place without one nullifying the other.

וְעַ' עוֹד בְּב"ר פ' ה' סִימָן ז' וְכֵן בּוּיֵק"ר פ"י סִימָן ט' שֶׁחֲשָׁבוּ שָׁם עוֹד
כְּמָה נִסִּים ע"ד זֶה

See further: Bereishit Rabba 5:7; Vayikra Rabba 10:9 where they list a number of other miracles of the same sort.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּר' חֲנִינָה בֶן דּוֹסָא הִנִּי' שֶׁהָרִי לֹא נִתְהַפֵּךְ הַחֹמֶץ לְשֶׁמֶן

And similarly with the miracle that happened with Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa, who said that vinegar can also burn, since the vinegar was not transformed into oil,

וְכֵן הָרִי לֹא נִתּוּסַף שֶׁמֶן בְּנֵר מַעֲרָבִי וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה

and similarly, no oil was added to the Western candle, nor to the Chanukah candle,

וְלֹא נִכְבְּהָ הָאֵשׁ בְּכַבֵּשׁוֹן בְּחֲנַנְיָה מִיִּשְׁאֵל וְעֲזַרְיָה

and the fire in the furnace into which Chananya, Mishael and Azarya were thrown.

אֵלָא הָיָה כָּל הַנְּסִים הֵלְלוּ בְּתוֹךְ הַטֶּבַע עֲצֻמָּה

Rather, all of these miracles took place within the natural order itself.

וְכָל זֶה הֵנָּה הוּא מְבַחֲשֵׁת אֹרֶךְ הַמְּקִיף כִּי הוּא הוֹלֵךְ וּמֵאִיר בְּתֵקָף אֹרֶךְ

All of this is due to the *ohr makif* (the transcendent light) which continues and illuminates with all the power of its light,

וְעוֹשָׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהַגּוֹף עוֹמֵד בְּכָל עֲבִיּוֹתוֹ וְצִמְצוּמוֹ וּבְכָל תְּכוֹנוֹתָיו

and has its effect even when the body remains in all its coarseness and the constriction of its qualities.

וְעוֹשָׂה הָאֹרֶךְ אֶת כָּל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹף עֲצֻמוֹ

Moreover, the *makif* light has its effect even within the body itself

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינוֹ מַבְטֵל אוֹתוֹ כָּלֵל הַגֶּם שֶׁהוּא הַפָּכוֹ

and yet it does not nullify it the body at all, even though it is its opposite.

וְכ"ז הוּא מְשׁוּם שֶׁכָּל פְּעֻלַּת אוֹר הַמְקִיף הוּא אֵינוֹ ע"י הַגּוּף כָּלֵל

And all of this is because the entire operation of the *ohr makif* is not via the body at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהוּא פְּעֻלַּת הָאוֹר עֲצֻמוֹ בְּלִתי כָּלִי

Rather, it is an operation of the light itself without a vessel.

וְלָכֵן אֵינוֹ מֵרַחֵיק אֶת עֲצֻמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם הַגּוּף וְכָלִי כָּלֵל

And therefore it does not distance itself in order to accord with the body or the vessel at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּכָל עֲנִיּוּתָם

Instead, it produces its effects as they the body and the vessel remain in their totally impoverished state

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינָם מַבְטֵלִים זֶה אֶת זֶה וְאֵינָם סוֹתְרִים זֶה אֶת זֶה הַגֶּם שֶׁהֵם הַפָּכִים

and yet they do not nullify each other the vessel and body do not nullify the light, or vice versa and they do not contradict one another, even though they are opposites.

כִּי זֶהוּ מִפְּעֻלַּת הַנִּסְתִּית לְהָאִיר בְּלִי גְבוּל גַּם בְּתוֹךְ גְּבוּל

For this is one of the miraculous effects of the *ohr makif* – it illuminates in an unlimited manner even within limitation within the vessel and the body that are subject to the laws of nature.

וּבִהְיוֹת הַכֹּל הוּא בְּכָל, וְאֵין דְּבַר חוּצָץ לְפָנָיו

And being that it the *ohr makif* is everything in the sense of all-encompassing, **it is in everything and nothing is a barrier to it,**

וְהָרִי הוּא מְאִיר בְּאוּרוֹ וְדְבוּק וְנוֹגֵעַ גַּם בָּהֶם וְעַכ"ז אֵינוֹ מְזִיז אוֹתָם
מִמְקוֹמָם כָּלֵל

and so its light illuminates and cleaves to and is relevant to
them the vessels and bodies as well, and yet it does not dislodge
them from their place at all.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי תְכוּנַת אוֹר הַמְקִיף הוּא בְּהִפָּךְ לְגִמְרֵי מֵהָאוֹר
הַפְּנִימִי

So it turns out that the characteristics of the *ohr makif* are the
opposite of those of the *ohr pnimi*.

כִּי הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הֵנָּה הוּא דוֹחֵק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם הַגּוֹף
בְּכָל הָאֲפָשָׁרִי

Because the *ohr pnimi* exerts itself to accord with the body or
the vessel as much as possible,

וְבוֹ תְלוּי כָּל קִיּוֹם הַגּוֹף וּבִטּוּלוֹ כִּי הֵיא מְאִיר בְּהַגּוֹף וּמַחֲיָה אוֹתוֹ

and the entire continuing survival of the body or its
nullification depends upon the *ohr pnimi* since it illuminates the
body and enlivens it,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ אוֹר חַיּוּתוֹ בְּהַגּוֹף בְּמִדָּה וּבְמִשְׁקָל

and its illumination and life-force is drawn into the body in a
limited manner.

כִּי אִם יִתְמַעֵט אוֹרוֹ מִמֶּנּוּ מֵהַשְׁעוֹר הַמְסַפִּיק לְכָדֵי חַיּוּתוֹ

For if the quantity of light from the *ohr pnimi* is less than the
measure sufficient to enliven it the body

אוֹ שִׁתְּגַבֵּר אוֹרוֹ בּוֹ יוֹתֵר מִכּחוֹ אִזְ יִחְלַשׁ הַגּוֹף וְהוֹלֵךְ וְנִמָּס עַד
שִׁישׁוּב הָעֶפֶר עַל הָאָרֶץ כְּשֶׁהִיָּה

or the light increases to more than the body's capacity to bear it then body will weaken and continue to wane until it returns to the dust of the earth as before.

וְלִכְּנֹן נִמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְגַּלֶּה אֹרֹחוֹ בְּהִגָּף רַק לֹאט לֹאט וּלְפִי כַח הַגּוּף שְׂיוֹכֵל
לְסִבֵּל

Therefore, its light is drawn down and revealed in the body gradually, according to the ability of the body to sustain the revelation,

כִּי כָל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ וְגִלּוּיוֹ הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק ע"י כָּלִי הַגּוּף

since its entire activity and revelation is always and only by means of the vessel of the body.

מִשָּׂא"כ אֹרֶךְ הַמְקִיף הֵנָּה הוּא אֵינוֹ דוֹחֵק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם
הַגּוּף כָּלֵל

But this is not so with the *ohr makif* – it does not exert itself to accord with the body or the vessel at all,

כִּי אֵינוֹ פּוֹעֵל וּמִתְגַּלֶּה ע"י הַגּוּף מְאוּמָּה

since it does not act or become revealed via the body at all,

וְאֹרֹחוֹ הוּא תָּמִיד לְמַעְלָה מִמְדְּרַגַּת וּמִדַּת הַגּוּף

and its light always transcends the level and limitation of the body.

וּבִין כִּשְׂאֵינוֹ מִתְגַּלֶּה כָּלֵל וּבִין כַּאֲשֶׁר מִתְגַּלֶּה בְּתִקְףֵהוּ אֹרֹחוֹ

Whether it the *ohr makif* is not revealed at all, or whether it is revealed with all the power of its light,

הֵנָּה אֵינוֹ גּוֹרֵם שׁוּם גִּרְעוֹן לְהַגּוּף אֶלָּא שְׂכָל גִּלּוּיוֹ הוּא רַק לְפַעֲלַת
הַנִּסְיָא לְבַד

it causes absolutely no deficiency in the body, since its entire revelation is only to bring about a miraculous effect,

לְהַאִיר וּלְפַעַל לְמַעַל מֵהַגְבּוֹל גַּם בְּהִיּוֹת כָּל הַחֲמֵר וְהַגְבּוֹל עַל
מְצִיאוֹתָיו.

**to illuminate and produce effects that transcend limitation,
even while all the material and the finite remain in existence.**

אָמַנְם דַּע כִּי כָּל מָה שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֶׁהָאֹר הַמְקִיף

However, be aware that everything we said regarding the *ohr makif* –

אֵינוֹ מְשַׁתָּה עִם הַגּוּף וְאֵינוֹ תְּלוּי חַיּוּתוֹ בּוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא רַק עַל בְּחִינַת
גְּלוּי דָּאוֹר הַמְקִיף

**that it does not exert itself to find affinity with the body, and its
life the life of the body is not dependent upon it – this is all in
regard to the *revelation of the ohr makif***

וְהִרְאוֹת כַּחוֹ וְתִקְפוֹ בְּמָה שֶׁהוּא נִבְדָּל מֵהָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי.

and displaying its strength and power distinct from the *ohr pnimi*
which is commensurate with the body it enlivens.

וְגְלוּי הַזֶּה הִיא בְּאֵמֶת אֵינוֹ בְּתַמִּידוֹת כָּלֵל כִּי הוּא רַק לְעֵתִים
וּלְפָרָקִים.

**In truth this revelation of the *ohr makif* is not constant at all; it
only happens from time to time.**

שֶׁהֵרִי הַנִּסִּים נִגְלִים אֵינָן אֶלָּא לְפָרָקִים וְכֵן רַק בְּמִקְוֹמוֹת מִיָּחָדִים

For revealed miracles are only occasional and in select places,

כִּי גְלוּי דָּאוֹר הַמְקִיף בְּתִקְף אוֹרוֹ בְּמָה שֶׁהוּא נִבְדָּל מֵהָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

**since the revelation of the *ohr makif* with all the power of its
light, in which it is dissimilar to the *ohr pnimi*,**

הֵנָּה הוּא עֲתֵה רַק בְּמַעוֹט הָאֶפְשָׁרִי עַד לְעֵתִיד לְבוֹא

**is at this time only to the minimum possible until the future
Time-to-Come *l'atid lavo*.**

This refers to that aspect of the *ohr makif* that, were it to be revealed, would upend the order of Creation.¹⁴

אָמנם בַּצִּמְצוּם וּבִהְעֵלֶם הִנֵּה פּוֹעֵל וּמְאִיר הָאוֹר הַמְקִיף גַּם כֵּן
תָּמִיד

**However, in a constricted and concealed manner the *ohr makif*
does have an effect, and it also shines forth constantly.**

וּבְזֶה הִנֵּה כָּל תְּהִלּוֹתָיו גַּם כֵּן רַק עַל דֶּרֶךְ אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי.

**In this respect its entire manifestation is also only in the
manner of the *ohr pnimi*.**

וְאַדְרָבָּה הוּא, כִּי כָּל פְּעֻלַּת אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי וְכוּ

**In fact, the opposite is true: all the activity of the *ohr pnimi* and
its powers**

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק מָה שֶׁמִּקְבֵּל וְשׁוֹאֵב מֵאוֹר הַמְקִיף אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה
וּמִסְבִּיבּוֹ

**is only by virtue of what it receives and draws out of the *ohr
makif* which transcends it and envelops it,**

כִּי בּוֹ הוּא קָשׁוּר וְאַחֲדוּד וּמִמֶּנּוּ שׁוֹאֵב תָּמִיד כָּל כֹּחַ וְאוֹרוֹ

**since it is bound to the *ohr makif* and is united with it, and from
it the *ohr pnimi* draws all of its power and light,**

וְעַל יְדּוֹ הִנֵּה קָשׁוּר אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה

and through it the *ohr pnimi* is bound on high

וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ הָאֶרֶץ כָּל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כֻּלָּם

so that all the radiances of the higher levels are clothed within it.

וְנִמְשָׁךְ תָּמִיד הָאֶרֶת אֹר הַמִּקִּיף עֲצָמוּ בְּהִגּוּף גַּם כֵּן לְהִדְבֵּק עִם
הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי שָׁבוּ

The radiance of the *ohr makif* itself is drawn down continuously into the body as well, to join with the *ohr pnimi* therein,

כִּי הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי הוּא מְשַׁלַּח הָאֶרֶתוֹ דֶּרֶךְ הִגּוּף מִבְּפָנִים לְחוּץ

for the *ohr pnimi* sends its radiance via the body from within it to the outside,

וְהָאֹר הַמִּקִּיף מְשַׁלַּח בּוֹ הָאֶרֶתוֹ מִחוּץ לְפָנִים

while the *ohr makif* sends its radiance to it from outside in.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְמַלֵּא כָּל הִגּוּף בְּאֶרֶן מִבֵּית וּמִבְחוּץ

Because of this the body is filled with the light of both of them, within and without,

וְנִעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי זֶה כְּלוּ חַי בְּאֹר הַנֶּר"נ שָׁבוּ

and in this way the person is fully alive with the light of the *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* in them.

וּבְבַחֲחִינַת הַזֶּה הֵנָּה מְאִיר הָאֹר הַמִּקִּיף בְּכָל הַתְּכוּנוֹת כְּמוֹ הָאֹר
הַפְּנִימִי מִמֶּשׁ וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן תָּדִיר

In this respect the *ohr makif* illuminates all the characteristics of a person exactly like the *ohr pnimi*, and it too is continuously active.

וְכָל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל מִתְּכוּנוֹת אֹר הַמִּקִּיף

Now everything that we said regarding the characteristics of the *ohr makif* –

שהוא בהפך מכל תהלוכות אור הפנימי

that it functions in the opposite way to the *ohr pnimi* –

הנה הוא רק בבחינת גלוי ובמה שמתגלה בתקף אורו להיות
מאיר הוא עצמו,

**is only as regards the aspect of revelation, and that which is
revealed in the full power of its light, being that it itself comes
into revelation,**

זולת ההשתתפות באור הפנימי,

distinct from its partnership with the *ohr pnimi*.

והאור הזה הוא אינו תדיר ואינו מצוי עתה כלל

**This latter aspect of the *ohr makif* is not constant, and is not
prevalent at all in our times,**

כי בזה הוא נמשך פעלתו בבלתי גבול ותכלית והוא רק אור הנסיי

**for this is how its effect is drawn down in an unlimited,
unbounded manner, and it is only as miraculous light**

אשר למעלה מהטבע לגמרי וגלויי הוא עתה רק במעוט היותר
אפשרי וכנ"ל

**that transcends nature completely, the revelation of which is
only to the minimum degree necessary nowadays, as explained
previously.**

אבל בהעלם הנה משלח אור המקיף את הארתו בהגוף גם כן
תמיד,

**Nevertheless, in a concealed manner the *ohr makif* does
constantly emit its radiance to the body as well**

להחיות אתו מבחוץ לפנים ע"ד אור הפנימי שמחיה אותו מבפנים
לחוץ,

to enliven it from the outside in, in the same manner as the *ohr pnimi* enlivens the body from the inside out.

וּבְזֶה הַנֶּה מִתְצַמֵּצֵם אֹר הַמְקִיף ג"כ רַק לְפִי כֹחַ הַגּוּף

And in this aspect the *ohr makif* is also constricted according to the capability of the body,

וּמִשְׁתַּתֵּף בְּזֶה עִם הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי לְעוֹלָם.

and it always partners with the *ohr pnimi*.

וְהִרִי נִמְצָא מְכַל זֶה כִּי פִעֻלַּת אֹר הַמְקִיף הוּא בִּבְחִינוֹת,

From all the above it emerges that the *ohr makif* is active in two respects:

הֵינּוּ ע"י הַגּוּף וְשֶׁלֹּא ע"י הַגּוּף וְהוּא בְּגָבּוּל וּבִבְלִי גָבּוּל.

via the body and not via the body; limited and unlimited.

אֲבָל הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי פִעֻלָּתוֹ הוּא רַק בְּגָבּוּל לְבַד וְרַק ע"י הַגּוּף לְבַד.

But the effect of the *ohr pnimi* is only limited, and only via the body.

Footnotes

1. It seems that the 'lower world' referred to here refers not only to BiY"A, but to all the worlds post-*tzimtzum*. [↩](#)
2. All of this is *prior* to the diffusion of light from the upper level into the lower. [↩](#)
3. Makover. [↩](#)
4. Makover notes that the author explained in the previous chapter that every superior level is in the category of 'infinite' compared with the levels below it. [↩](#)

5. As noted previously, *Sefer Yetzirah* 6:1 refers to three aspects, *olam shana* and *nefesh* – space, time and being. However, time is only a later manifestation, and only in the lower worlds. Consequently, it is not mentioned here. ↩
6. The Ba'al HaLeshem presents a new insight here – that the *kav* is actually an aspect of the *tzimtzum* (Makover). ↩
7. A second new insight – since the *kav* also has the aspect of 'vessel', it too is divided into *ohr pnimi* and *ohr makif* (Makover). ↩
8. A *partzuf* is the anthropomorphic representation of a *sefirah* or cluster of *sefirot* that fulfills a certain function described by the *partzuf*. For example, the *partzuf* of Abba (the *sefirah* of *chochmah*) has a role among the *sefirot* similar to the way a father has a role in the family unit. ↩
9. By way of contrast see *Zohar* I, p.105 regarding all the prophets other than Moshe Rabbeinu: "They would fall on their faces at the time of prophecy and their physical strength would leave them..." ↩
10. See also Talmud, *Megillah* 10b; *Yoma* 21a. Rashi explains: The space on each side of the Ark in the Holy-of-Holies measured ten cubits, and yet the entire space from wall to wall of the Holy-of-Holies measured twenty cubits altogether. So the Ark Moshe made took up no space. ↩
11. He was thrown into a furnace: *Zohar* I, p. 18, 34; *Pirkei d'R' Eliezer* ch. 26; *Bereishit Rabba* 38:19 etc. ↩
12. When King Solomon wanted to bring the Ark into the Holy-of-Holies, the gates were down and he said, "Lift up, gates for the Honored King!" The gates then asked, "And who is the honored king?" [since it could have been understood that Solomon was referring to himself]. But when he clarified that he was talking about the Almighty they immediately lifted up. ↩

13. The miracles mentioned above where miraculous events took place, but they did not nullify the natural order. Rather, they took place within the natural order. ↩

14. Makover. ↩

Chapter 4 — How the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent) lights are directed.

The or penimi and or makif have different reasons for how they function.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שְׁבָאֲרָנוּ שֵׁשׁ חֲלוּק בֵּין הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי

As we explained in the previous chapter there is a clear distinction between the illumination from the internalized light (the *ohr pnimi*),

לְהַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַמְּקִיף בְּהַפְּעוּלוֹת הַיּוֹצֵא מֵהֶם

and the illumination from the enveloping light (*ohr makif*) in terms of their effects.

כִּי הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי כָּל גְּלוּיּוֹ הוּא ע"י הַגּוֹף וְיוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ רַק פְּעֻלוֹת גְּבוּלִיִּים.

All the revelations from the *ohr pnimi* are via a body or vessel, and what emerge from it are limited effects.

אֲבָל הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַמְּקִיף הוּא דּוֹקָא שְׁלֵא ע"י הַגּוֹף

However, the illumination from the *ohr makif* is explicitly not by way of a body or vessel,

וְיוֹצֵאִים מִמֶּנּוּ פְּעֻלוֹת בְּלִתֵּי גְּבוּל וְכַנ"ל.

and what emerge from it are unlimited effects, as explained above.

כֹּן יֵשׁ חֲלוּק עַד"ז ג"כ בְּסִבַּת פְּעֻלוֹתֵיהֶם הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מֵהֶם לְהָאָדָם.

Similarly, there is a further distinction along these lines in terms of what causes the effects to be drawn down to man:

כי סבת פֿעלות אור הפֿנימי וְכָל אורו וְגִלּוּיוֹ

The cause of the *ohr pnimi's* effects that are drawn down to man, and all its light and illumination,

הִנֵּה חֶקֶק הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש חֲקִים גְּבוּלִיִּים לָזֶה אֲשֶׁר רַק עַל יְדֵיהֶם

are that the Emanator, may His Name be blessed, fixed (lit. Engraved) limiting laws as the exclusive basis around which

נִסְבֵּב וְנִמְשָׁךְ כָּל אורו וּפְעֻלָּתוֹ לְהָאָדָם

all its light and effects would revolve, and be drawn down to man,

וְהִנֵּה הֵם כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים בְּזָכוֹת אוֹ בְּחֻבָּה

via the actions of those below – whether they arouse merit or liability.

וְעַל יְדֵיהֶם נִמְשָׁךְ כָּל פְּעֻלּוֹת אור הפֿנימי שֶׁהוּא מִצְמָצֵם בְּגוֹף וְכָלִי.

Through them are drawn down all the activities of the *ohr pnimi* that are constricted into a body and vessel,

וּמִתְנַהֵג רַק ע"פ הַדִּין וְהַמִּשְׁפָּט לִהְיוֹת גּוֹמֵל לְאִישׁ חֶסֶד כְּמַפְעָלוֹ

and it conducts itself according to law and justice, granting a person kindness commensurate with his own actions,

וְלִרְשָׁע רָע כְּרִשְׁעָתוֹ

and to the wicked person according to his wickedness,

כִּי תִהְיוּכּוֹת אור הפֿנימי הוּא בְּמִדָּה וּבִמְשָׁקֶל וְאֵינוֹ עוֹבֵר עַל גְּבוּלוֹ.

since the paths of the *ohr pnimi* are measured and weighed, and do not step out of their bounds.

וְהוּא גִלּוּיוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל דְּרָכֵי הַטֶּבַע

And this is how He is revealed within the paths of nature

שְׁחַקק וְהִטְבִּיעַ בְּהִבְרִיאתָהּ מִשְׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית.

which He fixed and set as the disposition of the created world from the six days of Creation.

וְהֵם מְסֻדָּרִים בְּחִיּוּב וְנִמְנָע וְאִפְשָׁר וְאֵינוֹ עוֹבֵר כָּל אֶחָד אֶת הַקּוֹ.

These laws of nature are arranged as the necessary, the impossible and the possible but not necessary, and none of them violates its boundaries.

וּכ"ז הוּא מַפְעֵלֶת אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי כַּנ"ל.

All of this is the effect of the *ohr pnimi*.

כֵּן נִמְשָׁךְ עַד"ז ג"כ כָּל סִבַּת אוֹרוֹ לְהֵאָדָם הַכֹּל רַק לְפִי מַעֲשָׂיו

Similarly, there is drawn down to man the entire source of illumination – all of it only according to his deeds.

כִּי כְשֶׁמִּתְנַהֵּג ע"פ הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה אֵז הוּא בָּא בְּשִׁכְרוֹ

Thus when a person conducts himself according to Torah and mitzvot, then he receives his reward –

לְהֵנוֹת מִטּוֹב הָעוֹלָם כִּי כָּל הָעוֹלָם לֹא נִבְרָא אֶלָּא בְּשִׁבְלֹו.

and enjoys the goodness of the world, since the entire world was created only for this – for Torah and mitzvot¹** –**

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַבְּטָחוֹת הַתּוֹרָה בְּבְרִכוֹתֶיהָ וְטוֹבוֹתֶיהָ

just as the Torah promises all its blessings and goodness,

שֶׁהֵם תְּלוּיִם בָּלָם רַק בְּקִיּוֹם הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה.

which are all dependent upon fulfilling Torah and mitzvot.

וכמ"ש אם בְּחֻקֹּתַי תֵּלְכוּ כֹּי וְהָיָה אִם שְׁמוּעַ תִּשְׁמָעוּ כֹּי וְהָיָה עִקְבִּי תִשְׁמָעוּן כֹּי.

And as is it written, "If you will go in My statutes..." (Leviticus 26:3), and "If you will indeed obey" (Deuteronomy 11:13), and "When in the end you will obey..." (Deuteronomy 7:12).

וְכֹן לְהִפָּךְ כְּשִׁיעֲבְרוּ עַל הַתּוֹרָה אִז הוֹלֵךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָם לִנְגָדָם

And the opposite is also true: if they transgress the Torah, the entire world will go against them,

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁהוּא כָּל הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבַתוֹ"כ וְשֶׁבַמִּשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה

as the curses in Vayikra (Leviticus) and in Devarim (Deuteronomy) state explicitly.

וְכֹן כָּל עֲנָשֵׁי הַתּוֹרָה כָּלָם.

And the same is true of all the punishments in the Torah.

וכ"ז הוא הַכֹּל מֵהַחֻקִּים וּגְבוּלִים דִּהְאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

All of this is in the purview of the statutes and limitations engraved into the *ohr pnimi*,

וְעַל יָדוֹ הוּא כָּל דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה בְּכָל חֻקֹּתֶיהָ וּמִשְׁפָּטֶיהָ.

and by its agency are all the laws of the Torah, its laws and judgments,

כִּי מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְחֻקֵּי הַבְּרִיאָה אֶחָד הֵם.

because the statutes of the Torah and the laws of Nature are one and the same.

שֶׁהָרִי הַבְּרִיאָה נִתְיַסְדָּה בְּטוֹב וָרָע

For since the Creation is established on the basis of good and evil,

וּכְפָ"שׁ (קִהְלֵת ז', יד) גַּם אֶת זֶה לַעֲמֵת זֶה עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹקִים טוֹב לַעֲמֵת
רָע וְרָע לַעֲמֵת טוֹב

as the verse (Ecclesiastes 7:14) states: "G-d made one thing opposite the other" (Rashi: Goodness and reward for doing good, as opposed to evil and the punishment for doing evil) – good opposite evil, and evil opposite good.

וְכָל מְצִיאוֹת הָעוֹלָם הוּא הַכֹּל בְּתִמְוָה

Thus the way the entire world exists is as an exchange of one thing for another:

חַיִּים וּמוֹת עֶשֶׂר וְעֹנֵי מַמְשָׁלָה וְעִבְדוּת זָרַע וְשִׁמְמָה חֲכָמָה וְאוֹלֵת
שָׁלוֹם וּמִלְחָמָה.

life and death, wealth and poverty, leadership and servitude, fruitfulness and desolation, wisdom and foolishness, peace and war.

וְהֵם י"ד עֲתִים לְטוֹבָה וִי"ד עֲתִים לְרָעָה.

****These are the fourteen *itim* (**times) **for the good and fourteen *itim* (**times) for the bad mentioned in Ecclesiastes chapter 3.**

וְהֵם נִמְשָׁכִים כָּלָם ע"ש מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

All of them are drawn from the statutes of the Torah –

כִּי טוֹבָה שְׂמוּרָה לְטוֹבִים וְרָעָה שְׂמוּרָה לְרָעִים.

because good is kept for those who do good, and evil for those who do evil.

אֲךָ כ"ז הוּא רֶק מָה שְׂרָאוּי לַהֲיֹוֹת ע"פ חֻקֵּי וּגְבוּלֵי דֹאֹר הַפְּנִימִי.

However, this is all in regard to what is appropriate according to the set laws and limitation of the *ohr pnimi*,

כי על ידו הוא כל משפטי התורה בשכרה וענשה שהם הטוב והרע שבהבריא.

for all the judgments of the Torah, in terms of reward and punishment for good and evil in Creation are by way of it the *ohr pnimi*.

משא"כ אור המקיף אשר תהלכות פעלתו בגלוי הוא בלתי גבול

But this is not true of the *ohr makif* which performs in a way of limitless revelation

כי הוא אינו מצמצם כלל וכנ"ל.

since it is not constrained at all, as we discussed previously.

הנה כמו כן לא נמצא אליו בהבריא חקים וגבולים כלל גם לסבת גלוי.

Now in similar fashion, no laws or limitations can be found in Creation expressing the reasons for its revelation,

כי הוא למעלה מהבריא לגמרי והן גלוי והן סבת גלוי.

for it transcends the Creation completely – both in its revelation and the reason for its revelation.

הם שניהם למעלה מהטבע ולמעלה מהמדה ונעלם סבתו מכל בריה.

Both of them transcend nature and limitations, and the reason for it is hidden from every created being.

כי לא ניתן אליו בכל הבריא כלה שום סיבה לסבב אותו ושום חוק וגבול למנע אותו.

For within Creation there is no reason triggering it nor any law or limitation inhibiting it.

וכבר אמרנו לעיל ספ"ג כי אור המקיף יש בו שני בחי'

Now we already stated above (end of chapter 3) that the *ohr makif* has two aspects –

כי בבחי' אחת הוא מתייחד תמיד עם האור הפנימי

one aspect thereof is continuously united with the *ohr pnimi*,

ומשתתף גם הוא בכל הפעולות דגבול וצמצום ג"כ.

and it too participates in all the limited and constricted activities regulating the *ohr pnimi*. This is only a radiance of the *ohr makif*, as the author explained at the end of the previous chapter.

אמנם עי"ז הנה נמשך עוד שהגם שעקרו וגילויו הוא רק לעתיד,
וכמו שאמרנו שם,

Nevertheless, as a result of this radiance of the *ohr makif* another great advantage is drawn down (albeit that the primary aspect and revelation thereof will only be in the future, as we mentioned there) –

מכ"ז הנה ע"י יחודו בהאור הפנימי מתנהג האור הפנימי ג"כ
תמיד

from all of this, due to the radiance of the *ohr makif* uniting with the *ohr pnimi*, the *ohr pnimi* also always performs

רק ע"פ הכוונה התכליתית אשר לאור המקיף.

only according to the final purpose-oriented intention of the *ohr makif*.

והנה הם כל הכבשי דרחמנא אשר בההנהגה תמיד

Now all of these are the secrets of how the world is always conducted, and are known only to the Merciful One.

אשר נעלם סבתם מכל בריה וכמ"ש וחסנתי את אשר אהן ורחמתי
את אשר ארחם

The reasons for the way things are run are hidden from every creature, as the verse (Exodus 33:19) states, "I shall show favor to whom I choose to show favor, and I shall show mercy to whom I choose to show mercy,"

אע"פ שאיננו כדאי והגון לכך

even though they may not be fitting and worthy thereof.

וכן שאלה הנודע דצדיק ורע לו רשע וטוב לו וכמ"ש בברכות ז'.

Thus the well-known question arises regarding a righteous person who suffers and a wicked person who prospers, as the Talmud *Berachot 7a* discusses:

Moshe Rabbeinu wished to know the ways of Hashem, and one of the questions that he asked was this: "Master of the Worlds, why is it that in this world there is a righteous person who prospers and a righteous person who suffers? And a wicked person who prospers, and a wicked person who suffers?" The Almighty answered that a righteous person who prospers is a *perfectly* righteous person, and a righteous person who suffers is not perfectly righteous. Similarly, a wicked person who prospers is not completely wicked, whereas a wicked person who suffers is completely wicked. The Maharsha explains that one who is not completely righteous suffers in this world, so that he will merit the World-to-Come, whereas a person who is not completely wicked prospers in this world in order to reward him now for whatever good deeds he has, but he will not merit the World-to-Come.

וכיוצא בזה פליאות רבות בהנהגה אשר נעלם סבתם מכל בריה.

There are many other similar surprising matters regarding Hashem's conduct, the reasons for which are concealed from all created beings.

והנה הם מהנהגתו הנעלמה ית"ש אשר מנהיג הכל תמיד לכונן תכלית האחרון

All of these are products of **His hidden manner of conduct, with which He guides everything at all times for the ultimate final purpose known to Him.**

וכ"ז הוא נמשך ובא מאור המקיף ע"י יחודו באור הפנימי.

And all of this is drawn from and emerges from the *ohr makif* by way of its unifying with the *ohr pnimi*.

והגם שהרי נראה לפי זה סתירות גדולות

Now even though there appear to be huge contradictions

ובטול רב בכל החקים וגבולים דאור הפנימי שהם כל משפטי התורה

and a negation of all the statutes and limitations of the *ohr pnimi*, which are all the Laws of the Torah,

אך הוא ית"ש גדול העצה ורב העלילה

nevertheless, He (blessed is His Name) "is great in counsel and mighty in deed" (Jeremiah 32:19),

ועושה נפלאות גדולות לבדו.

And "He alone performs great wonders" (Psalms 136:4),

ומעמיד ומישר את הכל בפעלות וסיבובים נעלמים

arranging and organizing everything through hidden actions and indirect events

עד שלא נופל שום דבר ולא זז שום זיז כל שהוא

so that there is no skipping and no shifting, even a little,

מכל משפטי התורה ושכרה וענשה והכל באמת והכל בדין.

of all the statutes of Torah and its rewards and punishments.

והכל באמת והכל בדין.

Instead, **everything is according to the truth and everything is according to the law.**

אֵלָא מְשׁוּם שְׁנַעְשָׁה כ"ז ע"י אור המקיף וע"י יחודו באור הפנימי
כְּנִז'

But since it is all done by way of the *ohr makif* uniting with the *ohr pnimi*, as mentioned,

לְכוּ נִעְלָמִים הֵם כָּל הַדְרָכִים הַלְלוּ מְשׁוּם בְּרִיָּה

therefore all of these paths are concealed from any created being,

בְּאֶשֶׁר שְׁפַעְלַת כָּל אור המקיף וכחו הוא לְמַעְלָה מִהִבְרִיָּאָה לְגַמְרִי
וְכִנֵּז"ל

since the activities of the *ohr makif* and its power completely transcend the Creation, as mentioned earlier,

וְלִכּוֹן אֵי אֶפְשָׁר לְשׁוּם בְּרִיָּה לְהַשִּׁיגוֹ.

and therefore it is impossible for any created being to grasp this.

וְזֶהוּ מָה שְׁכָתוּב בְּהִ"ג מִדּוֹת הָרַחֲמִים שֶׁהֵם מֵהִ"ג תִּקּוּנִים

This is what is meant by describing the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy as 'the Thirteen *Tikunim*'²

וְהֵם כֻּלָּם מִגְלוּיֵי דְאוֹר הַמְּקִיף שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִן הַמַּדָּה.

since they are all from the *ohr makif* that transcends limitations shining out

הִנֵּה כְּתוּב שֶׁם אֶרֶךְ אֲפִים וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת.

Among the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy, the following is written (Exodus 34:6): "**Slow to Anger and Abundant in Kindness and Truth.**"

וַאֲמָרוּ אֶרֶךְ אַפִּים לַצַּדִּיקִים וְלַרְשָׁעִים

Regarding this our Sages **declared** (*Eruvin* 22a), He is "**Slow to Anger for the righteous and the wicked...**"

וְע' תּוֹסְפוֹת ב"ק נ' רע"ב מָה שֶׁהִקְשׁוּ שָׁם כִּי נִרְאָה בְּזֶה סְתִירָה]
מֵעֲרוּבִין לְסִנְהֶדְרִין ע"ש.

[See Tosfot *Bava Kama* 50b who raise an apparent contradiction between Tractates *Eruvin* and *Sanhedrin*.

אך הַעֲקָר הוּא כִּי בְּעֲרוּבִין מְדַבֵּר בְּרָשָׁעִי עוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים

However, the main point is that *Eruvin* is referring to wicked idolaters

כִּי עֲלֵיהֶם נֹאמַר וּמָשַׁלְם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ.

regarding whom it states (Deuteronomy 7:10): "**He will repay those who hate Him to their face and destroy them.**"

וְעַל זֶה סוֹבֵב דְּבַרִּי הַגָּמְרָא בְּעֲרוּבִין שָׁם כ"ב ע"א. וע"ש י"ט א'.

It is around this verse that Tractate *Eruvin* 22a revolves. And see also 19a there.

אַבְל בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין קי"א סע"א שָׁם מְדַבֵּר בְּרָשָׁעִי יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאָר
שָׁם ע"ש.

But Tractate *Sanhedrin* 111a is referring to the wicked of Israel, as is explained there. See there.

וְעַם רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵינוֹ מִתְּנַהֵג הַקֵּב"ה בְּמִדַּת וּמָשַׁלְם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל
פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ כָּלֵל וּכְלָל ח"ו

With the evildoers of Israel the Holy One, blessed be He, does not act in the manner of "He will repay those who hate Him to

their face and destroy them" at all, in any way, G-d forbid,

כמו שיתבאר למטה בדברינו. אלא רק]

as will be explained below. Only that... End of note]****

שהוא מאריך אף וגבי דליה וכמ"ש בתנחומא פ' תשא סימן כ"ו

He is "Slow to Anger" but will claim His due, as Midrash Tanchuma, Parshat Ki Tissa, 26 expounds

במעשה עגל שנאמר שם וביום פקדי ופקדתי.

regarding the golden calf, where it states (Exodus 32:34), "On the day I make a reckoning, I shall take into account their sin."

ומיסר ומעניש אותם אם בזה ובבא ובאפן שהעושה עברה נשאר והענש נפרע.

He will chasten and punish them, whether in this world or the next, in such a way that the sinner remains, while the sin is paid for.

וזהו מה שאמרו בזוה"ק בראשית מ"ו ע"א כי ביום שני דמעשה בראשית

And this is what the Zohar (Bereishit 46a) states: On the Second Day of Creation

אתברי גיהנם לחיבי עלמא כו' ביום תליתאי אתתקן יום שני כו'

Gehinom Purgatory was created for sinners in this world; on the Third Day of Creation the Second Day was rectified,

וביה אשתלימו רחמי על חיבי גיהנם.

for on that day compassion is achieved for those who are condemned to Gehinom;

ביומא תליתאה משתכין (ר"ל נשקטים) שביבין דגיהנם כו'.

on the Third Day the fires of *Gehinom* die down etc. (meaning they are diminished).

וְהַכּוֹנֶנָה הוּא כִּי גַם הַיּוֹרְדֵי גֵיהֶנֶם אֵינָם נֶאֱבָדִים שֶׁם אֵלָּא נֶעֱנָשִׁים
שֶׁם לֹאט לֹאט

The intention here is that those who descend to *Gehinom* are not destroyed there, but merely that they are punished bit by bit,

בְּאוֹפֶן שֶׁהָעוֹשָׁה עֲבָרָה נִשָּׂא וְהָעֶנֶשׁ נִפְרָע

in such a way that the sinner remains, while the sin is paid for.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר שְׁבִיּוֹם ג' נִתְּסַד וְנִשְׁלַם רַחֲמֵי עַל חֲבִיבֵי גֵיהֶנֶם

This is why it states that on the Third Day of Creation compassion is established and achieved for those who are condemned to *Gehinom*,

וְהִזָּה כָּל עֲנָשֵׁי גֵיהֶנֶם ג"כ רַק לְצָרוֹף וּלְלַבּוֹן אֲבָל נִשָּׂא לְהַשְׁאִירָה
נִצָּחִית עכ"פ

and all the punishments of *Gehinom* are also only to decontaminate and get rid of the impurities of sins, but in any event they the sinners remain forever,

וְכֵן הוּא מְפָרֵשׁ בְּזֵהָר פ' שְׁמוֹת דָּף כ"א ע"ב ע"ש.

as stated explicitly in *Zohar II* 21b.³ See there.

וְכֵן הוּא הַכּוֹנֶנָה בִּירוֹשְׁלָמִי תַעֲנִית פ"ב ה"א שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁם

This is also the intention of the Talmud *Yerushalmi Taanit 2:1* [p. 9a] which states:

ר' אַחָא ר' תַּנְחוּם בִּי ר' חֲזִיָּה בְּשֵׁם ר' יוֹחָנָן: אֶרְךְ אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאֵן
אֵלָּא אֶרְךְ אִפִּים.

Rabbi Acha and Rabbi Tanchum of the House of Rabbi Chiya said **in the name of Rabbi Yochanan:** *אֶרְךְ אַף – 'Slow to Anger' in the singular **is not stated here, but rather** אֶרְךְ אַפִּים – 'Slow to Anger' in the *plural* –

מֵאֶרְךְ רוּחוֹ עַד שֶׁלֹא יִגְבֶה. הֵתְחִיל לִגְבוֹת מֵאֶרְךְ רוּחוֹ וְגָבָה.

signifying that **He is slow to anger until He makes His claim** against the sinner to repay the debt owed to Him. **But even once He begins to claim, He is slow to anger while He claims.** And therefore the expression is in the plural, because in both situations He exhibits patience and compassion.

וְהַכּוֹנֵה הוּא ג' כ' כִּי אֵינוֹ נִפְרַע בְּפַעַם אַחַת אֶלָּא רַק לֹאט לֹאט.

The intention here is that He does not demand repayment in one large sum, but slowly, bit by bit,

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַעֲבוּרֵי ד' ע"א רַק אֶתְכֶם יִדְעָתִי מִכָּל מִשְׁפָּחוֹת
הָאֲדָמָה עַל כֵּן אֶפְקֹד כו'

as explained in Tractate Avodah Zara 4a, on the verse (Amos 3:2) "You alone did I know [or love – Rashi] **from among all the families of the earth; therefore I will hold you to account** for all your iniquities."

מִשָּׁל לְמַה"ד כו' אֶחָד אוֹהֵבוֹ וְאֶחָד שׁוֹנְאוֹ

Explains the Talmud (ibid.): **To what can this be compared? To a person claiming a debt owed to him by two people, one of whom is his friend, and the other his enemy –**

אוֹהֵבוֹ נִפְרַע מִמֶּנּוּ מְעַט מְעַט שׁוֹנְאוֹ נִפְרַע מִמֶּנּוּ בְּבַת אַחַת.

He allows his friend to pay back his debt slowly, but his enemy must pay back all at once.

וְהוּא כַּמ"ש קְדוּשִׁין ל"ו א' שִׁישְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאוּ בָּנִים לְמָקוֹם אֲפִי בְּזִמְנוֹ
שֶׁהֵם רִשְׁעִים ח"ו

This is also as stated in Tractate Kidushin 36a: Israel are called the children of the Omnipresent One, even when they are wicked, Heaven forbid,

וּמִבְּאֵר שֵׁם אֲפִי בְּעוֹבֵד עַבְדֵי רַח"ל.

and the Sages explain there that this is even in a case of idolatry, heaven forbid.

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בִּיּוֹמָא נ"ו נ"ז אֲפִי בְּזִמְנֵי שֶׁהֵם טְמֵאִים שְׂכִינָה עִמָּהֶם.

And so too it states in Tractate Yoma 56-57 that the Shechinah is with them even when they are ritually impure.

וְלָכֵן כָּל מָה שְׂגָבָה הַקֵּב"ה חוֹבָתוֹ מֵהֶם בִּיסוּרִים וְעֲנָשִׁים

And therefore, to the extent that the Holy One, blessed be He, claims payback for their debt by way of suffering and punishment

אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבָא הוּא הַכֹּל רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ צָרוּף וְלִבּוֹן

in this world and the next, this is all in a manner of cleansing and purging.

אֲבָל עִם רָשָׁעֵי או"ה הִנֵּה מִתְּנֶהֱג הַקֵּב"ה עִמָּהֶם בְּמִדָּה

But with the wicked of the nations He conducts Himself in a measure-for-measure manner –

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ וְכַמ"ש בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מִזְמוֹר ז'
סִי י"ז.

repaying those who hate Him to their face and destroying them, as Midrash Tehillim 7:17 explains.

וְהוּא בְּסוֹד הַכְּתוּב הִלּוּא אֵח עָשׂו לִיעֲקֹב וְאוֹהֵב אֶת יַעֲקֹב וְאֶת עָשׂו שְׂנֵאתִי.

This is the secret expressed in the verse (Malachi 1:2-3): "Was not Esau the brother of Jacob... Yet I loved Jacob, but Esau I

detested."

וכ"ז הוא מכבשי דרחמנא אשר בסוד ברית אבות וישראל

All of this is of those matters that are kept secret by the Merciful One, by virtue of the mystical Covenant He made with the Patriarchs and Israel,

שהוא בהנהגת אור המקיף ויחודו באור הפנימי

which is that these matters are conducted by the *ohr makif* as it unites with the *ohr pnimi*.

ולכן מתנהג עמם ברב חסד ואמת, שעושה עמם רב חסד ועכ"ז
הוא ואמת

And therefore He acts towards them with 'Abundant Kindness' by letting them repay their debt slowly and nevertheless with Truth by ensuring that they eventually pay up to expiate their transgressions.

שהכל במשפט והכל בדין כי בהארת אור המקיף הוא נושא עון

For everything is according to the Law and with Justice, for by beaming out the *ohr makif* He forgives sin

וסובל ומעלים עין מסוררים וטוב ומטיב לרעים ולטובים

and patiently bears transgressions and averts His gaze from them, with goodness and doing good to the wicked and to the virtuous,

כי הוא הולך ומאיר שלא ע"י מעשה התחתונים כלל

because He continues to shine forth in a manner not commensurate with the deeds of those below,

ולמעלה מן המדה לגמרי וזהו מדת ורב חסד

and completely transcending any measure-for-measure response. This is the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.'

אָבֶל ע"י יחודו בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הֵנָּה הוּא גּוֹבֵה דְּלִיָּה וְאִינוּ מוֹתֵר כָּלֵל

But, by way of unifying with the *ohr pnimi* He claims the debt due to Him, and He does not compromise at all.

זֶהוּ מִדַּת וְאַמֶּת וּמִתְיַחֲדִים שְׁנֵיהֶם וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל בְּפַעֲלוֹת וְסִיבּוּבִים
נֶעֱלָמִים

This is the attribute of 'Truth.' Both attributes unite and everything is achieved by way of direct actions as well as indirect and concealed activities

בְּאֶפֶן שְׁמֵתִקְיָמִים שְׁנֵיהֶם וְהוּא וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת בְּיַחַד:

in a manner that both attributes are satisfied – Abundant Kindness and Truth together.

Footnotes

1. See Shabbat 30b: [↩](#)
2. Makover notes that the author does not elaborate on what he means by this. However, the Arizal explains (*Eitz Chaim Sha'ar* 13, chaps. 4-5) that the 13 *Tikunim* flow from *Arich Anpin*, the first level of *keter*, which is an *ohr makif* as opposed to all the other *sefirot*, which are *ohr pnimi*. [↩](#)
3. The Zohar states as follows: [↩](#)

Chapter 5 — The mystery of the 13 tikunim (rectifications) of arikh, din (severity), gehenom (hell) applying to those who do wrong, and who will merit the world to come.

How is it that the 13 Attributes of Mercy flow from the 13 Attributes of Strict Justice? Apparent contradictions are resolved.

אִמָּנָם הוּא הִנֵּה לְעִיל פ"ג בְּאַרְנוּ כִּי הָאֹר פְּנִימִי וְהָאֹר מְקִיף הֵם
מְשֻׁרָשָׁם אֶחָד הוּא

We explained in chapter 3 that the source of the illumination of the internalized light (the *ohr pnimi*), and the illumination from the enveloping light (*ohr makif*) is one and the same,

כִּי נִמְשָׁךְ הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי מֵהָאֹר הַמְּקִיף כִּמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר שֵׁם

since the *ohr pnimi* is drawn from the *ohr makif*, as explained there.

וּא"כ הֲרִי נִמְצָא כִּי מֵדֶת 'וְאֶמֶת' הוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ מִמֵּדֶת 'וְרֵב חֶסֶד'

That being so, it turns out that the attribute of 'Truth'¹ is itself drawn from the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.'²

וְעוֹד כִּי הֲרִי מֵדֶת 'וְאֶמֶת' הֲרִי הוּא ג"כ מִ"ג מֵדוֹת הַרְחֻמִּים

Furthermore, the attribute of 'Truth' is also one of the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy,

וְהֵם מֵהִ"ג תְּקוּנִים דא"א כִּי 'וְרֵב חֶסֶד' הִיא תְּקוּנָה ו' 'וְאֶמֶת' הוּא
תְּקוּנָה ז'

and both of them are among the 'the Thirteen Tikunim,' for 'Abundant Kindness' is the sixth Tikun, and 'Truth' is the seventh Tikun,

וְכָל הַי"ג תְּקוּנִים הֵם כָּלם רַק אוֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים כַּמ"ש בַּשַּׁעַר א"א
פ"ח

and all of the Thirteen Tikunim are exclusively enveloping lights, as is explained in *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Arich Anpin* chapter 8.

אך לְבָאֵר עֲנֵנוּ זֶה הוּא בְּאֵמֶת עֶמֶק מְאֹד וְהוּא מֵהַסּוּדוֹת הַנִּעְלָמִים

However, to explain this concept the Thirteen Tikunim of Arich Anpin one must truly plumb the depths – it is one of the hidden mysteries.

וְעכ"ז הִנֵּה נְבוֹא בְּחִזְקַת הַיָּד לְדַבֵּר בְּזֶה מַעֲט וְהוּא רַחוּם יִכְפֹּר.

Nevertheless, we will approach this 'with a strong hand'³ and discuss it briefly, and may Hashem forgive...

הִנֵּה נוֹדֵעַ הוּא מִדְּבָרֵי הַזֶּה "ק וְהָאֲרִיז" ל כִּי הַי"ג מִדּוֹת הַרַחֲמִים
אֲשֶׁר בַּפ' תִּשָּׂא

Now it is known from the words of the Zohar and the Arizal that the 13 Attributes of Mercy in *parshat Ki Tisa* Exodus 34:6 ff.

הֵם נוֹבְעִין וְיוֹצְאִין מֵהַי"ג תְּקוּנֵינוּ שֶׁבְּפָסוּק 'מִי א-ל כְּמוֹךָ'⁴ כו' אֲשֶׁר
בְּמִיכָה בְּסוּפּוֹ

flow and emerge from the 13 Tikunim in the verse (Michah 7:18) "Who, O G-d, is like You ..." at the end of Michah.

אֵלָּא בְּמִיכָה מְסוּדָרִים שֵׁם בְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁבַח כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֵם לְמַעַלָּה בֵּא"א
עֲצָמוֹ,

Except that in Michah they are arranged as a tribute to the way they are above in *Arich* itself,

וּבַפ' תִּשָּׂא נֶאֱמָרוּ שֵׁם ע"ש גְּלוּיִים וְהַתְּפַשְׁטוּתָם לְמַטָּה בַּז"א לְצִדָּה
הַרַחֲמִים

whereas in *parshat Ki Tisa* they are stated as revealed aspects flowing down to *Ze'ir Anpin* for the purpose of compassion.

כִּי נִתְגַּלּוּ וְנִתְפָּשְׁטוּ מִלְּמַעַל לַמָּטָה שֶׁהוּא מֵא"א לז"א לְרַחֵם עַל
יִשְׂרָאֵל לְצוּרָךְ אוֹתוֹ הַמֶּאֱרָע

For they become revealed and flow down from above to below – from *Arich Anpin* to *Zeir Anpin* – in order to have compassion for Israel as required on that particular occasion.

וְגִלּוּיִים לַמָּטָה הוּא בְּאוֹתָן הַתְּבוּת וְהַמְּלוּת אֲשֶׁר בִּפ' תִּשָּׂא

Their revelation below is by way of those very same letters and words in *parshat Ki Tisa****.

וְע' בִּאֲד"ר קל"א וּבְדְבָרֵי הָרֹב בְּשֶׁעַר א"א פ"ט

See *Idra Rabba* p. 131 and in the words of the Rabbi – the Arizal – in *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Arich* chapter 9.

וְהִנֵּה נֶאֱמַר בְּפִסּוּק מִי א-ל כְּמוֹךְ כו' וְעִבֵּר עַל פֶּשַׁע שֶׁהוּא תִקּוּן ג'

Now the verse states "Who, O G-d, is like You... Who commutes iniquity" – which is the third Tikun,

וְאָמְרוּ בִּאֲד"ר קל"ג א' מֵאִי וְעִוְבֵר עַל פֶּשַׁע דְּאֶקְדִּים שִׁין לִפ"א
וְנַעֲשֶׂה מִפֶּשַׁע שְׁפַע

and it states in *Idra Rabba* 133a: What is the meaning of "Who commutes iniquity"? He places the letter *shin* before the letter *peh* and thus *pesha* (iniquity) becomes *shefa* (an outflow of benevolence).

'Commutes' is therefore understood here in the sense of 'transpose' or 'switch' – by switching the order of the letters *pesha* becomes *shefa*.⁵

וְהוּא מִדַּת 'וְחִנּוּן' שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת ג' אֲשֶׁר בִּפ' תִּשָּׂא וְהוּא יוֹתֵר מִ'רַחוּם'

This is the attribute of *v'chanun* (gracious), the third attribute of the 13 in *parshat Ki Tisa* , and it is more than 'compassionate'** which is the second attribute in *parshat Ki Tisa*,**

כי הוא חונן ונעשה מִפְּשַׁע שִׁפְעַ

since He grants grace, and *pesha* is commuted to *shefa*.

וְהִנֵּה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה הוּא קָשָׁה לְהַבִּין מֵאֵד אֵיךְ אֶפְשָׁר לְהַעֲשׂוֹת מִפְּשַׁע שִׁפְעַ

Now how it is possible for *pesha* to be commuted to *shefa* is a matter very difficult to understand

כִּי לֹא מְצִינוּ כֵּזֶה אֶלָּא רַק בְּעוֹשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה

since we only find a similar phenomenon with those who repent out of love,

שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְיוֹמָא פּוּ, ב שִׁדְוֹנוֹת נַעֲשָׂה לוֹ כְּזִכִּיּוֹת

regarding which the Sages stated in *Yoma* 86b that "deliberate transgressions are transformed into merits for him."

אָבֵל הִי"ג מִדּוֹת הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּרַחֲמִים לְבַד כִּי עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר

But the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy are all compassion exclusively, for regarding them it states,

וְחִנַּנְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אַחֲוֹ וְרַחֲמַתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אֲרַחֵם (שמות לג, יט) אע"פ שֶׁאִינוּ כְּדֹאֵי וְהִגּוֹן לְכַךְ

"I will be gracious to those whom I wish to show grace, and I will be compassionate to those to whom I wish to show compassion" (Exodus 33:19) even though that person is not worthy thereof.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּשֵׁמוֹת רַבָּה ס"פ מ"ה וְכֵן בְּתַנְחוּמָא שָׁם

A similar statement is made in *Shemot Rabba* end of chapter 45, and similarly in *Tanchuma* *ibid*.

כי הי"ג מדות הרחמים הם מאוצר גדול של מתנת חנם

that the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy are from the great storehouse of unearned gifts.

ואמרו בשמו"ר שם בפסוק (שמות לג, יט) 'אני אעביר כל טובי על פניך'

And our Sages in *Shemot Rabba* ad loc comment on the verse (Exodus 33:19), "I shall make all My goodness pass before you..."

כי 'כל טובי' הוא מדת הטוב ומדת הפרענות

"All My goodness" is both the attribute of good and the attribute of retribution

כי ע"י מדת הפרענות שהוא כל הענשים כלם אשר בעוה"ז וכן לאחר מיתה

because via the attribute of retribution, which includes all of the punishments in this world and also those after death,

הנה עי"ז יזכו כלם לכל טוב העתיד

by virtue thereof everyone will be worthy of all the goodness that will be bestowed upon them in the future.

והוא האוצר גדול של מתנת חנם שאמרנו

And this is the enormous storehouse of unearned gifts that we mentioned above.

אמנם עכ"ז איך שנעשה מפשע שפע זה קשה להבין

Nevertheless, how *pesha* is transformed into *shefa* is hard to understand.

וכן הוא עד"ז צריך באור עוד כי הנה התקין ז' אשר בפסוק 'מי אל קמוך'

Similarly, further explanation is needed regarding the seventh Tikun in the verse in Michah, 'Who, O G-d, is like You',

מֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שָׁם (פסוק יט) 'יָשׁוּב יִרְחֹמֵנוּ וּמָמְנוּ יוֹצֵא וְנִמְשָׁךְ הַמִּדָּה
ז' מֵהִי"ג מִדּוֹת שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת 'וְאֶמֶת'

as it states there (Michah 7:19) 'He will again show us mercy', from which emerges the seventh attribute of the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy mentioned in *Ki Tisa* (Exodus 34:6 ff.) – the attribute of 'and Truth' which the author explained as the source of the revelation of the *ohr pnimi* that is manifested in limitation.⁶

וְהָרִי צָרִיךְ בְּאוֹר אֵיךְ יוֹצֵא מִדַּת 'וְאֶמֶת' מִ'יָּשׁוּב יִרְחֹמֵנוּ'

Accordingly, we need an explanation of how the attribute of 'and Truth' emerges from 'He will again show us mercy'

הָרִי הֵם כְּשֵׁנֵי הַפָּכִים זֶה מִזֶּה כִּי זֶה רַחֲמִים וְזֶה דִּין

since they are like two opposites – one being compassion and the other strict justice.

וְעַד שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י"ז ב': ר' אֶלְעָזָר רָמִי כְּתִיב (תהילים סב,
'יג) 'וּלְךָ אֲדֹנָי חֶסֶד'

This is similar to what our Sages noted in Tractate Rosh HaShana 17b: Rabbi Elazar presents a contradiction – in Psalms 62:13 it is written 'Yours, O Lord, is kindness'

וּכְתִיב (שם) 'כִּי אֶתָּה תִּשְׁלַם לְאִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׁהוּ'

and the same verse continues 'For You repay each person according to their deeds.'

בְּתַחֲלָה כִּי אֶתָּה תִּשְׁלַם לְאִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׁהוּ וּלְבִסּוּף 'וּלְךָ אֲדֹנָי חֶסֶד'
וְעַ"ש בְּתוֹסָפוֹת

How could both of these be true – initially, 'You repay each person according to their deeds,' and yet in the end 'Yours, O

Lord, is kindness.' See Tosafot there.⁷

עוד שם אֶלֶּפָא רָמִי כְּתִיב 'וְרַב חֶסֶד' וְכְתִיב 'וְאֱמֶת' בְּתַחֲלָה 'וְאֱמֶת'
וּלְבִסּוּף 'וְרַב חֶסֶד'

Furthermore, in the same section Ilfa (a second generation Amora from Israel) also **presents a contradiction: It is written** in the Thirteen Attributes '**Abundant Kindness**' and it is written '**and Truth**' – but the resolution is **initially 'and Truth,' but nevertheless in the end 'Abundant Kindness.'**

The resolution of both these contradictions is that the attribute manifested at the outset is replaced by a different attribute later on. However, as the author will ask shortly, how could it be that the attribute of strict justice is *transformed into* compassion? That would seem to be impossible.

אָבֵל שִׁימֶשֶׁךְ מִדַּת 'וְאֱמֶת' מִמֵּדֶת 'יָשׁוּב יִרְחֲמֵנוּ' הֲלֹא לְכַאוֹרָה זֶה אֵי
אֶפְשָׁר בְּשׁוּם פְּנִים

But that the attribute of 'and Truth' can emerge out of the attribute of 'He will again show us mercy' would seem to be impossible at first glance.

וְגַם תְּרוּצוֹ שֶׁל הַגְּמָרָא הוּא לְכַאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מְדַקְדֵּק

Furthermore the Talmud's resolution of the contradiction does not seem to be precise

כִּי הָרִי בְּהַפְסוֹק כְּתִיב לְהִפָּךְ בְּתַחֲלָה 'וְרַב חֶסֶד' וְאַחֲ"כ 'וְאֱמֶת'.

since the terms in the verse are written in the opposite order – first '**Abundant Kindness**' and *afterwards* '**and Truth**,' and not vice versa.

אֲךָ הָעֵנִינּוּ בַכ"ז הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה נוֹדֵעַ הוּא כְּמָה גָּדוֹל עִמָּךְ הַדִּין

However, the idea is as follows: The extent of the depth of Divine Judgment is known to us

והכתוב אומר (קהלת יב, יד) 'האלהים יבא במשפט על כל נעלם'

as the verse states (Ecclesiastes 12:14) 'For G-d will judge every deed – even matters that are hidden – whether good or evil.'

ואמרו (ב"ק נ, א) כל האומר הקב"ה ותרו כו' אמנם כ"ז הוא אינו לנקמה ח"ו

And regarding this **our Sages** in the Talmud (*Bava Kama* 50a) **declared, 'Anyone who says that the Holy One, blessed is He, is lenient'** could be forfeiting his life...

אלא כדי לתן שארית ואחרית טוב גם לנפש החוטאת לנקותה מחלאתה וזהמטה

However, in order to permit even a sinning soul to survive and reach a positive ending, by cleansing it of its disease and infection,

ולצרפה וללבנה שתהיה ראויה להשאר בהשארה נצחית ולהאיר באור פני מלך חיים

and refining and purifying it so that it will be worthy of eternal life, and will be illuminated by the light of the Countenance of the Living King, the Almighty,

בימות המשיח אשר מזמן תחית המתים והלאה ולחיי העולם הבא

in the Messianic era from the time of the resurrection and on to life in the World to Come –

והרי נתיסדו כל הז' מדורי גיהנום

for this the seven levels of Gehinnom were established

כמבאר במדרש כונו ובמדרש תהלים י"א ובזהר חדש רות בארפה [ועי' עירובין י"ט ע"א ובזה"ק תרומה ק"נ ע"ב ובכ"מ

[as is explained in Midrash Konen and in Midrash Tehillim 11 and in *Zohar Chadash Ruth* at length. See also Tractate Eruvin 19a, and *Zohar, Terumah* 150b, and a number of other places].

וְכֹן הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם לֹא לְנִקְמָה ח"ו אֶלָּא לְמִרוּק שְׂיִזְכוּ גַם הַפּוֹשְׁעִים
וְהַמּוֹרְדִים

Similarly, all the punishments mentioned in the Torah and the writings of the Sages are not for the purpose of retribution, Heaven forbid, but rather to cleanse the sinners and rebels so that they too will have the merit

לְהִשָּׁאֵר בְּהִשְׁאָרָה נִצְחִית לְיָמֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

and will live eternally in the Messianic era and in the World to Come,

וְכִמּוֹ שְׂמַצִּינוּ בְּאַלִּישֶׁע אַחֵר בְּחִגִּיגָה ט"ו ב' שְׂאֲמְרוּ עָלָיו לֹא מִדֵּן
לְיַדִּינָה וְלֹא לְעִלְמָא דְאַתִּי לִיתִי

As we see regarding Elisha Acher in Tractate Chagiga 15b

אָמַר ר' מֵאִיר מוֹטָב דְּלִידִינָה וְלִיתִי לְעִלְמָא דְאַתִּי

regarding whom Rabbi Meir declared, "Better that he be judged and punished accordingly and then he can enter the World to Come.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי גַם מִי אֲשֶׁר דִּינוֹ הוּא שְׂלֵא יִהְיֶה לוֹ חֶלֶק לְעוֹה"ב

Thus we have it that even one whose sentence is such that he should not have a portion in the World to Come,

הִנֵּה הַדִּינִים וְהָעֲנָשִׁים מְמַרְקִין אוֹתוֹ וְיֵשׁ לוֹ תִּקְנָה ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים

the judgments and punishments cleanse such a person and he is rectified thereby.

וְכֹן הוּא בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ק"י רע"ב בְּעֵדֶת קָרוֹחַ כִּי כָּל תַּלְתִּין יוֹמִין מִהֲדָרָא
לְהוֹ גִּיהֵנָם כְּבָשָׁר בְּתוֹךְ קִלְחָת

This is also what Tractate Sanhedrin 110b states regarding Korach's band of rebels – that every thirty days Gehinnom returns them to this place, like meat being turned over in a pot

ועכ"ז הנה אָמְרוּ שָׁם ק"ח א' וק"ט ב' כִּי עֲלֵיהֶם הוּא אוֹמֵר (שמואל א' ב, ו) 'ה' מִמִּית וּמַחְיֶה מוֹרִיד שְׂאוֹל וַיַּעַל'

And nevertheless, the Sages state there (108a, 109b) that regarding them the verse (Samuel I, 2:6) states, 'G-d brings death and grants life, He lowers into the grave and raises up' – and thus

וַיָּקוּמוּ בַּתְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

they will arise with the Resurrection of the Dead and they will be granted life in the World to Come.

וְכֵן הוּא מְפָרֵשׁ בַּתּוֹרָה בְּקַלְלוֹת שְׁבַת־תּוֹרַת כְּהֹנָיִם

And this is stated explicitly in the curses in the Torah in Leviticus parshat *Bechukotai*

שִׁמְפָּרֵשׁ שָׁם גַּם חָטָא עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וּכְמ"ש שָׁם (ויקרא כו, ל) 'עַל פְּגָרֵי גִלּוּלֵיכֶם'

where it is unambiguous that even the sin of idolatry – as the verse (Leviticus 26:30) states, '...upon the carcasses of your idols' –

עכ"ז הנה נֶאֱמַר לְבַסּוֹף (ויקרא כו, מד) וְאֵף גַּם זֹאת כו'

and nevertheless at the end of that section it states (Leviticus 26:44), 'But despite all this... I will not despise them, nor reject them and destroy them...'

וּמִבְטִיחַ הַתּוֹרָה הַשְּׂאֵרָה נִצְחִית לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם גַּם בַּחֲטָא עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה הַחֲמוּרָה רח"ל

Thus the Torah promises eternal life for all Jewish people, even when there is the sin of idolatry, the most severe of all sins,

Heaven forfend.

הגם שֶהֵדִין בָּזֶה הוּא שֶׁלֹא יִהְיֶה לוֹ חֵלֶק לְעוֹה"ב

This is so even though the law is that he the transgressor will not have a portion in the World to Come,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁפֶסֶק הָרַמְבַּ"ם בַּפ"ג מִהִלְכוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה ה"ו וְהוּא מְגַמְרָא
רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י"ז א'

as Maimonides rules in chapter 3 of *Hilchot Teshuvah*, derived from the Talmud Tractate *Rosh HaShana* 17a.

עכ"ז הִנֵּה הָעֲנָשִׁים מְמַרְקִים אוֹתוֹ וְלֹא יֵאבֵד שׁוּם נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת
מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל

Nevertheless, punishments cleanse the person so that not a single Jewish soul will be lost,

וְכַמ"ש הַגֵּר"א בְּאַדְרֵת אֱלִיהוּ פ' נִצְבִּים פְּסוּק י"ח

As the Vilna Gaon writes in Aderet Eliyahu on Nitzavim verse 18

שֶׁהַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבְּתוֹ"כ הֵם נֶאֱמָרוּ לְכָל יָחִיד וְיָחִיד

that the curses in Leviticus 26:15 are directed at each person individually,

מִשָּׂא"כ הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבְּמִשְׁנֵה תוֹרָה הֵם נֶאֱמָרוּ לְכָלל יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּיַחַד

whereas the curses in Deuteronomy are directed at the entire Jewish people together.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאֶמְרוּ בְּמִגְלָה ל"א ע"ב הִלְלוּ בְּלִשׁוֹן רַבִּים אֲמֹרוֹת

This is the meaning of the statement our Sages made in Megillah 31b, that these earlier curses are stated in the plural –

ר"ל כִּי הֵם אֲמֹרוֹת לְכָל יָחִיד וְיָחִיד בְּפָנֵי עַצְמוֹ לְכָךְ נֶאֱמָרוּ בְּלִשׁוֹן
רַבִּים

meaning to say, they are expressed to each and every individual, and therefore they are stated in the plural –

משא"כ בַּמִּשְׁנָה תּוֹרָה הֵם נֶאֱמָרוּ רַק לְכָל־ל יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּיַחֲד לְכָךְ נֶאֱמָר
שֶׁם בְּלִשׁוֹן יַחֲדִיד

whereas the ones in Deuteronomy are said to the people as a whole, and therefore they are stated in the singular.

וְהָיִי לָנוּ מִזֶּה ג' כ' כִּי הִבְטַחְתָּ 'וְאִף גַּם זֹאת' כו' וּמִבְטִיחַ הַתּוֹרָה
הַשְּׂאֲרָה נִצָּחִית עכ"פ

It turns out that with the promise (Leviticus 26:44) 'But despite all this... I will not despise them, nor reject them and destroy them...' the Torah assures eternal life

הִנֵּה הוּא ג' כ' לְכָל יַחֲדִיד וְיַחֲדִיד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל כִּי גַם מִי שְׁדִּינוּ הוּא שְׁלֹא
יִהְיֶה לוֹ חֶלֶק לַעוֹה"ב ח"ו

for each and every Jewish individual, since even one whose sentence is that they will not have a portion in the World to Come,

הִנֵּה הָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָם וְכֻמוֹ הַקְּלָלוֹת שִׁבְתוּ"כ וְשִׁבְמִשְׁנָה תּוֹרָה

all of the punishments, such as those mentioned in Leviticus and in Deuteronomy,

ע"ש בַּהֲגָר"א כִּי זֶהוּ מָה שְׁנֶאֱמָר וְהִבְדִּילוּ ה' לְרָעָה ר"ל

(see GR "A ibid. that this is the meaning of Deuteronomy 29:20
'And God will set him aside for a bad patch,' Heaven have mercy,

הַגַּם שֶׁהֵם נֶאֱמָרִים רַק עַל כָּל־ל יִשְׂרָאֵל

even though these verses are stated regarding Israel as a whole.

ועי"ז 'הַתְּפִירָה בְּלָבָבוֹ לֵאמֹר שְׁלוֹם יִהְיֶה לִּי לְכוּ נֶאֱמָר וְהִבְדִּילוּ ה'
כו' ע"ש

גִּיהֵנוֹם כָּלָה וְהֵם אֵינָם כָּלִים הַכֹּנֶה הוּא ג"כ לַמַּעֲלִיּוֹתָא

'Gehinnom will come to an end, but they will not come to an end,' in a positive sense,

כִּי הֵם יִשָּׁאֲרוּ עכ"פ יִתְקַנּוּ גַם הֵם לְבִסּוּף

for they i.e. their souls will remain alive, and in any event they too will be rectified in the end,

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁהָאֲרִיךְ בָּזֶה הִגָּאוֹן קְדוֹשׁ ה' הֵרַם"ע מִפָּאנּוּז"ל בְּעֶשְׂרֵה
מֵאֲמָרוֹת מֵאֲמַר חֲקוּר דִּין חֶלֶק ה' ע"ש

as the holy Rabbi Menachem Azaria de Fano states at length in *Asarah Ma'amarot, Ma'amar Chikur haDin*.

וּמ"ש בְּגִמְרָא נְדוּנִין בָּהּ לְדוּרֵי דוֹרוֹת הַכֹּנֶה הוּא רַק עַד שֶׁכָּלוּ כָּל
הַדּוֹרוֹת לְצֵאת

Now when the Talmud states that they descend to Gehinnom and are sentenced there for generations, the intention is only until all the end of all generations,

וְהוּא בְּזֶמֶן תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים שָׁאֵז לֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד דּוֹרוֹת חֲדָשִׁים כָּלָל

which is at the time of the Resurrection of the Dead, when there will be no more new generations,

כִּי כִּבֵּר יִכְלוּ כָּל הַנִּשְׁמוֹת שֶׁבְּגוּף כַּמ"ש בִּיבְמוֹת ס"ב סע"א

for no souls will be left in the storehouse of souls called *guf* as Tractate Yevamot 62a states.

וְכֵן מ"ש שֵׁם בְּפוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּגוּפָן שִׁיְהִיו אֶפֶר תַּחַת כַּפּוֹת רַגְלֵי
הַצַּדִּיקִים

[And similarly when it states there that those Jews who sinned with their bodies will be dust under the soles of the feet of the righteous,

הכּוֹנֵה הוּא כִּי עִי"ז יִתְעַכַּל הָרַע שֶׁבָּהֶם וְיִשָּׂאֵר הַטּוֹב נָקִי וּמְבָרָר

the intention is that in this way the evil in them will be consumed, and they will remain good and cleansed and pure.

ועי"ז יתקנו ויחיו (ע' הגר"א בספד"צ פ"א בדה"מ מלך הרביעי)
[ויקומו בתחה"מ]

(See GR "A to *Sefra d'Tzniuta* chap. 1 s.v. 'The fourth king'⁹).
And in this way they will be rectified and will live to arise with the Resurrection of the Dead].

ועכ"פ הוּא כִּי ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבֵא יִתְקַנּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל
כָּלָם.

In any event, by means of all of the punishments in this world and the next, the entirety of Israel will be rectified,

וְזֶהוּ שְׂאֵמְרוֹ בִּשְׁמוֹ"ר הַנ"ל כִּי מָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר 'כָּל טוֹבִי' הוּא מִדַּת הַטּוֹב
וּמִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוּת

as it states in Shemot Rabba op. cit. regarding the verse "I shall make all My goodness pass before you..." – this refers to both the attribute of good and the attribute of retribution,

כִּי גַם מִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוּת הוּא אֵינוֹ לְנִקְמָה ח"ו אֶלָּא רַק כְּדִי לְזַכּוֹת עַל
יְדֵיהֶם

since the attribute of retribution is not in order to take revenge, Heaven forbid, but rather to make a person worthy

לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים אֲשֶׁר עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר מָה רַב טוֹבְךָ כו'.

of all the promises about the future regarding which the verse (Psalms 31:20) states, "How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away for those who fear You..."

אֲמָנָם כ"ז הוּא רַק לְרָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

However all of the above is only as regards wicked Jews,

אָבֵל לְרָשָׁעִי עֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הִנֵּה עֲלֵיהֶם נֹאמֵר אִיּוֹב (כ, ז) כ' כְּגִלְלוּ
לְנֶצַח יֵאבֵד

**but regarding wicked idolaters the verse states in Job (20:7),
"he will perish forever like his own dung."**

וְכֵן דָּנִיֵּאל (ט, כז) בְּסוּפוֹ וְעַד כָּלָה וְנִחְרָצָה תִּתֵּן עַל שְׁמִם'

**Similarly, Daniel (9:27) states "until the extermination decreed
will descend upon the lifeless idol."**

וְהַטַּעַם הוּא כִּי רָשָׁעִי אֹמֵרוֹת הָעוֹלָם

**The reason for this is because regarding the wicked of the
nations**

הִנֵּה אָמְרוּ עֲלֵיהֶם בְּעִירוּבֵין י"ט ע"א רָשָׁעִים אָפִילוּ עַל פִּתְחוֹ שֶׁל
גִּיהֵנָם אֵינָם חוֹזְרִים בְּתִשּׁוּבָה

**Our Sages state (Tractate Eruvin 19a): The wicked, even at the
entrance of Gehinnom, do not repent.**

וְלָכֵן נֹאמֵר עֲלֵיהֶם אִיּוֹב (יב, כג) 'מִשְׁגִּיא לַגּוֹיִם וַיֵּאבְדֻם'

**And therefore it states in Job (12:23) "He exalts nations and
[then] destroys them" if they do not acknowledge that their
greatness is due to His beneficence.**

וְכֵן (דְּבָרִים ז, י) וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל פְּנֵיו לְהֵאבִידוֹ

**Similarly (Deuteronomy 7:10), "And He repays His enemies in
their lifetime to make them perish" when they do not follow His
ways.**

אָבֵל בְּרָשָׁעִי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִנֵּה אָמְרוּ בְּעִירוּבֵין שֵׁם כִּי הֵם מַצְדִּיקִין
עֲלֵיהֶם אֶת הַדִּין

**But as for Jews who act wickedly our Sages state in Eruvin ad
loc., they acknowledge the righteousness of their sentence,**

וְאוֹמְרִים לְפָנָיו "רַב־שׁ עֵינֵה דָנְתָּ יִפְּה זְכִיתָ יִפְּה חִיבֶתָ וַיִּפְּה תִקְנֶתָ
גִּיהֶנֶם לְרָשָׁעִים, גּוֹן עֵדוֹ לְצַדִּיקִים"

and declare before Him: "Master of the World, You have judged fairly, You have exonerated fairly, You have convicted fairly, You have prepared Gehinnom for the wicked and the Garden of Eden for the righteous."

וְכֵן בְּגִטִּין (נ"ז, א) תָּא חֲזִי מָה בֵּין פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְנִבְיָאֵי אוֹמוֹת
[הַעוֹלָם ע"ש]

[And similarly in Tractate Gittin 57a: Come and see the difference between Jewish sinners and the prophets of idolatry]

וּבְאוֹתוֹת דֵּר' עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ח' מְבָאָר כִּי לֹא דֵי שְׂמַצְדִּיקִין עֲלֵיהֶם אֶת
הַדִּין

The work *Otiot d'Rabbi Akiva*, 8 explains that not only do they acknowledge the righteousness of their judgment

אֲלֹא שְׂגָם מְקַבְּלִים עַל עֲצָמוֹן אֶת הַדִּין וְאָמַר שָׁם כִּי רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

they even accept the sentence upon themselves.

וְאָמַר שָׁם כִּי רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשַׁעָה שֶׁהֵם רואִין פָּנֵי גִיהֶנֶם הֵם
מְקַבְּלִים עֲלֵיהֶם בְּעֲצָמוֹן דִּינוֹ שֶׁל גִּיהֶנֶם

And it states there that Jews who act wickedly, when they see the face of Gehinnom, they themselves accept the sentence of Gehinnom,

וְשׁוֹבְרִים אֶת לִבָּם בְּתִשְׁבּוּבָה לְפָנֵי הַקֵּב"ה

and their hearts break in *teshuvah* (repentance) before the Holy One, blessed is He.

וְעֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר קְרוֹב ה' לְנִשְׁבְּרֵי לֵב וּמַעֲלִין אוֹתָם וּמוֹשִׁיבִין אוֹתָם
בִּישִׁיבָה אֶצְל הַשְּׂכִינָה

Regarding them it states, "God is close to the broken of heart," and He raises them up and seats them next to the *Shechinah*.

וּמִקְבָּלִים שָׂכָר עַל כָּל חֲטָא שֶׁהָיָה בְיָדָם כְּצַדִּיקָה

They receive reward as if it was charity for repenting for every sin ascribed to them

וַיְהִיו עִם הַצַּדִּיקִים וְהַחֲסִידִים תַּמִּימִים וְיִשְׁרִים בְּעָלֵי צַדִּיקָה וְגוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים

and they will reside – together with the righteous, the pious, the innocent and the upright, the charitable and the kind,

בְּעָלֵי תּוֹרָה וְאֲנָשֵׁי אֱמוּנָה לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא ע"ש בָּאוֹת ז' ח' בְּאַרְכָּה

the masters of Torah and people of faith – in the World to Come. See there chaps. 7 & 8 at length.

וְהִגַּם שְׂאִין תְּשׁוּבָה לְאַחֵר מִיָּתָה אַךְ ע"י שְׂמִקְבָּלִין עַל עֲצָמוֹן דִּינוֹ שֶׁל גִּיהֲנוֹם

Now although there is no *teshuvah* (repentance) after death, by accepting upon themselves their sentence in Gehinnom,

וּמִתְמַרְקִין וּמִתְלַבְּנִים שָׁם הֵנָּה מִקְבָּלִים אַח"כ תְּשׁוּבָתָם ג"כ וְכַנ"ל בְּעֵדֶת קָרוֹחַ.

where they are scoured out and purified, their *teshuvah* is then also accepted, as mentioned above regarding Korach's band of rebels.

וְהֵנָּה עַל זֶה הָיָה חֲרָדַת כָּל הַצַּדִּיקִים מִרַב הָעֲנָוָה שֶׁבָּהֶם

This judgment was something even the righteous feared, due to their great humility,

כְּמוֹ דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ ע"ה שֶׁאָמַר לוֹלָא הָאֲמַנְתִּי כו'

as King David said, 'Had I not trusted that I would see the benevolence of God in the land of life...' (i.e. the World to Come),

וכמ"ש בברכות ד, א וכן ר' יוחנן בן זכאי שם כח, ב

and as the Talmud explains in Tractate Berachot 4a, and as Rabbi Yochanan ben Zakai declared, *ibid.* 28b.

והיה החררה שלהם אם שיזכו למעלת הצדקים ע"י המעשים טובים

Their fear was whether they would merit the worthiness of saintly Tzadikim due to their good deeds,

או אולי ח"ו רק ע"י צורף ולבון דוקא וכמו שיתבאר עוד למטה עקר עמק הענין בזה.

or whether perhaps, Heaven forbid, this would only be via scouring and refining, as will be explained further below in depth.

אמנם הנה בכמה מקומות בזה"ק (בזהר חדש לך לך ובזו"ח רות ובזהר תרומה ק"נ ע"ב)

Indeed in a number of places in the holy Zohar (*Zohar Chadash, Lech Lecha; Zohar Chadash, Ruth; Zohar Terumah* p. 150b)

מבאר כי מי שיורד למדור השביעי שנקרא אבדון,

it is explained that one who descends to the seventh level of Gehinnom, which is called 'destruction'

והם כל אלו שאמרו בראש השנה י"ז א' שהם נדונין לדורי דורות

and this includes all those whom the Talmud Rosh Hashana 17a declares would be sentenced for generations,

הנה הם אינם יוצאים משם לעולם

suggesting that they will never emerge from there,

וכן הוא בגמרא פסחים נד, א כי אור של גיהנם אין לו כביה לעולם

and so too Tractate Pesachim 54a states that the fires of Gehinnom are never extinguished,

וּלְמָדוּ זֶה מִמֶּקְרָא שֶׁכָּתוּב וְאֵשׁ לֹא תִכָּבֶה

which they the Sages derived from a verse (Isaiah 66:24) that states, "their fire will not be extinguished" –

אךְ כָּבֵר כָּתַב הָרַמ"ע מִפָּאנוֹ ז"ל בְּמֵאמֶר חֲקוֹר דִּין ח"ה פ"ה

but regarding this matter Rabbi Menachem Azaria de Fano already stated in *Asarah Ma'amarot*, *Ma'amar Chikur haDin 5:5*

שֶׁהוּא רַק כָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָעוֹלָם עוֹמֵד עַל מַדְרָגָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

that this is only as long as the world remains at its current spiritual level.

וְע"ד שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרָאשִׁית רַבָּה (לד, יא) בְּפֶסוּק (בראשית ח, כב) ע"ד
כָּל יְמֵי הָאָרֶץ

In similar fashion, Bereishit Rabba (34, 11), on the verse (Genesis 8:22) "all the days of the earth..." states

שֶׁהוּא רַק כָּל זְמַן שֶׁהַשָּׁמַיִם וְהָאָרֶץ קִיֻּמִּין

that this is only as long as the heavens and earth exist.

אֲבָל כְּשִׁיבּוֹא אוֹתוֹ יוֹם שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ (ישעיהו נא, ו) 'כִּי שָׁמַיִם כַּעֲשָׂן
נִמְלָחוּ וְהָאָרֶץ כַּבֶּגֶד תִּבְלֶה'

But when the day comes, regarding which it states (Isaiah 51:6), "for the heavens will scatter like smoke and the earth will wear out like a garment" –

בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה (זכריה יא, יא) 'וַיִּתְּכֶר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא' [[וַיִּדְעוּ כֵן עֲנִי
הַצֹּאֵן הַשְּׁמַרִים אֶתִּי כִּי דִבֶּר ה' הוּא]] כו' ע"ש

at that time "it became annulled on that day and the meek of the flock who paid heed to Me, recognized that is was so, that is was the word of God" (Zechariah 11:11).

כֵּן הוּא עַד"ז בְּעֲנִינֵינוּ כִּי מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁהָאֵשׁ שֶׁל גִּיהֶנֶם אֵין לוֹ כְּבִיָּה
לְעוֹלָם

And so too in our case – when they said that 'the fires of Gehinnom are never extinguished,'

וְכֵן מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵין יוֹצְאִים מִשָּׁם לְעוֹלָם

and when they said that 'they will never emerge from there' from Gehinnom –

הַכּוֹנֵנָה הוּא רַק כָּל זְמוֹן שֶׁהָעוֹלָם הוּא עַל הַמַּדְרָגָה שֶׁהִיא עַתָּה

the intention is – as long as the world remains at its current spiritual level.

אֲבָל לְעֵתִיד לָבוֹא בְּאֶשֶׁר יִתְבַטֵּל הָרַע כֻּלּוֹ וְיִכָּלֶה כָּל הַטְּמָאָה
וְהַזְהָמָה

But in the future, when evil will be entirely obliterated and all spiritual impurity and contamination will be eliminated,

הִנֵּה אֲזִי יִתְבַטְּלוּ כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם כִּי 'כָּל הָרָשָׁעָה כֻּלָּהּ בְּעֶשֶׂן
תִּכָּלֶה'

then all the punishments without exception will be nullified, for 'all evil will go up in smoke' as we say in the Rosh Hashana prayers.

וְאֲזִי יִטְהַר הַגִּיהֶנֶם ג"כ וְיִתְקַדֵּשׁ גַּם הוּא בִּקְדוּשָׁתוֹ שֶׁל גֶּן עֵדֶן

And then Gehinnom will also be cleaned out and will also be graced with the sanctity of the Garden of Eden,

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ רַז"ל בְּנִדְרִים ח' ע"ב אֵין גִּיהֶנֶם לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

as our Sages declared in Nedarim 8b: 'There is no Gehinnom in the World to Come.

אֵלָּא הַקֵּב"ה מוֹצִיא חֲמָה מִנִּרְתִּיקָה צְדִיקִים מִתְרַפְּאִים בָּהּ

Instead, the Holy One, blessed is He, will remove the sun from its sheath and the righteous will be healed thereby,

שֶׁנֶאֱמַר (מלאכי ג, כ) 'וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם יְרֵאֵי שְׁמִי שֶׁשֶׁמֶשׁ צִדְקָה וּמִרְפָּא' כו'

as the verse (Malachi 3:20) states, "But a sun of righteousness will shine for You who fear My Name, with healing in its rays..."

וְרָשָׁעִים נִדְּוִנִין בָּהּ שֶׁנֶאֱמַר (מלאכי ג, יט) 'כִּי הִנֵּה הַיּוֹם בָּא בֵּיעֹר בְּתַנּוּר וְהָיוּ כָּל זֵדִים וְכָל עֹשֵׂה רָשָׁעָה קֵשׁ וְלֹהֵט אֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבֹּא'

While the wicked will be judged thereby, as it states, (Malachi 3:19) "For behold the day is coming, burning like an oven, when all the wicked and all the evildoers will be like straw; and that coming day will burn them up..."

וְזֶהוּ בְּרָשָׁעֵי עֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים שֶׁיִּכְלוּ אַז

referring to the wicked idolaters who will be destroyed then.

אֲבָל בְּרָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר נִתְּצָרְפוּ וְנִתְּלַבְּנוּ בְּכָל עֹנָשֵׁי גֵיהֶנּוֹם

But as for the wicked Jews who have been refined and purified by all the punishments of Gehinnom,

וְכִבֵּר כָּלָה עֲנָשָׁם בְּבִטּוֹל הַגֵּיהֶנּוֹם וְנִתְּקֵנוּ הֵנָּה עֲלֵיהֶם אָמְרוּ שֶׁהֵם מִתְּרַפְּאִין בָּהּ

once their punishment is nullified with the abolishment of Gehinnom, it states that they will be healed thereby.

וּר"ל כִּי הֵם מִתְּרַפְּאִין אַז מִכָּל מַכּוֹת גֵּיהֶנּוֹם וְתַחֲלוּאֵיהָ

Meaning, they will be healed from all the afflictions of Gehinnom and its miseries.

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְּמַרְקוּ וְנִתְּלַבְּנוּ יִהְיוּ הֵם ג"כ בְּכָלֵל הַצַּדִּיקִים כַּנ"ל.

For after they have been cleansed and purified, they too will be counted among the righteous, as mentioned previously.

וכ"ז יהיו בזמן תחיית המתים שאז 'כל הרשעה בלה בעשן תכלה'

All of the above is at the time of the Resurrection of the Dead, when 'all evil will go up in smoke,'

ויתבטל אז הגיהנם ג"כ ויהיה הגמר דין והכליון לכל רשעי עובדי אלילים

and Gehinnom will be nullified as well and the final judgment and destruction will devolve upon the wicked idolaters

ע"י הוצאת חמה מנרתיקה וכנז' כי בעת תחיית המתים יתבטל הזהמא וכל עכירות דהגופות

when the sun will be taken out of its sheath, as mentioned. For at the time of the Resurrection of the Dead spiritual contamination will be eliminated as well as all the crassness of the body,

ויתחלף אז כל העולם בלו למדרגה יותר נעלה

and the entire world will be transformed to a loftier level.

כי יהיו כל הגופות והחמריים בר ונקי מכל עכירות וזהמא

For all bodies and coarse materiality will become pure and clean of all crassness and contamination,

וזך ומצחצח כמו שבארנו בארבה בספר הדע"ה ח"ב

remaining unpolluted and pure, as we explained in our *Sefer Drush Olam HaTohu* part 2.

ועכ"פ הרי נתבאר לנו כי מה שאמרו על אשו של גיהנם שאין לו כביה לעולם

In any event, it has been explained for us that when they said that the fires of Gehinnom are never extinguished,

וכן מה שאמרו על היורד במדרגה הז' שאינו יוצא משם לעולם

and when they said that 'one who descends to the seventh level will never emerge from there',

הכונה הוא רק כל הזמן שהעולם עומד על מדרגתה של עתה

the intention is only as long as the world continues at its current spiritual level.

אבל לעתיד לבוא יתבטל כל רע וכל עונש ויתקן הכל

But in the Time to Come, evil and its punishment will be destroyed and everything will become rectified,

ולא יאבד שום נפש אחת מישראל ויזכו כלם לתחיה"מ ולחיי העוה"ב

so that not a single Jewish soul will be lost, and all of them will merit the Resurrection of the Dead and the World to Come,

וכמו שיתבאר עוד למטה עמק הענין בזה.

the conceptual depths of which will be explained below.

אמנם דע כי גם בישראל עצמן הנה לא כל מי שאנו רואין בעינינו שהוא מזרע ישראל

But know this: not everyone who appears to be of Jewish descent

הוא ראיה שהוא מבני אברהם יצחק ויעקב ושבטי י"ד ומע' נפש דבית יעקב

is indeed a descendant of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob and the 12 Tribes of God and the seventy souls who were born to the House of Jacob,

ומספר רבוא שיצאו מהם שהם צבאות ה' המיוחדים לשמו

or of the tens of thousands who emerged from them – the hosts of God who are devoted to His name.

אֲשֶׁר רַק עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר כִּי חֶלֶק ה' עִמּוֹ יַעֲקֹב חֶבֶל נַחֲלָתוֹ

For it is only regarding them that it states (Deuteronomy 32:9), "for part of God is His people; Jacob is the rope of His legacy."

וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם נִקְרָא ה' אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר בָּנִים אֲתֵם לַה' אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

Only in regard to them is He called 'God, the Lord of Israel' and only in reference to them does it state (Deuteronomy 14:1), "You are children to the Lord your God."

וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם בְּטוּחִים בְּכֶלם עַל הַשְּׂאֲרָה הַנִּצְחִית שֶׁהוּא לַתּוֹחָה"מ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָה"ב וּכְכֹל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ

And only regarding them did we declare that all of them are certain of eternal life, which is the Resurrection of the Dead and the life of the World to Come, and everything else that we said.

וְאִלּוּלָא הַחֲטָא דְּעַץ הַדַּעַת לֹא הָיָה הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים בְּעוֹלָם כָּלֵל

Now were it not for the sin of the Tree of Knowledge idolaters would not have existed in this world at all,

וְלֹא הָיָה יוֹצֵא מֵאֲדָמָה"ר רַק יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַד

and only the Jewish People would have emerged from Adam.

אֲךָ ע"י הַחֲטָא דְּעַץ הַדַּעַת הִנֵּה לְבַד מָה שֶׁיּוֹצֵאוּ הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים בְּהָעוֹלָם

But due the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, not only did the existence of idolaters emerge in the world,

אֲלָא נִתְעַרְבַּ הַרְבֵּה מֵהֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל ג"כ

many of them even got mixed in among Jews as well,

וְאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי תִקּוּן נ' כִּי נִתְעָרְבּ בִּישְׂרָאֵל ה' מִיָּנִים

as the **Tikunim** the *Tikunei Zohar*, **Tikun 50** states – five types of people, i.e. five nations, **became mixed in with the Jews**,

אֲשֶׁר סִימָנָם הוּא נג"ע ר"ע

the initial letters of which spell the words *nega ra* ('a terrible plague').

וְהֵם נְפִילִים גִּבּוֹרִים עֲנָקִים רְפָאִים עַמְלָקִים

These are Nefilim, Giborim, Anakim, Refa'im, Amalakites.

וְכָל אֱלוֹהֵי מִיָּנִים בְּכָל־ל נִקְרְאוּ בְּשֵׁם עָרֵב רַב וְהוּא סוּד הַכְּתוּב
וְגַם עָרֵב רַב עָלָה אִתָּם

And all these five in general are called the *erev rav* the 'mixed multitude' which is the secret meaning of the verse (Exodus 12:38), "and the *erev rav* went up out of Egypt with them."

וְעֵין בְּזוּה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ה א' כ"ז ב' כ"ח ב' כ"ט רע"א מְשַׁפְּטִים)
ק"כ ע"ב פְּנִיחָס רל"ז א' ב' תצ"א רע"ז רע"ב בְּהַעֲלוֹתָךְ קנ"ג רע"ב
תִּשָּׂא קצ"א

(See *Zohar Bereishit* 25a, 27b, 28b, 29a; *Zohar Mishpatim* 120b; *Zohar Pinchas* 237a-b; *Zohar Tetzei* 277b; *Zohar B'Ha'alotecha* 152b; *Zohar Tissa* 191

וְכָל הָעֲנִין שֵׁם וּבְדַבְרֵי הָרַב בְּשֵׁעַר הַפְּסוּקִים פ' שְׁמוֹת בְּאֵרוּכָה
(הַרְבֵּה).

and the entire matter there in the words of the Master the Arizal in *Sha'ar haPesukim Shemot* at great length).

וְהֵם נִתְעָרְבוּ בִּישְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשָּׁנֻם בֵּינֵינוּ הַרְבֵּה מֵהֵם

They got mixed in with the Jewish People and there are many of them among us,

וכמ"ש בגמרא ביצה ל"ב ב' הני מערב רב קא אתו

as the Talmud states in Beitza 32b regarding certain wealthy people in Babylon who were overtly Jewish, yet failed to help another Jew in distress: "**These came from the *erev rav*.**"

והגם שאמרו בקידושין דף עא א שמשפחה שנטמעה נטמעה והם
כשרים לעתיד לבא

And even though it states in tractate Kidushin 71a that a family who became assimilated among the Jewish People are integrated and will be accepted in the future,

עכ"ז הנה כל אלו שהם מנשמתין דלהון שהן גלגול דלהון יש בהם
חלוק גדול

nevertheless, there is a big difference between all those who are descended from them (from the *erev rav*) who are the incarnation of those people the original mixed multitude that came out of Egypt with the Israelites,

לבין ישראל גמורים והוא כמ"ש שם דף ע' ע"א מעלה יתרה יש בין
ישראל לגרים

and those who are born Jewish i.e. the descendants of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob etc. **as it states there Kidushin 71a – there is an advantage in being born Jewish over becoming Jewish by conversion.**

דאילו בישראל כתיב בהו והייתי להם לאלהים [ואם"כ] והמה
יהיו לי לעם

Because regarding born Jews it states (Jeremiah 31:32) "I will be their God" [and afterwards] "and they will be My people" –

שהוא ית"ש מקרב אותם בתחלה

indicating that **He brings them close from the outset**,¹⁰ "I will be their God" – from the outset.

וְאֵילּוּ בְּגֵרִים כְּתִיב 'מִי הוּא זֶה עָרַב אֶת לְבֹו לְגִשֶּׁת אֵלַי נָא ה'
וְהָיִיתִם לִי לְעָם'

Whereas regarding converts to Judaism it is written (Jeremiah 30:22), "'for who would then embolden his heart to approach Me' says the Lord, 'to be a people to Me?'"

'וְאֲנֹכִי אֶהְיֶה לָכֶם לֵאלֹהִים' [וְאִם כ"]

[**Only afterwards does the verse continue**]: "**And I will be God to you.**" Thus first they have to approach God with good deeds etc., and then I will be God to you."

כִּי אֵין מְקַרְבִּין אוֹתָן מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן הוּא מְקַרְבִּין עַצְמָן
תַּחֲלָה לַהֲיוֹת טוֹבִים (כֵּן פִּי רַשִׁ"י שָׁם)

For Heaven does not bring them close unless they bring themselves close first, by undertaking to be good (as Rashi explains).

וְכֵן הוּא כִּי בְּכָל אֱלוֹ שֶׁנִּשְׁמָתֵינוּ שָׁלָהֵם הֵם מֵעֶרֶב רַב הֵגֵם שְׁנוּלָדוֹ
מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל

The same is true of all those whose souls derive from the *erev rav*, even though they are born into a Jewish family –

הִנֵּה הֵם לֹא יִזְכּוּ לְכָל יְעוּדֵי הָעִתִּידִים אֲשֶׁר לִימֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי
הָעוֹה"ב

they will not merit all the promises that will be in the future in the Messianic era and in the World to Come,

אֶלָּא רַק אִם יִהְיוּ רְאוּיִים לְכָךְ מִצַּד הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁבָּהֶם

unless they are deserving thereof in terms of their good deeds.

אָבֵל בְּלֹא זֶה הֵנָּה יָכֻלוּ גַם הֵם בְּכַלִּיהָ גְמוּרָהּ וּכְכֹל רָשָׁעֵי אוֹהֵה
נֶאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם גַּם כֵּן

But without that they will also disappear completely. And just like all the other wicked people of the nations, it states in regard to them,

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׁנָאֵיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ כַּמִּשְׁלֵם בְּזוּהָ "ק בְּרֹאשִׁית כֹּה'
רַע"ב וּפ' תִּצְאָ רַעֲז ב

"He will repay those who despise Him in their lifetime and destroy them (Deuteronomy 7:10) as the *Zohar Bereishit 25b* and *Teitzei 287b* state.

וְאָמְרוּ בְּפִרְשֵׁת בְּרֹאשִׁית שֵׁם כ"ה א' עַל הָעֶרֶב רַב דְּנִשְׁמָתֵיהוּ הוּא
מִסְטָרָא דְאֵילָן

They the Sages of the Zohar state there (*Bereishit 25a*) regarding the *erev rav* that their souls are from the aspect of those

דְּאִתְמַר בִּהְיוֹן כִּי שְׁמַיִם כְּעָשָׁן נִמְלָחוּ כו' וְאֵילָן אֵינוֹן דְּלֹא בְעָא נַח
וְרַחֲמֵי עֲלֵיהוּ

about whom it says "the heavens will scatter like smoke" etc. and those are the ones for whom Noah did not beg for Divine compassion.

וְאִתְמַר בִּהְיוֹן 'וַיִּמָּחוּ מִן הָאָרֶץ'

Regarding them it states (Genesis 7:23) "They were blotted out from the earth"

בְּגִין דְּהוּא מְאִילָן דְּאִתְמַר בִּהְיוֹן תִּמְחָה אֶת זָכֶר עַמְלֶק

because they were of those regarding whom it states (Deuteronomy 25:19), "wipe out the memory of Amalek."

וּמִשְׁהָ לֹא אִסְתַּמַּר מִנֵּיהוּ כו' כו' בְּיוֹמָא דִּיתְמַחוּן אֵילָן כו'

And yet Moses was not careful about accepting them to his own detriment. But on that day they the erev rav, who enticed the Israelites to worship the golden calf, will be erased...

וַיִּתְחַדֵּשׁ עָלְמָא הַה"ד כִּי בְּאֶשֶׁר הַשָּׁמַיִם הַחֲדָשִׁים וְהָאָרֶץ הַחֲדָשָׁה
כו'

and it will be as if the world is renewed, as it is written (Isaiah 66:22), "Just as the new heavens and the new earth that I will make will endure before Me... so too will your offspring and your name endure."

וְע' בְּהִגָּר"א בְּתִקּוּנֵי תִקּוּן ג' בְּאַרְכָּה

(See the GRA's commentary to Tikunim, Tikun 3 at length).

וְעכ"פּ הוּא כִּי הֵם מְעֻרָּבִים בִּישְׂרָאֵל הָרַבָּה מְאֹד

In any event, the fact is that very many of them are mixed in with the Jewish People,

וְהַרְשָׁעִים שֶׁבָּהֶם יִתְבַטְּלוּ בְּבִטּוֹל גָּמוּר עִם בִּטּוֹל הָרַע וְהַזְהָמָא כְּלָה

and the wicked among them will be nullified completely, together with the nullification of all evil and spiritual contamination.

אֲבָל כָּל מִי שֶׁהוּא מְכַלֵּל יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמֶּשׁ יִתְקַנּוּ כָּלָם וַיִּזְכוּ כָּלָם
לְתַחַה"מ

But any person who is properly counted as a Jew will be rectified and will merit the Resurrection of the Dead

וְלַחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא בְּלִי חֲסוּר אֶחָד מֵהֶם וְע"פ מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ.

and life in the World to Come, with no one left out, as per our discussion above.

Footnotes

1. This is the attribute of the *ohr pnimi*, which is the aspect of limitation, as explained at the end of the previous chapter (Makover). ↩
2. This is the attribute of the *ohr makif*, which is unlimited, as explained at the end of the previous chapter (Makover). ↩
3. Paraphrasing Isaiah 8:11 – הָיָד אֵלַי כְּחֹזֶקֶת הָיָד – ...
↩
4. מיכה ז, יח: מִי אֶל-כְּמוֹךְ נִשְׂא עֵוֹן וְעָבַר עַל פֶּשַׁע לְשֹׂאֲרֵית
נִחַלְתּוּ לֹא הִחֲזִיק לְעַד אֲפֹ כִי חִפֵּץ חֶסֶד הוּא ↩
5. See *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:4. ↩
6. Makover. ↩
7. Tosafot explains that 'Yours, O Lord, is kindness' mitigates the strict letter of the law when the Holy One blessed is He sees that the world cannot persevere on the basis of repaying each person only according to their deeds. ↩
8. **Perhaps the intention here is the verse in Daniel 12:10:**
... יִתְבָּרְרוּ וְיִתְלַבְּנוּ וְיִצְרְפוּ רַבִּים ↩
9. He states there that this could be through the process of *gilgul* (reincarnation). ↩
10. God chose the Israelites for who they are [the descendants of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob], not because of their deeds (Makover). ↩

Chapter 6 — Clarification of the matter of the revelation of the qualities of "ve rav hesed" vs. that of "ve emet"

More on the Attributes of Strict Justice as well as purification via mitsvot as well as suffering.

וּמַעֲתָה נִיחָא מָה שֶׁהֶעֱרִינוּ לְעִיל בְּדַבְרֵי רז"ל שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַחֲלָה
וְאִמֶּת וּלְבִסּוּף וְרַב חֶסֶד

And now there is no longer an issue concerning our earlier discussion regarding the words of our Sages (Rosh HaShana 17b – Ilfa's resolution of the contradiction) who explained initially 'and Truth,' but in the end 'Abundant Kindness,'

הַגַּם שֶׁבְּהִכְתוּב נֶאֱמַר לְהַפְךָ

even though the terms in the verse are stated in the opposite order – first 'Abundant Kindness' and afterwards 'and Truth.'

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁבְּאֲרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָם הֵם רַק לְצַרְךָ תִּקּוּן

Because as we explained, all punishments that devolve upon a person are only for the sake of rectification (lifting them up) –

שִׁיתְקִנוּ עִי"ז כָּל רִשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם לְהַשְׁאֵרֶת נֶצְחִי לְתַחֲיַת הַמֵּתִים
וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

so that all Jews who act wickedly will be rectified and will merit the eternal life of the Resurrection of the Dead and life in the World to Come.

א"כ הָרִי נִמְשָׁךְ מִדֶּת וְאִמֶּת מָה שֶׁהוּא ית"ש מִשְׁלֵם לְכָל אִישׁ
כְּמַעֲשֵׂהוּ

This being the case, the attribute of 'and Truth' – where God repays each person according to their deeds – is drawn down

רק ממדת ורב חסד כי ע"י שהוא רב חסד שהוא מדה ו' היוצא מתקונו ו' שבפסוק מי א-ל כמוך

exclusively from the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.' And indeed He is of 'Abundant Kindness' – the sixth attribute that emerges from the sixth Tikun in the verse, (Michah 7:18) "Who, O G-d, is like You ..."

והוא מה שנאמר שם כי חפץ חסד הוא שחפצו לעשות חסד עם הכל

And this is why it states there "for He desires [to do] kindness" with everyone,

שיזכו הרשעים ג"כ לכל טוב הצפון אשר באור פני מלך חיים

so that even the wicked will merit all the good that is hidden away in the light of the King's countenance – in which there is life.

לכן הוא משלם לאיש כמעשהו שהוא מדת ואמת

And therefore He repays each person according to his deeds, which is the attribute of 'and Truth'

לצרפו וללבנו כדי שיזכה עי"ז לכל טוב העתיד וכמו שיתבאר עמק הדברים בזה למטה.

in order to purge and refine a person so that he will thereby be worthy of all the goodness of the future, as will be explained in depth below.

ומה שכתוב (שמות לד, ו) 'ורב חסד ואמת' הוא מרישיה לספיה מדריש ומסיפה לרישיה מדריש¹

Now the verse (Exodus 34:6) 'abounding in Kindness and Truth' can be understood in two ways – from beginning to end, or from end to beginning, as will be explained below:

מרישיה לסיפה מדריש כי ע"י שהוא ורב חסד לכן הוא ואמת

From beginning to end it is interpreted as – since He is 'abounding in Kindness,' therefore there is 'Truth.'

שֶׁמֶשֶׁלֶם לְכָל אִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׂהוּ וְכִדִּי לְתַקְנוֹ כְּנִזְכָּר

For He repays each person according to their deeds in order to rectify them, as mentioned,

כִּי אֵלּוּלֵא מִדַּת וְרַב חֶסֶד הָיָה רָאוּי שְׁקוּיִם בְּכָל רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

since without the attribute of 'abounding in Kindness,' it would be proper for there to be fulfilled upon every wicked transgressor

מִקְרָא שְׁכָתוֹב (אִיּוֹב כ. ז) 'כְּגִלְלוּ לְנֶצַח יֹאבֵד' וְלֹא הָיָה שׁוּם גִּיהֶנֶם
וְעֵנֶשׁ לְאַחַר מִיתָה כָּלֹל

the verse (Job 20:7) that states, "he will perish forever like his own dung" and there would be no Gehinnom and punishment after death at all,

כִּי מֵאֵי דְהֵנָּה הֵנָּה וּמֵה תּוֹעֵלֶת יוֹצֵא מִזֶּה

since what was, was. And what benefit would emerge from this?

וְכִי הוּא יֵת"ש לְנִקְמָה הוּא צָרִיךְ ח"ו וּמֵה תּוֹעֵלֶת הוּא מְכַל
הָעֵנֶשִׁים שְׁלֹאֲחֵר מִיתָה?

Is He then in need of vengeance, Heaven forbid? What benefit would there be from all the punishments that are meted out after death?

וּמ"ש א-ל נְקָמוֹת ה' הָרִי מִפְּרֶשׁ הַכְּתוּב בְּעֶצְמוֹ א-ל נְקָמוֹת הוֹפִיעַ

[And when it states (Psalms 94:1) "God of vengeance, O Lord..." the same verse itself explains: "God of vengeance, appear!"

שהוא כדי להופיע מזה אורה וטובה גדולה וכמו שיתבאר קצת
סוד הדברים למטה

**so that light and great goodness can be manifested from it, the
mystical aspect of which will be explained below.**

כי הענשים עצמן הם מתהפכים אח"כ לאור גדול]

**For the punishments themselves will be transformed into great
light afterwards.]**

ואי משום כדי שיהא ירא האדם מלחטוא שהוא יראת הענש

**Now if those punishments after death are so that a person will be
afraid to sin – i.e. due to the fear of punishment –**

הרי האבדון הנצחי והכליה הגמורה הוא גופה הענש שאין
למעלה מזה

**being obliterated forever and complete destruction are
themselves the ultimate punishment,**

כמ"ש הרמב"ם ז"ל בפ"ח מהלכות תשובה הלכה ה'

as Rambam writes in chapter *Hilchot Teshuva* 8:5.

וא"כ מה תועלת הוא מכל הענשים שלאחר מיתה

**But if so, what benefit is there from all the punishments after
death?**

אך ע"י שהוא ית"ש חפץ חסד הוא ורוצה בתקנתו של רשעים

**Rather, since He, blessed is He, 'desires [to do] kindness,' and
wants the rectification of sinners,**

לכן יסד את הגיהנום וכן כל הענשים דלאחר מיתה

**He therefore established Gehinnom and all the punishments
that devolve upon a person after death,**

כדי לתקנם ע"י הצורף והלבון ולהביאם גם הם לכל יעודים
העתידים

in order to rectify them by way of spiritual purging and purification so that they too can be brought to all the promises of the future.

וזהו רב חסד ואמת אשר מרישיה לספיה מדריש

This then is the meaning of 'abounding in Kindness and Truth' as interpreted from beginning to end.

ומספיה לרישיה מדריש כי ע"י שמתנהג עם האדם במדת ואמת

But from end to beginning it is interpreted thus: since He acts towards man with the attribute of Truth,

ומשלם לכל איש כמעשהו ע"ז זוכה למדת ורב חסד

repaying each person according to his deeds, in this way a person merits the attribute of Abundant Kindness.

שהוא לקבל חסדו וטובו ית"ש בכל יעודים העתידים

In other words, they receives His blessed kindness and goodness in all the promises that will come to fruition in the future

אשר לימות המשיח מתחה"מ והלאה ולחי העוה"ב

in the Messianic era, from the Resurrection of the Dead on, and in life in the World to Come.

והוא מה שאמרו בתחלה ואמת ולבסוף ורב חסד

And this is what they the Sages said – first 'Truth' and in the end 'Abundant Kindness.'

וכן הרי ניקח בזה ג"כ מה שהערנו לעיל רפ"ה

This also resolves the question we posed above, in the beginning of chapter 5 –

איך יוצא מדת ואמת שהוא מדה ז' מתקון ישוב ירחמנו שהוא
תקון ז' שבפסוק מי אל כמוך

**how does the attribute of 'and Truth,' which is the seventh
Tikun in the verse in Exodus, uttered by Moshe Rabbeinu
(Moses), emerge from the verse in Micha "He will again show us
mercy," which is the seventh Tikun in the verse "Who, O G-d,
is like You?"**

There seems, at first glance, to be a mismatch between the verses.

אך עתה הרי הוא נִיחָא פשוט כי הרי לא אפשר שיתקיים הבטחת
ישוב ירחמנו

**But now the answer is straightforward and simple, because it is
not possible to fulfill "He will again show us mercy"**

שהוא לימות המשיח ולחיי העוה"ב אלא רק ע"י מדת ואמת

**– which refers to the Messianic era and to life in the World to
Come – were it not for the attribute of 'and Truth.'**

והוא ע"ד שאמר הכתוב כי אין לבוא אל שער המלך בלבוש שק

**This is similar to the statement in the verse (Esther 4:2) "it was
forbidden to enter the king's gate in a garment of sackcloth"**

כי אי אפשר לכל רשע ופושע בעודו בטמאתו וצחנתו ח"ו

**for it is forbidden for any wicked person or sinner, while still in
his state of spiritual impurity or with his stench of sin, Heaven
forfend,**

לכנס בהיכלי קדש הקדשים פנימה להנות מזיו השכינה

**to enter into the Holy of Holies and bask in the radiance of the
Shechinah,**

ולהיות במחיצתו של הקב"ה להאיר 'באור פני מלך חיים' (ראה
משלי טז, טו)

and be within the domain of the Holy One blessed is He, to be illuminated by the light of the King's countenance in which there is life (see Proverbs 16:15),

ולקבל את כל טוב הצפון אשר לימות המשיח ולחיי העוה"ב

and receive all the goodness hidden away for the Messianic era and the life of the World to Come.

אֵלָא רַק עַד שִׁיטְהָר מִכָּל טְמֵאָתוֹ וְזִהְמָתוֹ וְיִתְצָרְר וְיִתְלַבֵּן

This is only possible after he has been cleansed of all his spiritual taint and pollution, and he has been purged and purified

בְּכָל הַז' מַדּוּרֵי גֵיהֶנֶם לְפִי פֶשַׁעוֹ וּמִרְדּוֹ עַד שִׁיתְקַן לְגַמְרֵי

in all seven levels of Gehinnom, commensurate with his sin and insurrection, until he has been completely rectified.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי ע"י שְׁמֵשֶׁלֶם לְכָל אִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׂהוּ בְּלִי וְיִתּוֹר כָּלֵל –
שֶׁהוּא מִדָּת וְאֶמֶת –

So we find that by repaying a person according to his deeds, without being lenient at all – which is the attribute of "and Truth" –

הִנֵּה עִי"ז יִצִּיץ וְיִזְרִיחַ אֹר הַתִּקּוּן ז'

precisely through this, the light of the seventh Tikun emerges and shines forth.

שֶׁהוּא יָשׁוּב יִרְחַמְנוּ לְהִיטִיב לָנוּ בְּכָל יְעוּדִים הָעִתִּידִים

This is the attribute of, "He will again show us mercy," to grant us the benefit of all the promises the will come to fruition in the future.****

וְהָרִי אִי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁיתְקִים הַבְּטָחָה יָשׁוּב יִרְחַמְנוּ אֵלָא ע"י מִדַּת וְאֶמֶת
דְּוָקָא

Thus it is impossible for this promise of "He will again show us mercy" to be fulfilled other than via the attribute of "and Truth."

אבל במדת ואמת הנה יתקיים הבטחת ישוב ירחמנו עכ"פ

But with the attribute of "and Truth" the promise of "He will again show us mercy" will indeed be fulfilled,

ויזכו לזה כל ישראל כלם ממש וכנזכר.

and *all* of Israel, literally, will be worthy thereof, as mentioned.

ועמק הדברים בכ"ז הוא ע"פ מה שאמרו בזוה"ק (פ' שלח לך
קע"ג ע"ב)

Now the depth of these matters is according to what the Holy Zohar states (in *Shlach Lecha* 173b)

בפסוק מה רב טובך אשר צפנת מיהו אשר צפנת

on the verse (Psalms 31:20) "**How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away** for those who fear You."

וכי מאן יגזל ויטל מן ידוי מה דהוא בעי למיהב

For who would steal and grab from His hand that which He intends to give in the future – i.e. the hidden light² –

דכתיב צפנת (ר"ל למה הוא צריך לגנוז ולהטמין)

as it is written, "that You have stored away"? (Meaning to say – why did He have to store away and conceal it?)

אלא פוק וחמי עובדין דירחמנו דעבר קב"ה במה דאיהו מחי, ביה
יהיב אסותא

But the answer is – go out and see the acts of compassion for us that the Holy One blessed is He performs. In that the very thing which brings affliction, that very thing brings healing:

במה מחי בשמאל לא כו' כתיב 'מצפון תפתח הרעה' ובצפון מחי

With what does He afflict? With the left hand so to speak, a symbol of harshness, **as it is written** (Jeremiah 1:14), "**from the north the evil will commence**" – referring to the Babylonian conquest which destroyed the First Temple.

דמתמן נפקי כל דיניו וכל גזיריו קשין וביה שרי כל אגר טב

From there all the *dinim* severities and harsh decrees emerged, and there too the treasure-trove of reward also resides.

וְכָל טִיבוֹ דְּזַמֵּן קב"ה לְמִיָּהֵב לְיִשְׂרָאֵל לְזַמְנָא דְּאַתִּי

As for all the good that the Holy One blessed is He will grant to Israel in the future,

קרי קב"ה לצפון וימא ליה בך יהבית כל טיבו וכל אגר טוב לבני
כו'

the Holy One blessed is He called to the North and said to it, "I am placing all the good and all the reward for My children in you."

הב אגרין טבין דיהבית בך הה"ד אמר לצפון תני כו' כו' והינו אשר
צפנת כו' ע"ש

When the time comes, "**I will say to the North, 'Give...'**" (Isaiah 43:6). **This is the meaning of "that You have stored away!"**

וכן פתב הגר"א בתקונים תקון כ"א דף מז ע"א פי שני דינים הן

The GR"A writes similarly in his commentary on the Tikunim (the Tikunei Zohar), Tikun 21 p. 47a: There are two types of reprisal:

א' רצועה בישא דינא דמסבותא על ראש רשעים יחול

1. **The harsh strap of judgment from the aspect of the unholy "which will descend upon the head of the**

wicked" (Jeremiah 23:19);

ואֶחָד דִּינָא דְקָדְשָׁא יֵרָאֵת ה' וְהוּא שְׁלֵהוּבָא דְרַחֲמִימוּתָא

2. Judgment from the aspect of the holy – the awe of God – which is a flame of compassion,

וְכָל הַתְּעוּרֹרוֹת וְהַשְׁמָחָה וְשִׂכָר הָעוֹה"ב וְכָל טוֹבָה הַכֹּל שָׁם

and all arousal and joy and reward in the World to Come, and all goodness – all of it comes from there from the holy aspect of judgment,

וכמ"ש (תהלים לא, כ) מָה רַב טוֹבְךָ אֲשֶׁר צָפַנְתָּ

as it states in Psalms (31:20) "How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away..."

בְּצִפּוֹן (שֶׁהוּא גְבוּרָה) (תהלים כג ה) תַּעֲרֹךְ שִׁלְחֹן לִפְנֵי (וְשִׁלְחֹן הוּא בְּצִפּוֹן)

It is stored away in the North (which is the *sefirah* of *gevurah* – severity) as in (Psalms 23:5) "You prepare a table for me..." (the table in the Temple was on the North side the side of *gevurah*).

וְהוּא יין הַמְּשֻׁמֵּר בְּעֵנָבָיו יין הַמְּשֻׁמֵּחַ עֵין לֹא רָאִתָּה כו' ע"ש

The Tikunei Zohar continues: **This is also the wine that is guarded in its grapes** since the Six Days of Creation – referring to the mystical secrets of the Torah.³ It is also **the wine that brings joy,**⁴ "that no eye has seen but Yours, O Lord" (Isaiah 64:3) – again referring to the deepest mystical secrets of the Torah.

וְכֵן הוּא ג' כ בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דֵּר' עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ס' שְׁגָם מִתֵּן שִׁכָּרָן שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים שֶׁבָּגָן עֵדֶן הוּא ג' כ בְּצִפּוֹן כִּי הֵגֵן עֵדֶן הוּא בְּצִפּוֹן ע"ש

It also states in the work *Otiyot d'Rabbi Akiva***, chapter 60 that the reward for righteous in the Garden of Eden is also in the North,

since the Garden of Eden is in the North.** It is concealed within the aspect of *gevurah*.

וְהוּא סוּד מַעֲלַת וִיקָרֵת הַזָּהָב עַל הַכֶּסֶף הַגָּם שֶׁהַכֶּסֶף הוּא מִבְּחִי
הַחֲסָדִים

This is the secret of the superior value of gold over silver, albeit that silver is from the aspect of kindness,

וְהַזָּהָב הוּא מִבְּחִי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהֵם דִּינִין

whereas gold is of the aspect of *gevurot* which are severities.

אֲךְ כִּשְׁהַגְּבוּרוֹת הֵם נִמְתָּקִין וּמִתְבַּסְּמִין הֵם יוֹתֵר מַעֲלוֹת
מִהַחֲסָדִים

But when the *gevurot* become sweetened and fragrant
(Kabbalistic terms used to indicate the transformation of negative into positive, evil into good) **then they are superior to aspects of *chesed* kindness.**

כִּי בָּהֶם הוּא כָּל הַתְּעוּרוֹרוֹת וְהַשְׂמָחָה וְכוּ כָּל הַשְּׁלֵהוּבִין דְּרַחֲמֵינוּ
הֵוא מֵהֶם

For through them the *gevurot* is there arousal and joy, and all of the flames of love also come from them,

וְכָל טוֹב הַחֲסָדִים וְאוֹרָם וְגִלּוּיִים וּפְעֻלָּתָם הוּא רַק ע"י גְּבוּרוֹת
הַנִּמְתָּקִים

and all the goodness of the aspects of kindness and their light and revelation and their effects are only by way of sweetened *gevurot*.

וְהִנֵּה שְׂרֵשׁוֹ שֶׁל הַגְּבוּרוֹת כָּלָם לְמַעַלָּה הֵם כָּלָם קֹדֶשׁ קִדְּשִׁים

Now the root of all the *gevurot* above is from the Holy of Holies

וּמִמֶּתְקִים וּמִבְּסָמִים בְּתַכְלִית הַמֶּתוּק

and they become totally sweetened and fragrant,

וְהוּא סוּד מֵאֲמָרִים ז"ל בְּחִגְיָהּ ה' ע"ב וּמִי אֵיכָא בְּכִיָּה קָמִיה
הַקֵּב"ה

which is the mystical explanation of the statement of our Sages in Tractate Chagiga 5b – 'is there then weeping before the Holy One blessed is He?'

This was in response to a statement quoting the verse (Jeremiah 13:17) "... my soul will cry in hidden chambers."

וְהָאֲמַר רַב פָּפָא אֵין עֲצָבוֹת לִפְנֵי הַקֵּב"ה שְׁנֵאֲמַר הוּד וְהָדָר לִפְנֵי
עַז וְחִדְוָה בְּמַקְמוֹ

The Talmud continues: **But didn't Rav Pappa say, "There is no melancholy in the presence of the Holy One blessed is He, as the verse (I Chronicles 16:27) states, "Glory and majesty are before Him, courage and joy are in His place" – to the exclusion of sadness and weeping?**

הָא בְּבִתֵּי גֹאֵי הָא בְּבִתֵּי בְּרָאִי וּר"ל כִּי בְּבִתֵּי גֹאֵי לֵיכָא בְּכִיָּה

The Talmud resolves the contradiction: **That weeping is in the outer chambers, and this courage and joy are in the inner chambers. Meaning to say, in the inner chambers there is no weeping,**

Note that here Rabbi Elyashiv follows the explanation of Rabbeinu Chananel rather than Rashi who explained it the opposite way – joy in the outer chambers, weeping in the inner chambers. He expounds on this in a very long and learned note at the end of the chapter.

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת מִמֶּתְקִים

because the sweetened *gevurot* are there in the inner chambers.

וְכֵן שֵׁם י"ב סע"ב כְּתִיב יֵשֶׁת חֶשֶׁךְ סִתְרוּ כו' וּמִי אֵיכָא חֲשׂוּכָא קָמִי
שְׁמִיָּא וְהָא כְּתִיב וְנִהוּרָא עֲמִיה שְׁרִי⁵

Similarly, there in the same Tractate p. 12b the Talmud asks: It is written (Psalms 18:12) "He makes darkness His concealment..." – is there indeed darkness before the Heavens? Is it not written (Daniel 2:22) "...and light dwells with Him"?

הָא בְּבִתֵּי גֹאֵי הָא בְּבִתֵּי בְּרָאִי כִּי בְּבִתֵּי גֹאֵי שָׁם הוּא וְנִהוּרָא עִמִּיהָ
שְׂרִי

The Talmud resolves the contradiction in the same way as the previous one: **This light is in the inner chambers, and that [darkness] is in the outer chambers.**

כִּי בְּבִתֵּי גֹאֵי שָׁם הוּא וְנִהוּרָא עִמִּיהָ שְׂרִי כִּי שָׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת
מִמַּתְקִים וּמְאִירִים בְּשִׁלְהוֹבִין דְּרַחֲמֵי

This is because in the inner chambers the light dwells with Him, for there are the sweetened *gevurot*, and they illuminate with flames of love.

וְלָכֵן שָׁם הוּא כָּלֹ אֹר וְעַז וְחִדּוּהָ בְּמִקּוֹמוֹ וְהִנֵּה הַתַּפְּשֻׁטוֹת
הַגְּבוּרוֹת וְגִלּוּיִים לְמִטָּה

Accordingly, there it is all light and courage and joy in His place, due to the sweetened *gevurot* radiating down to and illuminating below

וְשִׁימְתָּקוּ וְשִׁיטְבִּסְמוּ לְמִטָּה ג"כ הִנֵּה הוּא ע"י הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

so that the worlds below will also become sweetened and fragrant – and this is through Torah and fulfilling the Commandments.

כִּי הַתּוֹרָה הִיא כְּלָה גְבוּרוֹת מִמַּתְקִים מִיְמִינוּ אֵשׁ דָּת

For the Torah is entirely sweetened *gevurot* as the verse (Deuteronomy 33:2) states, "From His right hand a fiery law..." denoting the stringencies of law, but coming from 'His right hand' – the aspect of *chesed* and kindness.

וְאָמְרוּ בִירוּשָׁלַיִם שְׁקָלִים פ"ו סוֹף הַלָּכָה א'

And it states in Talmud Yerushalmi, Shekalim 6:1 that

הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁנָּתַן הַקֵּב"ה לְמֹשֶׁה אֵשׁ לְבָנָה חֲרוּתָהּ בְּאֵשׁ שְׁחִירָה

'The Torah that God gave to Moses was engraved as white fire on black fire – an image depicting chesed as the foreground attribute, and *gevurah* as the background basis,

הִיא אֵשׁ מִבְּלֵלֶת מֵאֵשׁ חֲצוּבָה בְּאֵשׁ וְנִתְּנָה מֵאֵשׁ

which is fire mixed with fire, cast in fire and given in fire.'

וְע"י קִיּוּם הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמְצָנָה נִמְתָּקִים כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת

And through Torah and fulfilling the Commandments all of the *gevurot* are sweetened

וּמִתְגַּלִּים וּמֵאִירִים לְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר כָּאֵן הוּא כָּל הַסִּיגִים וְהַפְּסָלֹת

and become revealed and illuminate below, i.e. this world, where all the dross and impurities

שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ וְנַעֲשׂוּ מִתְקָר הַדִּינִים הַקָּשִׁים

that emerged from and were formed by the power of harsh *dinim* severities,

ע"י הַחֲסָרוֹן דֶּה־מִּתּוֹק שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בַעוּה"ז בְּסִבַּת הַחֲטָא דְּעַץ הַדַּעַת

due to the lack of sweetening that came about in this world as a result of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge,

וּבְסִבַּת כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת כָּלָם דְּשָׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תַּהוֹ.

and because of all the generations of the first two thousand years of chaos, prior to our receiving the Torah. That period extended from Adam until Abraham was 52 years old.⁶

הנה ע"י קיום התורה והמצוה שהיא כלה גבורות נמתקים

Thus through fulfilling Torah and the Commandments, which are all sweetened *gevurot*,

מתבסמין הדינין למטה ג"כ ומתבטל עי"ז השרש דהסיגים שהם
רק מתקף הדינין.

the harsh *dinim* below are made fragrant as well, and by way thereof the root of the dross, which is a result of the harsh *dinim*, is nullified.

ועי"ז נכרתים כל הסיגים משרשם בקדש וממילא שמתבטלים
וכלים

And through this all the dross is cut off from its root in holiness, and automatically it becomes nullified and expires.

והנה אלו שזכינו שיתקיים התורה בנו כמו שנתן לנו בראשונה

Now if only we deserved to have the Torah continue with us as it was given originally,

בקולות וברקים ומלהבות אש אז כבר היה נתקן

with thunder and lightning and flames of fire, then everything would already have been rectified,

ונעשה המתקת כל הגבורות למטה בכל הראוי והיה מתבטל כל
הזהמא כלה

and all of the *gevurot* would have been sweetened down below to the proper extent, and then all of the spiritual pollution would have been nullified,

והיה חוזר העולם לתקונו כמו קדם החטא

and the world would have returned to its rectified state, just as it was prior to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge,****

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֲנִי אֲמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם כו' ע' זוה"ק ס"פ יתרו ופ'
מִשְׁפָּטִים קי"ד רע"א

**as the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "I said, 'you are angelic'..."
See Zohar end of *parshat Yitro* and *Mishpatim* 114a.**

Rashi explains: 'You are angelic' – when I gave you the Torah, I gave it to you so that that the angel of death would hold no sway over you any longer.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה הוֹלֵךְ וּמִתְתַּקֵּן הָעוֹלָם מֵאָז

**Accordingly, the world would have continued to become
rectified from that time on,**

כְּמוֹ בְּהִתְקוּנֵי דְלַעֲתִיד אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר תַּחֲה"מ וְהִלָּאָה.

**just like the future Tikun after the Resurrection of the Dead
and on.**

אֲךָ מֵאַחֵר שְׁלֹא זָכִינוּ לְהַאֲוִר הַגָּדוֹל דְּמִתְּנָן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּתְחִלָּה וְנִשְׁתַּבְּרוּ
הַלּוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת

**But since we did not merit the great light of Matan Torah when
the Torah was given initially, and the first Tables were broken,
when Moses cast them down from his hands on seeing the golden
calf (see Exodus 32:19),**

הִנֵּה נִשְׁאָר הַיֵּצֵר הָרַע בְּתַקְפוֹ וּמִתְקַיֵּם זְהֵמַת הָעוֹלָם כְּמִקְדָּם

**the *yetzer hara* the evil inclination remained in all its strength
and the pollution of the world continued as before.**

וְאִין כַּח מַעֲתָה לְשׁוּם אָדָם לְקִים אֶת כָּל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה עַל
שְׁלִימוּתָהּ כְּהִרְאוֹי

**And now no person has the ability to fulfill the entire Torah
and all the mitzvot perfectly, as would be proper,**

וּכְמ"ש אִין צָדִיק בְּאַרְץ אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂה טוֹב וְלֹא יִחָטָא

as the verse (Ecclesiastes 7:20) states, "For there is no man on earth so righteous that he that he only does good and never sins."

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ וַיִּקְרָא רַבֵּה פ' י"ד סִימָן ה' בְּפֶסוּק 'הֵן בְּעוֹן
חֹלְלֵתִי

And so too in Midrash Vayikra Rabba 14:5 on the verse (Psalms 51:7) 'In iniquity I was formed' the Sages declare

אִפְלוּ חֲסִיד שְׁבַח־סִידִים אִי אָפֶשֶׁר שְׁלֵא יִהְיֶה לוֹ צֶר אֶחָד מֵעוֹן

– even with the most pious person it is impossible that there won't be some aspect of sin

וְהוּא מֵהַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבַע־סָה הַנִּשְׁרָשׁ בְּכָל אָדָם בְּסִבַּת הַנָּחַשׁ הַקְּדָמוֹנִי

which derives from 'the yeast in the dough' i.e. the *yetzer hara* that is rooted in every person as a result of the *nachash hakadmoni* literally, the primordial snake, i.e. the initial manifestation of evil.

וְכֵן הוּא סוֹד הַכְּוֹנֶה ג"כ בְּאוֹתָן שֶׁאָמְרוּ כִּי מֵתוּ בְּעֵטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחַשׁ

And this is also the mystical explanation of the Sages regarding those who died due to the poison of the snake,⁷ and for no other reason,

וּר"ל שְׁלֵא הָיָה בָּהֶם אֶלָּא רַק צֶד אֶחָד מֵעוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵהַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבַע־סָה

meaning to say, they had only a single aspect of sin from 'the yeast in the dough'

הַנִּשְׁרָשׁ בְּכָל אָדָם בְּסִבַּת נָחַשׁ הַקְּדָמוֹנִי וְכַמ"ש הַאֲרִיז"ל סוֹד עֲגִינ
הַדְּבָרִים בְּזֶה

that became rooted in every person as a result of the *nachash hakadmoni*, as the Arizal writes regarding the mystical aspects thereof

בספר זהר הרקיע דף ס"ט ודף ע' ואמר שם כי אלולא אותו השאור
שבועסה

**in the work *Zohar HaRakia* p. 69-70. He writes there that were
it not for 'the yeast in the dough'**

לא היה האדם בעל בחירה כלל ולא היה שָׂכָר ועונש ונתן בו כ"ז
לטובתו ע"ש בארכה

**no man would have free choice at all, and there would be no
reward and punishment. Thus all this was done for man's own
good. See there.**

והרי עכ"פ הוא כי אינו מתקנים עתה התורה על שלימותה בכל
הראוי כלל

**In any event, we see that the Torah nowadays cannot be
fulfilled perfectly, in a totally perfect way at all.**

ולכן הנה מכרח כל הרעות והתלאות העוברים על כל באי עולם

**And therefore all the negative events and hardships that engulf
the entire world**

והנה הם מתקף הדינים קשים הנמשכים ומתגלים תמיד

**are from the intensity of the harsh *dinim* that are constantly
drawn down and revealed**

ע"י כל עון וכל חטאת הנעשים מהתגברות הזהמא והטמאה
והרע

**due to every act of sin and transgression that are the result of
the welling up of pollution and impurity and evil.**

והנה יסד המאציל ית"ש שכל עון וכל חטאת אחר שנעשה

**Now the blessed Emanator established that any act of sin and
transgression,**

הנה מתהפך הוא עצמו לדין קשה ונעשה הוא גופא לסער

itself become transformed into harsh judgment and become a whirlwind

מתחולל על ראש רשעים יחול וכמ"ש ב"ב ס"ז א'

devolving on the head of the wicked, as Tractate Bava Batra 67a states

הוא יצר הרע הוא מלאך המות יורד ומתעלה ועולה ומרגיז נוטל רשות ונוטל נשמה

– this is the yetzer hara, which is also the angel of death, that descends and leads the world astray, and then ascends and arouses anger above, evokes permission to punish, and then takes a life.

וכן הוא כל הענשים כלם אשר הן בעוה"ז והן לאחר מיתה

And so too is it with all the punishment in this world and after death –

הנה הם כלם מהחטאים עצמן וכמ"ש משלי י"ג חטאים תרדף רעה

all of them derive from the sins themselves, as Proverbs 13:21 states: "Evil pursues sinners."

וכן אמרו ג"כ ברכות ל"ג א' אין ערוד ממית אלא החטא ממית

And similarly the Sages stated in Tractate Berachot 31a: It is not the *arod* a type of poisonous reptile or animal that kills, but the sin,

כי נעשה הדין והענש מאותה הזקמא והרע עצמו אשר גרמו את החטא

for the verdict and the punishment are made from the same pollution and the evil that caused the sin itself.

וְהֵם כָּלֵם אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ ר"ל שֶׁהַזֵּהָמָא וְהַחֲטָא וְהָעֲנֹשׁ הֵם כָּלֵם רַק
מְצִיאת אֶחָת

And they are all one thing, meaning to say the pollution, the sin, and the punishment are all the same,

אֲלָא שְׁמֵתְחִלָּפִים מְצוּרָה לְצוּרָה ע"י הָאָדָם הַמוֹצִיא אוֹתָהּ מֵהֶכֶח
אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

except that they change from one form to another when man causes them to emerge from potential to actual.

כִּי מִקְדָּם שְׁנַעֲשָׂה הַחֲטָא הִנֵּה הָרַע אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה רַק בְּכֹחַ וְאֵינוֹ עֲדִין
בְּמַצִּיאוֹת כָּלֵל

Before a sin is committed the evil therein was merely potential, but was not yet manifested,

וְכֵאֲשֶׁר הָאָדָם עוֹשֶׂה אֶת הַחֲטָא הִנֵּה הוּא הוֹצִיא וְהַמְצִיא אֶת אוֹתוֹ
הָרַע

but when a person commits a sin he brings out and manifests that evil

וְהוּא דְּבוֹק עִמּוֹ וּמִיָּחָד בּוֹ עַד שֶׁמוֹצִיא הָרַע אֶת כָּל כָּחוֹ בּוֹ שֶׁהוּא
הָעֲנֹשׁ

and it cleaves to him and unites with him until the evil is fully manifested in him, and that is his punishment.

וְאִז כָּלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל מִכָּל וְכָל

And then it the evil is entirely nullified.

ר"ל כִּי גַם כֹּחַ הַקְדוּם אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ יֵצֵא אוֹתוֹ הָרַע אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

Meaning to say, even the primordial power from which that evil is manifested,

הנה מאחר שיצא כחו בהענש הרי אין עוד מעֶתָּה כל אותו כח
להרע כָּלֵל וכָּבֵר כָּלָה ומתבטל

after it has emerged into actuality in the punishment, it no longer has all the same power of evil at all; it is already spent and nullified.

והרי נמצא כי בְּמָה שִׁיָּסַד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שֶׁהַחֲטָא עֲצָמוֹ הוּא נִהְפָּךְ
לְעֵנֶשׁ

So we find that the principle established by the blessed Emanator – that the sin itself becomes the punishment –

הנה הוא תִּקּוּן גָּדוֹל כִּי עִ"ז הוֹלֵךְ וּמִתְבַּטֵּל הָרַע תָּמִיד

is itself the great rectification, for the evil continuously dissipates.

וְכָשִׁיכָּלָה כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים יִכָּלָה מִמִּילָא כָּל הָרַע כְּלוּ כִּי אֵין הָרַע נִצְחִי
ח"ו

And when all of the punishments have dissipated, all the evil will automatically dissolve, for evil is not forever, Heaven forbid.

שֶׁהֲרִי אֲדוֹרְבָא הוּא שְׁהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַהֶפְסֵד וְהָאֲבִדוֹן הַהֶחֱלָטִי

On the contrary, since it is the root of all deficit and total destruction,

וְהָרַע וְהַחֲטָא וְהָעֵנֶשׁ כֻּלָּם יִתְבַּטְּלוּ מִכָּל וְכָל כִּי הֵם כֻּלָּם אֶחָד
כְּנֻכָּר.

evil and sin and punishment will all be totally nullified, since they are all one thing, as mentioned.

וְהֵנָּה יָסַד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שֶׁיַּעֲשֶׂה כ"ז רַק ע"י הָאָדָם עֲצָמוֹ

Now the blessed Emanator established that this can be achieved only by the person himself –

ר"ל כי הן מציאות הרע שהוא יציאתו מהכח אל הפועל והן בטולו

meaning to say, the existence of evil, which is its emergence into actuality, and its nullification –

הנה נעשה כ"ז רק ע"י האדם עצמו וזהו שאמרו במדרש תנחומא
פ' בראשית סי' ז'

all of this is the result of man's own actions. And as it states in Midrash Tanchuma Bereishit 7

שאין לאדם טענה על חטאיו ממה שיצר לב האדם רע מנעריו

that a person cannot make a disclaimer for his sins based on the fact that 'the impulse of a person's heart is evil from his youth,'

ומאחר שהוא רע מי יוכל לעשותו טוב

and since he is evil who could possibly make him good? i.e. because he was created with a yetzer hara how could he not sin?⁸

אמר הקב"ה אתה עושה אותו רע – אתה עשית אותו רע כו' ע"ש

Such an argument cannot work, **for the Holy One blessed is He says, "You did the evil..."** in other words, it is not inherently evil. Rather, **"you were the one who made it evil..."**

והוא כמו שאמרנו כי התחלת מציאת היצה"ר באדם הוא רק בכח

And this comports with what we stated – that the initial existence of the yetzer hara in a person is merely a potential;

ואינו עדין רע ממש ורק בפעלת החטא יוצא מן הכח אל הפעל

it is not yet actually evil, and only the act of sin brings it from potential to actual,

ונעשה עי"ז מציאת הרע ממש בהאדם וכן נעשה אח"כ בטולו ג"כ
ע"י האדם

thus creating the existence of actual evil in a person. And therefore its nullification is also by that person.

וְהוּא ע"י הָעֲנֵשׁ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ וּלְפִי עֶרֶךְ גְּדֹל כְּמוֹת וְאִיכוֹת הַחֲטָא

This nullification is by way of the punishment that devolves upon them, and is commensurate with the magnitude and gravity of the sin.

הִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה מִקֵּדֶם כָּל מְצִיאת הָרַע שָׁבוּ

Thus first the actuality of evil is created in them,

וְכֵן נַעֲשֶׂה אַח"כ כָּל בְּטוּלוֹ בְּהָעֲנֵשׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא ג"כ בְּעֶרֶךְ זֶה מִמַּשׁ כִּי
הֵם אֶחָד כְּנֻזָּכָר

and then it is also nullified is by way of a proportionate punishment, for they are one and the same, as noted.

וְהִירִי נִמְצָא כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל ע"י הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ

Hence we find that the entire situation is created by the person himself or herself.

וְהִנֵּה מָה שֶׁיִּסְדַּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שֶׁיַּעֲשֶׂה בְטוּל הָרַע ע"י הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ
הִנֵּה פְּשוֹט הוּא

So the fundamental principle that the blessed Emanator established –the nullification of evil is by the person himself the perpetrator – is straightforward.

כִּי מֵאַחֵר שֶׁכָּל הַתְּקוּן דֵּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם שֶׁיִּתְקַנּוּ

For since the entire *tikun* of rectifying all the worlds

לְהַאֲיר בָּאוֹר זֶיו שְׂכִינָתוֹ וּקְדֻשָּׁתוֹ ית"ש מִן הָעוֹלָם וְעַד הָעוֹלָם

to illuminate them with the light of the *Shechinah* the Divine Presence and His blessed Holiness from world to world,

שֶׁרַק זֶה הוּא תְּכִלִּית כָּל הַתְּכִלִּיּוֹת הִנֵּה הוּא תְּלוי רַק בְּבְטוּל הָרַע

for this exclusively is the ultimate purpose – depends entirely on nullifying evil.

לְכֹן יִסַּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שֶׁיַּעֲשֶׂה בְּטוֹלוֹ ע"י הָאָדָם כְּדִי שִׁיְהֶא הָאָדָם
עֲצָמוֹ הַסִּבָּה

Therefore the blessed Emanator established that its nullification will be by man, so that man himself is the reason for

וְהַגֵּרָם לְכָל הַתְּקוּנִים בְּלָם אֲשֶׁר לַעֲתִיד כִּי עִי"ז יִהְיֶה כ"א מְשֻׁלוֹ
מֵה שֶׁהָכִין לַעֲצָמוֹ

and the cause of all future rectifications. So in this way each person will enjoy his own portion – that which he prepared for himself!

וְע"ד שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּבֹא מְצִיעָא לַח, א) אָדָם רוֹצֶה בְּקָב שְׁלוֹ מִתְּשַׁעָה
קָבִין שֶׁל חֲבִירוֹ.

This is akin to what the Sages said (Bava Metzia 38a) – A person prefers a single portion of his own to nine portions belonging to someone else.

וְהַסִּבָּה בְּזֶה הוּא מְשׁוּם סוּד הָאֶחָדוּת הַגָּנוּז בְּהַעוֹלָם

[The reason for this is the mystery of unity concealed within the world,

כִּי הַעוֹלָם מְשַׁכְּלָל עַל סוּד הָאֶחָדוּת וְכִמּוֹ שִׁיְהִיָּה בְּסוּף תְּקוּנָה
הָאַחֲרוֹן

for the world is graced in a concealed manner with the mystery of unity, just as it will be in a revealed manner when the final *tikun* is completed.

וְהוּא ג"כ הִיסוּד הָרֵאשׁוֹן שֶׁבָּה הָאָבִו שֶׁתִּיָּה שְׁמִמְנָה הַשְּׁתֵּת הַעוֹלָם

This was also the mystical secret of the first foundation of the world – the *even shetiya* the foundation-stone from which the

entire world spread forth.⁹

וְלִכְּנָן תִּכְוֶנֶת כ"א לְהִנּוֹת מִשְׁלוֹ וְאָדָם קָרֹב אֶצֶל עַצְמוֹ

Therefore it is the nature of each person to enjoy his own portion, since 'a person is his own closest relative.'¹⁰ This is the basis of the principle in Jewish law that a person cannot testify against himself, just as he is not allowed to testify for or against his close relatives,

כִּי אֵין אֶחָדוֹת יוֹתֵר מֵעַצְמוֹ אֶל עַצְמוֹ, וְהִבֵּן הַדְּבָרִים]

since there is no unity greater than the unity of himself with himself. Understand these matters!]

וּמִשּׁוּם זֶה יִסֵּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שְׂיִהֵא הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ הַסִּבָּה וְהַגֶּרֶם

It was for this reason that the blessed Emanator established the rule that a person himself will be the reason and cause

לְכָל הַתְּקוּנִים כָּלֵם דְּלַעֲתִיד וְיִהְיֶה כ"א מִשְׁלוֹ

of all the future *tikunim* that he has to do**, and everyone will enjoy his own,**

כִּי זֶה גּוֹפֶה הוּא מִהַתְּקוּנִים דִּסּוּד הָאֶחָדוֹת הַשְּׁלִימָה

for this itself is one of the Tikunim of the mystery of complete Oneness.

אֲמָנָם מָה שְׂיִסֵּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שְׂיִהֵא גַם מְצִיאת הָרַע

However, the principle that the blessed Emanator established – that the existence of evil,

וְיִצְיָאֲתוֹ מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל ג"כ רַק ע"י הָאָדָם הוּא עֲנִין עֵמֶק מְאֹד

and that its emergence from potential to actual is also only by way of human agency, is a very profound matter,

וְהוּא נוֹגֵעַ לְכַמָּה סִדּוֹת נִעְלָמִים אֲשֶׁר בְּאַרְנוֹ אוֹתָם בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה
ח"ב

and is relevant to a number of hidden mysteries that we explained in our Sefer HaDe'ah Drushei Olam haTohu part 2.

אך מה שנצרך לעניינינו נאמר בקצור נמרץ וברמז

But what we need for our current purposes let us state very briefly, hinting to deeper themes without explaining them here.

כִּי הָרִי עָנִיו כַּח הַמְצִיאוֹת כָּל הָרַע הֵנָּה נַעֲשֶׂה שְׂרָשׁוֹ בְּכֹנֶה מִן
הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש

Now the concept of the potential of all evil to exist, the root of which was formed intentionally by the Emanator, blessed is His Name,

בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּתוֹקָף הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים כְּאֲשֶׁר שֶׁהָיוּ בְּלֹא בְּסוּם וְהַמְתָּקָה
כָּלל

within the existence of harsh *dinim* when they were as yet without any or fragrance of any sweetening at all.

וְהוּא אַחֵר מִיִּתֵּת הַמְלָכִים דְּסוּד עוֹלָם הַנִּקְדוֹת

This was after the 'death of the kings'¹¹ in the mystical secret of the *nekudot* – the embryonic and undeveloped (hence point-like) vessels of that world that could not contain the powerful lights that flooded them.

וְאֵז יֵצֵא עֵקֶר הָרַע בְּמַצִּיאוֹת נוֹרָא מְאֹד

And then the root of evil emerged into a existence, arousing great dread.

וְהָיָה יִצְיָאָתוֹ ג"כ מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל רַק ע"י רְשָׁעַת הַתַּתְקַע"ד
דְּוֵרוֹת הַנִּזְכָּר בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת בְּדַבְּרֵי רז"ל

There too the evil emerged from a state of potential into actuality via the wickedness of 974 generations mentioned in a number of places in the writings of our Sages.¹²

וְהָגַם שְׁלֹא הָיָה מְצִיאוֹתָם כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא עֲתָה אֲךָ הָיוּ בְּמִצִּיאוֹת עַכ"פ

Now although their existence then was not as it is now, nevertheless, they did exist,

וְהָיוּ רָשָׁעִים גְּדוֹלִים כַּמּ"ש בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מִזְמוֹר צ'

and they were extremely evil, as *Midrash Tehillim*, 90 explains.

וַע"י רָשָׁעֵתָם יָצָא הָרַע מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל וְנִתְחַרְבוּ כָּלָם תִּכְרָ

Due to their evil deeds the evil emerged from potential to actual and destroyed them all instantly,

וְהָרַע נִתְהַפֵּךְ לְסַעַר מִתְחַלֵּל עַל רֹאשׁ רָשָׁעִים יָחוּל וַכַּמ"ש בְּחִגְיָה
י"ג סע"ב

and the evil was transformed into a whirlwind "which descends upon the head of the wicked" (Jeremiah 23:19), as is explained in Tractate Chagiga 13b.

וְהִנֵּה הָגַם שְׁנֵרָאָה כָּל הַפְּעֻלוֹת הַלָּלוּ לְקִלְקוֹל גְּדוֹל

Now although all of these activities appear to be massively destructive,

אֲךָ בְּאֵמֶת הָיָה נַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז לְצוּרֶךָ תִּקּוֹן גְּדוֹל כִּי הָרִי יָצָא עִי"ז כָּל
כְּחוֹת דְּתִקְרָה הַדִּינִים

in truth this was all for the sake of a great *Tikun*, for through this all the powers of the most intense *dinim* emerged

בְּתִכְלִית הַשְּׁלֵמוֹת הַנִּצָּרָךְ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לַעֲתִיד עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל
הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

in the consummate completeness necessary to bring about all the promises for the future

דְּשֻׁכָּר הָעוֹה"ב אֲשֶׁר הֵם נֶעְשִׂים רַק בְּהַאֲוֵרוֹת דְּבַחִי גְבוּרוֹת אַחֵר
שִׁיתְּבַסְמוּ כִנ"ל

regarding reward in the World to Come, which is produced only by the lights of *gevurot* severities after they have been sweetened and made fragrant, as mentioned above.

וּבְאֲשֶׁר שָׁאִין דֶּרֶךְ לַכַּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת לְהוֹצִיאָם בְּכָל תִּקְפָּם

And since there is no way for the powers of *gevurah* to bring them out in all their intensity

אֲלֹא רַק כְּשֶׁהֵם מִתְחִילָה בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל כִּי בְּסוּמָם הוּא ע"י אוֹר
קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש הַמִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

unless they start off without any sweetening at all, since the sweetening process is by way of the light of His blessed Holiness becoming revealed in them,

שֶׁהוּא חֶסֶד פָּשוּט וְאֵז מְאִירִים הַגְּבוּרוֹת בְּחֶסֶד וְהֵם דִּינִין דְּקִדְשָׁא

which is pure *chesed* kindness, which then illuminates the *gevurot* with *chesed* and they become powers of *din* in holiness.

שֶׁהֵם עֲנֵג כָּל הָעֲנוּגִים וְעֵדוֹן כָּל הָעֵדוּנִים שֶׁהוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר
לְעֵתִיד לָבוֹא.

They are then the delight of delights and the pleasure of all spiritual pleasures.

אֲךָ עכ"פ כִּי כְּשֶׁהֵם מְבַסְמִים אִי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁיתְּגַלוּ בְּכָל תִּקְפָּם כִּי הֵרִי
הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּחֶסֶד

But in any event when they have become fragrant and thus diluted it is impossible for them to become revealed in all their strength, since they are already merged into *chesed*.

וְלָכֵן הָיָה הַצָּרִיךְ לְהוֹצִיאָם מִתְחִילָה בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל

And therefore it was necessary to have them emerge from the outset without any dilution¹³

כְּדִי לְהוֹצִיא כֹחוֹתֵיהֶם בְּכָל תְּקֵפָם בְּתַכְלִית הָאִפְשָׁרִי

in order to bring out their full strength to the maximum possible.

אֲמָנָם כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׁהֵם בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל וְהֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּהֶעֱלֵם אוֹר
קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש מֵהֶם לְגַמְרִי

Nevertheless, when they are without dilution at all, and they are in a state of complete concealment from His holy light;

הֵנָּה בְּאַמֶּת עוֹמְדִים אִז בְּסִכְנָה גְּדוֹלָה עֲצוּמָה לְמָאֵד

they are truly in a position of tremendous danger.

וְהָיוּ עֹנִין כָּל הַתַּתְּקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ שִׁיִּצְאוּ בְּעוֹלָם הַתְּהוֹ שֶׁהוּא
אַחֵר מִיַּתֵּת הַמַּלְכִּים

This is the idea of the 974 generations we mentioned that emerged in the World of *Tohu*, which was after the death of the 'kings,'

וְהָיוּ מִתְּקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים וְעִי"ז נִתְּהַפְּכוּ לְדַעַת אַחֲרֵת¹⁴ רח"ל

who derived from the severest of harsh *dinim* and thus deviated into other ways of thinking or false conjectures, possibly a euphemism for all three cardinal sins – idolatry, murder and sexual impropriety.

וַיֵּצֵא עִי"ז כָּל הָרָע כְּלוּ מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

In this way all of the evil emerged from potential to actual,

שֶׁהוּא מִכּוֹחוֹת תְּקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים עִי"ז רִשְׁעַת הַתַּתְּקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת
כְּנֻזָּר.

produced by the intense powers of *dinim* due to the wickedness of those 974 generations, as mentioned above.

וְהָיָה עֲלֵיהֶם הוּא סוּד הַכְּתוּב (קהלת ד, א) דְּמַעַת הָעֲשָׂקִים וְאִין
לָהֶם מְנַחֵם

Regarding them the verse (Ecclesiastes 4:1) states, "...Tears of the oppressed with none to comfort them."

כִּי הֵם בּוֹכִים וְצוֹעֲקִים עַל מָה שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ הֵם מִתְקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים כ"כ

Mystically interpreted this means that **they weep and cry out about why they derive from the most powerful of harsh *dinim* attributes of punitive justice,**

וְנַעֲשׂוּ הֵם כְּמִטְרָה לְחִיצִים לְהוֹצִיא עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל הַכְּחוֹת דִּתְקַף
הַדִּינִים

so that they became like a target for the arrows that emerge as all the powers of intense *dinim*,

ע"י שְׁנִיתָנוּ בְּסִכָּנָה גְּדוֹלָה כָּזֶה עַד שֶׁכַּמַּעַט הָיוּ כְּמִכְרָחִים וְאֲנוּסִים
עַל כָּל מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם

because they are in such great danger that they are almost forced and compelled in all of their actions,

מֵאַחֵר שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה כָּל מִצִּיאוֹתָם מִתְקַף הַדִּינִין אֲשֶׁר הֵם בְּלֹא בְּסוּם
כָּלֵל

since their entire existence is produced by the power of those completely undiluted *dinim*.

אֲמָנָם עֲתִידִים גַּם הֵם לְהִתְנַחֵם לְעֵתִיד לְבוֹא

However, the time will come when they too will be comforted *le'atid lavo* in 'the Time to Come' – a term that refers to the Messianic era and sometimes to the era of the Resurrection of the Dead.

ומה גם כי באמת הם אינם יחידים בזה

Particularly so, since in truth they are not alone in this anguish about their condition.

כי משתתפים עמם כל הדורות כלם אשר עד ביאת המשיח

For all the generation until the Messiah comes join together with them in their anguish,

כי כל זמן הגלות הוא העולם תהו וצדיקים הם מועטים

since the entire period of the exile is the World of Tohu, and the righteous are few,

ועי"ז הנה הוא כל הרעות והתלאות העוברות על כל באי עולם

and therefore all this evil and suffering washes over the entire world.

ומי שאינו מתתקן בהתלאות דהעוה"ז הנה הוא נדון בהענשים
דאחר מיתה כ"א לפי מעשיו.

And anyone who is not rectified by the suffering of this world is sentenced to punishment for their sins after death, each according to his deeds.

כי כל חטא נתהפך לענש כי הם אחד כנ"ל

For every sin is transformed into punishment, because they are all one thing, as explained above.

ואחר שנעשה הענש הנה כלה ומתבטל כל הרע שבו לגמרי

But after the punishment has been administered, all the evil in him is terminated and nullified

ונשארו אז כל תקף הדינים וכל כחותיהם שיצאו ונתגלו עי"ז
טהורים

and the most intense aspects of the *dinim* and all their powers that emerged and were revealed through this process are pure

וְנִקְיִים מְכַל סִיג וּפְסוּלֹת וְהֵם רְאוּיִם לְקַבֵּל עֲתָה כָּל בְּסוּם
וְהַמִּתְקָה מְאֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

and uncontaminated by any dross or waste, and they are ready to accept any dilution and sweetening by the light of His Holiness, may He be blessed,

וְנִכְלְלוּ בָּלֶם עִם שְׁרָשָׁם שֶׁבְּקִדְשׁ הַקִּדְשִׁים

and all of them merge into their roots in the Holy of Holies

וְנִעְשִׂים מֵאֵז לְרִשְׁפֵי אֵשׁ שְׁלֵהֲבֵת י"ה שְׁלֵהוּבִין דְּרַחֲמֵי

and become from that point on the flames of fire of the Divine Flame¹⁵ – flames of love –

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן לְכָל הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים.

where everything is the hidden goodness mentioned in all the promises that will come to fruition in the future.

וְהִנֵּה הַבְּסוּם וְהַמִּתְקָה מְאֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

Making them the harsh *dinim* fragrant and sweetening them by way of the light of His blessed Holiness

הַנִּמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל תִּקְוַת הַדִּינִין אַחֵר שֶׁנִּעְשָׂה בָּהֶם הָעֲנָשִׁים

that is drawn into and revealed within the most intense aspects of the *dinim*, after the punishment has been administered through them,

הִנֵּה הוּא ג"כ בְּסִבַּת וְגֵרָם כָּל אָדָם בְּעַצְמוֹ

this too is because of, and by means, of every person himself or herself

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם בְּזֶהָר הַדָּשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּפָסוּק אֵלֶּה
תּוֹלְדוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם

**as the *Midrash HaNe'elam in Zohar Chadash, Bereishit* states
on the verse (Genesis 2:4) – "These are the products of
heaven...":**

אָמַר רַב הוּנָא אֵין לָךְ רָשָׁע מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁאֵין לוֹ מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים
דְּמַעֲלִיא לָהּ לַעֲלֵמָא דְּאֵתִי

**Said Rabbi Huna: "There is no wicked Jew who does not have
good deeds that will bring him into the World to Come."**

וְהוּא כִּמּוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ ג' כ' עִירֻבִין י"ט א' פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מְלֵאִים מִצְוֹת
כְּרִמּוֹן

**This is the same thing as the Sages declare in Tractate Eruvin
19a: Even the sinners of Israel are as full of *mitzvot* as a
pomegranate is full of seeds.**

וּבִזְהָ הָרִי יִזְכּוּ הַתַּתְּקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת ג' כ' כִּי הֵם מִתְּגַלְּגִלִּים בְּכָל דּוֹר

**So in this way the 974 generations of wicked people will also be
meritorious, for they reincarnate in every generation.**

וְהָרִי עכ"פ הוּא כִּי כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם יִזְכּוּ לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעָתִידִים

**Accordingly, at least it is clearly established that all Jews will
merit all of the promises for the future.**

וְנַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז ל"א בְּסִבְתּוֹ עֲצֻמוֹ כִּי כִּבְר יִסַּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש

**And all of this is due to the person himself or herself because
the blessed Emanator established**

עֲלִילוֹת וּפְעֻלוֹת נִפְלְאוֹת עַל זֶה שֶׁגַּם הָרָשָׁע שְׂבִי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מְכִין לַעֲצֻמוֹ

**the strategies and wondrous means by which even a wicked
Jew can prepare himself**

את היעודים העתידיים אשר בחיים הנצחיים

for the future promises that will be fulfilled in eternal life.

וזה סוד מאמרם ז"ל באדרא קל"ג א' הנ"ל פ"ה

And this is the mystical explanation of the statement of the Sages in *Idra Rabba* 133a, cited earlier in chapter 5,

בסוד התקון דעובר על פשע שנעשה מפשע – שפע.

regarding the Tikun of "Who commutes iniquity" – where *pesha* (iniquity) becomes *shefa* (an outflow of benevolence).

As explained there, 'commutes' is understood in the sense of 'transpose' or 'switch' – by switching the order of the letters *pesha* becomes *shefa*. Now how does this switch come about?

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו כי ע"י שנתהפך לענש עי"ז כלה ונתבטל
הטמאה והרע שבו

This is according to what we said before that the sin itself is transformed into punishment, and in this way the spiritual impurity in him is terminated and nullified,

ונשארו כל מציאת הכחות שנתגלו עי"ז טהורים ונקיים

and all the soul-powers that were revealed thereby remain pure and uncontaminated,

ונכללו בשרשם ומתבסמים והרי נעשה הקלקול לתקון

and they merge into their root and become fragrant, so that the blemish becomes the rectification

ומתהפך הפשע לשפע וזהו שאמרו באדרא רבא שם

and *pesha* becomes *shefa*, as they state in the *Idra Rabba*:

באריך אנפיו כתיב ועובר על פשע וכתיב ורוח עברה ותטהרם

'Regarding Arich Anpin it is written, "Who commutes iniquity," and it is written (Job 37:21) "...like clouds in the sky, which are blown away and cleared by the wind."

כי שם אינו נוגע החטא כלל והנה מתגלה שם התקון תכף

For there in Arich Anpin sin has no effect at all, so that the Tikun is revealed there immediately

ע"י רוחא דפרדשקא דנשיב ממנו כמ"ש שם ק"ל ע"ב

by way of the breath of the nostrils that flows from it – this is meant as an analogy for the flow of life-force down from to Arich Anpin to ze'ir anpin, as it states there p. 130b,

לדחות ולהרחיק כל סיג ופסולת וזהו שאמר ורוח עברה ותטהרם

to push away and distance itself from any dross and impurities. This is the meaning of "which are blown away and cleared by the wind."

ומגיע ומתעורר למעלה גלוי דגבורות מבסמים תכף

This immediately reaches to and arouses the gevurot that have become fragrant

ונעשה שם הכל לתקונים ועומדים כלם מוכן על לעתיד לבוא

and everything there is rectified and stands ready for l'atid lavo – the Time to Come.

וזה סוד מ"ש איוב י"ד מי יתן טהור מטמא לא אחד

This is the secret of the verse in Job 14:4 "Who can produce purity from impurity? No one!" –

והוא נדרש הן למעלה והן למטה כי למעלה והוא במקום שאין מגיע הטמאה והרע כלל

This is elucidated as applicable both above in the higher worlds and below in our world: above – this is where impurity and evil

do not reach at all,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה שֵׁם הַכֹּל לְתַקוּנִים הָרִי נִתְקַן וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַטְּהוֹר מִטְמֵא תִכְפֹּר
כְּנִזְכֹּר

and everything becomes rectified, for the impure becomes pure immediately, as we just explained.

וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ לְמַטָּה כִּי הָרִי אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְהַפֵּךְ כָּל חַטָּא וְעוֹן וּפֶשַׁע לְעוֹנֶשׁ

And it is also elucidated as applicable down below, because once all sin and transgression has been transformed into punishment –

וְעִי"ז הֵנָּה כָּלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל הַטְּמֵאָה וְהָרַע וּמִתְגַּלֶּה אַח"כ הַתְּקוּן
וְהַטּוֹב שֶׁבָּה גַם לְמַטָּה

by means of which the impurity and the evil is terminated and nullified, after which the rectification and the goodness in it is revealed below as well,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה גַם לְמַטָּה מִפֶּשַׁע שֶׁפַּע וְכִמוּ שִׁיחִיָּה לְעֵתִיד וְהָרִי מִתְתַּקֵּן
וְנַעֲשֶׂה טְהוֹר מִטְמֵא

so that down below *pesha* becomes *shefa*, as it will be in the future, and thus it is rectified and impure is transformed into pure.

וְכַמ"ש בַּזוֹה"ק פְּקוּדֵי רַל"ז ע"ב בְּסוּד פָּרָה אֲדָמָה

As is written in *Zohar Pikudei* 237b, regarding the mystical explanation of the *para aduma* the red heifer whose ashes are used to purify those who have become spiritually impure through contact with the dead

דָּהָא בְּקִדְמִיתָא טְמֵא וְהִשְׁתָּא דְּאַתְעֵבִיד בֵּיה דִּינָא וְאַתִּיהִיב לִיקִידָת
אִשָּׁא בְּנוֹרָא דְּדָלִיק כּו'

– the person was initially spiritually impure, but now that the stringency of the law has been followed, and the red heifer was

committed to the flames until it burned to ashes –

השָׁתָא אִיהוּ טָהוּר מִטְמָא, טָהוּר דְּנִפְיָק מִטְמָא, וְכֵן הוּא בְּעִנְיָנֵינוּ.

now he is pure out of impurity, purity that emerged from impurity. And so too, in the matter under discussion.

וְהִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז הוּא לְמַעְלָה וְהוּא לְמַטָּה הַכֹּל ע"י הָאָדָם

Now all of this – both above below – is achieved by man's agency.

כִּי מִצִּיאוֹת הָרַע שֶׁהוּא תּוֹלְדוֹת תְּכֵלִית הַגְּבוּרוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר קָשִׁים

This is because the existence of evil is a product of the most intense harsh judgments *gevurot*

הָרִי יוֹצֵא הוּא מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל רַק ע"י הָאָדָם

which only emerge from potential to actual through man, as explained at length above.

וְכֵן אַח"כ כָּל בְּטוּלוֹ שֶׁכֻּלָּה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל בְּהֶעֱנֵשׁ

And similarly, their subsequent nullification – that they are terminated and nullified through punishments,

שֶׁהוּא כָּל הָרָעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת דֶּהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְכֵן הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל גִּיהֵנּוֹם
דְּלֵאחֶר מִיתָה

which are all the negative events and suffering of this world as well as the fires of Gehinnom after death –

אֲשֶׁר כ"ז הוּא מִהַמִּצִּיאוֹת עֲצָמוֹ דֶּהָרַע שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה ע"י הַחֵטָא

all of this is the coming into being of the evil itself that is created through sin,

וְהוּא הוֹלֵךְ וּמִתְבַּטֵּל בְּהֶעֱנֵשׁ אֲשֶׁר מִתְיַסֵּר הָאָדָם בּוֹ

and it is continually nullified by way of the punishments by which a person is tormented.

וע"י כל זה נטהרו כל אותן מציאות הגבורות שיצאו ונמצאו ע"י האדם עצמו

And through this, the entire existence of the *gevurot* that surfaced and are there because of the person himself become purified;

ונכללו בשרשם ומתבסמים

they merge into their root and become fragrant.

כי מאחר שנטהרו הרי נתבטל המחצה והמסך מבדיל אשר בינם לבין שרשם

Because when they become purified the fence and the barrier separating them from their root is nullified,

וממילא שנכללים למעלה בקדש הקדשים

and they automatically merge above into the Holy of Holies.

ובפרט ע"י המצות ומעשים טובים שישנם לכל רשע מישאל עכ"פ

And this is particularly so when this is accomplished through the *mitzvot* and good deeds that even every wicked Jew has to his credit,

כנ"ל מגמרא זוהר חדש וע"י כ"ז הנה מתבסמים ונמתקים כל אותן הגבורות כלם

as cited above from the Gemara and the *Zohar Chadash*. And through this they all those harsh *gevurot* become fragrant and are sweetened,

ונעשה בהם כל יעודים העתידים ושכר העוה"ב

and form all of the promises that will come to fruition in the future, as well as the reward in the World to Come.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּלָם עַכ"פ לְטוֹב הָעֵתִיד

So it turns out that every Jew will be worthy of good in the future –

מֵאֲשֶׁר הָכִין כ"א לַעֲצֻמוֹ ע"י הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת בָּלָם שְׁנַעֲשָׂה בּוֹ.

from that which each one prepares for themselves by way of all the events that occur with that person.

Footnotes

1. See Berachot 60a [↩](#)
2. Makover. [↩](#)
3. *Sod* (the mystical secrets of Torah) and *yayin* (wine) both have the numerical value (*gematria*) of 70, indicating a common underlying theme, as the saying (Sanhedrin 38a) goes: "When wine goes in, the secrets come out." [↩](#)
4. See Judges 9:13; Tractate *Berachot* 35a. [↩](#)
5. In Daniel 2:22: וְנִהְיָא [וְנִהְיָא] עִמָּה שְׂרָא [↩](#)
6. See Tractate Avodah Zara 9a. [↩](#)
7. Tractate Shabbat 55b; Bava Batra 17a. They were Benjamin (son of Jacob); Amram, Moses' father; Yishai, King David's father, Calev, King David's son. [↩](#)
8. Makover. [↩](#)
9. The *even shetiya* is a rock that juts out from the top of the Temple Mount. It was in the Holy of Holies, and it served as the base for the Ark. The Talmud (Yoma 54b, Rashi) explains that the entire world spread out from, and was built upon, this rock. [↩](#)

10. Sanhedrin 9b. [↩](#)
11. See Genesis 36:31 ff. The seven kings of Edom 'who ruled and then died' listed there refers to the seven *sefirot* of the World of Tohu – also called the World of *Nekudim*, since the vessels were undeveloped and like embryonic points (*nekudot*) – that shattered and then fell into the lower worlds in a mystical process known as *shevirat hakelim*. See *Etz Chaim* 5:1; 8:2. [↩](#)
12. See *Sefer haDe'ah* part 2, *drush* 2, subsection 2:1. [↩](#)
13. The word בְּסוּם in this context is best translated as 'diluted' rather than 'made fragrant.' [↩](#)
14. This may be a misprint that should read דת אחרת – a different religion or set of beliefs – as in *Sefer Ha-Ikarim* 1:24. [↩](#)
15. See Song of Songs 8:6 רֶשֶׁפִּיָּהּ רֶשֶׁפִּי אֵשׁ שְׁלֵהֶבְתִּיהָ [↩](#)

Avnei Miluim — Talmud Hagiga 5b: Explanation of the verse, My soul shall weep in the hidden parts

Explanation of the discussion in the Talmud of the verse, My soul shall cry in the hidden parts.

This is a note the Baal HaLeshem added to the text of this chapter discussing two versions of the Talmudic text. The girsa (version) found in our editions of the Talmud follows Rashi, according to which joy is found in the outer chambers, but weeping in the inner chambers. Rabbi Elyashiv prefers the girsa of Rabbeinu Chananel – that weeping is in the outer chambers, and joy in the inner chambers, and he makes the case as to why this version is the primary one.

The above text that weeping is in the outer chambers, and joy in the inner chambers **is found in an older version** of the Talmud, favored by Rabbeinu Chananel. **However, the version in the current editions of the Talmud follow Rashi's girsa, which is the opposite of the one stated above. This is the wording of the Talmud as currently printed: The verse (Jeremiah 13:17) states: "But if you will not hear it, My soul shall weep in secret [b'mistarim] for your grandeur." Rav Shmuel bar Inya said in the name of Rav: The blessed Holy One has a place where He weeps, and its name is *Mistarim*. What is the meaning of "for your grandeur"? Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: G-d weeps for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given to the gentile nations. Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said: He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world.**

The Gemara asks: **But is there weeping before the blessed Holy One? Didn't Rav Pappa say: There is no sadness before the blessed Holy One as the verse states (I Chronicles 16:27): "Grandeur and majesty are before Him; strength and gladness are in His place"?** The Gemara responds: **This is not a difficulty. This statement that Gd weeps is referring to the innermost chambers, where He can weep in secret, whereas the other**

statement, that He does not weep, is referring to **the outer chambers**.

The Gemara then asks: **And is there none no weeping in the outer chambers? Doesn't the verse state (Isaiah 22:12): "And the Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning, and shaving off their hair, and donning sackcloth"?**

The Gemara responds: **The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash the Temple is different, as even the Angels of Peace cried, as the verse (Isaiah 33:7) states: "Behold, the valiant ones weep outside; the Angels of Peace weep bitterly."** This is the end of the quote from the Gemara.

Rashi explains: The statement that there is weeping refers to **in the innermost chambers, since the verse states, *b'mistarim* in secret, i.e. the inner chambers. And he adds: This is the accepted version: And is there none no weeping in the outer chambers? Doesn't the verse state, "He called it a day for weeping and mourning"? But wherever the word 'called' ויקרא appears it signifies audible sound. This is as far as Rashi explains.**

Now this Rashi's version is cited in a number of works written after Rashi's time, e.g. *Sefer Ha-Ikkarim*, 4:23; *Sefer Ha-Akeida Sha'ar* 87; and so too in *Yalkut Yirmeya* on the verse 13:17. The *Yalkut* was also compiled after Rashi's time, as is known from the works of historians – see e.g. *Seder HaDorot*, end of section 1.

However, from Rashi's own words – 'this is the accepted version' – it is evident that he also had another version in front of him. And this is indeed noted by the Radvaz in *Magen Avot* #2 that the version of older works it states the opposite: This statement that G-d weeps is referring to **the outer chambers**, whereas **the other** statement, where there is no weeping, refers to **the inner chambers**. And when the Gemara asks: **And is there no weeping...** the older version continues: **in the inner chambers? Doesn't the verse state: "And on that day the Lord called..."**

The older version is also cited in Rabbi Yosef Gikatilia's *Sha'arei Tzedek* in the section on the *sefirah* of *binah*. And

similarly in Rabbi Todros HaLevi's *Otzar HaKavod*, Tractate *Chagiga* 5b: "There are other works where it states: "And is there no weeping **in the outer chambers?" (i.e. Rashi's version) but these cannot be correct. See there (**although there are a few words missing there).

But now we have the benefit of Rabbi Chananel's work which was printed in the new Vilna edition of the Talmud from the manuscript. And he too writes exclusively according to the old version, just like the Radvaz.

According to Rashi's version then the Gemara's opinion was initially that "in the inner chambers there is weeping, but not in the outer chambers." But the older version states the opposite, that "in the *outer* chambers there is weeping, but not in the *inner* chambers." But according to the conclusion, when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed there was weeping everywhere in both the inner and outer chambers. Here there is no disagreement among the versions. But leaving aside the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, there is a distinction between the versions, from one point of view to its opposite.

What motivated Rashi to opt for the other version is straightforward – because the term 'in secret' [*b'mistarim*] clearly implies only the inner chamber which is concealed from the public. But see Rabbeinu Chananel's explanation of why *mistarim* refers to the outer chambers, whereas in the inner chambers there is no weeping, as per the older version. However, this matter needs some 'spice' added to it to make it more palatable.

The concept of the inner chambers and outer chambers is discussed in the Zohar II, *Shemot* 18a. The inner chambers are the sanctuary of Atzilut, whereas the outer chambers are the sanctuary of the worlds of BiY" A. The Zohar *ibid.* explains that with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash there was weeping in the inner chambers as well, but aside from that destruction, there is no sadness in the presence of the blessed Holy One – i.e. only in the outer chambers but not in the inner

ones, as is explained in Zohar III, *Vayikra* 15b. And this is like the view of Rabbeinu Chananel and the older version.

But there is another concept regarding the inner and outer chambers, and both of these are in Atzilut itself, for the letters ך"י *yud, hei* of the Name are the inner chambers, meaning the sanctuaries of Abba and Imma. But the letters ך"ו *vav, hei* of the Name are the outer chambers, i.e. the sanctuaries of ze'ir anpin and nukvah (*malchut*), since ze'ir anpin and nukvah are below the *parsa* the dividing line between *Arich Anpin* and the other *partzufim* so that they ze'ir anpin and nukvah are *Arich's netzach, hod, yesod*¹ – he ze'ir anpin corresponding to *netzach* and she *nukvah* corresponding to *hod*. Now all the three *sefirot netzach, hod and yesod* are separate from the body the main *sefirot*, just as the legs are separate from the torso, as the *Sifra d'Tzniuta* beginning of chapter 2 states. See the GRA ad loc.

Abba and Imma are also called *nistarot* 'concealed aspects' as Eliyahu taught²: "the *nistarot* – referring to *chochmah* and *binah* – are for G-d alone." And therefore they are the 'inner chambers,' whereas ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers.' So stated the Rabbi Rabbi Yitzchak Luria, the Arizal, in *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar Pnimit v'Chitzoniut, drush 9*: Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' referring to the sanctuaries of Abba and Imma, as mentioned.

Thus we have explained that the 'inner chambers' and the 'outer chambers' represent two concepts: 1) The 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY"A; 2) In Atzilut itself Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers.'

We can now explain the statement of the Rabbis: 'The blessed Holy One has a place and its name is *Mistarim*' in a similar manner to our explanation above. Here too, there are two aspects: 1) the chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah where *malchut* of Atzilut is vested – this is the mystery of 'the appearance of a Man sitting upon the Throne' (see Ezekiel 1:26). And she *malchut* of Atzilut is called 'Esther' because she is

concealed within the 'head' i.e. Abba and Imma / *chochmah* and *binah* of Beriah. This is because the name Esther is an expression of concealment,³ as *Raya Mehemna* in Zohar III *Teitzei* 76a states. All of this is explain in the words of the Arizal, *Sha'ar Kisei haKavod*. See chapters 2, 5, 6 there.

This is the meaning of the statement 'The blessed Holy One has a place and its name is *Mistarim*.' And this is what Rabbeinu Chananel said – that the place called '*Mistarim*' refers to the outer chambers, since it is the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, which is an external aspect compared with Atzilut, as mentioned. It is only there that the *Shechinah* is called Esther because of her state of concealment there, since Atzilut is her primary place, as the rabbis established in the *Aleinu* prayer: "The abode of His majesty is in the loftiest heights," for there she is in full revelation, and she is the final *hei* of the Name Havaye. But when she descends into BiY" A she becomes concealed, and the Name Havaye becomes clothed within the Name A-d-o-n-ai.

Similarly, Beriah is called by the Name E-lohim, which has the same *gematria* numerical value as א"ס כס – the Throne (=86), since the World of Beriah is the Realm of the Throne, as is known. But in the World of Atzilut she is part of the Name Havaye itself, the final *hei* thereof, for that is where she is fully revealed, as mentioned.

Now at the beginning of the discussion, the Gemara resolves the apparent contradiction between two statements by explaining that 'This statement refers to the innermost chambers, whereas the other statement, refers to the outer chambers' and that in the inner chamber there is no weeping, and weeping is only in the outer chambers. The questioner (or the Gemara itself, presenting contrasting viewpoints which were not actually expressed) is of the opinion that when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed there was weeping only in the outer chamber, and the fact that the verse states, "My soul shall weep in secret [*b'mistarim*]" refers to the place called '*Mistarim*' which is the chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah, where the *Shechinah* is clothed and becomes concealed. And that is where the

weeping takes place, since it is always the outer chamber when compared with Atzilut. And therefore the question arises "and in the inner chambers is there no weeping? Doesn't the verse state: "And on that day A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye Tzva'ot called it a day for weeping and mourning..."?

Now the verse here uses three holy Names A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye, and Tzva'ot – in that order – and they encompass both aspects of the 'inner chambers' we spoke about above – the Name A-d-o-n-ai is in *malchut* of Atzilut, as the Zohar III, *Vayikra* 11a-b states, and in several other places.

[But the fact that we stated above that this Name is in Beriah, the intention was that in Beriah even the Name Havaye therein is concealed within the Name A-d-o-n-ai exclusively, so that only the light of the Name A-d-o-n-ai is perceived, and so although it is written as ה-ו-ה-י (Havaye) it is read as א-ד-נ-י (A-d-o-n-ai).

But in Atzilut, where the Name Havaye is primary, the Name A-d-o-n-ai is only secondary, since its presence there is merely as the root of the worlds of BiY" A, and it constitutes the outer aspect thereof. However, the essence of Atzilut is the Name Havaye exclusively i.e. Havaye fully iterated with the letter *hei* as the *milui* – ה"ו ה"ו ה"ו ה"ו which is the Name Ba"n =52, that numerically = 2x Havaye⁴ (2x26=52) since it encompasses all of Atzilut, and it is the final *hei* of the macro Name Havaye, because as explained earlier there are macro and micro revelations of the Name Havaye, each of which is illuminated in its own way by the light of the entire Name Havaye. And this is besides the macro Name Havaye that encompasses the entire Atzilut with the light of a single instance of the Name Havaye. In this respect, *malchut* is merely one letter thereof, i.e. the final *hei* of this Name Havaye.

This is also found in Midrash *Pesikta Rabbati* 21: The Name of the Holy One, blessed is He, is Tzva'ot (usually translated as legions). Rabbi Yehuda bar Simon said: 'The bottom line is that this does not apply only to the entire Name, but even a single letter of His Name creates a legion, just like His entire Name.'

This is just as we said – that every letter of the blessed Name Havaye includes the entire Name, including the final *hei*, which is the Name Havaye in *malchut* of Atzilut – the very essence and primary aspect of Atzilut within her.

But since she *malchut* is also the root of the Worlds of BiY"A, the revelation of the Name A-d-o-n-ai (and all the other Names) is also manifested in her, i.e. in her outer aspects.

Thus, in any event, the fact is that the Name A-d-o-n-ai is in *malchut* of Atzilut, which is the Name A-d-o-n-ai in the verse we are discussing.]

Now the Name Havaye Tzva'ot is in *nh"y netzach, hod, yesod* of Atzilut (as it states in Tikunim, Tikun 18, p. 34a – Havaye Tzva'ot is the covenant of circumcision i.e. *yesod* and the two thighs i.e. supports of truth – *netzach* and *hod*). And they also include *chesed, gevurah, tiferet* of Atzilut, as the Rabbi the Arizal states in the *kavanot* of *Kedushah*. See the Intro to the Tikunim p. 11b, and the GRA there beginning with the word *אנין* and Zohar III p. 11b.

Thus, included in the Name A-d-o-n-ai Havaye Tzva'ot are all the seven lower *sefirot* of Atzilut. These are the inner chambers of the first aspect we mentioned above i.e. where we explained that the 'inner chambers' and the 'outer chambers' can be explained in two ways, the first of which is that the 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY"A.

Now the verse cited above (Isaiah 22:12) is written with the Name Havaye with the vowels of *Elokim* וִיקְרָא אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה which is *binah*, as the Zohar III 10b states, i.e. supernal Imma as she includes the *chochmah* of Abba, as the Zohar III *parshat Acharei* 65a states. See the note 7 of Rabbi Chaim Vital on that section. Thus Abba and Imma are both included in the Name Havaye with the vowels of *Elokim* (see Zohar I, 26a: Havaye Elokim – Abba and Imma). And these are the inner chambers of the second explanation mentioned above – where Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and *ze'ir anpin* and *nukvah* are the 'outer chambers' in *Atzilut itself*.

This then is the question the Gemara poses according to the version favored by Rabbeinu Chananel:** And is there no weeping** **in the *inner* chambers?** **Doesn't the verse state (Isaiah 22:12): "And on that day the Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning..."?**

The Name Havaye is written here with the vowels of Elokim, as explained above, so that both these Names allude to both aspects of the inner chambers 1) where the 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY"A**,** 2) where Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers' *in Atzilut itself*. **Accordingly, it would seem that there is weeping in the 'inner chambers' according to both explanations! But the Gemara responds: The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash is different, as even the Angels of Peace wept, as the verse states: "Behold, the valiant ones weep outside; the Angels of Peace..."**

At first glance this is surprising. After the Gemara proves that there was weeping in the inner chambers as well, at the very highest levels i.e. even in Abba and Imma of Atzilut, what is the meaning of "*even* the Angels of Peace cried"? If there was weeping even in the inner chambers, how much more so in the outer chambers? And what does the fact that they were Angels of Peace add?

However, the idea is this: As is known, the angels do not have free choice, and they are fixed and unchanging in all their attributes, similar to fire and water where fire is dry and water is wet and they cannot change and be transformed from one into the other. The same is true of the angels – one that is appointed over peace is the vessel for all sorts of goodness and blessing, and cannot be transformed into weeping and moaning and groaning. But at the time of the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may heaven have pity, the orders of Creation above and below were disrupted, as our Sages expound on the verse (Lamentations 2:2), "He profaned the kingdom and its leaders," cited in Rashi ad loc. 'the angels above were exchanged.' And this is the meaning of the statement that "the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash is different," for the entire

order of Creation was upended. And therefore it is not surprising that there was weeping in even the inner chambers above to the loftiest levels.

Similarly, the *Midrash Tehillim* 20 states that when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed weeping and wailing overtook the entire world, as the verse states: "And A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye Tzva'ot called it a day for weeping and mourning..." Then the ministering angels said before Him: "Are these weeping and mourning indeed before You? Is it not written, "Grandeur and majesty are before Him; strength and gladness are in His place"? To which He replied: "Is My house not destroyed and weren't My children led away in chains, that I shouldn't be distraught? Is it not written (Psalms 91:15), 'I am with him in times of distress.'" See there.

So it turns out that there was weeping in both aspects of the inner chambers, to the very loftiest levels. And how much more so was there weeping down below, as *Midrash Tehillim* states, that weeping and wailing overtook the entire world.

However, when the verse states, "...My soul shall weep in secret [*b'Mistarim*] for your grandeur," and our Sages explain that 'The blessed Holy One has a place where He weeps, and its name is *Mistarim*' we cannot explain as we did above – that this refers to the Holy of Holies of Beriah – because according to the Gemara's conclusion there was weeping even in the inner chambers of Atzilut, as mentioned.

But there is another aspect of the place called *Mistarim* which is at the loftiest of levels – the inner chambers of this highest aspect, referred to earlier as the letters ה"י (*yud, hei*) of the Name i.e. Abba and Imma. At those levels too there is a place called *Mistarim*, regarding which the verse states, "My soul shall weep in secret [*b'mistarim*] for your grandeur," as the Arizal explains in *Sha'ar Ruach HaKodesh* regarding the rectification of conceit, the negative side of grandeur, and similarly in *Sefer HaYichudim* – that the sin of conceit even has an impact on the letters ה"י *yud, hei* of the Name, since the

letters י"ה *yud, hei* have the same *gematria* numerical value as the word for conceit גאו"ה.

However, the outside forces the *chitzonim*⁵ do not impact the letters י"ה themselves, only their *milui* (iteration). Now there are three possible *miluim* of the letters י"ה – with a *yud*, like this: יו"ד ה"י; or with an *aleph* ה"ד א"י or with a *hei* יו"ד ה"ה. The blemish cause by conceit impacts only the latter sequence with a *milui hei*, and only the letters of the *milui* itself: ה"ד' which has the same letters as דָּוָה – anguish⁶ – which is also the *gematria* of גאו"ה (conceit).

Now the *milui* letters are called '*mistarim*' because their iteration is hidden and concealed within the primary letters. So this then is the meaning of "...My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (גוה)."

[Note that the word גוה here is missing an *aleph* – it should read גאוה = grandeur – because of the blemish done to it to His grandeur. For גאוה grandeur is appropriate only for the blessed Holy One, as the verse (Psalms 93:1) states: ה' מָלַךְ גִּאוּת לְבָשׁ – "G-d has donned grandeur." Now the word גִּאוּת is written in the plural – once for the primary letters, and once for the *milui*, as mentioned, both of which are appropriate only for the blessed Holy One alone.

Thus, when there is a blemish in the *milui*, the verse states, "... My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (גוה)" – meaning to say, due to the blemish made in it. And this is why the word is written with only a *vav* without the *aleph*, because the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven has been withdrawn, may He have compassion for us, and when His grandeur descends below, it does not descend the way it is Above, Heaven forfend, Heaven forfend, and therefore גוה is written in the defective form, without the *aleph*.]

Now the three *miluim* of the letter *hei*, which are ה"י and ה"א and ה"ה together have the *gematria* of 31 = the Name א-ל that

appears in the verse (Exodus 34:6-7) of the Thirteen Attributes of Divine Mercy **א-ל רחום וחנון** etc.

The Name **א-ל** is also the first of the 13 *Tikunei Dikna*,⁷ situated below the *pe'ot* sidelocks of the head, at the top of the beard, next to the ears. (There lies the secret of "From the straits I called out to י"ה" (Psalms 118:5) – the name י"ה we mentioned earlier. At the top of the beard the *pe'ot* are narrower, and below, near the mouth, they broaden). Thus they are actually two Names, one to the right and one to the left corresponding to the two *pe'ot*, and each of them comprises three aspects of the Name **א-ל שד"י** – **א-ל** and **א-ל הוי"ה** and **א-ל אדנ"י**, making six times that the Name **א-ל** is manifested here and all of them emerge from the Name י"ה with its *milui*.

Now six times the Name **א-ל** is the numerical value *gematria* of **מקו"ם** place = 186, which is the mystical secret of the statement of the Sages cited earlier: 'The blessed Holy One has a place, and its name is *Mistarim*,' the actuality of which is six times the Name **א-ל**, which is the *gematria* of **מקו"ם**, fashioned out of the letter ה in its three iterations, as mentioned above, of the *milui* of the final *hei* exclusively. But the blemish is only in the *milui*, which is the *mistarim*,** as we explained, and only in the *milui* of the final *hei*, which is the final *milui*, comprising the letters *dalet*, *vav*, *hei* **דוה** which has the same *gematria* as grandeur (**גאורה**).

This then is the meaning of the verse, "...My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (**גורה**)" – because of the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven that was withdrawn at the time of the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash**, may the Merciful One have compassion for us.** The destruction of the First Beit HaMikdash impacted the first *hei* of the blessed Name Havaye, as *Zohar II*, 9b states, and look into *ibid.* 4a. See also *Zohar I*, 26a. Now the first *hei* of the blessed Name Havaye is always united with the *yud* (since they are two beloved friends who do not part⁸) and that is the place of the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, as the verse (Psalms 93:1) states: **ה' מִלְךְ גִּאּוֹת לְבָשׁ** – "G-d has donned grandeur," as mentioned above.

Given all of this analysis above it is clear that the place of *mistarim* is in the inner chambers of Atzilut as well.

Accordingly we must conclude that there are two aspects: One aspect of *mistarim* is located in the outer chambers, and this is in the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, as explained above; and the other aspect of *mistarim* is in the inner chambers of Atzilut, in the *milui* of the letters י"ה. The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash caused weeping in both aspects, and this is why the verse states *mistarim* in the plural – as the *-im* suffix at the end of the word indicates.

Now regarding these two aspects of weeping, which took place in the two localities of *mistarim*, the Sages in Tractate *Chagiga* 5b asked: "What is the meaning of "for your grandeur"? Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: G-d weeps for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given.... to the gentile nations. Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said:** He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world.**

According to the above analysis, these are not contradictory views. **Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak is referring to the weeping in the outer chambers, for that is where the grandeur of Israel is located. This is because the secret of the Shechinah, as manifested in in the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, descended into the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the Beit HaMikdash down below when the Beit HaMikdash stood, for the Chamber of the Holy of Holies below corresponds to the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, as the Arizal writes in *Drushei Ma'n uMa'd*, end of *drush* 1. And it the Holy of Holies of Beriah is the Beit HaMikdash on high, regarding which our Sages state in Tractate *Chagiga* 12b: "The Archangel Michael stands and makes sacrificial offerings there of the souls righteous Tsaddikim before the Holy One, blessed is He." The *Midrash haNe'elam* in *Zohar Chadash*, *Noach* (beginning with the words הפתח השלישי) **explains this. (**The *Zohar Chadash* states there that this is not in the same manner as all other sacrificial offerings, but rather like a person presenting a gift to a king. So too, the Archangel**

Michael proffers the souls of righteous Tsaddikim before the Divine Presence the Shechinah in the Supernal Beit HaMikdash, which is the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah).

When the Beit HaMikdash stood, then the Supernal Beit HaMikdash descended into the Beit HaMikdash below, similar to the statement in Tractate *Sukkah* 5a: "The Throne extended itself downward..." In the same manner Atzilut extended down until the Ark and the Cherubim on top of the Ark, and the worlds of BiY" A received their life-force and sustenance only via the Beit HaMikdash below. The intention in all of this was to contract His Presence and dwell within the Jewish People themselves, as the verse (Exodus25:8) states, "Make for Me a Beit HaMikdash, so that I may dwell within them..." The verse does not say "within it," but "within *them*" – within each Israelite.

This was indeed Moses' request when he asked (Exodus 34:9) "If I have now found favor in your eyes... let the Lord go now in our midst" – within the Israelites, literally. This is such a great and sublime quality that there is nothing loftier than it, as the GRA writes in *Aderet Eliyahu*, *Ki Tisa*, and this is the grandeur of Israel. But with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may the Merciful One spare us, the Shechinah with withdrawn above as it states in Tractate *Rosh HaShana* 31a: "She the Shechinah ascended and returned to her place, as the verse (Hosea 5:15) states, "I will leave and return to My place."

Nowadays the *shefa* the flow of spiritual sustenance is drawn down through exceedingly crooked paths (see *Zohar* II *Terumah*, p. 152b).

This then is what Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak was saying – the weeping is "for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given.... to the gentiles," and he is referring to the weeping in the *mistarim* of the outer chambers, for that is where weeping for the grandeur of Israel that has been rescinded takes place.

But Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said: "He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world." He is referring to the weeping in the *mistarim* of the inner chambers in Atzilut, regarding which it states, "G-d has donned grandeur." This aspect of *mistarim* is in the *milui* of the letters ה"י (yud, hei) of the Name, as explained above. When the Beit HaMikdash stood, and the revelation of the *Shechinah* was down below, then the verse "G-d has donned grandeur" was fulfilled, since the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven was revealed throughout the earth. But with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may the Merciful One spare us, it states "... My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for Your grandeur." Examine the words of the Arizal in *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar Mi'ut haYare'ach* chaps 2-3.

As we explained above, the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven is in the letters ה"י of the Name, whereas the grandeur of Israel in the letter ה"ו of the Name, and they depend upon one another, as Tractate *Megillah* 29a and Midrash Tehillim 9:14 and a number of other works state.⁹

This is also the concept of when 'the Name is complete and the Throne is complete' discussed in *Pesikta* on the verse (Deut. 25:17) "Remember what Amalek did to you" cited in Rashi at the end of *Beshalach*. Because when 'the Name is complete' this is the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, and when 'the Throne is complete' is the grandeur of Israel, as the verse (I Chronicles 29:23) states, "and Solomon sat on the Throne of G-d". See Zohar I p. 243a; Tikunei Zohar Chadash 37b and similarly in Tikunim, Tikun 22, p. 76a. This is enough for now.

Now all of this is according to the older prior version of the Talmud, elucidated by Rabbeinu Chananel, which is the primary version as the Radvaz maintains and Rabbi Todros HaLevi writes in *Otzar HaKavod*, as explained above.

However, we found that one of the holy Sages of Truth – a designation for master Kabbalists – a Master of the Secret Teachings, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero in *Pardes, Sha'ar Mehut v'Hanhaga* chap. 12 accepts Rashi's version, that in the inner

chambers there is weeping, but not in the outer chambers. This is due to the principle that any outflow is only from above, and whatever is below is what they receive from above.

Accordingly, when they said according to this version that there is none in the outer chambers, this is because they have nothing of their own, whereas it is in the inner chambers, since that is the source. He also cites a few statements from the Zohar to prove his point.

Nevertheless, in my own impoverished view the main thrust of his words is very surprising. For it is very well known that all strict judgments above are all sweetened and fragrant and are the flames of compassion, and this is the entire subject of the statement of our Sages that there is no sadness before the blessed Holy One, but only as the verse (I Chronicles 16:27) states "might and joy are in His place". Might and joy are also only from the revelation of *gevurot* (attributes that generally tend to judgment and restriction) but in this case these are sweetened *dinim* judgments and are referred to in the verse (Judges 9:13) as 'the wine that gladdens.' It is inappropriate to even call these types of *gevurot* 'judgments' for that term implies judging each according to his deeds to chastise and punish, Heaven forbid. Indeed, the opposite is true – sweetened *dinim* benefit the world, and in this way He is good and does good for the wicked and for the righteous.

This is also the concept of the Thirteen Attributes (*Middot*) of Divine Mercy, which are also *gevurot*, which is why they are called *middot*, for they disburse compassion in a measured manner, not broadly. Nevertheless, they subdue all the harsh judgments because they are sweetened *gevurot*, as the Rabbi the Arizal writes regarding all this in *Pri Eitz Chaim Sha'ar haShofar* chaps. 1 & 2. See there.

All of the 13 Attributes of Divine Mercy are found and revealed in *binah*, which is nourished by the last *mazal* – *mazal* in the sense of 'constant outflow***' from *nozel*, flowing, not in the sense of 'constellations' – this is the *mazal* of ונקה "and He cleanses" (Exodus 34:7). This is the 13th *Tikun* of the 13 *Tikunei Dikna* (see footnote 6) which includes all the others. Thus *binah*

is in the category of the inner chambers, as explained above, and therefore it is certainly so and obvious that there "might and joy are in His place" and judgments are not actually revealed other than below, in the outer chambers, for that is where sin and blemish reach and compassion is concealed, so that the *gevurot* become actual *dinim* – harsh judgments – thereby.

Thus there is no claim at all from the fact that whatever is below is only from above, for although this is certainly the case, nevertheless the *dinim* only become revealed in a place where sin and blemish are of great consequence since compassion is concealed. This is only in the outer chambers, whereas the inner chambers are always aromatic.

So it turns out that even though that whatever is below is only from above, the revelation of *dinim* as actual *dinim* i.e. harsh judgments – is always in the world below exclusively. Furthermore, when suffering grows down below, then either through prayer or through crying out in pain, compassion is aroused above, subduing the *dinim* below due to the revelations from above. This means to say that the *gevurot* above are revealed down below, but because those *gevurot* are always fragrant, the *gevurot* below also become fragrant.

In any event, above, in the inner chambers, they the *dinim* are always fragrant, so that there "might and joy are in His place," except at the of the destruction, may the Merciful One spare us, for then the order of Creation was upended completely and weeping and the revelation of *dinim* in the negative sense and weeping impacted on high as well, i.e. to the place of *mistarim* above, as was all explained earlier. Accordingly, the words of the Ramak are very surprising in my view.

In addition the proofs he the Ramak cites from several statements of the Zohar are also surprising in my view. For what the Zohar, *Noach* 61b states regarding the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash: 'And thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers, and this is the meaning of the verse, "Behold, the valiant ones weep outside..." and "the

Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning..." – the language of these verses expresses the opposite: that even at the time of destruction weeping took place only in the outer chambers! This is the meaning of: 'And thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers' – where the expression 'certainly' implies that it is as if it said that the possibility for sadness is only there in the outer chambers, and not in the inner chambers at all. Whereas the Ramak explains that the Zohar's intention is that during the destruction sadness was manifested as a new phenomenon even in the outer chambers, like the Talmud states according to Rashi's version.

But the language of the Zohar does not indicate this at all, but rather that even at the time of the destruction there was weeping *only* in the outer chambers, meaning to say, the outer chambers of Atzilut, which is in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut*, and there sadness is also manifested, as the *Idra Rabba* 144a explains on the verse (Genesis 6:6) "He was saddened to His heart," which is the inner chambers of the first aspect we mentioned above. This is because compared with the Worlds of BiY" A, *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* of Atzilut are called 'inner chambers,' as the Zohar *Shemot*, 18a states. But compared with Abba and Imma, *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* are the only the outer chambers, as explained above.

The Zohar in *parshat Noach* on our subject cited by the Ramak is that even at the time of destruction there was weeping only in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut*, but not in Abba and Imma. This does not comport with the view of the Talmud in *Chagiga* 5b as explained above, since at the time of the destruction there was weeping even in Abba and Imma, in the place of *mistarim*, as we explained above.

However, the primary view seems to be as later authorities write, that this entire section of the Zohar, which is in parentheses from the words *והאי אמריתו* to *וגומר* is not part of the Zohar at all, but an addition from some student, and so it seems from the language as well; it is not the language of the Zohar at all. Accordingly the primary view is that of the

Talmud – that at the time of the destruction there was weeping even in the inner chambers above, in both aspects of *mistarim*, which is why *mistarim* is stated in the plural, as we explained. So there was weeping in the place of *mistarim* above as well. And this is understood explicitly from the Zohar *Shemot* 18a, that at that time there was weeping in the inner chambers above, but only in the *mistarim* there, as it states explicitly there 17b – *b'mistarim*. See there.

From all of this it seems that the entire addition in the note in Zohar Noach 61b, which states that 'Thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers,' is of the view that even at the time of the destruction there was weeping in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* exclusively. But this is not the primary view. Accordingly, whether one explains it this way or that way it cannot be a proof for the Ramak's view. To the contrary, it stands in contradiction to his words. Understand all of this well and you will see that this is indeed so, since 'truth is its own witness.'¹⁰

The Ramak brings another proof for his view that the primary potency of *dinim* and where weeping is appropriate is only in *binah*, which is of the inner chambers. He cites the Zohar *Noach*, 70b, which states that when supernal fire, which is *binah*, acts to increase the *dinim* down below in *malchut*, then supernal ire becomes even more potent and destroys everything, since it does not cease. Meaning to say that the ire does not abate until the judgment is carried out in full, and this is what transpired during the flood, which is why the entire world was destroyed, and only Noah and his family remained. And even he had to hide away in the Ark, invisible to the eye, as it states there p. 64b. A similar exposition is proffered in Zohar *Pikudei* 227b. But when strict judgment *din* is drawn down from *malchut* alone, without its strength being increased by *binah*, then the *din* is made to be halted, and it does not cause total destruction, Heaven forbid. See there.

The Ramak brings a proof from the above that the primary potency of *dinim* is in *binah*, which is from the inner chambers,

and therefore the primary quality of sadness and weeping is relevant there exclusively.

Now although a superficial view of the matters mentioned there would seem to imply that this is indeed so, anyone who is somewhat familiar with the words of the holy Zohar in other places, and particularly the Ramak, for whom the gates of the Zohar were wide open, it is surprising that a holy mouth like his could utter such words! For it is known that *binah* itself is the supernal reservoir from which all blessings emerge (as in Zohar *Noach*, 64b; *Terumah* 162a; *Acharei*, 65a; *Va'etchanan* 264b. And examine *Pri Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar haBerachot* chap. 1). For she *binah* is all compassion, albeit that from her side i.e. the left column, which she heads, *dinim* can be aroused as is written in Zohar *Vayikra* 10b and *Acharei* 65a.

But *malchut* is *din* as in Zohar *Noach*, 64b and *Vayikra* 11b, regarding which the Sages stated¹¹ "*dina d'malchuta dina*" which means literally that the law of the state is the law. However *din* also means harsh judgment, as we have been explaining all along, and *malchuta* can mean the state but also alludes to *malchut*. Now all of this is straightforward and is known from the words of all the Kabbalists, and it is true that *binah* is the root specifically of the *gevurot* and she is the 'dark lamp' and the supernal fire mentioned in *parshat Noach* above.

Nevertheless, she *binah* is called only 'pure fire' as explained in the *Idra Rabba* p. 135b because all of the *gevurot* within her are all sweetened and fragrant, as mentioned above. As for what the Zohar states in *parshat Noach*, that sometimes potent *dinim* are also drawn down from her, the Zohar explains in *parshat Acharei* p. 65a that this is only when wicked people change compassion into harsh judgment. Then certainly *din* is empowered greatly, since the sins of those wicked people caused compassion to be transformed into harsh judgments, and those harsh judgments have an impact all the way up to *binah*.

Now it is well known that the loftier the *sefirah* the more superior its qualities are compared with the lower *sefirot*, and incomparably so, as the Rav the Arizal writes in *Eitz Chaim*

Mochin d'Tzelem chap 2 and in *Derushei Abiy'a* chap. 14.

Therefore, when a sin has the effect of revealing *dinim* even in *binah*, due to the wicked transforming compassion into harsh judgment, then certainly *dinim* become very powerful. And this is what the Zohar said in *parshat Noach* 70b – that as long as the supernal fire continues to strengthen, then smoke, which is *din* down below, strengthens the ire and destroys everything. This is because the ire does not abate until judgment is carried out in full. But when *din* down below does not continue to grow more powerful together with the *din* above, then a judgment is made and the *din* abates and does not destroy completely. And for this reason the verse (Genesis 8:21) states, "I will not continue to curse the land because of man." In other words, I will not continue to give additional strength to *din* down below. The quote from the Zohar ends here.

All of this is because the *gevurot* of *binah* are without question much greater than the *gevurot* of *malchut*, comparable to the superiority of *binah* over *malchut*, which is immeasurable. But the *gevurot* of *binah* are all fragrant and sweetened, and therefore the entire reward of the World-to-Come and all the concealed goodness is in *binah*, for she is the World-to-Come, as is known.

But when sin and depravity have the effect of revealing *dinim* even in *binah*, because compassion was transformed into harsh judgment and in place of the flames of compassion complete *din* is produced, may the Merciful One spare us, then certainly the *dinim* become very, very powerful, to the point of destruction, Heaven forbid, just as at the time of the Flood.

Now in truth, the blessed Holy One already made a promise that "I will not continue to curse the earth because of man," and He made a covenant in this regard, the Covenant of the Rainbow. Thus *binah* always remains in her praiseworthy loftiness, which are the flames of compassion, and in her are hidden and concealed all the good of the future and the rewards of the World-to-Come. And this is in the inner chambers above, as we said, regarding which it states, "Might and joy are in His place." Only in the place of *mistarim* therein

is there sadness and weeping for the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, as explained above.

Thus it has been explained that the citations from the Zohar are not a proof at all that there is weeping in the inner chambers (other than with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash), and the words of the Ramak remain very surprising in my view. For the Zohar *Vayikra* 15b states explicitly that sadness is *only* in the outer chambers, and not in the inner chambers, Heaven forbid – meaning the outer chambers of Atzilut, as explained above. It is only up to there that sadness reaches and no further, Heaven forbid. And this is also what the *Idra Rabba* 144a states on the verse (Genesis 6:6) "He was saddened to His heart," see there.

Now this is just like the original and older version of the Talmud explicated by Rabbeinu Chananel, which is the primary version, as the Radvaz and Rabbi Todros in *Otzer HaKavod* state, as noted earlier. As regards the effort the Ramak made to establish Rashi's version, one who examines his words will see that he did not know that the primary version states the opposite, and he surmised that only Rabbi Todros HaLevi and the *Sha'arei Tzedek* found a different version of the Gemara. See *Pardes, Sha'ar* 8:12. And therefore he toiled to establish Rashi's version, which was the original version in his view. But since we have merited the words of Rabbeinu Chananel, and the testimony of the Radvaz that this is the version in the older works, it has become clear that the original version of the Gemara is also found in the words of the Zohar and the Kabbalists. This being so, we need no longer be in doubt about this, and the truth will show the way and will be called the holy way.

Here ends the *Avnei Miluim*

Footnotes

1. *Ze'ir anpin* and *nukvah* 'clothe' Arich from his navel to his feet i.e. forming Arich's *netzach*, *hod* and *yesod*. (Makover)

(Note that these anthropomorphisms are not to be taken literally; they are used only to illustrate concepts that can best be understood through our own human experiences). [↩](#)

2. In *Patach Eliyahu*, Intro. to *Tikunei Zohar*. [↩](#)

3. From the word 'hester' concealment. [↩](#)

4. See *Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar Rapa"ch* chap. 3. [↩](#)

5. The waste and refuse of holiness that constitutes evil. [↩](#)

6. As in the verse (Lamentations 5:17) **עַל זֶה הָיָה דָּוָה לְבָנוּ עַל אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם** [↩](#)

7. The *Dikna* is the metaphoric beard of *Arich Anpin* and possesses thirteen conduits (*tikunei dikna*), which correspond to the Thirteen Attributes of Divine Mercy. [↩](#)

8. These correspond to the partzufim of Abba and Imma. [↩](#)

9. Midrash Tehillim states this succinctly: [↩](#)

10. This is a rabbinical expression meaning that the truth stands at its own witness and does not need further proof. [↩](#)

11. See Tractates *Nedarim* 28a; *Gittin* 10b; *Bava Kama* 113a etc. [↩](#)

Chapter 7 — A continuation of an explanation of how the negative (ra) is flipped to positive (tov)

All that God does is for the good. So what about punishment and Hell?

וְהִנֵּה כָּאֲשֶׁר תִּתְּבוֹנוּ בְּכָל הַדְּבָרִים הַלֵּלוּ הֵנָּה תִּרְאֶה

Now when you contemplate all of these matters you will perceive

עֵמֶק מֵאֲמָרָם ז"ל בְּרִכּוֹת ס' ע"ב כָּל דְּעֵבֵד רַחֲמָנָא לְטָב עֲבֵד

the depth of the Sages' statement (*Berachot* 60b) that "everything the Merciful One did, He did for the good!"

כִּי הָרִי גַם בְּרִיאַת כָּל הָרָע כֻּלּוֹ, וְאֲשֶׁר נִכְשְׁלוּ בוֹ בְּנֵי אָדָם

For even the creation of all evil, in which people have floundered,

וְכָל הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים שֶׁנִּעְשְׂהָ מִזֶּה

and all of the suffering and punishments that were produced thereby,

הֵנָּה עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר קִהַלְתָּ ג': רָאִיתִי אֶת הָעֲנִיּוֹן אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים לִבְנֵי הָאָדָם לְעֲנוֹת בוֹ אֶת הַכֹּל עֲשֵׂה יָפֶה בְּעֵתוֹ

regarding them it states (*Kohelet* 3:10-11): "I have observed the matter that God has given man to answer to – He made everything in its proper time."

כִּי הָרִי רַק בְּזֶה יוֹצֵא כָּל כֹּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

Because it is only in this manner that all the powers of *gevurah* (harshness and constriction) emerge from potential to actual.

וכְּנוּדֵעַ שֶׁהִגְלוּי הָאֲחֵרוֹן שֶׁל כָּל דְּבַר הֵנָּה הוּא רַק כְּאִשֶּׁר מִתְרַחֵק
מִהַמְּנַגְדּוֹ בְּתַכְלִית הָאִפְשָׁרִי

And as is known, the ultimate revelation of anything is only when it distances itself from its opposite to the maximum degree possible,

וּמִתְהַפֵּךְ מִקְצֵה לְקֵצֵה וְהֵם הָעֲנִין אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים לִבְנֵי הָאָדָם
לְעֲנוֹת בּוֹ

and it is transformed from one extreme to the other. This is the meaning of 'the matter that God has given man to answer to'

וְעַל זֶה אָמַר אֵת הַכֹּל עָשָׂה יָפָה בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי הֵם כָּלָם לְתַכְלִית טוֹב
וְיָפָה

And it is in this regard that the verse states, 'He made everything in its proper time' for all of these matters are for the sake of the good and the proper,

אֲלֹא שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הַכֹּל בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי כָל כְּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת

although everything is made in its time since all the powers of *gevurah* and constriction

הַמִּסְדִּים לְמַצִּיאת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה וּלְכָל הַנְּהַגָתָם

that established the existence of the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, and how they are conducted,

הֵנָּה הֵם בְּהִז' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהֶאֱצִילוֹת שֶׁהֵם הִז' כְּפוֹלוֹת בַּג"ד כִּפְר"ת
שֶׁהֵם בְּרָפָה וְדָגֵשׁ

are located in the seven lower *sefirot* of Atzilut, which are the seven double letters בַּג"ד כִּפְר"ת meaning those letters which take two forms – soft and hard i.e. they are sometimes written with a *dagesh*, and sometimes without a *dagesh*.¹

וּמֵהֶם הוּא כָּל הַתְּמוּרוֹת כַּמ"ש בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה פ"ד

All of the *temurot* – a quality and its opposite, such as life and death, peace and war (or evil), wealth and poverty – **come from there, as its states in *Sefer Yetzirah* chapter 4, *mishnah* 1.**

וְעִקְרָם דְּהַז"ת הוּא ו' שְׁהֵם חֲג"ת נה"י וְהֵם עֲצָמִים חֲסָדִים

Now the main *sefirot* of the seven lower *sefirot* are six – *chesed*, *gevurah*, *tiferet*, *netzach*, *hod*, *yesod* – and they themselves are aspects of *chesed* – these are the six *sefirot* of *ze'ir anpin*, which is characterized primarily by *chesed* – kindness and compassion – whereas the seventh *sefirah*, *malchut*, is characterized by *din*, as the *Baal HaLeshem* goes on to explain...

וּבְהַמְלָכוֹת דְּכ"א שֵׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת שְׁבָהֶם

And the *malchut* of each of them of the *sefirot* mentioned is the aspect of *gevurot* constrictions or severities in them,

וּכְלָלוֹת הַמְּלָכוֹת כָּלָם הִיא הַז' וְהִיא רִאשִׁית דְּנִבְרָאִים

and the *malchut* of all of them in general is the seventh *sefirah*, which is the beginning of created beings.

כִּי בָּהּ הוּא הַשֵּׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּעֶשְׂרֵה מְאָמוֹת

For in her in *malchut* is the root of all existence of the Worlds that were created by the **Ten Utterances**,² as the *Tikunei Zohar***³** states: "*malchut* is the mouth" from whence the Ten Utterances issue forth.

וְעַל יָדָהּ הֵם מְתִנְהָגִים. וְהֵם הַשֵּׁשֶׁת אֲלָפִים שָׁנָה דְּמִשְׁךְ יְמֵי עוֹלָם

And by her *malchut* they are conducted or managed. And these are also the six thousand years that the world endures,⁴

כִּי אֵלּוּ הוּ"ק הֵם הַשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְּרִאשִׁית כִּמ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק בְּרִאשִׁית ל"א
סע"א

because these six edges the six *sefirot* that define *ze'ir anpin* are the six days of Creation, as the *Zohar Bereishit* 30a explains.

וַנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם דְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהוּ"ק כַּמִּשְׁשָׁם כ"ב א' וְכ"ט, ב.

Thus the world was created via the *malchut* of each of these six the six *sefirot* of *ze'ir anpin*, as the *Zohar* *ibid* writes p. 25a; 29b.

וְכֹן מִתְנַהֵּג כָּל אֱלֹף בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּכ"א

And similarly the world is conducted or managed – each millennium by the *malchut* of that millennium.

כִּי אֱלֹף הָרִאשׁוֹן הָיָה בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהַחֲסֵד וְאֱלֹף הַשְּׁנִי בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהַגְבוּרָה

The first millennium was that of *malchut* of *chesed*; the second millennium the *malchut* of *gevurah*;

הַג' בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהַת"ת וְכֹן כו' עַד עֵתָה שֶׁהוּא בְּהַמְלָכוֹת בְּהִיסוּד

the third millennium the *malchut* of *tiferet*, and so on, until this moment, which is the *malchut* of *yesod*.

וְע"י הַנְּהֻגָת כָּל אֱלֹף בְּכָל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת כֻּלָּם דִּנְעָשָׂה בּוֹ

And through the way each millennium is conducted in all of the events that take place in that millennium

הִנֵּה יוֹצְאִים עִי"ז כָּל הַגְבוּרוֹת דְּאוֹתָהּ הַמְלָכוֹת מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

all the *gevurot* of that *malchut* emerge from potential to actual.

וְהַמְלָכוֹת הִנֵּה הִיא נִקְרָאת עֵת [כַּמִּשְׁשָׁם בְּזוּה"ק וַיֵּרָא קַע"ז ע"ב
מִקְצָ קצ"ח א' ופ' תְּרוּמָה קנ"ה ב']

Now *malchut* is called '*et*' – a period of time – [as the *Zohar* states in *Vayera* 177b; *Miketz* 198a; *Terumah* 155b]

כִּי בָּהּ וְעַל יָדָהּ יוֹצֵא וְנִעְשָׂה כָּל דְּבַר בְּעֵתוֹ וּבְזִמְנוֹ (ע' זוֹהַר וַיֵּצֵא
קנ"ג א')

because in it and through it *malchut* every event takes place *b'ito* – in its proper time and period.

וְהוּא שֶׁאָמַר הַפֶּתוּב כִּי אֶת הָעֲנִין אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים לִבְנֵי הָאָדָם
לְעֲנוֹת בּוֹ

This is the meaning then of the verse, "I have observed the matter that God has given man to answer to..."

שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר הֵם נֶגְדַת דַּעַת הָאָדָם

these are all the events that oppose man's opinion of how things should be.

שֶׁרָצוֹנוֹ וְנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מִשְׁתּוֹמָמֶת עֲלֵיהֶם עַל מֶה עָשָׂה אֱלֹהִים
כָּכָה

His will, and indeed his soul, are astonished by those events – and he asks why did God do this?

הִנֵּה אֶת הַכֹּל עָשָׂה יָפָה בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי כֻלָּם הֵם לְהוֹצִיא אֶת גְּבוּרוֹת
הַמַּלְכוּת

But, the verse declares, "He made everything in its proper time" for all these events are intended to bring out the *gevurot* of *malchut*

מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעַל וְשִׁיּוּצָאֵם כֻּלָּם בְּסִבַּת וְגֵרָם הָאָדָם דּוֹקָא

from potential to actual, and that their emergence is due to, and by the agency of, man explicitly.

וְהוּא מִשּׁוּם כִּי סוֹפֵן שֶׁל הַגְּבוּרוֹת הוּא לְהַעֲשׂוֹת בָּהֶם כָּל טוֹב
הַצָּפוֹן

And the reason for this is because the ultimate goal of the *gevurot* is to bring out all the hidden good in them.

וְלָכֵן הֵגֵם שֶׁכֶּאֱשֶׁר הֵם יוֹצְאִים וּמִתְגַּלִּים ע"י חֲטָא וְעוֹן הִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה
בָּהֶם הַטְּמָאָה וְהָרַע

And therefore, even though they the *gevurot* emerge and are revealed by means of transgression and sin, producing

impurity and evil,

אך כל טמאה ורע הנה נתהפך תכף לענש

all the impurity and evil immediately become transformed into punishment.

וכשנעשה הענש מהבעל הרע שבו ונשארו הגבורות טהורים
ונקיים

Now when the punishment of the perpetrator of evil is accomplished, the *gevurot* remain pure and unsullied

והם נכללים תכף בשרשם שבקדש הקדשים

and they immediately merge into their source in the Holy of Holies,

ומתבסמים ונמתקים ונעשים הם לעדן גן אלהים

where they are made fragrant and are sweetened, and become the delightful Garden of the Lord

לצמח בהם כל נטע שעשועים וכל טוב הצפון לעתיד לבוא

in which every planting of delight flourishes, and all the goodness is hidden away for the Time to Come.

ונמצא כי באשר יכלה הזמהא והרע שהוא אחר שנעשה הענש

So it turns out that when the pollution and the evil are dispelled, which is after the punishment has been administered,

ונצרך ונתלבן העושה עברה מכל חלאתו וצחנתו

and the sinner has been refined and purified of all his infection and stench,

הנה יתהפכו כל אותן הכחות דתקף הדינין אשר נעשה הענש
בהם

then all of those powers of intense *din* will be transformed,
after the punishment has been administered,

הִנֵּה יִתְהַפְּכוּ הֵם עֲצָמָן לְגִבּוּרֹת מִמִּתְקִים וַיְהִיו כָּלָם קָדָשׁ לַה'

and they themselves will be transformed into sweetened
gevurot and will all be sanctified to God.

וְהֵם עֲצָמָן יִהְיוּ הַסִּבָּה לְסִבֵּב עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים
לְבוֹא

Thus they themselves are the indirect cause of promises for the
future becoming actualized –

לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

in the Messianic era and in the life of the World to Come.

וְזֶהוּ ג' כ סוּד הַכְּתוּב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהִנֵּה טוֹב
מְאֹד

This is also the mystical explanation of the verse (Genesis 1:31)
"And God perused all that He had made and indeed it was
very good."

וְאָמְרוּ רַז"ל בַּב"ר פ'ה מֵאֲדָז זֶה מִדַּת יְסוּרִין, מֵאֲדָז זֶה גִּיהֶנָּם מֵאֲדָז זֶה
מַלְאֲךְ הַמָּוֶת כו' ע"ש

Regarding this verse our Sages declared in Bereishit Rabba 5 –
the word *me'od* (= very) is the aspect of suffering, *me'od* is
Gehinnom, *me'od* is the angel of death!

וְהוּא כִּי כָּל אֱלוֹ הָעֲנִיָּנִים כָּלָם הָרִי הֵם מִתְקָר הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים

This is because all of these concepts just mentioned are from the
intensity of harsh *dinim*,

אֲבָל בְּאֲשֶׁר יִתְבַּטֵּל הָרַע וַיִּמָּתְקוּ כָּל הַדִּינִים כָּלָם

but when evil is nullified and all the *dinim* are sweetened,

הרי יתהפכו כל הסבות דהענשים שהם הגבורות והדינים היותר גדולים

then all the origins of punishments, which are the greatest *gevurot* and *dinim*, will be transformed

להיות הם עצמן הסבה לכל טוב העתיד

and will themselves be the origin of all good in the future,

וכל מה שהוא עתה סבה לענש יותר גדול יהיה הוא אז סבה לטובה יותר גדולה

so that anything that is currently a cause of the harshest punishment will then become the cause of the greatest good.

והוא ענין טהרתו של גיהנום כי יתהפך הוא עצמו לגן עדן

This is the concept of the purification of Gehinnom, which will itself be transformed into the Garden of Eden,

ע"י שימתקו ויתבסמו כל הדינים שבו ויתהפכו כלם לדינים דקדשא

by virtue of all the *dinim* therein becoming sweetened and fragrant, so that they are all transformed into holy *dinim*

ולשלהובין דרחימו מישראל לאביהם שבשמים ית"ש.

and flames of love from the Jewish People towards their Father in Heaven, may His Name be blessed.

ואין להרהר כי איזה תכלית יהיה מכל ענשי גיהנום אשר לרשעי עובדי אלילים

One should not mull over the purpose of all the punishments in Gehinnom for wicked idolaters – the answer the author gives, after quoting and explaining several verses and insights of the Sages, is that their purpose is for the sake of Israel.

אשר עליהם נאמר (איוב יב, כג) משגיא לגוים ויאבדם

Regarding them the idolaters it states (Job 12:23), "He exalts nations and then destroys them"

וְלִהְשֹׁמֶד עָדִי עַד (תהלים צב, ח) אֶךְ דַּע כִּי הוּא ג' כ לְצַרְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

and (Psalms 92:8) "When the wicked bloom like grass... **it is to destroy them forever,**"

וּבְסוֹד (איוב כז, יז) יָכִין [רָשָׁע] וְצַדִּיק יִלְבֹּשׁ

and according to the mystical explanation of (Job 27:17), "he [a wicked person] may prepare it, but a righteous person will wear it."

וְהוּא ג' כ בְּסוֹד מ"ש יְבָמוֹת ס"ג א' אֵין פְּרַעְנוֹת בָּא לְעוֹלָם אֶלָּא
בְּשִׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל

This is also the mystical secret of the statement of our Sages in Tractate Yevamot 63a: Punishments descend upon the world for the sake of Israel i.e. the Jewish People –

כִּי כָּל הַטּוֹב וְכָל הַתְּמוּרוֹת הוּא הַכֹּל רַק לְצַרְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

for all good and its opposite is all for the sake of Israel,

וּכְמ"ש בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּשִׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ רֵאשִׁית וּבְשִׁבִילֵם נִבְרָאוּ
הַכֹּל

as it states Genesis 1:1 "In the beginning..." which the Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishit 3 interprets as for the sake of Israel, who are called 'the beginning' and everything was created for their sake,

וְכָל מָה שֶׁיְסוּבֵב לְטוֹבָה מִכָּל הַתְּמוּרוֹת כָּלֵם וּמִכָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלֵם

as is everything that evolves for the good, from all the qualities and their opposites, and from all the punishments.

וְע"פ מָה שֶׁאֱמָרָם הוּא הַכֹּל רַק לְצַרְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי בְּשִׁבִילֵם נִבְרָא
הָעוֹלָם וּבְשִׁבִילֵם נַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל

This is according to what our Sages declared – that everything is only for the sake of Israel, because for them was the world created, and everything was made.

וְכָל רָשָׁעִי עֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הֵם תּוֹלְדוֹת דֶּהֱרַע עֲצָמוֹ

Whereas all the wicked idolaters are the products of evil itself,

כִּי אִלּוּלָא מְצִיאוֹת הָרַע לֹא הָיוּ הֵם כָּלָם בְּמְצִיאוֹת כָּלָל

for if evil did not exist they would not exist at all.

וְהֵם מְרַכָּבָה לְהַשְׁמָ' אֶל אַחֵר וּבְנֵינּוּ שְׁבַעוּה"ז, ע' בְּתִיקוּנִים תְּקוּן כ"ד

They are the vehicle for the unholy, 'the other gods' and their entire supporting structure in this world. See *Tikunei Zohar*, *Tikun 24*,

וּבְדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב דְּרוֹשׁ ד' עֲנָךְ ד'

and our commentary in the work *Drushei Olam HaTohu* part 2, 4:4.

וְהֵם ע"ד שִׁישְׁרָאֵל הֵם מְרַכָּבָה לְהַשְׁכִּינָה וּמְצִיאוֹתָהּ וּבְנֵינָהּ בַּעוּה"ז

Just like Israel, who are the vehicle for the *Shechinah* the Divine Presence as manifested in *malchut* and its manifestation and all the structures thereof in this world,

וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם דִּישְׁרָאֵל הוּא הַכֹּל בָּהּ כִּי הֵם גּוּפָהּ דִּילָהּ אַבְרָם דִּילָהּ

so that all matters concerning Israel are all in her in *malchut* the *Shechinah* for we are her body and limbs i.e. the practical manifestation of the *Shechinah*,

כֵּן הוּא עַד"ז כִּי כָּל עֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הֵם גּוּפָא דְּסַמ' אֶל אַחֵר אַבְרָם דִּילָהּ

so too, are they – the idolaters – who are the body and limbs of the unholy, 'the other gods.'

וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם הוּא הַכֹּל בּוֹ וַיִּתְּבֵטְלוּ הֵם בְּבִטּוּלוֹ לְגַמְרִי

And all matters concerning them are in it in the unholy vehicle, and with its demise they too will be completely nullified.

וְכָל מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּסִבַּת מְצִיאוֹתָיו הוּא סִבַּת מְצִיאוֹתָם

And everything that we said regarding the cause of its existence is also the cause of their existence.

וְכֵן כָּל מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּהִכָּרַח בְּטוּלוֹ מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֵשׁ הַהִפְסָד
וְהָאֲבִדוֹן הַחֲלָטִי,

And everything we mentioned regarding the necessity of its nullification, since it is the source of absolute destruction and total annihilation,

הוּא הִכָּרַח בְּטוּלָם, וּמִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם מַעְצָם הָרַע

this necessitates their nullification, since they derive from the essence of evil,

אֲשֶׁר כָּל עֲצֻמוֹתָם הוּא לְהָרַע וְלְהָרִס וּלְחַבֵּל

and their entire essence is to harm and destroy and damage.

וְכָל קִיּוּמָם בְּזִמּוֹ קִיּוּמָם הֵנָּה הוּא רַק ע"י תְּמִצִּית הָאֶרֶץ הַקְדוּשָׁה
שֶׁמֵאִיר עֲלֵיהֶם מִסְבִּיב

And their entire existence, while they exist, is only from a smidgeon of the radiance of holiness that illuminates them from without,

וּבִסּוֹד (יחזקאל א, ד) וְנִגְהָ לּוֹ סְבִיב כַּמ"ש בְּזוּה"ק יִתְרוֹ ס"ט ע"א

as in the mystical interpretation of the verse in Ezekiel (1:4), "a glow all around it" in *Zohar Yitro* 69a.

וְהָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ מִצִּיאוֹתָם עַד שִׁיגְמָר לְצֹאת כָּל כְּחוֹת דִּתּוּקָה הַדְּנִים
קָשִׁים

**Now they will continue to exist until all the powers of intense
dinim have emerged,**

כָּל מָה שִׁישׁ בָּהֶם בְּתַכְלִית הַיּוֹתֵר אֲפָשָׁרִי

**and all that is in them that serves this purpose to the maximum
possible degree.**

אָבֵל אַחֵר שִׁיגְמָרוּ לְצֹאת לְגַמְרֵי הֵנָּה יִסְתַּלַּק מֵעֲלֵיהֶם סוּד הַגָּגָה
הַנִּזְכָּר

**But as soon as it has all emerged completely their secret
protection will be withdrawn, as mentioned,**

וְאִזּוֹ יִתְהַפֵּךְ כָּל הָרַע בְּלוֹ לָאֵשׁ שׁוֹרֵף וַיִּתְקַיֵּם אִזּוֹ עָלָיו

**and then all of the evil will become a consuming fire, and there
will be fulfilled upon them,**

וְעַל כָּל תּוֹלְדוֹתָיו שֶׁהֵם כָּל מְרַכְּבָתוֹ וּבְנֵינּוֹ אֲשֶׁר בַּעוּה"ז

**and upon all of their descendants, which are its vehicle and
structures in this world,**

מִקְרָא שֶׁכְּתוּב מִלֵּאכִי (ג יט-כ) 'הֵנָּה הַיּוֹם בָּא בֵּיעַר כְּתַנּוּר וְהָיוּ כָּל
יָדִים וְכָל עֲשֵׂה רָשָׁעָה קֵשׁ וְלֹהֵט אוֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבֹּא... אֲשֶׁר לֹא יַעֲזֹב
לָהֶם שְׂרֵשׁ וְעֵנָף. וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם יְרֵאִי שְׁמִי שֶׁמֶשׁ צִדְקָה וּמִרְפָּא
בְּכַנְפֶיהָ כו'

**the verse (Malachi 3:19-20) that states, "For behold the day is
coming, burning like an oven, when all the wicked people and
all the evildoers will be like straw; and that coming day will
burn them up... so that it will not leave them a root or branch.
But a sun of righteousness will shine for you who fear My
Name, with healing in its rays..."**

כי יצטרפו ויתלבנו אותן התקף דינים קשים ויכללו בשרשם ימתקו
ויתבסמו

The intense harsh *dinim* will be refine and purify them, and they will merge into their source and become sweetened and fragrant,

ויעשו כלם לשלהובין דרחימו לישראל

and all of them will become flames of love for Israel.

זהו שאמרו (נדרים ח, ב) רשעים נדונין בה וצדיקים מתרפאין בה
ולא עוד אלא שמתעדנין בה:

This is what Tractate *Nedarim* 8b states in this regard: The wicked will be judged thereby and the righteous will be healed thereby; furthermore they will be refined thereby.

ומה שמתהפך הרע לאש שורף ולסער מתחולל הנה הוא נוהג
באמת תמיד גם עתה

That evil will be transformed into a burning fire and 'a tempest that seeks rest – devolving upon the head of the wicked' (Jeremiah 23:19) is always going on, even now,

כי מזה הוא כל הרעות והתלאות וכל הענשים וכנ"ל

because from there all the bad things, the suffering and all the punishments, derive.

אלא שעתה הנה יוצא תאור כחות חדשים מתקף הדינים קשים

Only that now new powers appear from the intensity of harsh *dinim*,

ומתחלפים תולדותיהם תמיד כי הראשונים מתבטלים ונמתקים

and their progeny constantly changes, because the earlier ones become nullified and are sweetened,

ומתחדשים אחרים תחתיהם וכן מתחלף כל רגע בכחות חדשים

and other ones are generated anew instead of them, and they are also constantly replenished with new powers.

עד שיגמרו לצאת כלם לעת קץ הימין שהוא בזמן תחיית המתים

This will continue until all of them have finished emerging – at the end of days, which is the time of the Resurrection of the Dead,

ואז יתבטל הזהמא מכל וכל (כמ"ש בפ' יתרו ס"ט ב' ובכ"מ)

and then the pollution will be nullified completely (as it states in *Zohar Yitro 69b et al*).

ואז יתגלו ויתפשטו למטה כל המתקת הגבורות כלם

And then all the sweetened *gevurot* will be revealed and will spread out below.

שנמתקו מכל התלאות והענשים אשר בעוה"ז ובעולם הנפשות

They became sweetened from all the suffering and the punishments that accrue in this world, and in the World of Souls,

מעת החטא דעהד"ע עד אותה הזמן דתחה"מ

from the time of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge until the time of the Resurrection of the Dead.

ויאירו כלם בכל טוב הצפון לכל מי אשר בשם ישראל יבנה

All of them will shine forth with all the hidden goodness to all those who are called by the name of Israel,

וכמ"ש בישעיה (מד, ג-ה) אצק רוחי על זרעך וברכתי על צאצאריך
וצמחו כו'

as the verse states in Isaiah (44, 3-5), "... I shall pour out My spirit upon your offspring and My blessing upon your progeny, and they shall flourish...

זֶה יֹאמֵר לֵה' אֲנִי וְזֶה יִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם יַעֲקֹב וְזֶה יִכְתֹּב יָדוֹ לֵה' וּבְשֵׁם
יִשְׂרָאֵל יִכְנֶה

This one will say, 'I am God's', and the other one will call himself by the name of Jacob; this one will sign his allegiance to God and adopt the name of Israel."

כִּי יִזְכּוּ כ"א לְפִי מִדְרָגָתוֹ אֲבָל עכ"פ הוּא כִּי יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם:

For each one will merit according to his level, but in any event all of Israel will be meritorious.

וְכָל מָה שְׁאִמְרָנוּ הִנֵּה הוּא עֲנִין מָה שְׁאִמְרוּ רז"ל בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּא
וְתַנְחוּמָא ס"פ בְּשַׁלַּח (ע' תַּנְחוּמָא שָׁם ס' כ"ג כ"ד)

Everything that we stated above is the same concept propounded by the Sages in Midrash Rabba and Tanchuma end of *Beshalach* (see Tanchuma ad loc 23, 24)

כִּי מִדַּת הַקֶּבֶד"ה הוּא אֵינוֹ כְּמִדַּת בֶּשֶׁר וְדָם

that the way of the Holy One, blessed is He is not like the ways of flesh and blood

כִּי מִדַּת בֶּשֶׁר וְדָם מַכָּה בְּאֶזְמֵל וּמִרְפָּא בְּרִטָּה

– for the way of flesh and blood is that a wound caused by a knife is healed with ointment,

אֲבָל מִדַּת הַקֶּבֶד"ה בְּמָה שֶׁהוּא מַכָּה בּוֹ הוּא מִרְפָּא

whereas the way of the blessed Holy One is to heal with that very thing that wounded.

וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שְׁאִמְרָנוּ כִּי כָּל אוֹתָן הַסְּבוֹת עֲצָמוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵהֶם הוּא כָּל
הַרְעוֹת

As we said – all of those factors themselves that produced all the evil,

וְהַצָּרוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם הֵנָּה הֵם עֲצָמָן יִהְיוּ הַסְּבוֹת לְהַעֲשׂוֹת עַל
יְדֵיהֶם כָּל טוֹב הָעָתִיד

and all the suffering and punishments, they themselves are the factors by which all good in the future will come about.

וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ מ"ש רז"ל בִּלְקוּט תְּהִלִּים ה' סוּף רִמְזוֹ תַּרְכָּח

And so too is expounded by our Rabbis' statement in *Yalkut Tehillim* 5, end of allusion 628:

אַל תִּשְׂמַחֵי אִיבְתִּי לִי כִּי נָפַלְתִּי קָמְתִּי כִּי [עַל הַפְּסוֹק מִיכָה ז, ח]
אֲשֶׁב בַּחֹשֶׁךְ ה' אֹר לִי

on the verse [Michah 7:8] "Do not rejoice over me, my enemy, for though I fell, I will rise! Though I sit in darkness, God is a light for me!"

אֲלוּלָא שְׁנַפְלְתִּי לֹא קָמְתִּי אֲלוּלָא שִׁישְׁבְּתִי בַּחֹשֶׁךְ לֹא הָיָה אֹר לִי

The Rabbis explain: were it not that I fell, I would not rise; were it not that I sit in darkness, He would not be a light for me!

וְהוּא ג"כ ע"פ מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ כִּי תוֹצְאוֹת כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת כֻּלָּם

This accords with what we said – that the result of all the *gevurot*

עַל תְּכִלִּית הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי שֶׁבָּהֶם הֵנָּה הוּא וְכֵן בְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁהֵם
מְסַלְקִים מִהַחֲסָדִים לְגַמְרֵי

that serve the ultimate purpose possible for them – is only when they completely withdraw from the powers of kindness (*chasadim*).

וְכֵן"ל שֶׁהַגְּלוּי הָאֲחֵרוֹן שֶׁל כָּל דָּבָר, ר"ל הַגְּלוּי הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי שֶׁבוֹ,

As we said earlier – the ultimate revelation of anything, i.e. the maximum revelation possible for that thing,

הוא דוקא רק באשר שמתרחק מהמגדו בתכלית האפשרי
ומתהפך מקצה לקצה

is specifically only when its opposite withdraws to the maximum possible and it becomes transformed from one extreme to the other.

והרי אי אפשר להגברות לצאת בכל כחותיהם

Thus it is impossible for the *gevurot* to emerge in all their strength

אלא רק ע"י שנתגלו מתחילה בתקף דינים קשים בתכלית
האפשרי

unless they emerge initially with all the intensity of severe *dinim* to the maximum extent possible.

ונברא ע"ז כל הרע ותולדותיו אשר כל תכונתו הוא להרס ולחבל

Thus is created all the evil and its progeny, the nature of which is to destroy and damage,

והוא החטא והענש ובזה יוצא כל כחו ונפסד ומתבטל

and this is the sin and its punishment. In this manner all of its power emerges and is terminated and nullified,

כי כל עצמו הוא רק כח השחטה וההעדר עד שנעדר הוא גופה

since its entire being is only the power of destruction and deficiency, until it itself becomes nonexistent.

ולא יהיה מעתה שום רע כלל לא חטא ולא ענש ולא שום העדר
כלל

From then on there will be no evil at all, no sin and no punishment and no deficiency at all,

וַיִּשְׁאָרוּ כַּחוֹת כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת טְהוֹרִים וְנִקְיִים מִכָּל סִיג וּפְסָלָת

and the powers of all the *gevurot* will remain pure and unsullied by any dross or waste.

וַיִּכְלְלוּ בְּשֶׁרֶשׁן לִהְיוֹת בְּתַכְלִית הַמַּתּוֹק וְהַבְּסוּם

They the *gevurot* will merge into their root to become absolutely sweetened and aromatic,

וְאִזּוּ יִתְגַּלֶּה וְיַעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל טוֹב הָעָתִיד שֶׁהוּא רַק ע"י הַגְּבוּרוֹת
כַּנ"ל

and then they will reveal and fashion all the goodness of the future, which is only by way of the *gevurot* as explained above.

וְהָרִי כ"ז נַעֲשֶׂה רַק ע"י שִׁיּוּצָאוּ מִתְחִילָה בְּתַקָּף דִּינִים קָשִׁים

Thus all of this comes about only when the intensity of severe *dinim* emerge from the outset,

שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַמַּאֲרָעוֹת כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר מַחֲטֵא עַץ הַדַּעַת וְהַלָּאָה

which are all of the negative events from the sin of the Tree of Knowledge and from then on,

וּע"י כָּל הַתְּלָאוֹת כָּלָם שְׁבַה־עוֹה"ז וְכָל עֲנָשֵׁי גֵיהֶנֶם

and by way of all the suffering in this world, and the punishments in Gehinnom.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אֱלֹלָא נִפְלַתִּי לֹא קָמַתִּי אֱלֹלָא שִׁישְׁבֵּתִי בְּחֹשֶׁךְ לֹא
הָיָה אוֹר לִי:

This then is what they the Rabbis said – 'were it not that I fell, I would not rise; were it not that I sit in darkness, He would not be a light for me!'

וּמִמִּילָא הוּא כִּי מִגְדַּל הָרַע וְרַבּוּי תּוֹלְדוֹתָיו וּמִגְדַּל הַצָּרוֹת וְרַבּוּי
הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים

From the tremendous evil and the multitude of its progeny, and from the great troubles and piles of suffering and punishments, it follows automatically

הרי אפשר להבין קצת ערך גדל ורבוי הטובה דלעתיד

that we have some possibility of understanding a little of the quality and quantity of goodness that will be revealed in the future,

כי הרי כל מה שנעשה מהרע ותלאותיו הנה הוא רק בסבות
הדינים קשים

since all the evil and suffering created is only due to the harsh *dinim*

שהם מתולדות כחות הגבורות לבד.

that are only the product of the powers of *gevurot*.

אבל מה שיעשה מכ"ז בטוב העתיד הרי הוא ע"י המתקנות
הגבורות בחסדים

But the future goodness that will be produced from all this is due to the sweetening of the *gevurot* by the powers of kindness (*chasadim*)

אשר למעלה למעלה עד אין קו ותכלית

which are infinitely superior to the *gevurot*.

והרי יהיה הטוב העתיד ע"י החסדים והגבורות יחד:

Thus the future good is by way of *chasadim* and *gevurot* together.

והוא מה שאמרו סוטה י"א א' כי לעולם מדה טובה מרבה ממדת
פרענות

This is what it states in Tractate *Sotah* 11a – that the attribute of benevolence is greater than the attribute of punishment.

וּבְתוֹסַפְתָּא סוּטָה רפ"ד מְבַאֵר כִּי מִדָּה טוֹבָה מְרֻבָּה עַל אַחַת חֲמִשׁ
מֵאוֹת ע"ש

And the *Tosefta Sotah* beginning of chapter 4 explains that the attribute of benevolence is 500 times greater. See there.

וְהוּא בְּסוּד הָה' גְּלוּיִם הַכּוֹלְלִים שְׁבָאֲרֵנוּ לְעִיל שְׁעַר ד' פ"ג

This is the mystical secret of the five general levels of revelation we explained in Sha'ar 4 chapter 3 – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, *Adam Kadmon*, *Atzilut* and *BiY"A* (*Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* which are counted as a single unit).⁵

שְׁכֵלָם הֵם בְּגִלּוּי אֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש וְהֵם כֻּלָּם בְּהַמְתִּיקַת הַגְּבוּרוֹת

All of them are revelations of the light of His blessed holiness, and they are all by way of the sweetening of *gevurot*.⁶

וְהֵם לְמַעֲלָה עַל כָּל תִּקְוָה הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע
וְעִבְרָה הוּא רַק בְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה

And they transcend all the intensity of the harsh *dinim* that are manifested in the Worlds of *BiY"A*, and only in *Asiyah* is there transgression.

אֲבָל גְּלוּי מִדַּת טוֹבוֹ ית"ש הוּא בְּאוֹר כָּל הָה' גִּילּוּיִים הַעֲלִיוֹנִים

But the revelation of His blessed attribute of goodness is in the light of all five of those supernal revelations,

וּכ"א הוּא כָּלּוּל מִמָּאָה וְהֵם ה' מֵאוֹת אֲשֶׁר מִדָּה טוֹבָה מְרֻבָּה

each of which comprises one hundred levels – thus the 500 times greater that the attribute of benevolence is than the attribute of punishment.

כִּי כָּל הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהַעֲנָשִׁים הֵרִי הֵם רַק מִהַדִּינִים קָשִׁים הַנַּעֲשִׂים
מִכַּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת לְבַד

For all of the suffering and punishment derive only from the harsh *dinim* that are formed from the *gevurot* alone,

הַמִּתְגַּלִּים לְמִטָּה מִכָּל הָה' גְּלוּיִם הֵנּוּ

and these are revealed only below all of the five revelations mentioned,

אָבֵל כָּל הַטּוֹבָה דִּלְעִתִּיד הֵנָּה הֵם בְּכָל הָה' גִּילִים הָעֲלִיוֹנִים כָּלָם

whereas the benevolence of the future is manifested in all of the five supernal revelations,

אֲשֶׁר הֵם בָּאוּר קִדְשֵׁת כָּל הַחֲסָדִים הָעֲלִיוֹנִים וְכָל הַגְּבוּרוֹת
הָעֲלִיוֹנִים

since they are in the holy light of the supernal *chasadim*, and all of the sweetened supernal *gevurot*

שְׁנֵיהֶם יַחַד וְהֵם הַטּוֹבָה הַכָּלּוּל מָה' מֵאוֹת (500)

both of them together – forming the inclusive goodness that comprises 500 aspects.

שֶׁהֵם הָה' גְּלוּיִם הֵנּוּ אֲשֶׁר כ"א הוּא כָּלּוּל מִמֵּאָה

These are the five revelations mentioned, each of which comprises 100 aspects.

וְהוּא ג"כ סוּד עֵץ הַחַיִּים מִהֶלֶךְ ת"ק שָׁנָה שְׁאֶמְרוּ בִּבְרָאשִׁית רַבָּא פ'
ט"ו סִימָן ה'

And this is also the mystical secret of the Tree of Life, the measure of which is 500 years, as stated in *Bereishit Rabba* 15:5.

וְלִעֲתִיד יַחְזוֹר הָעֵץ הַדֹּעַת אֲשֶׁר מִשָּׁם הוּא עֵתָה שֶׁרֶשׁ הָרַע וַיִּנְקֶתוּ

In the future, the Tree of Knowledge, which is the root of evil and its sustenance at this time,

יַחְזוֹר הוּא ג"כ לְהָעֵץ הַחַיִּים וַיַּעֲשׂוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם לְאַחַד

will return to also be the Tree of Life, and both of them will become one,

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכְּתִיבְנוּ בְּזֶה בְּאַרְכָּה בְּסֵפֶר הַרְמ"ה ח"ב

as we have written about at length in the *Sefer Derushei Olam HaTohu* part 2.

וְדִי בְּזֶה כְּעֵת שֶׁלֹּא לְצֹאת מִן הָעֵינִין יוֹתֵר מִדָּאִי.

Let this now suffice, lest we stray too far from the main subject.

Footnotes

1. Specifically, when any of these letters appear at the beginning of a word they take a *dagesh*, and in the middle of a word – after a *sheva nach* (a resting *sheva*). [↩](#)
2. See Pirkei Avot 5:1 – בעשרה מאמרות נברא העולם [↩](#)
3. Intro, ד"ה פתח אליהו [↩](#)
4. Sanhedrin 97a. [↩](#)
5. See Makover. [↩](#)
6. Makover notes that the first four revelations mentioned are sweetened in their root. Only when they emerge into *BiY"A* is there any admixture of evil. [↩](#)

Chapter 8 — The purpose of punishment (cause and effect) and rectification (balancing) via the power of the tsadikim (righteous people)

וְהָיָה נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ מִכָּל דְּבָרֵינוּ כִּי הָעֲנָשִׁים גּוֹפָה הֵם עֲצָמוֹ הַסִּבָּה
לְכָל הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

Thus it has been clarified for us from all the above that the punishments themselves are the reason for all the promises of the future,

כִּי כְמוֹ שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת

because just like Torah and the mitzvos

הֵנָּה נַעֲשׂוּ הֵם גּוֹפָה הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּכָל טוֹב הָעֲתִיד וְכַמ"ש שֶׁכָּבֵר מִצְוָה
מִצְוָה

themselves become the actuality of good in the future, as the Sages declared "the reward of a mitzvah is the mitzvah" –

שֶׁהַמִּצְוָה גּוֹפָה הִיא עֵצָם הַשָּׂכָר שֶׁהִיא עֲצָמָהּ הֵנָּה הִיא הַיּוֹ
וְהַנֶּעֱמָ הַנִּצְחִי

that the mitzvah itself is the essence of the reward, since it itself is eternal radiance and pleasantness,

שֶׁאֵין לְמַעֲלָה מִזֶּה כּוֹ יֶסֶד הַקֵּב"ה פְּעֻלוֹת וְתִקּוּנִים

and there is nothing that surpasses this, for that is the foundation that the blessed Holy One laid regarding activities in the realm of Torah and mitzvot and rectifications (Tikunim) –

לְסַבֵּב אֶת הַשְּׂאֵרֶת הַנִּצְחִי וְטוֹב הַצָּפוֹן גַּם לְנַפֵּשׁ הַחוּטָאִת

that they bring about eternal life and reveal the hidden good, even for a sinning soul.

וְהוּא ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבֵא כִּי הֵם נוֹבְעִים וּבָאִים ג"כ רַק מִהַתּוֹרָה

And this is by way of all the punishments in this world and the next that also flow and emerge exclusively from the Torah.

כִּי כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים הֵנָּה הֵם בַּמִּדָּה וּבַמִּשְׁקָל ע"פ מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

Because all of the punishments are measured and weighed according to the laws of the Torah

לְהַעֲבִיר עָלֶיהָ וְהֵם מִהַעֲבֵרוֹת עֲצָמוֹ וְכַמ"ש שְׂכָר עֲבֵרָה עֲבֵרָה

for those who transgress it. And those punishments derive from the transgressions themselves, as the Sages state "the 'reward' of a transgression is the transgression" –

שֶׁהַעֲבֵרָה גּוֹפָה הִיא עֶצֶם הָעֲנֵשׁ הַיּוֹצֵא וְנִעְשָׂה מִתּוֹקֶף הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים

in other words, the transgression itself is the essence of the punishment that emerges and is formed by the intensity of the harsh severities (*dinim*)

הַמִּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְדִינֶיהָ.

that are revealed and drawn forth from the statutes of the Torah and its laws.

וְכַשְׁנִגְמַר פְּעֻלָּתָהּ אֲשֶׁר מִמִּדַּת הַדִּין וְהַמִּשְׁפָּט שָׁבָה הֵנָּה כָּלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל עִ"ז

And when the attribute of justice and judgment has fulfilled its purpose, this puts an end to and nullifies

כָּל תִּקְוָה וְקִשְׁיוֹת הַדִּינִים וּמִתְבַּסְּמִים וְנִמְתָּקִים כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַגְּבוּרוֹת

all of the intensity and harshness of the *dinim* and all the *gevurot* aspects of harshness become aromatic and sweetened

וְנֶעֱשִׂים לְרֹשְׁפֵי אֵשׁ שֶׁלִּהְבֶּת י"ה וְהֵם עֲצָמוֹן מֵעֲתָה סִבַּת הַגְּלוּי

and are made into 'flares of fire of the flames of God' (see Song of Songs 8:6) and they themselves become from that point on the indirect cause of the revelation

דְּכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים וְכָל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי
הָעוֹה"ב

of all the promises for the future, and all the hidden good that will be in the Messianic era and the World to Come.

וְהָרִי הוּוּ הָעֲנָשִׁים גּוֹפָה סִבָּה לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

Thus the punishments themselves are the indirect cause of all the promises for the future,

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר יִתְבַּטֵּל הָעֲנֵשׁ יִתְהַפְּכוּ אוֹתוֹן הַדִּינִין עֲצָמוֹן לְדִינִין דְּקִדְשָׁא

for when the punishments are nullified, those very *dinim* will be transformed into holy *dinim*.

וּכ"ז הוּא ג"כ רַק מְאוּר קִדְשַׁת הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

All of this is also only from the luminousness of the holy Torah and mitzvot,

כִּי כָל גְּלוּי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ מִתְחַלָּה לְסִבַּת הָעֲנֵשׁ

because all the *gevurot* that were originally manifested for the purposes of punishment

הֵם נִתְגַּלוּ וְיֻצְאוּ רַק מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְדִינֶיהָ וּבִמְדָּה וּבִמִּשְׁקָל ע"פ
הַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים שֶׁבָּהּ

are revealed and emerge exclusively from the laws of Torah and its statutes, measured and weighed according to those laws and statutes.

וְהָרִי יוֹצֵא כָּל טוֹב הָעֲתִיד רַק מִהַתּוֹרָה לְעוֹלָם

Thus all the good that will be in the future is exclusively from Torah for all time.

וְהוּא מָה שְׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יִצְרָה פ"ב עֲשָׂרִים וּשְׁתַּיִם אוֹתִיּוֹת יִסּוֹד
(שֶׁהֵם יִסּוֹד כָּל דְּבָר)

This is what is meant by the statement in *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:4 that twenty-two foundational letters (i.e. the foundations of everything)

קָבַעַן בַּגִּלְגָּל כְּמִין חוֹמָה בְּרַל"א שְׁעָרִים וְחוֹזֵר הַגִּלְגָּל פָּנִים וְאָחוֹר

He set in a circle like a wall with 231 gates, and the circle turns forwards and backwards.

The commentaries explain that this can be depicted as two concentric circles, each having the entire Hebrew alphabet engraved upon them. One or both wheels rotate forming unique two-letter combinations (one from each circle). We exclude identical letter combinations such as **אא** or **בב** since these are not *unique* 2-letter combinations. The formula for the sum total of combinations would thus be 22×21 divided by $2 = 231$. (We divide by 2 since **אב** and **בא** are the same letters, just in reverse order).

וְסִימָן לְדָבָר אֵין בְּטוֹבָה לְמַעֲלָה מֵעֵנֶג וְאֵין בְּרָעָה לְמַטָּה מִנֶּגַע

The *Sefer Yetzirah* continues: **A sign of this is – there is nothing in good higher than delight *oneg* (ענג) and nothing in evil lower than plague *nega* (נגע).**

The implication here is as mentioned above – that the intensity and harshness of the *dinim* and all the *gevurot* will become aromatic and sweetened, just like *nega* in a different permutation forms the word *oneg*, as the author states explicitly below.

וְע"י מִשְׁפָּטָה וְדִינִיָּה שֶׁהֵם הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם הֵיא מְטִיָּה כָּל טְמָאָה
וּמְהַפֵּךְ כָּל רָעָה לְטוֹבָה וְכָל נֶגַע לְעֵנֶג.

Thus through the Torah's judgments and *dinim*, which all are the punishments meted out to those who transgress the Torah,

everything polluted is purified, and all evil is transformed into good, and all *nega* to *oneg*.

וְהוּא סוּד טְהוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל גִּיהֶנֶם לַעֲתִיד לָבוֹא שִׁיתְהַפֵּךְ הוּא עֲצָמוֹ
לְקִדְשָׁתוֹ שֶׁל גֵּן עֵדֶן

This is the mystical secret of the decontamination of Gehinom in the future – it will be transformed into the holiness of Gan Eden.

וַיַּעֲשֶׂה כ"ז הַכֹּל רַק מִגְלוּיֵי זוֹהָרֵי אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה

And all of this will be achieved exclusively by way of the revelation of the radiance of the light of Torah –

שְׂאֵחַר שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה מִשְׁפָּטָה וְדִינָה תֵּאִיר וְתִתְגַּלֶּה לְהַמְתִּיק אֶת כָּל
הַגְּבוּרוֹת

for after its the Torah's judgments and *dinim* have been carried out, then the light will shine forth to sweeten the *gevurot*,

וְיִתְהַפְּכוּ כָּלֶם לְדִינֵי דִקְדָּשָׁא שְׂבָהֶם הוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוּן:

and all of them will be transformed into *dinim* of holiness, in which is all the hidden goodness.

וּבִדְבָרֵינוּ הִלְלוּ יוֹבֵן סוּד מֵאֲמָרָם ז"ל בְּבִרְאשִׁית רַבָּא פ"ב סִימָן ה'

With these words, we can understand the mystery of the statement of the Sages in *Bereishit Rabba* 2, 5:

מִתְחִלַּת בְּרִיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם צָפָה הַקֵּב"ה בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל צְדִיקִים
וּבְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים

From the beginning of the creation of the world the blessed Holy One foresaw the actions of the righteous and the actions of the wicked.

אֲבָל אֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ בְּאִיזָה מֵהֶם חָפֵץ אִם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה אֱלוֹ וְאִם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה אֱלוֹ

But how do we know which one He desired – whether the actions of these the righteous, or the actions of the others, the wicked?

כִּיּוֹן דְּכָתִיב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב הָיָה בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל
צַדִּיקִים חָפֵץ

But since it is written (Genesis 1:4) "the Lord saw that the light was good," we know that He desires the actions of the righteous,

וְאִינוּ חָפֵץ בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים וְעַ' בְּמַכְרָשִׁים שֶׁטָּרְחוּ מְאֹד בְּדַבְּרֵי
הַמִּדְרָשׁ הַזֶּה

and does not desire the actions of the wicked. See the commentators who expended much effort in explaining this Midrash.

וְכֵן קָרוֹב לְלִשׁוֹן זֶה הוּא ג"כ בְּסִפְרֵי רִישׁ פ' רָאָה רָאָה אֲנֹכִי נָתַן
לְפָנֶיכֶם הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה וּקְלָלָה

A similar expression is also found in *Sifri, Re'eh* on the verse (Deuteronomy 11:26) "Behold I have placed before you today a blessing and a curse..."

לְפִי שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַחַיִּים וְהַמּוֹת נָתַתִּי לְפָנֶיךָ הַבְּרָכָה וְהַקְלָלָה

The *Sifri* comments: **Since another verse (Deuteronomy 30:19) states, "Life and death I have placed before you, the blessing and the curse..."**

שֶׁמָּא יֹאמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּאִיל וְנָתַן הַקֵּב"ה לְפָנֵינוּ שְׁנֵי דְרָכִים

perhaps a Jew will say: 'Since the blessed Holy One placed before us two paths,

דֶּרֶךְ הַחַיִּים וְדֶרֶךְ הַמּוֹת נִלְךְ בְּאִיזָה מֵהֶם שְׁנִירָצָה

the path of life and the path of death, one can traverse whichever one chooses,'

תלמוד לומר ובחרת בחיים למען תחיה אתה וזרעך

in response **the Torah** (in continuation of the verse just quoted) teaches "**and you shall choose life, so that you and your progeny may live.**"

והנה הוא מובן ע"פ דברינו כי מאחר שתכלית הבריאה שהוא
בשביל התקון דלעתיד

Now it is understood from what we said that the purpose of creation is the Tikun rectification that will be completed in the future,

אשר לימות המשיח ולחיי העולם הבא הנה הוא יעשה עכ"פ
שיתקן הכל

in the Messianic era and in the World to Come, where everything will have been rectified

ע"י הענשים ג"כ כי ע"י כל התלאות שבהעוה"ז והענשים אשר
לאחר מיתה

by way of punishments as well, because through suffering in this world, and punishments after death

יתבטל הרע כלו ויכלה כל הטמאה והזהמא

all of the evil will be nullified, and all spiritual impurity and infection will have been disposed of,

ויהיו כל הענשים גופה ג"כ לסבה גדולה להתקון העתיד ולהגלוי
דטוב הצפון וכנ"ל

and all the punishments themselves will also be the indirect cause of the Tikun of the future and the revelation of the hidden good, as mentioned previously.

א"כ שמא יאמר אדם שילך באיזה דרך שירצה

This being so, a person may say to himself that he can traverse whichever path he wishes,

כִּי אֵין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה בָּזֶה יוֹתֵר מִבָּזֶה, מֵאַחַר שֶׁתְּכַלִּית הַכּוֹנֵה
הָרִי יַעֲשֶׂה עֵכָפ

since the blessed Holy One's Will is not in this one path, the way of life, more than that other path, the way of suffering and punishment, and the Divine intention is accomplished in any event.

*Side note: The central theme of this idea is also found in the הגהה
– writings of one of the great Jewish thinkers*

וְהוּא הַגָּאוֹן בַּעַל הַחֲנוּךְ בְּמִצְוַה ס"ט

the great scholar, the author of the Chinuch, mitzvah 69.

שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר בְּדֶרֶךְ זֶה מָה שְׁאַמְרוּ רז"ל בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת – עֲנֵשׁ שֶׁמֵּעֲנֵנּוּ,
אַזְהָרָה מִנִּיין?

*In this manner he explains the statement the Sages made in a
number of places¹ – 'the punishments we heard about; but where is
the warning?'*

וּלְכַאוֹרָה יִפְּלֹא לָמָּה אֵינוֹ מְסַפִּיק הָעֲנֵשׁ לְבַד בְּלִיתִי הָאַזְהָרָה

*Now at first glance this question is astonishing – why is the
punishment not sufficient, without a warning?*

וְאָמַר הוּא ז"ל כִּי לֹא הָאַזְהָרָה הֵייתִי אוֹמֵר כִּי הָרְשׁוֹת בִּיד כָּל
הָרוֹצֶה

*And he answers: for without a warning I might have said that a
person is allowed*

שֶׁלֹּא יַחוּשׁ לְצַעְרוֹ לַעֲבֹר עַל הַמִּצְוָה וּלְקַבֵּל הָעֲנֵשׁ

*to ignore his own suffering and transgress the commandment and
receive his punishment,*

ולא יהא בזה נגד חפץ הש"י ומצותו כלל

and this does not go against the Will of God and His commandments at all,

כי כל מצוה הוא רק כעין מקח וממכר או שיעשה המצוה או
שיסבל הענש

for every mitzvah is merely a transaction: either do the mitzvah or suffer the consequences,

ואין חפץ הקב"ה בזה יותר מבזה.

and the Holy One, blessed is He, has no preference for one over the other.

ולכן אמרו לא ענש אא"כ הזהיר

To avoid this misconception the Sages therefore declared that there is no punishment without a warning first –

להודיע שרצונו ית"ש הוא במצוותיו דוקא

in order to inform us that His blessed Will is specifically for His commandments to be fulfilled,

ולא נעשה אותו הדבר שהענש בא עליו עכ"ל ע"ש

and that the person not do that which brings punishments upon themselves. This is what the author of the Chinuch says.

והרי קטב הדברים מה שאמרנו ע"כ הגהה

This is the central theme of our analysis. End of note.

לכן אמרה התורה ובחרת בחיים כי רצונו של הקב"ה הוא

This is why the Torah declares, "choose life" because the will of the blessed Holy One

רק שיעשה התקון אשר בתכלית כונתו ית"ש ע"י קיום התורה
והמצוה דוקא

**is that the Tikun He ultimately intended should be
accomplished by way of Torah and mitzvot specifically,**

להוציא כל כחות הגבורות מן הכח אל הפועל

**bringing forth the powers of the *gevurot* from potential to
actual,**

וכל גלויים היותר אפשרי ע"י גברי כח עשי דברו.

**and all the possible revelations by way of the "the brave
warriors who do His bidding" (Psalms 103:20).**

ואז היו יוצאים כלם בתכלית המתוק והבסוס גם מתחלה

**Then everything will emerge completely sweetened and
fragrant from the very outset,**

כי התורה הנה היא היסוד והשרש והכח דכל המציאות כלו אשר
מן העולם ועד העולם

**since the Torah is the foundation and root and potency of all
existence from this world to the World to come (see Psalms
106:48).**

והרי יש אפשרות בקיומה להוציא כל כחות הגבורות כלם

**Thus, by fulfilling the Torah, it is possible to bring out all of the
powers of the *gevurot***

בכל השעור המספיק לתכלית כל התקון כלו.

to the full extent needed for the purpose of the entire Tikun.

וא"כ הרי נדאי הוא חפצו של הקב"ה שיעשה התקון אשר בכונת
כל הבריאה

This being so, it is certain that the desire of the blessed Holy One is that the Tikun that is the purpose of the entire Creation should be accomplished

רק ע"י קיום התורה והמצוה ולא ע"י הענשים אשר ממשפטיה
ודיניה

only by way of Torah and the mitzvot, and not by way of the punishments that result from transgressing her laws and statutes.

והוא מטעם ג' דברים עקריים:

And this is for three primary reasons:

אחד הוא כי אלו לא החטא היה נעשה ונשלם כל תקון העולם בלוי
מיד

1) Were it not for the transgression, the entire Tikun of the world would have been completed immediately

ע"י אדם הראשון עצמו תכף משבת בראשית והיה מתקן העולם
מאז

by Adam himself with the very onset of the first Sabbath of Creation, and the world would have been rectified from that moment,

בהתקון דחיי העולם הבא אשר באלף השביעי שהוא היום שכלו
שבת

with the Tikun of the life of the World to Come that will take place now only in the seventh millennium – the era that is all Shabbat.

והיה נשלם אותו התקון תכף בשבת בראשית ולא היה נגנז האור
הגנוז בכלל

That Tikun would have been completed immediately with the very onset of the first Sabbath of Creation, and the hidden light

would not have been concealed in the first place.

אֵלָא שְׁהָיָה מְשַׁמֵּשׁ וְהוֹלֵךְ מֵאִזְ וּלְעוֹלָם וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר כ"ז בְּאַרְכָּה
בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב

Instead, it would have been in continual use from then forever, as is explained at length in our work *Drushei Olam HaTohu* part 2.

וְכֵן גַּם אִפְּי' אַחֵר שֶׁחָטָא אָדָם ר' אֱלוֹ שֶׁזָּכִינוּ לְהַלּוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת

Similarly, even after Adam's sin, had we merited to receive the first Tablets on which the Ten Commandments were inscribed,

הָיָה חוֹזֵר הָעוֹלָם לְתִקּוּנוֹ ג"כ מֵאִזְ ע"י מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ ע"ה

the world would also have been restored to its rectified state from then on by Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him,

וְהָיָה מֵאִיר וּמִתְגַּלְיָה הָאֹר הַגָּנוּז מֵאִזְ כִּמּוֹ שִׁיְהִיָּה בְּתִקּוּן הָאַחֲרוֹן

and the hidden light would have shone out and been revealed from then on, as will be when the final Tikun is accomplished.

וְהָיָה גַּרֵם הַחָטָא כָּל אַרְיכוֹת הַזְּמַן וְכָל הַקְּלָקוּלִים וְהָרִיסוֹת
הַגְּדוֹלוֹת

But that sin caused the prolonged period of time and all the great damage and destruction

וְהַתְּלָאוֹת הַנוֹרָאוֹת הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה בְּעוֹלָם מֵעַתָּה מִתֵּן חוֹרָה עַד בִּיאַת
הַמָּשִׁיחַ

and the terrible suffering done in this world from the time of the giving of the Torah until the advent of Mashiach.

כִּי אֵלּוּלָא הַחָטָא הָיָה כָּל הַתִּקּוּנִים אֲשֶׁר עוֹמְדִים עֲתָה לְהַעֲשׂוֹת
רַק לְעֵתִיד

For were it not for that sin, all of the Tikunim that now remain to be accomplished only in the future

הנה היו נעשים כלם מכבר שהוא מאז ומקדם:

would all already have been completed a long time ago, from that primordial era.

ענין השני הוא כי הגם שאמרנו שכל הצרות והענשים

2) The second reason is that even though we said that all the suffering and punishments –

אשר הן בעוה"ז והן לאחר מיתה הנה הם כלם תקונים שיתקון עי"ז גם נפש החוטאת

both those in this world and after death, are all Tikunim through which the soul of a sinner will also be rectified –

אפי' בחטאים ועונות היותר גדולים ולא יאבד שום נפש אחת מישראל

even for the greatest sins and transgressions, and not a single Jewish soul will be lost.

כי על זה נאמר שמואל ב' י"ד ולא ישא אלהים נפש

Regarding this the verse states in II Samuel 14:14 "God spares no one..."

(ר"ל שמשלם לכ"א כמפעלו בעוה"ז או לאחר מיתה)

(meaning to say, each person will be repaid according to their deeds, either in this world or after death)

וחשב מחשבות לבלתי ידח ממנו נדח

and the verse continues: "making calculations so that no one will be banished from Him."

עכ"ז הנה עקר יסוד המעמיד אותם כל אותו הזמן

Nevertheless, the fundamental principle that maintains them throughout that period,

אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִתְּקַנִּים וְהוֹלְכִים ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים וּמִתְקַיָּמִים כָּל אוֹתוֹ
הַזְּמַן

during which they are continually rectified by way of punishments, and they nevertheless survive throughout that time,

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁל צְדִיקִים אֲשֶׁר יִשָּׁנָם בְּכָל דּוֹר
דּוֹר עכ"פ

is solely because of the good deeds of the righteous *tsaddikim* of each generation.

וּכְמ"ש סְנֵה־דָרִין צ"ז ב' לֹא פָחוֹת עֲלָמָא מִתְּלָתִין וְשִׁתָּא צְדִיקֵי
דְּמִקְבְּלֵי אִפִּי שְׂכִינָה בְּכָל דָּרָא

As Tractate Sanhedrin 97b states: there are no less than 36 righteous *tsaddikim* in every generation who receive the Divine Presence.

עוֹד שָׁם דָּרָא דְקָמִי קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא תִּמְנִי סְרִי אֶלְפֵי כו'

It states further that 18 thousand in a generation stand before the blessed Holy One,

וּבַחֲלִין צ"ב א' וְאַכְרָה לִי בַחֲמֶשֶׁה עָשָׂר כֶּסֶף וְחֹמֶר שְׁעָרִים וְלִתְרָה
שְׁעָרִים

and in Tractate Chulin 92a on the verse (Hosea 3:2) "So I acquired her for myself for fifteen pieces of silver and a measure and a half of barley..."

אֱלֹהֵי מ"ה צְדִיקִים שֶׁהָעוֹלָם מִתְּקִים בָּהֶם שְׁלֹשִׁים בָּאָרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּט"ו
בַּחו"ל

– these are the 45 *tsaddikim* upon whom the world is sustained, thirty in the land of Israel and fifteen (the half measure) in the

Diaspora.

וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּא פ"ג שְׂאִין יִשְׂרָאֵל חֲסִידִים לְעוֹלָם

Midrash Bamidbar Rabba ch. 3 states that among the Jewish people there are never less

מג' צדיקים כאברהם יצחק ויעקב וכן כחנניה מישאל ועזריה

than three tsaddikim like Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, and Chananya, Mishael and Azaryah.

וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁם כִּי נִמְצְאוּ לְעוֹלָם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל צַדִּיקִים יִשְׂרָיִם חֲסִידִים בְּנֵי תוֹרָה

The Sages state there that there are always tsaddikim, upright and pious people and Torah scholars among the Jewish People,

אֲפִלּוּ סוּרִיָּהוּ (הַקּוֹצִים שֶׁבֵּהֶם) גּוֹמְלֵי חֶסֶד אֲנוּן

and that even the dropouts (the 'thorns' among them) are benevolent.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי אֲלוּלָא הַצַּדִּיקִים לֹא הָיָה מִתְקִים הָעוֹלָם כָּלֵל

From this we conclude that were it not for the tsaddikim the world would not survive at all.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי כָל קִיּוּמָם שֶׁל הָרָשָׁעִים כָּל עֵת הַצְרוּף וְהַלְבוּן שֶׁלָּהֶם

So it turns out that the continued survival of wicked people, throughout their period of decontamination and purification –

שֶׁהוּא כָל מִשְׁךְ זְמַן שֶׁהֵם מִתְתַּקְּנִים וְהוֹלְכִים ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים

which is the entire period during which they continue to be rectified through punishments –

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים

their continued survival **is due only to the good deeds of tsaddikim**

שְׂבָהֶם מִתְקִים הָעוֹלָם וְנִעְשָׂה עִי"ז תְּקוּן לְהַרְשָׁעִים ג"כ

through whom the world continues to exist, and this also brings about the rectification of the wicked.

אָבֵל אֲלוּלָא הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים הִיָּה מִתְבַּטֵּל הָעוֹלָם מְכַל
וְכָל

But were it not for the good deeds of tsaddikim the entire world would be completely destroyed.

וְהָיָה נִעְשִׂית כָּל אַפְשָׁרִית תְּקוּנָם שֶׁל הַרְשָׁעִים רַק ע"י הַצַּדִּיקִים
דְּוָקָא

Thus all possible rectifications of the wicked come about through the tsaddik.

וְלָכֵן הוּא כִּי גַם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּגְמַר תְּקוּנָם ג"כ הִנֵּה יִהְיוּ לְעוֹלָם רַק
טַפְלִים לַצַּדִּיקִים

And therefore, even after their rectification, they are always subordinate to tsaddikim.

שֶׁצַּדִּיקִים הֵם הָעֶקֶר לְעוֹלָם וְהַרְשָׁעִים שֶׁנִּתְקְנוּ הֵם טַפְלִים לָהֶם
וְכָלּוּלִים עִמָּהֶם

For the tsaddikim are always the primary factor, and the wicked who have been rectified are subordinate to them and are included with them,

כִּי רַק הַצַּדִּיקִים הֵעֲמִידוּ אוֹתָם

since the tsaddikim were the ones who set them right.

וְהָיָה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בְּהִיעוּדִים דְּלַעֲתִיד בְּכָל הַיּוֹם וְהַלָּה וְהָעֶנְג
וְהַנֶּעַם

Hence there is a great difference between the promises for the future – in terms of the radiance and the luminosity and the delight and pleasantness

אֲשֶׁר לַיָּמֹת הַמָּשִׁים וְלַחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

that will accrue in the Messianic era and the World to come –

בֵּין הַמִּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים דִּהְיוּ וְהַמַּצָּחָה

between that which is revealed and drawn down by means of the good deeds deriving from Torah and mitzvot,

לְבֵין הַמִּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים ע"י גְּלוּי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהֵם הַסְּבוֹת דִּהְיוּ וְנִמְשָׁכִים

and that which is revealed and drawn down by way of the disclosure of the *gevurot* that are the cause of the punishments

הַיּוֹצְאִים מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמַּצָּחָה

that emerge from the judgments of the Torah and its commandments,

וְהֵגַם שֶׁיִּכָּלְלוּ זֶה בָּזֶה וַיַּעֲשׂוּ כָּלֶם לְאַחַד בְּסוּד הָעוֹה"ב

even though they will merge one into the other and become one in the mystery of the World to Come.

אֲךְ הַיְסוּד וְהַמַּעֲמִיד וְהַמְּקוֹר וְהַמַּעֲיֵן הוּא לְעוֹלָם הַצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁבְּתַחֲלָה שֶׁהֵם הַצַּדִּיקִים גָּמוּרִים

However, the foundation and the pillar and the source and the spring are always those who were *tsaddikim* from the outset, for they are complete *tsaddikim* whereas those who become *tsaddikim* are dependent upon the former.

עֲנִין הֵג' הוּא כִּי הָרִי כָּל הָרָעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלֶם

3) The third reason is that all the evil and the suffering and the punishments

אֲשֶׁר הֵן בַּעוֹה"ז וְהֵן בְּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר מִיתָה

that take place in this world and in the world of souls after death,

הִנֵּה הֵם רַק בְּסוֹד הַסֵּתֶר פָּנִים שְׂמֻצְמָצִם וּמַעֲלִים אוֹרוֹ וּקְדוּשָׁתוֹ
יִת"ש

partake of the mystical secret of 'the hidden presence' of God, who constricts and conceals His blessed light and holiness,

וּכְמ"ש תְּהִלִּים ה' כִּי לֹא אֵל חָפֵץ רָשָׁע אֶתָּה לֹא יִגְרָךְ רַע

as it states in Psalms 5:5 "For You are not a God who desires wickedness, no evil resides with You."

וְכֵן אֵיכָה ג' כִּי לֹא עָנָה מְלֵבוּ כִּי אֵין הַקֵּב"ה חָפֵץ לְחַיִּיב שׁוֹם בְּרָיָה
וּלְיִסֵּר אוֹתוֹ

Similarly, in Lamentations 3:33: "For He does not torment capriciously..." – for the blessed Holy One does not wish to find any creature guilty and torment them.

וּכְמ"ש ג"כ יִחְזָקֵאל י"ח כִּי לֹא אֶחָפֵץ בְּמוֹת הַמֵּת

And as is also written in Ezekiel 18:32 "I do not desire the death of those who should die..."

וְחָפְצוֹ הוּא תְּמִיד לְהַצְדִּיק אֶת בְּרִיּוֹתָיו וּלְהִיטִיב לָהֶם הֵן בְּזֶה וְהֵן
בְּבָא

Rather, His desire is always to justify His creatures and do good for them, both in this world and the next,

כִּי הוּא יִת"ש מְשִׁתַּעֲשֵׂעַ תְּמִיד בְּצַדִּיקִים שֶׁבָּגוּ עַדן כְּנוֹדָע

because He, may His Name be blessed, always delights in the tsaddikim in Gan Eden, as is known.

וְמָה שִׁסַּד אֶת מַצִּיאוֹת כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים הָרִי הוּא ג"כ רַק כְּדֵי לְתַקֵּנָם
בְּנ"ל

And the fact that He established all the punishments is only for the purpose of rectifying them, as explained above.

וְלָכֵן חָפְצוֹ וְרָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש הוּא רַק בְּמַעֲשֵׂה הַצְּדִיקִים וְכְדֵי לְהַטִּיב
לָהֶם לְאַחַר מִיתָה ג"כ

Therefore, His blessed desire and will is only the actions of tsaddikim, in order to benefit them after death as well,

בְּכָל הָעֲנוּגִים וְהַעֲדוּנִים שֶׁבָּגוּ עָדוֹ

by granting them all the delights and spiritual pleasures of Gan Eden.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הַמִּדְרָשׁ כִּינּוֹן דְּכֻתִּיב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב

This is what the Midrash cited earlier concludes: Since the verse (Genesis 1:4) states: "The Lord saw that the light was good,"

הוּא בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶם שֶׁל צְדִיקִים חָפֵץ וְאִינוֹ חָפֵץ בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים

we know that He desires the actions of the righteous, and does not desire the actions of the wicked.

כִּי הִגַּם שְׂגָם הֵם יִתְקַנּוּ לְבִסּוּף ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים וַיִּזְכּוּ בָּלָם עי"ז
לְטוֹב הָעָתִיד

For although they too will be rectified in the end by way of punishments, and they will all merit the goodness of the future thereby,

אֲךָ הוּא ית"ש אֵין חָפְצוֹ בְּהָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָל וּלְעוֹלָם יִהְיוּ הַצְּדִיקִים
הָעֹקֵר בְּזֶה כְּנֻזָּר

He, may His Name be blessed, does not desire those punishments at all, and tsaddikim are always the main goal, as mentioned.

וְלֵכֶן אָמַר הַכָּתוּב וּבַחֲרַתְּ בַחַיִּים

And therefore the Torah declares, "You shall choose life."

וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר עַל כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַצְדִּיקִים וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב

And so too it states – regarding the actions of tsaddikim – "The Lord saw that the light was good..." i.e. He desires first and foremost the actions of the righteous – Torah and mitzvot – that are compared to light, not the actions of the wicked, who are compared to darkness, even though they will eventually be rectified and will also become righteous.

Footnotes

1. E.g. *Sanhedrin* 54b, 60b, 66a; *Yevamot* 3b. [↩](#)

Chapter 9 — Why the matters of the world to come and the days of the mashiakh (messiah) are not mentioned in the Torah, as well as an explanation of the rectification of the neshamot (souls) of Israel in the world to come

ואחר כל הדברים הללו הנה יובן לנו עוד ענין אחד נעלם

After all the above, we also understand another esoteric matter

מה שנתחבטו בזה כמה קדושי עליון והוא מה שלא נזכר בתורה
מפרש מאומה

– a matter that a number of holy and distinguished scholars were puzzled by – and that is the fact that it does not state explicitly in Torah anything

מכל עניני דימות המשיח וחי העולם הבא

regarding the Messianic era and the life of the World to Come!

וע' בספר כלי יקר בפ' בחקותי בפסוק והתהלכתי בתוכם

See the *Kli Yakar's* work in *parshat Bechukotai* on the verse (Leviticus 26:12) "And I will walk among you."

שמביא שם מדברי גדולי עולם ז' תרוצים על זה ע"ש

There he offers seven answers from the words of the greatest thinkers

אמנם אחרון חביב מה שכתב בזה השל"ה בהקדמת תולדות אדם
בבית אחרון ע"ש

However – since 'the later the more cherished'¹ – the *Shelah*² also writes about this in his 'Introduction to *Toldot Adam*' last section,

דְּבָרֵי פִי חָכָם חֵן וְשִׁפְתָּיִם יִשָּׁק

and 'the words of a wise man win favor' (Ecclesiastes 10:12)
and 'lips will kiss his holy words (see Proverbs 24:26).

אך סוד הענין בזה הוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו כי הרי כל התורה כלה

**But the mystical explanation of this matter is according to
what we noted – that the entire Torah**

לפי גלויה ולבושה שהיא עתה לפנינו (ע' זוה"ק בהעלותך קנ"ב א'
זוהר חדש פ' כי תבא)

**as it is revealed clothed in garments before us at this time (see
Zohar Behalotecha 152a and Zohar Chadash parshat Ki Tavo) –**

הרי אינו מבטיח שום טובה ושום שכר אלא רק לעושיה ולשמרה
לחוקרה ולדורשה ולמי שעומד נאמן בקיומה

**does not promise any good nor any reward other than for those
who fulfill it and keep it and examine it and expound it, and for
those who remain faithful to fulfilling it.**

וכל גלויה הוא שנדון כ"א לפי מעשיו והכל במשפט והכל בדין

**All revelations of Torah, in other words, novel insights or deep
understanding and intuitive awareness are judged according to
each person's deeds, whether they are worthy thereof or not, and
everything is according to how they are assessed and
adjudicated.**

אמנם התקנה העתידה דכל חמדת ישראל

However, the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for

שהם כל היעודים אחרונים דימות המשיח וחי העוה"ב

**– which are the final promises regarding the Messianic era and
the life of the World to Come –**

הנה הם תלויים באמת רק בברית ולא בזכות

in truth these are dependent only upon the Covenant and not upon merit.

וְהוּא בְרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְהַבְּרִית לֹא תוֹפֵר לְעוֹלָם

This is the Covenant that God made with the Patriarchs³ and with Israel

וְכֵן אָמַר רַבֵּינוּ תָּם (בְּתוֹסַפַּת שְׁבֵת נ"ה א' דה"מ וּשְׁמוּאֵל)

****And so says Rabeinu Tam (**Tractate Shabbat 55a, Tosafot s.v. וּשְׁמוּאֵל)**

דְּזִכּוֹת אֲבוֹת תָּמָה אֲבָל בְּרִית אֲבוֹת לֹא תָמָה

– that although the merit of the Patriarchs may have petered out, the Covenant with the Patriarchs did not expire.

וְכֵן הוּא מִפְּרָשׁ בְּתוֹרָה בְּסוֹף קְלָלוֹת דִּתְּוֹרַת כְּהֻנִּים

This is stated explicitly in Torah at the end of the curses in Leviticus:⁴

וְאִי גַם זֹאת כֹּ' לֹא מֵאַסְתִּים וְלֹא גְעֻלָּתִים לְכַלֶּתָם לְהַפֵּר בְּרִיתִי
אִתָּם כִּי אֲנִי ה' אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

"Nevertheless, I will not despise them, nor tire of them that I would destroy them and break My Covenant with them, since I am God their Lord."

וְהָרִי מִפְּרָשׁ הַהִבְטָחָה עַל הַבְּרִית יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא תוֹפֵר אֶפְי' בְּחֻטָּא
עב"ז רחמ"ל

Thus, regarding the oath of the Covenant with Israel, it is stated explicitly that it will not be broken, even with the sin of idolatry, Heaven have mercy upon us.

וְכֻמוֹ שֶׁמִּפְּרָשׁ שֶׁם בִּפְרָשָׁה עַל פְּגָרֵי גְלוּלֵיכֶם

**And as it states unambiguously in the same section (26:30),
"upon the carcasses of your idols..." (Emphasis added).**

וְאוֹתוֹ הַבְּרִית הַזֶּה הוּא גַם לְכָל יָחִיד וְיָחִיד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל בְּפָרֶט וּכְמִ"ש
הַגֵּרָ"א בִּפ' נִצְבִּים וְכַ"ל בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ פ"ה ע"ש

**And this covenant is also with each and every individual Jew,
not just with the community as a whole, as the GRA writes in
Parshat Nitzavim, and as we mentioned above in chapter 5.**

כִּי סוּד בְּרִית אָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאַרְנוּ בַּכ"מ מִדְּבָרֵינוּ

**For the mystical explanation of the Covenant with the
Patriarchs and with Israel we explained in a number of places**

כִּי הוּא בַּתְר"כ עֲמוּדֵי וְנִתִּיבוֹת אוֹר הַנִּזְכָּר בְּתַפְלַת ר' נְחוּנְיָא בֶּן
הַקָּנָה וּבִמְסַכֶּת אֲצִילוֹת

**is that it concerns the 620 pillars and channels of light
mentioned in the prayer of Rabbi Nechunya ben HaKana, and
in Masechet Atzilut⁵**

*What follows is a highly esoteric explanation of the origin of those
pillars and channels of light.*

וְהֵם בַּחוּרְתָּא דֵּא"א הַמְּאִירִים מִחֻכְמָתָא עֲלָאָה סְתִימָאָה אֲוִירָא
דְּלָא אֲתַפֵּס, רִישָׁא דְּאֵין

**They are among the white hairs of the 'beard' of Arich Anpin
that shine forth from the hidden chochmah above, from the
avira⁶ that is not grasped, the head of ayin nothingness.**

וְשֵׁם הוּא סוּד וְשֵׁרֶשׁ הַכָּל וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּשִׁבִּיל יִשְׂרָאֵל
שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ רֵאשִׁית

**There is the mystical secret of the root of all, and therefore the
Sages stated, 'Bereishit – in the beginning' alludes to Israel, who
are called 'reishit – the first of His crops' (Jeremiah 2:3).**

וְאָמְרוּ בַּב"ר ס"א סִימָן ד' מִחֻשְׁבָּתוֹן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדָמָה לְכָל דָּבָר

The Sages in *Bereishit Rabba* 1:4 declare that the thought of Israel preceded everything,

כִּי הֵם תְּלוּיִם וּמְשֻׁרָשִׁים בְּתוֹרַת עֲמוּדֵי אֹר שֶׁהוּא הַשְּׂרֵשׁ גַּם לְכָל
הָאֲצִילוֹת כָּל

because they are attached to, and are rooted in, the 620 pillars of light, which is also the root of the entire World of Atzilut.⁷

וְאִינוּ מְגִיעַ שָׁם מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים כָּלֵל וְשָׁם הוּא סוּד הַבְּרִית אֲבוֹת
יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלָכֵן אֵי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁישְׁתַּנָּה

The actions of the lower creations do not have any effect there at all, and that is the secret of the Covenant with the Patriarchs and with Israel, and that is why it cannot change.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין צ"ח א' אֵין בֶּן דָּוִד בָּא אֶלָּא בְּדוֹר שֶׁכָּלּוּ זַכָּאֵי
אוּ בְּדוֹר שֶׁכָּלּוּ חַיִּיב

This is also what the Sages said in Tractate Sanhedrin 98a: The descendent of David i.e. the Mashiach/Messiah will only come to a generation that is either completely worthy, or to a generation that is completely unworthy.

וְע' בְּהֶגֶר"א בְּתַקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן ס"ט קכ"ו ע"א שֶׁאָמַר וַיְדַאי אֶפֶן הַשְּׁנִי

See GRA *Tikunim*, *Tikun* 69 p. 126a who speculates that this will certainly be the latter,

וְכַמִּי"ש בִּפ' שְׁמוֹת ז' ב' יִסְתַּכֵּל מֵאֵן אֲנוּ דְקִיָּמִין כו' וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּכַּח
זַכָּאֵי כו' ע"ש

as the Zohar states in Shemot 7b: He will examine those who are living then... and will not find one who is worthy... See there.

[However, the concept of 'completely unworthy' does not mean completely wicked, Heaven forbid, for that is impossible. It simply means that one whose sins are in the majority over their

mitzvot is called unworthy, as Tractate Rosh HaShana 16-17 states.]

וְהָרִי לָנוּ דִּימוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ אֵינוֹ תְּלוּי בְּזָכוֹת וּמַעֲשִׂים כָּלֵל

Thus we have it that the Messianic era does not depend on merit and good deeds at all.

וְכֵן שָׁם בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין צ"ז סע"ב בְּפִלּוּגָתָא דְר' אֱלִיעֶזֶר וְר' יְהוֹשֻעַ

And so too in Tractate Sanhedrin 97b, in the argument between Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua

וְאָמַר ר' יְהוֹשֻעַ חָנָם נִמְכַּרְתֶּם וְלֹא בְכֶסֶף תִּגָּאֲלוּ לֹא בַתְּשׁוּבָה
וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים

Rabbi Yehoshua said, quoting the verse (Isaiah 52:3): 'You were sold for nothing and not with silver will you be redeemed' – 'not with silver' means not with repentance and good deeds.

(There is a printing error in our version of the Talmud. The words of Rabbi Eliezer and the words of Rabbi Yehoshua got switched around, as is proved by the *Beraita* that follows 'The other one said...' as we stated it. The correct version is stated in the earlier *Beraita* there and as printed in the Talmud Yerushalmi *Taanit* 2b. See there).

וְשָׁקְלוּ וְטָרוּ בָּזָה ר"א ור"י וּלְבִסּוּף שֶׁתַּק ר"א כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְבָאָר שָׁם

Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua discuss the matter back and forth, until eventually Rabbi Eliezer fell silent, as explained there.

וְהָרִי הוֹדָה ר"א ג"כ לר"י שֶׁהִגְאֵלָה הָעֲתִידָה אֵינוֹ תְּלוּי בַתְּשׁוּבָה
וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים כָּלֵל

Hence Rabbi Eliezer acknowledged the correctness of Rabbi Yehoshua's view that the future redemption does not depend upon repentance and good deeds at all.

וְכֵן כָּתַב הַרְמַב"ן בַּפ' הָאֲזִינוּ שֶׁהִבְטַחַת גְּאֻלָּה הָעֵתִידָה אִין בְּהַ
תְּנָאִי בִתְשׁוּבָה וְעִבּוּדָה

So too Ramban writes in his commentary to *Ha'azinu* (Deuteronomy 32:40) that the promise of the future redemption is not conditioned upon repentance and proper service.

אֶלָּא שֶׁהָיָא מִבְּטָח לְבוֹא עַכ"פ ע"ש

Rather it is promised that it will take place in any event, see there.

וְמָה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בְּכַמָּה אַגְדוֹת שֶׁתְּלוֹי בִתְשׁוּבָה

The fact that we do find in a number of Rabbinic sources that this depends upon repentance,

הִנֵּה הוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין קי"א א'

this is as the Sages declared in Tractate Sanhedrin 111a –

כִּי אֶחָד מֵעִיר מְזַכֶּה כָּל הָעִיר כְּלָה וּשְׁנַיִם מִמִּשְׁפָּחָה מְזַכִּין כָּל
הַמִּשְׁפָּחָה כְּלָה

that even one in a city makes the whole city meritorious, and two in a family makes the entire family meritorious.

וְכֵן הוּא מִבְּאֵר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם בְּזֵהָר חֲדָשׁ פ' נח סְמוּךְ לְסוּפּוֹ

And so too it states in *Midrash Ne'elam* in the *Zohar Chadash*, *Noach*, near the end of the section –

שֶׁאָמַר שָׁם ר' אֱלִיעֶזֶר בְּפֶרוּשׁ כִּי הֵגַם שֶׁהַכֹּל תְּלוֹי בִתְשׁוּבָה

that Rabbi Eliezer said explicitly that even though everything depends upon them repenting,

אֲךְ אִי יִחְזְרוּ בִתְשׁוּבָה אִפִּי' חֲדָא כְּנִישְׁתָּא בְּזִכּוּתָם יִתְכַּנֵּשׁ כָּל
גְּלוּתָא ע"ש

even if a single community repents the entire exile will be annulled in their merit. See there.

וּבְאַמֶּת הָרִי יִשְׁנָם כַּמָּה צַדִּיקִים בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר עַכ"פּ ל"ו צַדִּיקִי
דְּמִקְבְּלֵי אָפִי שְׂכִינָה

In truth, there are a number of righteous people *Tzadikim* in every generation, and at least 36 *Tzadikim* who receive the Divine Presence.

וּבִתְקוּנֵי תְקוּוֹן כ"א נ"ז א' מְבַאֵר כִּי הֵם ע"ב ל"ו בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל ל"ו
(בְּחוּ"ל וּמִשְׁמַע שֵׁם כִּי הֵם נִסְתָּרִים כִּי הֵם בְּמַדְרַגַּת לֵב ע"ש)

(In the *Tikunim Tikunei Zohar* *Tikun 21* p. 57a it is explained that there are 72: 36 in Israel, and 36 in the Diaspora. And it appears from there that they are hidden *Tzadikim*, for they are on the level of 'heart.' See there).

מ"ה צַדִּיקִים שֶׁבָּהֶם מִתְקִים הָעוֹלָם וְכנ"ל פ"ח

Elsewhere it states that **there are 45 *Tzadikim* through whom the world continues to exist, as we explained above chapter 8.**

וְהָרִי אֵינוֹ חֹסֵר הָעוֹלָם מִכַּמָּה צַדִּיקִים בְּכָל דּוֹר אֲשֶׁר בְּזָכוּתָם יָבוֹא
הַגְּאֻלָּה

Thus the world never lacks a number of *Tzadikim* in every generation, in whose merit the redemption will come

לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם אָפִי כְּשִׁיחִיו רַבָּם חַיִּב וְכִנְז'

to the entire Jewish people, even if the majority are guilty of sins, as mentioned.

וְכֵן מוֹרָה כַּמָּה פְּסוּקִים בִּיחֻזְקָא ל"ו - ל"ז וּמְבַאֵר שֶׁ כַּמַּעֲט
בְּפִרוּשׁ

A number of verses in Ezekiel chapters 36-37 also indicate this, almost explicitly,

שְׁהִגָּאֲלָהּ הָאֲחֻרָּנָה אֵינוֹ תְּלוּי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים כָּלֵל וְהִיא
בְּטוֹחָה לְבוֹא עַכ"פ

that the final redemption is not dependent upon repentance and good deeds, and it is promised that it will take place, no matter what.

וְמָה גַּם כִּי הָרִי הָאִישׁ לְבוּשׁ הַבְּדִים שֶׁהוּא הַמִּלְאָךְ גַּבְרִיאֵל (ע' ב"ר
פ' כ"א ס' ה')

And particularly since 'the man... clothed in linen' (see Ezekiel 9:2), who is the angel Gabriel (see *Bereishit Rabba* 21:5),

בָּא בְּשִׁבּוּעָה בְּחַי הָעוֹלָם כִּי לְמוֹעֵד מוֹעֲדִים וְחֲצִי כו' וּכמ"ש בְּדִנְיָאֵל
י"ב

came and swore by the Life of the World that after an era, an era and a half the redemption would arrive, as it states in Daniel 12:7.

וְאִם שְׁהִיָּה קֶץ הִגָּאֲלָהּ תְּלוּי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה הָרִי לֹא שֵׁיךְ שְׁבֻעָה עַל זֶה
כִּי תְּשׁוּבָה תְּלוּי בְּבַחֲרִיהָ

Now if the final redemption depended upon repentance, an oath would not be relevant, since repentance depends upon choice.

וְהוּא בְּאֵמַת הָרִאִיָּה אֲחֻרָּנָה שֶׁמִּבִּיא ר' יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְדַבְּרֵיוֹ וְהוּא רִאִיָּה
שֶׁאֵין עָלֶיהָ תְּשׁוּבָה

And this is indeed the last proof that Rabbi Yehoshua brings for his view, a proof to which there can be no response.

וְכוֹנֵן נֶאֱמַר ג"כ חֲבִיקוּק ב' וַיִּפֹּחַ לִקְצֵי וְלֹא יִכָּזֵב אִם יִתְמַהֲמָה חֲכָה לוֹ
כִּי בֹא יָבֹא לֹא יֵאָחֵר

And so too it states in Habbakuk 2:3 "...it will speak of the End and it will not deceive. Though it may tarry, await it, for it will surely come; it will not delay."

ומה שאמר לא יכזב ולא יאחר הכונה מבאר שלא יהיה שום עכוב
בדבר

**When it states that 'it will not deceive' and 'it will not delay'
this means that it will not be withheld –**

וכשיגיע עת הקץ הנה יבא עכ"פ בין אם יהיו זכאי או חייב

**when the End-time comes it will come in any event, whether
they are worthy or unworthy.**

והרי לנו מכ"ז כי הגאולה העתידה אינו תלוי בזכות ומעשים כלל.

**So we derive from all this that the future redemption does not
depend upon merit and good deeds at all.**

וכן גם בענין חיי עולם הבא הרי אמרו ג"כ סנהדרין ק"ד סע"ב

**And also as regards the life of the World to Come, in Tractate
Sanhedrin 104b our Sages declared**

דורשי רשומות היו אומרים כלן באין לעוה"ב

**'interpreters of the verses'⁸ would say that everyone will enter
the World to Come,**

שגם דואג האדומי ואחיתפל וירבעם בן נבט ואחאב ומנשה וגחזי
כלם באים לעוה"ב

**even Do'eg haEdomi, Achitofel, Yeravam ben Nevat, Achav,
Menashe and Geichazi, unrepentant sinners all of them,
nevertheless, all of them will enter the World to Come.**

וכן אמרו בפסיקתא רבתי פסקא א' ובירושלמי כלאים פ"ט
וכתובות פ' י"ב הלכה ג'

**And similarly it is stated in the *Pesikta Rabbati* 1, and in the
Talmud Yerushalmi *Kila'im* 9 and *Ketubot* 12:3**

שגם ירבעם בן נבט וחבריו כלם יזכו לתחיית המתים

that even Yeravam ben Nevat and his cronies will all merit the Resurrection of the Dead.

שָׁאֲמָרוּ שֶׁם עַל הַפְּסוּק נֹתֵן נִשְׁמָה לָעָם עָלֶיהָ (יִשְׁעִיָּה מ"ב)

They said there, on the verses (Isaiah 42:5), "[God] who gave a soul to the people upon it,"

וְנִתְּנִי רוּחִי בְכֶם וְחַיִּיתֶם (יְחֶזְקֵאל ל"ז)

and "I have given My spirit to you and have brought you to life" (Ezekiel 37:14):

ר' בִּרְכִיָּה שָׁאֵל לר' חֵלְבּוֹ ר' חֵלְבּוֹ שָׁאֵל לר' אֲמִי ר' אֲמִי שָׁאֵל לר'
אֶלְעָזָר ר' אֶלְעָזָר שָׁאֵל לר' חֲנִינָא וְאֵית דְּאֲמָרִין ר' חֲנִינָא שָׁאֵל לר'
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן לֵוִי

Rabbi Berachya asked Rabbi Chelbo, and Rabbi Chelbo asked Rabbi Ami, and Rabbi Ami asked Rabbi Elazar, and Rabbi Elazar asked Rabbi Chanina, and some say that Rabbi Chanina asked Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi:

אֲפִי כְּגוֹן יִרְבְּעָם בֶּן נֶבֶט וְחֻבְרִי

Even the likes of Yeravam ben Nevat and his cronies?

אָמַר לִיה גְּפָרִית וּמֶלַח שְׂרָפָה כָּל אֶרֶץ כּו' כִּיֹּן שֶׁנִּשְׂרָפָה א"י
נַעֲשֶׂה בָהֶן מִדַּת הַדִּין

He responded, citing the verse (Deuteronomy 29:22) warning about the dire consequences of disobeying the Torah: "**Sulphur and salt, a conflagration throughout the Land...**" – once it has been burned down, I know that justice has already been done,

שֶׁכֶּבֶר קִבְּלוּ דִּינָם וְיִזְכּוּ גַם הֵם לְתַחִית הַמֵּתִים

because they received their penalty and they too will therefore merit the Resurrection of the Dead.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכֹּז שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲבֹב שׁוּם חֵטָא וְעוֹן לֹא לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וְלֹא לַתְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים וְלֹא לַחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא

Thus we have it from all this analysis that no sin or transgression can cause the Messianic era, the Resurrection of the Dead, or life in the World to come to be withheld.

וְהוּא ע"פ סוּד הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל פ' ה' ו' ז' ח' כִּי גַם כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לְאַחַר מִיתָה

And this is according to the mystical truth we mentioned earlier in chapters 5, 6, 7, 8 that all of the punishments after death

הֵנָּה הֵם כָּלֵם תְּקוּנִים וּפְעוּלוֹת שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל נֶפֶשׁ הַחוּטָא ג"כ לְכָל תְּקוּת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל

are all rectifications and activities by which every soul, even a sinful one, will be worthy of the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

וּמִי שֶׁלֹּא זָכָה לָבוֹא בְּשָׂכָרוֹ ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים דֵּהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת

And those who were not worthy of reward for their good deeds and Torah and mitzvot

הֵנָּה הוּא יִתְקַן ג"כ עכ"פ ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים דֵּהַז' מְדוּרֵי גִיהֶנֶם

will also be rectified – at least by way of the punishments of the seven levels of Gehinnom

הַיּוֹצְאִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִמַּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת וְכֵן"ל בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ עֵין עֲלֵיהֶם

that derive from, and are drawn down by, the laws of the Torah and the mitzvot, as explained above. Analyze them carefully.

אֲךָ עכ"פ הוּא כִּי לֹא יֵאבֹד שׁוּם נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּגְמָרָא עִירוּבִין כ"א סע"א

But in any event not a single Jewish soul will be lost, as the Gemara *Eruvin* 21a states:

דְּרִישׁ מְרִי בַר מַר מֵאִי דְּכִתִּיב וְהָיָה שְׁנֵי דוֹדָאֵי תַּאֲנִים מוֹעֲדִים לִפְנֵי הַיֵּכָל ה'

Rabbi Mari bar Mar taught: What is the meaning of the verse (Jeremiah 24:1-2) "God showed me [a vision] in which there were two baskets of figs, prepared before the Sanctuary of God...

הַדּוּד הָאֶחָד תַּאֲנִים טְבוֹת מְאֹד כְּתָאֵר הַבְּכֻרוֹת וְהַדּוּד אֶחָד תַּאֲנִים רְעוֹת מְאֹד אֲשֶׁר לֹא תֵאכְלָנָה מֵרַע.

One basket had very good figs, like the figs that ripen early. And one basket had very bad figs, so bad they were inedible."

תַּאֲנִים הַטּוֹבוֹת אֵלּוּ צְדִיקִים גְּמוּרִים תַּאֲנִים הָרְעוֹת אֵלּוּ רָשָׁעִים גְּמוּרִים

Rabbi Mari bar Mar then offered this interpretation: **the good figs represent the truly righteous, and the bad figs represent the thoroughly wicked.**

וְשָׁמָּה תֵּאמַר אֲבָד סִבְרָם וּבָטַל סְכוּיָם ת"ל הַדּוֹדָאִים נִתְּנוּ רִיחַ

Perhaps you will say that the latter's prospects are lost, and their hopes are annulled? Therefore the verse (Song of Songs 7:14) teaches "the mandrakes give forth their scent." The word for mandrakes here is *dudaim*, the same word as the plural for baskets in the verse in Jeremiah, hinting that both baskets of figs will give forth a pleasant scent, as he goes on to state explicitly:

אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ עֲתִידִין שְׁיִתְּנוּ רִיחַ וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ל"ז א' וַיֵּרַח אֶת רִיחַ בְּגָדָיו. אֵל תִּקְרִי בְּגָדָיו אֶלָּא בּוֹגְדָיו

These and those – the good and the bad – will in the future give forth their scent. And so too it was stated in Tractate Sanhedrin 37a on the verse (Genesis 27:27) "And he Isaac smelled the fragrance of his garments" – the garments that Jacob was wearing, while pretending to be Esau. The Gemara interprets do

not read it as *begadav* – his garments – but *bogdav* – his deception. Isaac sensed that the person before him was not Esau but Jacob, and he nevertheless blessed him.

והגם שפשטות הדברים הוא משום שגם פושעי ישראל מלאים מצות כרמון

Now although the simple sense of this is that even Jewish sinners are as full of mitzvot as a pomegranate is full of seeds,

אך עמק פונתם ז"ל הוא בסוד מי יתן טהור מטמא שאמרנו לעיל פ"ו

but the depth of the Sages intention is the secret of the verse in Job 14:4, "Who can produce purity from impurity?" as we explained above chapter 6.

והרי עכ"פ כי יזכו כלם לכל תקות חמדת ישראל העתיד.

In any event, we have it that all of them will merit the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

ולכן לא נזכר בתורה מפדש מכל היעודים העתידיים הנצחיים

And this is why the Torah does not mention explicitly any of the eternal promises that will take place in the future,

כי כל התורה לפי גלויה ולבושה שהיא עתה לפנינו הרי נדון כ"א רק לפי מעשיו

for according to the entire Torah before us in its current state of revelation and the garment it is clothed in, every person is judged by their deeds,

וכ"א הוא בא בשכרו ונאמר בה כרת ואבדון להמורדים ופושעים

and each person receives their payback as stated – excision and removal⁹ for the renegades and deliberate sinners.

אך לימות המשיח וחי העוה"ב הרי אין כרת ואבדון כלל

But in the Messianic era and life in the World to Come there is no excision or removal at all,

שְׁהָרִי גַם יִרְבְּעָם בֶּן נֶבֶט אֲשֶׁר חָטָא וְהִחֲטִיא אֶת הָרַבִּים בְּחָטָא
עבו"ז הַחֲמוּרָה כְּמָה וְכְמָה שָׁנִים,

for even Yeravam ben Nevat who sinned and caused multitudes to sin – the sin of idolatry, the most serious of all – and for many years,

וּמִנִּשָּׁה שֶׁהֶעֱמִיד צֶלֶם בַּהִיכָל וְדוֹאֵג הָאֲדוֹמִי שֶׁהָרַג נֹב עִיר
הַכֹּהֲנִים

and Menashe who set up an idol in the Sanctuary, and Do'eg the Edomite who put Nov, the city of priests, to death,

גַּם הֵם יִתְקַנּוּ וַיִּזְכּוּ לְתַחֲיִית הַמֵּתִים וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב כְּנִז'

even they will be rectified and will merit the Resurrection of the Dead and life in the World to Come.

וְכֵן עַד"ז כָּל הַמּוֹרְדִים וּפּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם וְהֵגַם שְׁהָרִי הוּא
לְכַאוּרָה נֶגֶד דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁפָּטָה וְעֲנִשָּׁה

And the same applies to all those who are renegades and deliberate sinners, even though this seems to contradict the laws and judgments of the Torah and her punishments.

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁרְאִינוּ מֵאַנְשֵׁי כְנַה"ג שֶׁעָלוּ בְּדַעַתָּם לְדַחוֹת אוֹתָם כָּלָם

And as we saw with the Men of the Great Assembly, who thought to reject all of them those mentioned in the

Talmud**¹⁰** and rule that they could not be redeemed, but their opinion was overruled.

וְכֵן רָצוּ לִמְנוֹת אֶת שְׁלֹמֹה ג"כ ע"פ דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁפָּטָה

And they the Men of the Great Assembly also wanted to count Shlomo (King Solomon) among those who do not have a portion

in the World to come, since some of his wives caused him to veer off in the wrong direction.¹¹

אָמַנְם הֵנָּה יֵצֵא בֵּת קוֹל מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאָמַר לָהֶם הִמְעַמְךָ יִשְׁלַמְנָה
כו'

But a Heavenly voice said to them, regarding the reward or punishment for a person's deeds **"is that your prerogative?** No, it is Mine!"¹²

וְהוֹדִיעָם בָּזֶה כִּי כָּל פֶּסֶק וְדִין הַנוֹגֵעַ לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב הוּא תְּלוּי
בְּכַבְשֵׁי דִרְחֻמָּנָא

He informed them that any ruling or verdict regarding life in the World to Come depends upon the Merciful One,

וְאִין לְבֵית דִּין שֶׁל מַטָּה לַעֲשׂוֹת בָּזֶה פְּסָקִים וְדִינִים כָּלֵל

and the Rabbinical Court down below in our world may not make rulings or verdicts in this regard.

וְלָכֵן מְבִיא הַגְּמָרָא שֶׁם תִּכְרֶה דְּבָרֵי דוֹרְשֵׁי רְשׁוּמוֹת שֶׁכָּלֵן בְּאִין
לְעוֹה"ב

This is why the Gemara there immediately brings the words of the 'interpreters of the verses' that everyone will enter the World to Come.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּירוּשְׁלַמִּי סְנֵהֲדִרִין פ"י סוֹף הֶלְכָּה ב'

The same view is expressed in the Talmud Yerushalmi, Sanhedrin 10:2

שֶׁהִבֵּת קוֹל יֵצֵא עַל כָּל אֵלוּ שֶׁנִּמְנָנוּ שָׁם בְּמִשְׁנָה וְהָיָה הֶהָקְפָּדָה עַל
כָּלָן ע"ש

– that the Heavenly Voice was in regard to all those mentioned in the Mishnah, and was emphatically including all of them. See there.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי רָצוֹן הָעֲלִיּוֹן גָּלָה לָהֶם שֶׁלֹּא יִדְחוּ שׁוֹם אֶחָד מֵהֶם וְכָלֹן
בָּאִין לְעוֹרָה"ב

Thus we have it that the Divine Will revealed to them that none of them would be rejected, and all of them would enter the World to Come.

וְהִגֵּם שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד דֵּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁפָּטָה אַךְ עַל זֶה הִנֵּה הוּא ית"ש
גָּדוֹל הַעֲצָה וְרַב הָעֲלִיָּה

And even though this seems to contradict the strict laws and judgments of the Torah, nevertheless, He, may He be blessed, is "great in counsel and mighty in deed" as the verse (Jeremiah 32:19) states.

וַיֵּשׁ לוֹ עֲצוֹת וּפְעֻלּוֹת וְסִבּוּבִים מְסֻבּוּבִים שׁוֹנִים שֶׁלֹּא לָזוּז מִהַתּוֹרָה
שׁוֹם זִז כָּל שֶׁהוּא

This means that He has the counsel and the deeds and roundabout means by which to avoid deviating from the Torah even one iota,

וְשֶׁלֹּא לִוְתֹר מֵאַמָּה וּבִאֲפֹן שֶׁהָעוֹשֶׂה עֲבֵרָה נִשְׁאָר וְהָעֹנֵשׁ נִפְרָע

without compromising at all, so that the perpetrator of the sin will remain alive and the sin will be paid for.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה שִׁיזְכָּה עַכ"פ לְכָל תִּקְוָה
חֲמִדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלֹ

And yet everything will be done according to the laws of the Torah itself – so that in any event the individual will merit the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

וְהוּא הִנְהִיגַת מִדּוֹתָיו ית"ש וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת שֶׁמִּיִּשְׂר אֶת הַכֹּל
בְּתִקְוֹנִים מִתִּקְוֹנִים שׁוֹנִים הַכֹּל מִהַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה

This then is the way the attributes of "abundant kindness" and "truth" operate in harmony to straighten everything out and

rectify matters in different ways, and all according to Torah itself.

וכ"ז הוא באמת רק מכבשי דרך־מנא

And all of this is in truth only from the Merciful One Himself

כְּדִי לָקִים אֶת הַבְּרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִתְנַהֵג עִמָּהֶם בְּהִי"ג מִדּוֹת
הַרְחָמִים

**in order to fulfill the Covenant He made with the Patriarch and
with Israel, towards whom He acts with the Thirteen
Attributes of Mercy**

שְׁנֵקְרָאִים כָּל טוֹבֵי

that are called 'all of My goodness.'¹³

וְהִנְהִיגָה הַזֶּה בְּכָל דְּרָכֶיהָ הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה

**This conduct, and the paths by which it travels, is hidden from
every created being.**

אֲמָנָם הוּא הִנֵּה הָגַם שְׁדֵרְכֵי הִנְהִיגָה הַזֹּאת בְּפִרְטוֹת הַמִּתְנַהֵּג עִם
כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד (בְּזֶה וּבָבֵא)

**Indeed, the manner in which each individual is treated
specifically, in this world and the next,**

בְּדֵרָכִים מִדְּרָכִים שׁוֹנִים הִנֵּה הִיא נֶעְלָמָה מֵעֵינַי כָּל חַי וְלֹא יֵת"ש
לְבַד נִתְכַּנּוּ עַל־לִילוֹת

**in all the different types of ways, is hidden from the eyes of
every living being, and He alone 'accounts for the deeds' of
man (see I Samuel 2:3).**

אֲמָנָם בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּל־ל הִנֵּה הִיא נִרְאָה קֶצֶת לְעֵינֵינוּ ג"כ

**But in a general sense we can also get a glimpse with our own
eyes**

איך שְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל בַּמִּשְׁפָּט וְהַכֹּל בַּדִּין וּמִתְקִים מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

**how everything is done according to the statute and the law,
and all the statutes of the Torah are fulfilled –**

בְּדִנֵי כְרִיתוֹת וְאֲבִדוֹן לְהַמְחִיבִים בָּהּ

**with respect to the laws of excision and loss to those who are
culpable,**

עַד שֶׁכִּמְעַט כָּבֵר נִפְרַע מֵהֶם דֵּינָם

**to the extent that their sentence has almost been carried out
fully,**

גַּם בַּעוֹה"ז ע"פ דְּרָכֵי הַתּוֹרָה ג"כ

even in this world, according to the ways of Torah as well.

וְהוּא כָּל הַרְעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת הַגְּדוֹלוֹת וְהַנּוֹרָאוֹת שֶׁמִּתְחַלְפִּים
וְעוֹבְרִים עַל כָּלֵל יִשְׂרָאֵל

**And this is via all the bad things that happen and the great and
terrible suffering that passes over the Jewish Community,**

מֵעֲנוּי וּמֵעֲנֵי וּמִחֲלָאִים רָעִים וְנֶאֱמָנִים וּמִכָּל פְּחָדִים הַבָּאִים מִדֶּבֶר
וְחֶרֶב וְשָׁבִי וּבִזָּה

**including torment, poverty, terrible illnesses and all the fears
that arise from plagues and wars and being taken captive and
pillaging.**

וּכְבָּר אָמְרוּ מִכּוֹת כ"ג א' כָּל חֲיָבֵי כְרִיתוֹת שֶׁלְקוֹ נִפְטְרוּ יְדֵי כְרִיתָתָם

**As the Sages already declared in Tractate Makkot 23a: All those
culpable of sins that are punishable by excision, but suffered
lashes, are exempt from excision.**

וּבִפְרָט בְּהִכָּאָה שְׁאִין לָהּ קִצְבָּה הָרִי הוּא חֲמוּר מִמִּיתָה כּמ"ש
כְּתוּבָת ל"ג רע"ב

And this is particularly so regarding beatings that have no established limits; these are worse than death, as Tractate Ketubot 33b states.

וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁם עוֹד נ"א ע"ב שְׁבוּיֵי מַלְכוּת הָרִי הֵן כְּשְׁבוּיֵין

They also said there Ketubot 51b that political prisoners are regarded as captives,

וְשָׁבִי קָשָׁה מִכָּלֶם מִמָּוֶת וּמִחֶרֶב וּמִרָעָב דְּכוּלָּהּוּ אֵיתְנָהּוּ בֵּיהּ כַּמ"ש
בָּבָא בְּתָרָא ח' ב'

and being taken captive is the most devastating of all, more than death, war and famine, because it has elements of all of them, as the Sages write in Bava Batra 8b.

וְאָמְרוּ עוֹד בְּמַכּוֹת כ"ב כ"ג וְנִקְלָה אַחִיךָ לְעֵינֶיךָ בֵּינּוּ שְׁנִקְלָה הָרִי
הוּא כְּאַחִיךָ

The Sages also said (Makkot 22-23) on the verse (Deuteronomy 25:3), "Lest your brother be dishonored in your eyes" – once he has been dishonored, he is like your brother.

וּבִסְנֵה־דָרִין מ"ה א' כִּי בִזְיוֹנִי הוּא קָשָׁה מִיִּסּוּרִים

In Tractate Sanhedrin 45a the Sages state: Humiliation is worse than torture.

וּכְבָּר דִּי בִזְיוֹ וְקֶצֶף שְׁנֵתוּנִים לְחֶרֶף וּלְמָשָׁל וְלִשְׁנִינָה

It is already more than 'enough contempt and rage' (see Esther 1:18), when they are shamed, derided, and mocked (see Jeremiah 24:9).

וְהָרִי בְּכָל זֶה הִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל דֵּין כְּרִיתוֹת וְדִין ד' מִיתוֹת ב"ד בְּכָל־
יִשְׂרָאֵל

Thus, with all of these things, the Jewish People as a whole have borne the sentence of excision, and the verdict of the four types of death meted out by the Rabbinical court.

וְכָבֵד נִפְרָעוּ וְנִפְטְרוּ מִכָּל גַּם ע"פ מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

All of their sins **have thus been fully paid for and they are no longer indebted at all, even according to the laws of the Torah.**

וְאִם עֲדִין נִשָּׂאֵר בְּאֶחָד אִיזָה חָטָא וְשִׁמְץ דְּפִי

Now even if there remains for an individual some sin or smidgeon of a defect

הֲלֹא מִיָּתָהּ מִמָּרְקָת וְחִבּוּט הַקֶּבֶר וְעֲנָשֵׁי גֵיהֶנֶם מְנַקִּין אוֹתוֹ

– doesn't death wipe it away, and decomposition in the grave and the punishments of Gehinom cleanse him of his sin?

וְלֹא נִשָּׂאֵר מֵעֲתָה עַל שׁוּם אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל אִיזָה חוֹב וְשִׁטְר פֶּרְעוֹן מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

And from now on, there does not remain for any Jew any debt or promissory note in terms of the laws of Torah

לְעַכְבֹּב אוֹתוֹ מִתְקוּהַּ הָעִתִּידָהּ וְע"י כ"ז הִנֵּה יִזְכּוּ כָּלֶם לְכָל תִּקְוַת חֲמִדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל.

that could prevent him from what we all hope for in the future. By means of all this, everyone will merit what all Jews anticipate and yearn for.

וְהַעֲקָר הוּא כִּי גַם הַתּוֹרָה בְּכָל מִשְׁפָּטָהּ וְעֲנָשָׁהּ אֵינָה נוֹתֵן יָאוֹשׁ כָּלֶל לְשׁוּם רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

The main point is that all the laws of the Torah and its punishments should not cause despair at all to a wicked person or a sinner

מִהַשְׁאֲרַת הַנִּצָּחִי וְכמ"ש בְּתוֹרַת כְּהֲנִים פ' אֶמּוֹר כ"ג

regarding the eternal life of his soul, as it states in the Sifra¹⁴ on Leviticus**, *Emor* 23**

בפסוק והאבדתי את הנפש ההיא מקרב עמה

verse (30): "I will remove that soul from among its people":

והאבדתי מה ת"ל לפי שהוא אומר כרת בכל מקום ואיני יודע מהו

'I will remove' – what does this teach us? Wherever it states excision, and I do not know that that is,

כשהוא אומר והאבדתי למד על הכרת שאינו אלא אבדון

when it states, 'I will remove' this teaches you about excision, which is the removal meant.

וכתב שם הר"מ מלבים ז"ל כי יש הבדל בין כריתה ובין אבדון

The Malbim explains there that there is a difference between excision and removal,

כי הכוונה כוונת את העצם משרשו וקוצץ הדבר עצמו

because excision cuts off the thing itself from its root and detaches the thing itself from its source,

והמאבד הוא רק שנוי מקומות שלא תעלה הנפש אל צרור החיים
רק יורדת לגיהנם

whereas 'removal' means merely that it changes locality, so that the *nefesh* the aspect of the soul that enlivens the body does not ascend to be bound in the Bond of Life, but instead it descends to Gehinom.

ובכ"ז אינה נכרתת רק נאבדת לזמן מגבל כמ"ש משפט רשעים
בגיהנם י"ב חדש

Nevertheless it is not cut off completely, but is only 'removed' for a specified time, as the Sages said: The sentence of a wicked person in Gehinom is 12 months maximum.¹⁵

וכל אובד מתבקש וכמ"ש ובאו האבדים בארץ אשור

And anyone who was 'removed' is subsequently summoned, as the verse (Isaiah 27:13) states: "Those who were removed to the land of Assyria will come... and prostrate themselves before God in Jerusalem"

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר לִמַּד עַל הַכֶּרֶת שְׁאִינוּ אֶלָּא אָבְדוֹן

This is why they said that this teaches you about excision – that it is nothing other than removal.

רְצוֹנוֹ לומר שְׁאִינוּ כְּרִיתָה נִצְחִית רַק אָבְדוֹן בְּשָׂאוֹל וְאָבְדוֹן לְשַׁעְתּוֹ עַד יִקְבֹּל עָנְשׁוֹ

Meaning to say, this is not permanent excision, only removal to *She'ol* (Gehinom) and temporary removal until the person has undergone their punishment.

כִּי ה' בְּרַחֲמָיו חוֹשֵׁב מִחֲשָׁבוֹת בִּלְתִּכְרֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּהַחֲלֵט עַכ"ל

For God in His mercy calculates matters so that a soul will never be cut off completely." Here ends the quote from the Sifra.

וְהוּא כַּמ"ש בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ק"ט ע"ב וַיֵּאבְדוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַקְהָל

And this is similar to what it states in Tractate Sanhedrin 109b on the verse (Numbers 16:33) "They were lost from among the congregation":

ר' יְהוּדָה בֶּן בֶּתִירָה אוֹמֵר הֵרִי הוּן כְּאֵבְדָה הַמִּתְבַּקֶּשֶׁת שְׁנֹאֲמַר תַּעֲיִתִי כְּשֶׁה אֵבֵד בְּקֶשׁ עֲבֹדְךָ

Rabbi Yehuda ben Beteira declared: "They are like a lost object that their owner is seeking, as it states (Psalms 119:176) "I have strayed like a lost sheep; seek out Your servant..."

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּמִכּוֹת כ"ד א' עַל הַפְּסוּק וַאֲבִדְתֶּם בַּגּוֹיִם שְׁאִין זֶה הַכֶּרֶם בָּלָל לְאֲבֹדוֹן מִחֲלֵט ח"ו

And so too in Tractate Makkot 24a on the verse (Leviticus 26:38) "You will become lost among the nations..." – this need not be interpreted at all as complete destruction, Heaven forfend,

אֵלָא רַק בְּאַבְדָּה הַמִּתְבַּקֶּשֶׁת וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכ"ז שְׁגָם בְּמִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה
וְדִינֶיהָ וְעֲנִשָּׁהּ

but instead like a lost object that the owner seeks. Thus we have it from all the above that even according to the laws of the Torah and its sentencing and punishments

אִין בָּהּ כָּלֵל אֲבִדּוֹן הַחֲלָטִי ח"ו לְשׁוּם רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

this does not at all imply complete destruction, Heaven forfend, for any wicked person or sinner.

וְעוֹד כִּי הָאֱמֶת הוּא שֶׁכָּל עֲנִשָּׁהּ בְּכָל הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבְּתוֹרַת כְּהֲנִים
וְשֶׁבְּמִשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה

Furthermore, the truth is that all of the punishments and curses found in Leviticus and Deuteronomy

הֵנָּה הוּא ג"כ אֵלָא רַק בְּגִלוּיָהּ וּלְבוּשָׁהּ שֶׁהִיא עֲתֵּה לְפָנֵינוּ

are all only in the revealed aspects and the 'garments' of the Torah as it is before us at this time.

אֲבָל בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָהּ וּבְהֶעֱלֵם הֵנָּה אָמְרוּ בַּזֶּהר חֲדָשׁ פ' כִּי תָבֹא בָשֶׁם
אֲלֵיהֶו זְכוּר לְטוֹב

But in its inner dimension and in a concealed manner the *Zohar Chadash*, Tavo states in the name of Elijah, may his memory be a blessing,

כִּי כָל הַבְּטָחוֹת וְנִחְמוֹת דִּישְׂרָאֵל בְּהֵנִי קְלָלוֹת כְּתִיבִי

that all the promises and consolations of the Torah are expressed in those curses!

וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁם כִּי בַפֶּסוּק וְהָיוּ חַיֵּיךָ תְּלוּיִם לָךְ מִנֶּגֶד וּפְחָדָה לַיְלָה וַיּוֹמֵם
וְלֹא תֵאֱמִין בְּחַיֵּיךָ

For example, **they state there on the verse** (Deuteronomy 28:66)
**"Your life will hang in the balance, and you will be frightened
night and day, and you will not be sure of your livelihood"**

הִנֵּה שֶׁם מְרַמֵּז קִץ הַגָּאֻלָּה.

the *Zohar Chadash* understands that **this is an allusion to the final
redemption.**

וְהָרִי נִרְמַז בְּהַתּוֹרָה גּוֹפָה בְּכָל מִשְׁפָּטָה וְעֲנָשָׁה כָּל הַיְעוּדִים
הָעֲתִידִים

**Thus it is hinted in the Torah itself that in all the judgments
and punishments are all the guarantees regarding the future.**

שֶׁהֵם לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם גַּם מִי שֶׁעוֹמֵד תַּחַת שִׁבְט כָּל הַקְּלָלוֹת שָׁבָה
בְּלִי חֲסוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם

**And this applies to all of Israel without exception, even one
who stands under the threat of all the curses therein.**

וְהוּא כִּמּוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל תִּקְוָה הָעֲתִידָה הִנֵּה הוּא תְּלוּי בְּבְרִית וְלֹא
בְּזָכוֹת

**And this is as we said, that the hope for the future depends
upon the Covenant, and not upon merit,**

וְכָל בְּרִית לֹא תוּפֵר וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁישְׁתַּנֶּה

and no Covenant will be abrogated, nor can it possibly change.

וְכַמ־ש"ג כ' יְרֻמָּה ל"א וַיֵּשׁ תִּקְוָה לְאַחֲרִיתָךְ נֹאם ה'

**And as is written in Jeremiah 31:16 "There is hope for your
future, says the Lord."**

עוד שם כה אָמר ה' נתן שֶׁמֶשׁ לְאוֹר יוֹמָם חֻקַּת יָרֵחַ וְכוֹכְבִּים לְאוֹר לַיְלָה כו' אִם יִמְשׁוּ הַחֻקִּים הָאֵלֶּה כו' גַּם זָרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יִשְׁבְּתוּ מֵהָיִיתָ גוֹי לִפְנֵי כָּל הַיָּמִים כֹּה אָמַר ה' אִם יִמְדּוּ שָׁמַיִם מִלְמַעְלָה וַיִּחְקְרוּ מוֹסְדֵי אָרֶץ לְמָטָה גַּם אֲנִי אֶמָּאֵס בְּכָל זָרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשׂוּ נָאֻם ה'

Furthermore, it also states there (Jeremiah 31:34-36): "Thus says the Lord, Who gives the sun as light by day, the laws of the moon and the stars as lights by night...? If these laws could budge... then so could the seed of Israel cease from being a people before Me forever. Thus says the Lord, If the heavens above could be measured, or the foundations of the earth below be plumbed, so too would I reject the entire seed of Israel because of everything they did, says the Lord."

וְכֵן שָׁם כ"ט כִּי אֲנֹכִי יֹדַעְתִּי אֶת הַמַּחְשָׁבֹת אֲשֶׁר אֲנֹכִי חֹשֵׁב עֲלֵיכֶם נָאֻם ה' מַחְשְׁבוֹת שְׁלוֹם וְלֹא לְרָעָה לָתֵת לָכֶם אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה.

Similarly, in Jeremiah 29:11 "For I know what I think about you, says the Lord; thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and hope."

וּמ"ש שְׁלוֹם וְלֹא לְרָעָה הַכּוֹנֶנָה מִבְּאֵר שָׁגֹם כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָם

When it states, "of peace and not of evil" the intention is clear – all the punishments as well

הֵם אֵינָם לְנִקְמָה וּלְהַשְׁמִיד וּלְהַשְׁחִית ח"ו אֲלָא רַק כְּדֵי לָתֵת אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה

are not for the purpose of revenge, to destroy and uproot, Heaven forbid, but only 'to give... a future and hope."

וְכֵן יֵשׁ בָּמָה כְּתוּבִים בְּתַנְ"ךְ הַמּוֹרִים עַל זֶה שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲכֹב שׁוּם חֻטָּא וְעוֹן לְתִקְוַת הָעַתִּידָה.

There are a number of other verses in the Tanach (Scripture) that also indicate that no sin or transgression can withhold our hopes for the future.

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׁנָאֵיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהֶאֱבִידוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּרָשָׁעֵי עֹבְדֵי
אֱלִילִים

As for the verse (Deuteronomy 7:10) that states, "**He repays His enemies to their face to destroy them**" – **this applies only to wicked idolaters,**

וכמ"ש במדרש תהלים מזמור ז' וְכֵן בְּעֶרְב רַב כֵּן"ל פ"ה

as Midrash Tehillim 7 states, and also to the erev rav (the mixed multitude who made and worshiped the golden calf), as explained above, chap. 5,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק בראשית כ"ה ב' וְכֵן בַּפ' תֵּצֵא רַע"ז ב'

as the holy Zohar, Bereishit 25b also states, and in Tetzai 277b as well.

אֲבָל בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אֵינוֹ מִתְּנַהֵג הַקב"ה בְּמַדָּה זוֹ כָּלֵל

But the blessed Holy One does not comport Himself with Israelites in this manner at all,

וכמ"ש בספרי ברכה בפסוק יחי ראובן ואֵל יָמָת

as the Sifri explains on the verse (Deuteronomy 33:6) "May Reuven live and not die" –

כִּי לְעוֹלָם אֵין מַחְלִיפִים לֹא זְכוּת בְּחוּבָה וְלֹא חוּבָה בְּזְכוּת

merit is never exchanged for culpability, or culpability for merit.

אֲלֹא נוֹתְנִים מַתָּן שָׂכָר עַל הַמִּצְוֹת וְעֵנָשִׁים עַל הָעֲבֵרוֹת

Instead, reward is given for mitzvot fulfilling the Commandments, and punishment for transgression.

וְכָל עֲבֵרָה וְעֵנָשׁ אֵינָם נִצָּחִים ח"ו וְהֵם נִפְסָקִים וּמִתְבַּטְּלִים וְכֵן"ל
בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ

And no transgressions and its punishment are forever, Heaven forfend; rather, they end and are nullified as we explained above.

אבל המצוות ושכרן אין להם הפסק לישראל והם נצחיים בהם

However, the mitzvot and their reward have no end and they are eternal for Israelites.

והסבה בזה הוא כי בישראל אשר עליהם נאמר בנים אתם לה' אלהיכם

The reason for this is that about the Jewish People the verse (Deuteronomy 14:1) states "You are children to the Lord your God,"

הנה כל מצוה עצם בו כי אוריתא וישראל חד הוא

thus every mitzvah is an essential part of them, since 'the Torah and Israel are one',¹⁶

אבל העברה הוא רק מקרה בו כי הוא מהתערבות רע בטוב אשר ע"י החטא דעץ הדעת

whereas a transgression is merely incidental to them to their essence since it is a composite of good and evil that came about because of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge,

ולכן מתבטל העברה ע"י הענש ונשאר עצמותו קודש לה'

and therefore the transgression is nullified by the punishment meted out to them, and their essence remains sanctified to God.

אבל בעובדי אלילים הוא להפך כי עצמותם הוא מעצם הסמ' אל אחר עצם הרע

But with idol worshippers the opposite is true, since their essence is from the essence of the satanic other god, the essence of evil,

שהוא שרש האבדון וההפסד וכנ"ל פ"ז

which is the root of destruction and annihilation, as explained above in chapter 7.

וכל מצוה ודבר טוב שעושים הוא אינו מעצמותם אלא
מהתערבות הטוב ברע

And any good deed they do is not part of their essence, but from the admixture of good in the evil

אשר ע"י החטא דעץ הדעת ומשרש סוד הנגה המאיר עליהם
מסביב כנ"ל פ"ז

that resulted from the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, and from the mystical concept of the glow that radiates to them from all around, as explained in chapter 7.

והרי הוא אינו שלהם כלל כי הרע והטוב הרי הם שני הפכים

Accordingly, it the good deed is not theirs at all, since good and evil are two opposites.

ולכן לעתיד כשיברר הטוב מהרע ויתבטל הרע מכל וכל הנה
יתבטלו הם בבטולן כי הם תולדותיו וממנו

And therefore, in the future when good will be purified of evil, and evil will be completely nullified, they too will be annulled with its nullification, since they are its product.

וכל מצוה ודבר טוב שנעשה על ידם בעוה"ז ע"י התערבות טוב
ברע הנז'

And any mitzvah or good deed they did in this world, by way of the admixture of good within evil, as mentioned

הנה משלם להם הקב"ה בעוה"ז ג"כ כי הוא ית"ש אינו מקפח
שכר כל בריה

the blessed Holy One will also pay them in this world, because He does not withhold the reward of any creature,

וְהָיָה נַעֲשֵׂת עַל יָדָם עַכְכָּ"פ וּמִשּׁוּם כ"ז הִנֵּה מִתְנַהֵּג הַקָּב"ה עִמָּהֶם
בְּמִדָּה

and indeed it was done by them, and therefore the blessed Holy One acts towards them measure for measure –

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשִׁנְאָיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ מִשָּׂא"כ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל ח"ו וְכֵנִז'

rewarding those who deserve reward, and repaying those who despise Him to His face with destruction. But this does not apply to the Jewish People, Heaven forbid, as we explained.

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם וְעַמָּךְ כָּלֵם צְדִיקִים וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק
לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא.

And therefore, about them it states (Isaiah 60:21) "and all of Your people are righteous" and 'all of Israel have a portion in the World to Come.'¹⁷

אֲמָנָם כָּל אֱלוֹ שֶׁחֲשָׁבוּ רז"ל וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק לְעוֹה"ב

However, all those whom our Sages reckoned and declared would not have a portion in the World to Come,

הִנֵּה כָּתֹב הַרְקָאנְטִי פ' תִּשָּׂא בַּפִּסּוּק אֲנִי אֶעֱבִיר כָּל טוֹבֵי בְּשֵׁם רַבֵּינוּ
עֲזָרָא

Recanati¹⁸ **writes in the name of Rabbeinu Ezra**¹⁹ **on the verse in Parshat Ki Tissa (Exodus 33:19) "I shall make all My goodness pass before you" –**

כִּי מֵה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּמִּקּוֹמוֹת רַבִּים מִדְּבַרֵּי רז"ל אֵין לוֹ חֵלֶק לְעוֹה"ב

When we find in a number of places in the words of our Sages, that certain people do not have a portion in the World to Come,

ר"ל אין לו בית בפני עצמו אוצר שהוא ברשותו והוא מושל עליו
וזהו עושין לו מדור לפי כבודו

this means that they do not have an abode of their own, that is their own domain and in their control, as in 'they provide a righteous soul with an abode befitting his honor.'²⁰

ומי שאין לו זכות הוא עומד במקום שעומדים רבים עכ"ל

But someone who does not have that merit stands in a place together with many others. This concludes the words of Rabbi Recanati.

וכן כתב רבינו בחיי סוף פ' אחרי (ע"ש בארקה ותמצא כדברינו)

Rabbeinu Bechaye writes in similar vein at the end of Parshat Acharei (see there at length and find our words corroborated).

ולפ"ז הרי אפשר לומר כי דורשי רשומות שאמרו בסנהדרין ק"ד
סע"ב כִּלְוֹן בְּאִין לַעוּה"ב וְכַנ"ל

Accordingly, it is possible to say that the 'interpreters of the verses' mentioned in Tractate Sanhedrin 104b, that all Israelites will enter the World to Come,

הנה לא פליגי על המשנה שם צ' ע"א במה שאמרו ואלו שאין להם
חלק לעוה"ב

do not argue with the Mishnah there Sanhedrin 90a when they said that 'these do not have a portion in the World to Come.'

כי הרי גם הדורשי רשומות לא אמרו אלא לשון בְּאִין לַעוּה"ב

For the 'interpreters of the verses' only said that 'they will enter the World to Come,'

אבל לא אמרו שיש להם חלק שהוא מקום מיוחד השיך להם

but they did not say that 'they have a *portion* – a space designated for each of them individually – in the World to

Come.'

אֵלָא שֶׁהֵם יִשְׁתַּמְּשׁוּ בְּאוֹרָן שֶׁל הַזּוֹכִים שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר הַכִּלְי הַכוֹלֵל
כָּלֶם

Instead they will be allowed to share in the light of those who are worthy – the all-inclusive light that includes everyone –

וְהוּא כְּעֵין מְקוֹם מַעְבָּר לְרַבִּים וְיִהְיֶה לְפִי"ז הַבְּדֵל גָּדוֹל

which is a sort of passageway for all, and therefore there will be a major difference

בֵּין עַבְד אֱלֹהִים לַאֲשֶׁר לֹא עֲבָדוּ כְּגִבְהַ שָׁמַיִם עַל הָאָרֶץ וּבְרִחוֹק
מִזְרָח מִמְּעַרֵב

between those who served God and those who did not, like the difference between the heights of the heavens and earth, and like the distance between east and west.

וְהִיא ע"ד שְׁאֲנוּ רוֹאִין בַּעוֹה"ז כִּי הָגֵם שֶׁכָּל מִי אֲשֶׁר יַחְבֵּר לַחַיִּים יֵשׁ
לוֹ מְקוֹם וּמִזוֹן בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

This is similar to what we see in this world – that although one who is connected to Life has a place and his sustenance in this world,

עכ"ז הָרִי כְּמָה הַבְּדֵל גָּדוֹל בֵּין מִי שֶׁמְכַלְכֵּל אֶת נַפְשׁוֹ בִּלְחֵם לֶאֱכֹל
וּבִגְד לְלַבֵּשׁ

nevertheless, what a great difference there is between one who sustains their soul with just enough bread to eat and clothing to wear,

לְבִין מִי שֶׁמַּתְעַנֵּג אֶת עַצְמוֹ וּמַתְעַדֵּן כָּל יָמָיו בְּסִגְלַת מְלָכִים

and one who indulges himself and delights in the delicacies of kings for his entire life.

וְגַם בְּהַזְכִּים גּוֹפָה הָרִי יִהְיֶה בָּהֶם ג"כ כְּמָה וְכְמָה חֲלוּקֵי מַדְרָגוֹת

Even among those who have the merit of a portion in the World to Come there are several different levels,

וְכַמְבָּאָר בְּכִמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת מִדְּבָרֵי חַז"ל וְאָמְרוּ בְּתַעֲנִית סַפ"ק לֹא
הַכֹּל לְאוֹרָה וְלֹא הַכֹּל לְשִׂמְחָה צְדִיקִים לְאוֹרָה וְיֹשְׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה

as explained in a number of places in the words of our Sages, who said in the first chapter of Tractate Ta'anit: "Not everyone is granted light; not everyone is granted joy – the righteous are granted light and the upright, joy.

וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ תְּהִלִּים מְזֻמּוֹר י"א סִי' ו' חוֹשֵׁב שֶׁשֶׁם ז' חֲלוּקֵי מַדְרָגוֹת בֵּין
כְּתוּבֹת הַצְדִּיקִים לְעֵתִיד לָבוֹא ע"ש

Midrash Tehillim 11:6 reckons 7 levels of groups of the righteous in the Time to Come. See there.

וּבִיּוֹקְרָא רָבָא פ"ל סִימֵן ב' וּבִגְמָרָא ב"ב ע"ה א' עֵתִיד הַקֶּב"ה
לַעֲשׂוֹת שִׁבְעַת חֲפֻצֹת לְכָל צְדִיק וְצְדִיק

In Vayikra Rabba 30:2 and in the Gemara Tractate Bava Batra 75a: In the future the blessed Holy One will make seven wedding canopies for each righteous person,

וְלִכָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד חֲפָה לְפִי כְבוֹדוֹ וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד נִכְוָה מִחֲפָתוֹ שֶׁל
חֲבֵרוֹ

and for each of them the wedding canopy will be according to the level of the person's honor, and each person will be envious of the beauty of his friend's wedding canopy. In other words, he will envy the righteousness that granted his friend such a glorious canopy.

עוֹד שֶׁם בְּעֵינָיו סִפֵּת עוֹרוֹ שֶׁל לוֹיֵיתָן זָכָה עוֹשִׂין לוֹ סִכָּה לֹא זָכָה
עוֹשִׂין לוֹ צֶלְצֵל

In that same source (Bava Batra 75a) it states regarding the covering²¹ that will be made from the skin of the Leviathan: If one is worthy they will make him a covering and four walls;** if

he is not** as **worthy, they will provide him shade** – just a covering without walls;

לא זָכָה עוֹשִׁין לוֹ עֵנָק לֹא זָכָה עוֹשִׁין לוֹ קָמַע

even **less worthy, they will make him a necklace**, and even **less worthy – an ornament** hung on a chain around the neck. All of the above are clearly analogies for varying spiritual rewards.

ועד"ז בַּכֶּמֶה אֲגָדוֹת חז"ל בְּעֵנֶנּוּ חִלּוּקוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת בֵּין מַדְרָגוֹת
הַצְדִּיקִים לַעֲתִיד לָבֹא וּכְנֻדָּע

Similar statements can be found in the Aggadic²² writings of the Sages regarding the various differences between the levels of the righteous in the Time to Come, as is known.

אֲמָנָם ע"פ עֵמֶק הַדְּבָרִים שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ לְעֵיל הִנֵּה יִהְיוּ כָל חִלְקֵת
הַמַּדְרָגוֹת הַנִּמְצָא בְּדַבְרֵי רז"ל

However, based on the depths of the matters discussed above, all of these various disparate levels among the righteous found in the teachings of the Sages

לְפִי עֵרֶךְ חִלְקֵת שֶׁרֶשׁ הַנִּשְׁמוֹת דָּכָל אֶחָד כִּי אֵין נִשְׁמָה דּוֹמָה
לַחֲבֵרָתָהּ

parallel the differences there are in the roots of the soul of each individual, because no soul is similar to any other one,

וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ שֶׁרֶשׁ בְּפָנָי עֲצָמוֹ וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ רז"ל בַּפָּסוּק
אֵיפֹה הָיִיתָ בְּיָסְדִי אָרֶץ

and each person has their own individual root, as our Sages teach on the verse (Job 38:4) "Where were you when I laid the earth's foundation"

בְּשִׁמּוֹת רַבָּא פִּרְשָׁה מ' סִימָן ג' וּבכ"מ וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים

– in *Shemot Rabba* 40:3 and in a number of other places: The entire Torah, and all good deeds,

וְכֵן לְהִפָּךְ כָּל הַחֲטָאִים וְעֲוֹנוֹת הֵנָּה נֹגַע כ"א לְפִי שֶׁשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ

and the opposite, all the sins and transgressions, affect a person according to the root of their soul.

וְכֵן עַד"ז בְּשִׁכְרוֹ וְעֲנָשׁוֹ כִּי אֵין שׁוּם אָדָם דּוֹמֶה לַחֲבֵרוֹ בְּכָל הַדּוֹרוֹת
כָּלָם

Similarly as regards reward and punishment, for no person is identical to another in this regard even in all previous generations,

וּבְכָל מִשְׁךְ יְמֵי עוֹלָם כָּלּוֹ

and even throughout the entire history of the world.

וְכֵן אֵינָם דּוֹמִים בְּכָל תְּהִלּוֹתֵיהֶם וּמֵאֲרָעוֹתֵיהֶם בַּעוֹה"ז

Nor are they similar in their paths through life and in the events that occur to them in this world.

וְעַד"ז בְּשִׁכְרוֹ וְעֲנָשׁוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְאַחַר מִיתָה בְּגֵן עֵדֶן וּגְיֵהֶנָּם

And the same applies to their rewards or punishments after death in the Garden of Eden or in Gehinom.

וְכֵן הֵם חִלּוּקִים בְּמַדְרָגוֹתֵיהֶם לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

Similarly, there are divisions between their levels in the World to Come,

וְהֵגַם שֶׁהָרִי בְּתִקּוֹן הָאֲחֵרוֹן יִכְלָלוּ כָּל הַנִּשְׁמּוֹת כָּלָם זב"ז ע"ד שֶׁהָיוּ
כְּלוּלִים כָּלָם בְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן

even though with the final rectification all souls will be integrated, in the same manner that they were all included in Adam.

אֲךְ גַּם בְּפִרְצוֹי אֶחָד וְאָדָם אֶחָד הָרִי אֵינּוּ דּוֹמֶה אֶבֶר אֶחָד לַחֲבֵרוֹ

However, even in one composite entity of a single person, one limb is not the same as another.

וּבְזֶה יִהְיוּ כָּל חִלְקֵי הַמִּדְרָגוֹת לְעֵתִיד לָבוֹא וְהֵבִין כ"ז.

This will be the manner in which all the divisions will exist in the future. Understand all this.

וְכֵן בְּעֵנֵינוּ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת אֵין לוֹ חֵלֶק לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

Similarly as regards the statement of the Sages in a number of places that 'such a person has no portion in the World to Come'²³ –

הִנֵּה יִהְיֶה הַכּוֹנֵה לְפִי דְבָרֵינוּ עַל כָּל מִשָּׁךְ הַזְמַן עַד שְׁיָגִיעַ עֵת הַתְּקוּן

according to our analysis presented above, the intention is: the entire time *until* the rectification.

כִּי כָּל חֵלְקוֹ וְשָׂכְרוֹ דְּעוֹה"ב אֲשֶׁר הָיָה מוֹכֵן אֵלָיו

Because his or her entire portion and reward in the World to Come, which is prepared for him or her

בְּאוֹרוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים דְּשֶׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ

as the illuminations contained in the supernal *gevurot* at the root of his or her soul,

הָרִי נִסְתַּלְקוּ מִמֶּנּוּ וְנִפְסַק מֵהֶם ע"י שְׁנֵת חֲלָפּוֹ אוֹתָן כָּל הַכּחוֹת דְּהַגְּבוּרוֹת

these are withdrawn from him or her and are terminated due to all the powers of the *gevurot* being transformed

לְתַקֵּף דִּינִים קָשִׁים ע"י אַחֲזִיזַת הַחִיצוֹנִים בָּהֶם

into the powers of harsh judgments by means of the outside spiritual forces latching onto them.

וְהָרִי נֶאֱבַד חֶלְקוֹ מִמֶּנּוּ לְגַמְרִי ע"י אוֹתוֹ הָעֲבֵרָה הַחֲמוּרָה

Thus the person's portion is lost to him completely, due to that serious transgression

וְהִשְׁלִיט אֶת הַחִיצוֹנִים בְּהַגְבוּרוֹת דְּשֶׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הָיָה
שְׂכָרוֹ וְחֶלְקוֹ דְּעוֹה"ב

by which he gave dominance to the outside forces over the *gevurot* at the root of his soul – where his reward and portion in the World to Come were located.

וְאִין לוֹ תִּקְנָה מֵעַתָּה שְׂיִחְזֹר לוֹ אֶלָּא רַק אוֹ ע"י תְּשׁוּבָה וּתְפִלָּה
וְצִדְקָה הַמַּעֲבִירִין אֶת רַע הַגְּזֵרָה

And now he has no other recourse to return it other than through 'repentance (*teshuvah*), prayer and charitable acts, which remove the awful decree,'²⁴

שֶׁהֵם דּוֹחִין אֶת הַחִיצוֹנִים וּמַבְטְלִין כִּי בְּתְשׁוּבָה וּתְפִלָּה וְצִדְקָה

for these push away the outside forces and nullify them, because by means of repentance and prayer and charitable acts

מִתְבַּסְּמִין וּמִתְמַתְקִין הַגְּבוּרוֹת בְּרִשְׁפֵּי אֵשׁ שֶׁלֹּהֶבֶת יְיָ וְשׁוֹרְפִין
וּמַכְלִין אֶת כָּל אוֹתוֹ הָרַע שֶׁנֶּאֱחָז בָּהֶם

the *gevurot* are perfumed and sweetened by the blazing flames of God that burn and destroy all the evil that latches onto them.

אֲבָל בְּלֹא תְּשׁוּבָה אִין לוֹ תִּקְנָה שְׂיִחְזֹר לוֹ חֶלְקוֹ

But without repentance there is no way to rectify the situation and restore his portion,

אֶלָּא רַק אַחֵר שְׂיִתְהַפֵּךְ כָּל אוֹתוֹ הָרַע לְסַעַר מִתְחַלֵּל וּלְדִין קָשָׁה
לְפִי מִדַּת וּמִשְׁקַל אוֹתוֹ הָעֲבֵרָה

until after that evil will be transformed into 'a storm that devolves' (Jeremiah 23:19) the harsh verdict upon the head of the perpetrator,²⁵ commensurate with the seriousness of his transgression.

ועי"ז יתבטל אותו הרע ג"כ אחר שיפרע ממנו מכל וכל ואז יחזר לתקונו ולחלקו ושכרו

In this way too that evil is nullified, once his debt has been paid completely. Only then will his status and portion and reward be returned to him,

אחר הצרור הגדול והלבון כנ"ל בדברינו

after the great scouring and purification we discussed above.

וזהו כוננתם ז"ל בכל אותן העברות שאמרו עליהם אין לו חלק לעוה"ב

This then is what the Sages mean when they said about certain transgressions that the person will not have a portion in the World to Come –

והכונה הוא כי אבד חלקו ונפסק ממנו (כי נסתלק ועלה ונתעלם בשרשו)

the intention is that he loses his portion and it is blocked from him (because it was retracted above and became concealed in its source),

ואין לו תקנה שיחזר לו אלא ע"י אחד מב' דברים הנז' ע"י זה או ע"י זה

and he has no recourse to have it returned other than in one of the two ways mentioned – by way of this repentance, or by way of that his punishment.

אבל לבסוף הנה יתקן עכ"פ והוא ע"י הענשים והצרור והלבון וככל מה שאמרנו לעיל

But in the end it will be rectified in any event, via punishments and scouring and purification, and everything we mentioned earlier.

הגהה — וְכֵן מִצָּאֵתִי מִפְּרֶשׁ בְּדִבְרֵי הָאַרִיז"ל בְּשֵׁעַר הַגִּלְגּוּלִים סוּף
הַקִּדְמָה כ"ד וְכֵן בְּמֵאמְרֵי רז"ל סְנֵהֲדְרִין דָּף ו' סע"א מִדְפוּה"ח דָּגָם
כָּל אֵלּוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אִין לָהֶם חֶלֶק לַעוֹה"ב הַכִּנְנָה הוּא שְׁאִין עוֹלִים
לִמ"ן בְּאֵמָא עֲלָא הַנִּקְרָא עוֹה"ב אֵלּא (שֶׁאֲחֵר שְׁמִקְבָּלִים עֲנָשָׁם)
הֵנָּה הֵם בְּסוּד מ"ן שְׁבִמְלָכוֹת ע"כ הַגָּהָה

Note: I found this stated explicitly in the words of the Arizal in Sha'ar haGilgulim end of Intro 24, and also in the statements of our Sages in Sanhedrin 6a (in the new printing) – that all those about whom it was said 'they have no portion in the World to Come,' the intention is that they cannot arouse ma"n the 'feminine waters'²⁶ to Ima ila'ah binah above, which is called 'the World to Come' – until after they receive their punishment. Thus they are the secret of the ma"n of malchut. End of note.**

וְזֶהוּ ג"כ עֲנִין הַג' סְפָרִים שֶׁנִּפְתָּחִין בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם ט"ז ב'

This is also the concept of the 3 books that are open on Rosh Hashana, see Tractate Rosh Hashana 16b,

וְכָתְבוּ שָׁם הַתּוֹסֵפֹת שֶׁעֲנִין הַג' סְפָרִים הֵלְלוּ הֵם לַחַיִּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא

regarding which the Tosafot comments: these 3 books are relevant to the World to Come.

וְלִכְאוּרָה יִפְּלֵא מָה שֶׁיֵּךְ לָדוֹן עַל חַיִּי עוֹה"ב בְּעוֹד שֶׁהָאָדָם עֹדִין
בַּעוֹה"ז

Now at first glance this is astonishing – why is it relevant to discuss life in the World to Come, while a person is still alive in this world?

הֲלֹא אִין עֲתָה הַזְּמַן לָזֶה וְגַם אִם יֵצֵא חַיִּב בְּדִינוֹ שְׁמָא יִשׁוּב וְיִתְכַפֵּר
לוֹ

Isn't it so that now is not the time for this discussion? And furthermore, even if he is found guilty in his judgment, perhaps he will repent and be forgiven?

וְכֵן אִם יֵצֵא זָכָאֵי הָרִי לֹא יֵאֱמִין בְּקִדְשׁוֹ וַיֵּשׁ שְׁקוּנָה עוֹלָמוֹ בְּשַׁעָה
אַחַת וַיֵּשׁ שְׁמַאֲבֵד עוֹלָמוֹ בְּשַׁעָה אַחַת

Similarly, if the person emerges meritorious in his judgement 'He cannot have faith even in His holy beings' (Job 15:15), and 'one person can acquire his world in a moment,'²⁷ while another can lose his world in a moment.

וְמָה תוֹעֵלֶת הוּא מָה שְׂדָנִים אוֹתוֹ עַל זֶה בְּכָל שָׁנָה הָרִי רַק הָרָגַע
אַחֲרוֹנָה תוֹכִיחַ

What benefit then is there in judging him in this regard every year, since only his last moment will determine his fate?

אֲךָ הָעֲנִין הוּא כִּי בָּאִם שְׁזוּכָה לַחַיִּי הָעוֹה"ב הִנֵּה נִפְרָעִין מִמֶּנּוּ עַל
עוֹנְתָיו בְּעוֹה"ז

But the idea is that if he merits the World to Come, then the debt for his transgressions is claimed in this world.

וּבָאִם שְׁאִינוּ זוֹכָה לַחַיִּי עוֹה"ב וְצָרִיךְ לְצֻרוֹף וּלְבוֹן גָּדוֹל וְהוּא רַק
בְּהִז' מְדוּרֵי גֵיהֶנֶם

And if he is not worthy of the World to Come, then he requires great cleansing and purification, which is only in the seven chambers of Gehinom,

וְכָל הַדִּינִין דְּלֵאחֶר מֵיִתָּהּ וּמִטִּיבִין לוֹ בְּעוֹה"ז ע"ד שְׁאֶמְרוּ בְּקִדּוּשֵׁין
ט"ל ב' ע"ש כִּי מְסַלְקִין דִּינֵינוּ עַל לֵאחֶר מֵיִתָּהּ

and all of the harsh judgments that take place *after* death. But in this world he has it good, as the Sages say in Tractate Kiddushin 39b, see there, because they withhold his judgment until after death.

וּלְפַעֲמִים מְרִיעִין לוֹ בַּעוֹה"ז ג"כ כִּי יֵשׁ רָשָׁע וְטוֹב לוֹ רָשָׁע וְרַע לוֹ
הַכֹּל לְפִי עֶרֶךְ כְּמוֹת וְאִיכוֹת עֲוֹנָתוֹ

Now it does sometimes happen that things go badly with him in this world as well, because there are different categories of wicked people – there is a wicked person who has some good in him, and a wicked person who has only evil in him, and everything is according to the quantity and quality of his transgressions.

וְכָל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת דֵּהֶעוֹה"ז אֵיךְ שֶׁמִּתְנַהֲגִים עִמּוֹ הוּא תְּלוּי הַכֹּל לְפִי
מַה שֶׁעוֹמֵד בְּדִינוֹ בְּעֵנֶן חַיִּי עוֹה"ב

And all of the events that unfold in this world – how a person is treated – all depends upon the judgment passed on him regarding his life in the World to Come.

וְלִכּוֹן נִדּוֹן כָּל אָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בְּתַחֲלָה וּמִסֵּתְכָלִים עָלָיו אֵיךְ
שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד בְּדִינוֹ בְּעֵנֶן חַיִּי הָעוֹה"ב

And therefore every person is judged at the beginning of every year, and they the Heavenly Court examine his standing regarding life in the World to Come.

וְאַח"כּ הוּא נִדּוֹן לְפִי זֶה עַל כָּל מֵאֲרָעוֹתָיו דְּחַיִּי הָעוֹה"ז

Only after this is he judged regarding everything that takes place in his life in this world.

וְכֵן הוּא עֵנֶן עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת כֵּלָן הֵרִי הֵם רַק לְחַיִּי הָעוֹה"ב

There is also another concept here: all of the mitzvot only relate to the life of the World to Come,

וְכַמ"ש קְדוּשִׁין ס"ל ב' שֶׁכָּר מִצְוָה בְּהָאֵי עֲלָמָא לִיכָא

as it states in Tractate Kiddushin 30b: There is no reward in this world for a mitzvah.

וְכֵן בַּעֲבוּרֵי ג' הַיּוֹם לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ וְלֹא הַיּוֹם לְטַל שְׂכָרָן וְכָל חַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם
וְטוֹבוֹתֶיהָ

And so too in Tractate Avodah Zara pp. 3-4: Do it the mitzvah today, but their reward is not today, and all of the life of this world and the goodness thereof

הַנֶּה הוּא רַק בְּחֶסֶד וּבְצַדִּיקָה וְכַמ"ש בְּרָכוֹת י"ז ב' כָּל הָעוֹלָם כְּלוּ
נִזְוָנִין בְּצַדִּיקָה ע"ש

is only out of kindness and charity, as it states in Tractate Berachot 17b: The entire world is nourished by charity. See there.

וְהוּא רַק לְצַרֵּךְ קִיּוֹם הָעוֹלָם לַעֲשׂוֹת בָּהּ תּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם ב'

And this is only for the sake of the continued existence of the world, to fulfill Torah and mitzvot in it for the sake of the World to Come.

וְלָכֵן נִמְשָׁךְ כָּל חַיֵּי וְצָרָכֵי הָעוֹלָם לְהָאָדָם רַק לְפִי עֶרֶךְ שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד
בְּדִינוֹ לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם ב'

And therefore his entire life and his needs in this world are granted to him according to the degree he stands in judgement regarding the World to Come.

וְלָכֵךְ דִּנּוּן אֶת הָאָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בְּתַחֲלָה עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם ב'
וְאַח"כּ דִּנּוּן אוֹתוֹ לְפִי"ז עַל חַיָּיו וְעִנְיָנָיו דֶּהָעוֹלָם ז'

And therefore a person is judged annually regarding his life in the World to Come at the beginning of the year, and after this he is judged accordingly about his life and the matters concerning it in this world.

וְהִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא נִמְתָּק בְּיוֹתֵר ע"פ דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל עִנְיָן דָּאִין לוֹ
חֶלֶק לְעוֹלָם ב'

All of this makes much more sense²⁸ according to what we said – that any matter that does not have a portion in the World to

Come,

הַכּוֹנֵה הוּא רַק עַד שִׁיִּצְרָר וְיִתְלַבֵּן וְצָרִיךְ לְתִקּוּנִים גְּדוֹלִים לְהִתְתַּקֵּן
וּלְבוֹא לְמִדְרָגָתוֹ הַקּוֹדֶמֶת

**the intention is only until it will be cleansed and purified,
which requires great rectifications in order to be rectified and
come to its former stature.**

אֲךָ הוּא ית"ש הֵנָּה חֹשֵׁב מַחְשְׁבוֹת לְבַל יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח וּמִסַּבֵּב עָלָיו
סְבוּבִים שׁוֹנִים

**But He, may His Name be blessed, He calculates how nothing
will be pushed away from Him, and He ensures that certain
events take place,**

אִם בַּעוֹה"ז אוּ בַּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחֵר מִיָּתָה עַד שִׁתְּקַן
לְבִסּוּף עכ"פ

**whether in this world or in the world of souls after death, until
it will be rectified eventually.**

וְלָכֵן דָּנִין אֶת הָאָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה מִתְחַלֶּה בְּדִין דְּחֵי הַעוֹה"ב

**This is why a person is judged each year from the outset
regarding life in the World to Come,**

כְּדִי לְהִסְתַּכֵּל אֵיךְ לְהִתְנַהֵּג עִמּוֹ בְּכָל מַאֲרָעוֹתָיו דְּחֵי עוה"ז הַנִּצְרָךְ
לוֹ לְתִקּוּנוֹ

**in order to examine how to act towards a person in all of the
events that take place in the life of this world, as necessary for
him to achieve his rectification.**

וְזֶהוּ הַג' סְפָרִים שֶׁנִּפְתְּחִין בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֵׁם ט"ז ב'

**These are the three books that are opened on Rosh Hashana, as
it states in the Tractate 16b –**

וְהֵם עַל חַיֵּי עוֹה"ב וּבָהֶם הוּא בְּצַדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים וּבְרָשָׁעִים גְּמוּרִים
הַחֲתִימָה ג"כ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה

and these are about life in the World to Come in regard to the completely righteous and the completely wicked, and this is signed on Rosh Hashana.

אָבֵל בְּחַיֵּי עוֹה"ז הָיָה הַחֲתִימָה בְּכֻלָּם רַק בְּיוֹם הַכְּפוּרִים וְהוּא
כְּדַבְרֵי הַתּוֹסֵפֶת שָׁם

But, as regards life in *this* world, the final seal for everyone is only on Yom Kippur the Day of Atonement, as the Tosafot explains there.

וְכֵן הַסֵּפִים הֵגֵךְ"א בְּאו"ח סס"י תַּקַּפ"ב ע"ש.

The GRA too agrees with this conclusion in his commentary to *Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim*, chapter 582, see there.

וְתִקְנוּ לְבַקֵּשׁ עַל הַפְּתִיבָה עַד נַעֲלָה מִשּׁוּם דָּאִין לְהַחֲזִיק עֲצָמוֹ
לְצַדִּיק גְּמוּר

The Sages established that we offer supplications to be signed for a good year in this world *until the Ne'ilah* prayer, the final prayer on Yom Kippur, because a person should not regard himself as perfectly righteous.

וְהַבִּקְשָׁה הוּא הֵן עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב וְהֵן עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ז

This supplication includes both life in the World to Come and life in this world.

וּמוֹעִיל הַבִּקְשָׁה אִף לְרָשָׁע גְּמוּר גַּם בְּחַיֵּי עוֹה"ב הַגֵּם שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר
הַחֲתִימָה שֶׁהוּא בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כִּנּוּז'

This supplication is also beneficial for a completely wicked person, even as regards the life in the World to Come, albeit after the seal on Rosh Hashana,

משום שִׁיפָה צָעָקָה לְאָדָם בֵּין קֹדֶם גְּזַר דִּין בֵּין לְאַחַר גְּזַר דִּין כִּמ"ש
שֶׁם ט"ז א.

and the reason for this is that a person's crying out to God is beneficial whether before or after the decreed verdict, as it states there Tractate Rosh Hashana 16a.

ומ"ש שֶׁם הַגֵּר"א שָׂאִין לומר לְשָׁנָה טוֹבָה תִּכָּתֵב וְתִחָתֵּם אֶלָּא
תִּכָּתֵב

The GRA writes there that one should not say "May you be signed and sealed for a good year," but only, "*may* you be signed."

משום דְּלִשּׁוֹן לְשָׁנָה טוֹבָה שֶׁהוּא הוֹרָאת שָׁנָה אַחַת שָׁנָה זֶה

****The reason is that the expression "**May you have a good year..." applies only to a single year – *this* year.**

הָרִי הוּא רַק עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם כִּי בָּאֵם שֶׁהִיָּה הַכֹּנֶנָה עַל חַיֵּי עוֹלָם
ג"כ הִיָּה צ"ל סֵתֵם לְחַיִּים טוֹבִים תִּכָּתֵב וְתִחָתֵּם

Thus it applies only to life in this world, since if the intention was also the life in the World to Come, it should have simply said, "May you be signed and sealed for a good life,"

בְּלִי לְהַזְכִּיר לִשּׁוֹן שָׁנָה שֶׁהוּא מְשַׁמֵּעַ שָׁנָה זֶה

without mentioning the word 'year,' which implies *this* year.

וְהַעֲקָר הוּא מְשׁוּם שֶׁהָרִי לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם ב' נִגְמַר הַדִּין מִקֹּדֶם הֵן
הַכְּתִיבָה וְהֵן הַחֲתִימָה

The main point is that the judgment regarding life in the World to Come is completed earlier on, both the writing and the sealing,

וְאַחַר הַחֲתִימָה אֲשֶׁר לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם ב' נַעֲשֶׂה הַכְּתִיבָה בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה
לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם ז'

Only after the verdict regarding life in the World to Come has been sealed, is the writing begun on Rosh Hashana regarding life in this world.

וא"כ אם נאמר שהלשון לשנה טובה הוא כולל שניהם

This being so, if we say that the expression we wish others, 'may you have a good year' includes both of them, life in the World to Come and in this world,

הרי הנה הלשון תכתב ותחתם אינו מיִשֵּׁב ומיִשֵּׁר כָּלֵל

****then the expression "may you be written and sealed" does not sit well and is not straightforward at all,**

כי הכתיבה אשר לחיי העוה"ז הוא רק אחר החתימה דחיי העוה"ב וכנ"ל

since the writing regarding life in this world is only after the sealing of the verdict regarding that person's life in the World to Come!

והיה צריך להאריך ולומר לחיים טובים תכתב ותחתם בחיי העוה"ב

If that was the intention it would have been necessary to express this at length and say, "May you be written and sealed for the life of the World to Come..."

ולשנה טובה תכתב לחיי עוה"ז ואין המנהג להאריך כ"כ

and written for a good year of life in this world!" But it isn't the custom to express this at such great length,

לכן אמר הגר"א שאין לומר תחתם רק תכתב וקאי על חיי עוה"ז

and therefore the GRA said not to say 'sealed' but only 'written,' referring to life in this world,

ונכלל בו ג"כ ברכת חיי עוה"ב דאל"כ הרי אינו טובה כָּלֵל

and it included a blessing for the life of the World to Come as well, for if not, that would not be a good year at all.

אָמנם ענין הכתיבה והחתימה מה שהם וגם ענין מה שנגמרו זה
בראש השנה וזה ביום"כ

However, the concept of 'writing' and 'sealing,' and the fact that one is completed on Rosh Hashana, and the other on Yom Kippur,

וכן ענין הג' ספרים מה שהם אין כאן המקום לזה

and also the idea of the three books that are opened on Rosh Hashana – here is not the place to analyze this.

וכשיזכני השי"ת למקום היאות להם נדבר בזה

When the Almighty will grant me the merit and the proper occasion for these, we will discuss them.

ונחזר להענין ונשלים דברינו כי הנה נתבאר שכל תקנות חמדת
ישראל

But let us return now to the subject and complete our words. We explained that the hoped for thing that all of Israel yearns for

הנה הם יעודים העתידים לכל ישראל כלם בלי חסור אחד מהם

are the promises that will be fulfilled for all of Israel, without exception,

כי הוא תלוי בבְּרִית ולא בזכות והבְּרִית הוא באור המקיף

because it depends on the Covenant, and not on a person's merits, and the Covenant originates in the *ohr makif* – the transcendent light –

שהוא מאיר בלתי גבול ולמעלה מן המדה

that illuminates without limitation, and beyond all measure.

אבל הזכות הנה הוא באור הפנימי ובו הוא כל משפטי התורה
ושכרה וענשה

But merit is a feature of the *ohr pnimi* the light that is invested in vessels in which reside all the statutes of Torah and its rewards and punishments.

שהם במדה ובמשקל וגומל לכל איש כמפעלו

These are measured and weighed and are paid back to every person according to their deeds,

משום שהאור הפנימי הוא מצמצם בכלי ולכן הוא בחק וגבול

because the *ohr pnimi* is constricted into a vessel and therefore it is elicited according to laws and limitations,

ואינו מעביר על מדותיו וכמ"ש עבו"ז דף ד' ע"ב

and He does not overlook His attributes, as it states in Tractate Avodah Zara 4b:

תורה דכתיב בה אמת אין הקב"ה עושה לפנים משורת הדין

Regarding the Torah, described as Truth, the blessed Holy One does not do less than the letter of the Law.

וכן אמרו ב"ק נ' סע"א כל האומר הקב"ה ותרן הוא יתרו חזיו

Similarly in Tractate Bava Batra 50a: Anyone who says that the blessed Holy One makes concessions concedes his life.

שנאמר הצור תמים פעלו כי כל דרכיו משפט

For it states in the Torah (Deuteronomy 32:4) "*Hatzur* – 'the One Who forms' – Perfect is His work, for all His paths are justice."

ואמר כאן הצור שהוא תארו ית"ש ע"ש יצירת העולם

The verse here states *haTzur* – a descriptive term used for Him as Creator, may His Name be blessed, because of the formation**

of the world** yetzirat ha-olam**.**

משום שחקי היצירה ומשפטי התורה אחד הם בנ"ל רפ"ד

This is because the laws governing the formation of the world and the statutes of the Torah are one, as explained above in chapter 4,

כי הם שניהם באור הפנימי המצמצם שהוא מצד עצמו אינו עובר על חקו כלל

since both of them are in the *ohr pnimi* that is constricted in such a way that in themselves they do not step outside the bounds of their laws.

אמנם כבר אמרנו כי כל עקרו דאור הפנימי הוא נמשך מאור המקיף

However, we have already noted that the primary aspect of the *ohr pnimi* is drawn entirely from the *ohr makif*,

והוא רק חלק ממנו והרי הם אחד בתחלתם וכו' יתיחדו בסופם

and it is merely an aspect thereof. Accordingly, they are one at the outset, and will reunite at the end.

כי ע"י כל הדין והמשפט הנעשה באור הפנימי ע"י שהוא מִסַּד על זכות ועל חובה

This is because the judgments and rulings made by the *ohr pnimi*, due to the fact that it is founded on merit and culpability,

הנה עי"ז גופה יתקנו כלם לקבל את הגלוי דאור המקיף ששם הוא סוד הברית

itself brings about the rectification of all of them so that they will be able to receive the light of the *ohr makif* in which the secret of the Covenant resides,

וכנ"ל פ"ו שע"י מדת ואמת זוכים למדת ורב חסד

as explained above in chapter 6 – that through the attribute of Truth they are worthy of the attribute of Abundant Kindness,

כי מדת ואמת הרי הוא ג"כ רק מאור המקיף ולכן אינו מתנהג
בכל משפטי שבו

because the attribute of Truth is also from the *ohr makif*, and therefore its judgments do not act in such a way as to

להשמיד ולהשחית ח"ו אלא שהם נמשכים בתהלוכות שונות

destroy or annihilate, Heaven forbid; instead they are drawn into various channels

באופן שמשפטי נעשים ומתקיימים בלם ועכ"ז נשאר העושה עברה
על קיומו

in a manner that justice is carried out, nevertheless the person who committed the transgression remains

לקבל את כל טוב העתיד דאור המקיף

to receive in the future all the good of the *ohr makif*.

וזהו שאמר הצור תמים פעלו כי כל דרכיו משפט כו' צדיק וישר
הוא

And this is why it states, "*Hatzur* – 'the One Who forms' – Perfect is His work, for all His paths are justice; righteous and upright is He."

כי הגם שכל דרכיו משפט עכ"ז צדיק וישר הוא שעושה כל
משפטי בצדקה תמיד

For although all His paths are justice, nevertheless, righteous and upright is He, for He always carries out His judgments in a charitable way.

שָׁכַל מִשְׁפָּטָיו הֵם רַק כְּדֵי לְהִיטִיב בְּסוּפּוֹ וַיִּתְיַחֲדוּ בְּסוּפּוֹ הָאוֹר
הַפְּנִימִי ג"כ בְּאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף

**For all of His judgments are only in order to benefit in the end,
and in the end the *ohr pnimi* will become one with the *ohr
makif*,**

כִּי ע"י הַצָּרוּף וְהַלְבוּן יִתְקַנּוּ כָּלֵם לְהַגְלוֹי דְּאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף וְכַנ"ל בְּכָל
דְּבָרֵינוּ

**since by means of scouring and cleansing all of them will be
prepared to receive the revelation of the *ohr makif*, as we
explained above.**

וְהָרִי יִתְקַיֵּם יִסּוּד הַזְכוּת ג"כ וַיִּקְבְּלוּ אֶת כָּל טוֹב הָעָתִיד ע"י יִסּוּד
הַזְכוּת וַיִּסּוּד הַבְּרִית בְּיַחַד

**Thus the principle of merit will also be upheld, and they will
receive all the good of the future by way of the principle of
merit and the principle of Covenant together.**

כִּי יִתְיַחֲדוּ הֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם ג"כ וְכ"ז הוּא ע"י שְׁמִדַּת וְאַמְתָּה הוּא ג"כ
עֲקָרוֹ מֵאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף

**For the two will become one, and all this is by virtue of the fact
that the main aspect of the attribute of Truth is also from the
ohr makif,**

וְהוּא נוֹבֵעַ וְיוֹצֵא מֵהַתְקוּן יָשׁוּב יִרְחֲמֵנוּ וְנִמְשָׁךְ מִמֶּדֶת וְרַב חֶסֶד
וְכַנ"ל פ"ו

**and flows forth and emerges from the Tikun of "He will again
show us mercy" and is drawn from the attribute of Abundant
Kindness, as we explained in chapter 6.**

וְלָכֵן הוּא מְנַהִיג תָּמִיד רַק לְתַכְלִית זֶה וְהֵבִן כָּל הַדְּבָרִים מֵאֵד.

**And therefore He leads things always only towards this
purpose. Understand all of these matters very well.**

Footnotes

1. See *Bereishit Rabba* 78:8 (on the verse in Genesis 33:2) [↩](#)
2. *Shnei Luchot Habrit* by Rabbi Isaiah Horowitz, d. Prague 1630. [↩](#)
3. See Genesis chaps. 15; 28:10-15. [↩](#)
4. 26:44 [↩](#)
5. This is an early Kabbalistic work, assumed to be from the time of King David. [↩](#)
6. Literally, "atmosphere," or empty space. Referring to a very lofty and indescribable aspect of *keter*. [↩](#)
7. This could also be rendered as "the root of the entire emanation." [↩](#)
8. *Dorshei reshumot* is a term that seems to imply a non-literal interpretation of verses. See Rashi. [↩](#)
9. It will become evident below why we have translated it this way. [↩](#)
10. Tractate Sanhedrin 90a ff*.* [↩](#)
11. Tractate Sanhedrin 104b. [↩](#)
12. Explained according to Maharsha ad loc. [↩](#)
13. Exodus 33:19. [↩](#)
14. Or, *Torat Kohanim*. [↩](#)
15. *Mishna Eduyot* 2:10. [↩](#)
16. See Zohar III, 93b; Zohar III, 73a. Ramchal, commentary to *Idra Rabba* 467-507; *Nefesh Hachaim* 4:11. [↩](#)

17. *Mishnah, Sanhedrin* 10:1. [↩](#)
18. Rabbi Menachem Recanati, a distinguished Italian Kabbalist 1250-1290. [↩](#)
19. Rabbi Ezra of Gerona (d. 1227), a student of Rabbi Isaac Sagi Nahor. According to some historians, he taught Kabbalah to Ramban (Rabbi Moshe ben Nachman). [↩](#)
20. cf. *Menorat haMaor*, ner 4, chap. 2:2b; *Shnei Luchot haBrit, Torah Ohr*, p. 222. [↩](#)
21. See Rashi ad loc. [↩](#)
22. Non-legalistic exegetical texts of rabbinic origin. These texts include folklore, historical anecdotes, short biographies, ethical teachings and practical advice. In many cases they also mask deeper mystical secrets. [↩](#)
23. *Mishnah Sanhedrin* 10:1 [↩](#)
24. Words from the *Netanah Tokef* prayer of Yom Kippur [↩](#)
25. See Rashi ad loc. [↩](#)
26. *Mayim nukvin*, abbreviated as *ma"n*, refers to the arousal or awakening from below to seek out the Divine and bond thereto. [↩](#)
27. *Avodah Zara* 10b, 17a. [↩](#)
28. Literally, "sweetened to the maximum...." [↩](#)

Chapter 10 — The revelation of the hidden light in the creation of the world as well as in the world to come

ומעתה הנה נאמר עוד כי הנה כל הענין הזה אשר אמרנו באור המקור

And now we can say further: the entire concept that we discussed regarding the *ohr hamakif*,

שבו יהיה כל תקוה העתידה דכל חמדת ישראל

in which resides the future hope and desire of all Israel,

ואורו הוא בבלתי גבול ותכלית וממנו היה כל הנסים הנגלים

is that its light is without limitation or cessation, and from it come all revealed miracles.

כי הוא בלי צמצום וגוף כלל

For it is not constricted in any way and is not manifested in any particular body.

משא"כ האור הפנימי הנה הוא מלבש בגוף וכלי ומתצמצם על ידו

This is not so with the *ohr hapenimi* which is clothed in a 'body' and a vessel that constrict it.

וממנו נעשה כל הטבע כלו וכן בו הוא כל משפטי התורה בשכרה וענשה וכן"ל בדברינו מפרק ד' עד כה.

And from it from the *ohr hapenimi* all of Nature is made and in it are all the laws of the Torah with its rewards and punishments, as mentioned above from chapter 4 on.

עכ"ז הנה צריכים אנו לדעת מאד כי האמת הוא

Nevertheless, we have to know very clearly that the truth is –

שהן ראשית הבריאה כלו והן ראשית גלויי ית"ש בנתינת התורה

whether we are talking about **the beginning of the entire Creation, or whether** we are talking about **the beginning of His revelation of Himself with the giving of the Torah –**

הנה הנה כל ההתחלה והראשית בשניהם רק בהגילוי אור דבליתי
גבול

the inception and beginning of both of them was exclusively from the revelation of the Infinite Light.

והוא האור הראשון שנגנז אשר עליו נאמר ויאמר אלהים יהי אור
כו'

This was the initial light that was concealed, regarding which the verse (Genesis 1:3) states, "And God said, 'There shall be light' and there was light."

The Zohar explains in a number of places (e.g. Zohar I, 16b; 31b) that there are two types of light mentioned in this verse – the light that shall be ("There *shall be* light"), for this light will only be revealed in the future; and the light that in fact was ("and there *was* light"). The former light was the ultimate intention, but it was hidden away – and is therefore referred to as the *ohr haganuz*, 'the concealed light' – emerging only for the sake of creating the worlds, and through man's righteous actions. This is referred to below as the "light [that] was good."

וירא אלהים את האור כי טוב ובו הנה ראשית הבריאה כלה

And the next verse continues, **"And God saw that the light was good," and with it He initiated the beginning of the entire Creation.**

והגם כי מאחר שנעשה הבריאה בהאור הגנוז איך הנה אפשר
שישתנה ע"י החטא

Now since the Creation was brought about with the concealed light, how was it possible that sin could affect it?

כי איך נעשית החטא כלל כי איך היה שום אפשרות ומקום
למציאת הרע בהעולם כלל

Indeed, how could one sin at all? How was there even a possibility for any evil to exist in the world?

אך הענין בזה הוא כי כל הגלוי דהאור שנגנז אשר נתגלה לצורך
הבריאה

However, the idea is this: the entire revelation of the light that was concealed, which became revealed for the purpose of creating,

הנה היה סדר גלוי ע"פ מה שאמרנו לעיל פ"א

the order in which it was revealed is according to what we mentioned in chapter 1 –

כי קדם הבריאה הנה היה נע[□]ה בחי' צמצום בכל המקום שהיה
עתיד להעולמות בי"ע

***that before the creation there was the aspect of the tzimtzum-withdrawal from the entire area that would in the future become the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.*

וכאשר נתגלה אח"כ האור שנגנז לצורך המציאות דהעולמות בי"ע

And when the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) necessary to bring about the existence of the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* was revealed,

הנה לא נתפשט האור הזה בכל המקום דהצמצום כלו

this light did not spread throughout the area of the tzimtzum,

שהוא בכל המקום דהעולמות בי"ע של עתה

which is throughout the space that the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* currently occupy.

אלא נשאר עדין חלק גדול בהצמצום בלתי האור הזה

Instead there still remains a significant aspect of the *tzimtzum* that withdrew the light,

וְהָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש שֶׁאָדָם הָרָאוֹ שׁוֹן ע"י מַעֲשָׂיו יִמְשֹׁךְ וְיִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאוֹר
הַזֶּה לְמַטָּה ג"כ:

and it was His blessed will that Adam, by his righteous deeds, would draw down and spread this light below as well.

וְהִעֲנִין בְּפִרְטוֹת הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה אֵז הָיוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע בְּמִדְרָגָה גְבוּהָ
נִעְלָה מְאֹד

Specifically, at that time the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* were on a very lofty level,

עַד שֶׁכָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הָיָה מְסֻתָּיִם אֵז בְּסִיּוֹם הוּא סְפִירוֹת
הָרָאוֹנוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

to the extent that the entire World of *Asiyah* ended at that time with the conclusion of the first six *sefirot* of the World of *Yetzirah* as it is currently.

וְאִם"כ בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבָּת בְּרָאשִׁית בְּסוּף שָׁעָה ו' כְּשֶׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָה"ר בְּגוֹ-עֶדֶן

But subsequently, on the eve of the first Sabbath of Creation, at the end of the sixth hour, when Adam entered the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*),

הִנֵּה נִתְעַלּוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת עוֹד וְנִסְתָּיִם כָּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּסִיּוֹם הוּא רָאוֹנוֹת
דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

then the worlds ascended further, and the entire World of *Asiyah* now ended at the conclusion of the first six *sefirot* of what is currently the World of *Beriah*,

וְהָיוּ הֵד' רָאוֹנוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה ג"כ בְּמָקוֹם הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁל עֵתָּה

and the four first *sefirot* of the world of *Asiyah* were also in the place which is now the World of *Atzilut*,

וְהוּא תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה הָיוּ בְּמָקוֹם הוּא רִאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּהִבְרִיָּאָה שֶׁל
עֵתָהּ וּמִשָּׁם וּלְמַטָּה הָיָה מָקוֹם פָּנוּי

and the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah were in the place of the first six *sefirot* of what is now Beriah. And from there on down was empty space.

וְהִנֵּה לֹא הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז אֶלָּא רַק עַד סוֹף הַעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁל אָז

Thus the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) was not drawn down further than the end of the World of Asiyah the way it was then:

שֶׁהָיָה מִתְחִלָּה בְּסוֹף הוּא רִאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּהִצְיָרָה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ

it began at the conclusion of the top six *sefirot* of what is now Yetzirah,

כִּי שָׁם הָיוּ מְסֻתְיָמִים אָז כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם

for it was there that all the worlds ended,

וְכָל מִשְׁךְ הַמָּקוֹם דָּהֵד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהִצְיָרָה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ

and the entire span of space of the four lower *sefirot* of what is now Yetzirah.

וְהַמָּקוֹם דָּהֵי' סְפִירוֹת דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ שָׁם הָיָה כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת
דְּהַקְלִיפוֹת

And the place where the ten *sefirot* of Asiyah are now was the place where all the *kelipot* were initially. The *kelipot*, literally "shells" or "husks" are symbolic, portraying the powers of obstruction and evil.

וְהוּא סוֹד מָה שֶׁאֶמְרוּ בְּחִגְיָגָה (יב, א) מֵאֵי דְכָתִיב אֲנִי א-ל שַׁדַּי

This is the mystical explanation in Tractate Chagiga (12a) on the verse (Genesis 35:11) "I am E-l Shad-ai..."

אֲנִי הוּא שֶׁאֶמְרָתִי לְעוֹלָמֵי דִי. וְהַכּוֹנֵה כִּי בְּמָקוֹם הִי"ד סְפִירוֹת הִנָּן

The Talmud explains: **"I am He who said to My World, 'Enough!' Do not extend down any further"**

שְׁהֵם הָד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהִיצִירָה וְהִי דְּהֶעֱשִׂיהָ לֹא הִמְשִׁיךְ שָׁם
מִהָעוֹלָמוֹת מֵאוֹמָה

– referring to the four lower *sefirot* of Yetzirah, and the ten *sefirot* of Asiyah – nothing was drawn down further than those Worlds,

כִּי שָׁם הֵנִיחַ מְקוֹם לְהִמְצִיאוֹת דְּהֶקְלִיפוֹת

for He left a space there for the existence of *kelipot*.

וְלָכֵן אָמַר לְהָעוֹלָמוֹת דִּי שְׁלֹא יִתְפַּשְׁטוּ בְּאֵלוֹ הַד' י סְפִירוֹת
דְּהֶקְלִיפוֹת

And therefore He said to the Worlds "Enough!" so that those 14 *sefirot* would not spread forth into the *kelipot*.

אֲךָ ע"י הַחֲטָא יָרְדוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם וְנִכְנְסוּ מֵהַד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת
בְּהִיצִירָה וּלְמַטָּה בְּתוֹךְ הַקְּלָפוֹת מִמֶּשׁ.

But because of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, all of the worlds fell, and the four lower *sefirot* of Yetzirah and down actually descended into the *kelipot*.

וְהָרִי הָיָה אֲזִי מְצִיאת הַקְּלָפוֹת בְּעוֹלָם ג"כ

Thus the existence of *kelipot* was manifested in the world as well,

כִּי לֹא הִתְפַּשְׁט הָאוֹר הַגָּנוּז אֶלָּא רַק עַד סִיּוֹם הַז' רִאשׁוֹנוֹת
דְּהִיצִירָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

for the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) extends down only until the end of the first six *sefirot* of Yetzirah as it is now.

וְהָיוּ נִשְׁאַרוּ עֲדִין מִהַקְּלָפוֹת אֲשֶׁר נִבְרְאוּ בְּעוֹלָם הַתְּהוֹ בְּאוֹתוֹ
הַמְּקוֹם דֵּה"ד סְפִי' הַנִּז'

But there still remained aspects of the *kelipot* that were created in the World of Tohu, in the place of the 14 *sefirot* mentioned,

וְזֶהוּ מָה שֶׁנִּתֵּן לָאָדָם הָרָאוּשׁוֹן לְתַקֵּן בְּמַעֲשָׁיו

and it was assigned to Adam to rectify this with his deeds,

שִׁמְשִׁיד אֶת הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז לְמַטָּה ג' כ' וּלְבַטֵּל אֶחָד הַקְּלִיפּוֹת מִכָּל וְכָל

by drawing down the *ohr haganuz* there as well, thereby nullifying the *kelipot* completely.

This is what was meant to be, but due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, the *kelipot* were not nullified. To the contrary, the worlds sank down into the *kelipot*, as the Baal haLeshem will soon explain.

וְהִנֵּה עֵקֶר הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז הוּא רַק בְּאַצִּילוֹת אֲמָנָם הִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהֶאֱרָתוֹ
עַד סוֹף הָעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁל אֲז

Now the primary light that was concealed originally illuminated only Atzilut; nevertheless its radiance extended down until the end of Asiyah the way it was then,

אֲשֶׁר הָיָה מִתְחִילָה עַד סוֹף הו"ר דְּהִיּוֹצִיָּה שֶׁל עֵתָּה.

which was from the top to the bottom of the first six *sefirot* of Yetzirah as it is now.

וְאִח"כ בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבַּת בְּרֵאשִׁית

Then, on the eve of Shabbat Bereishit the first Sabbath of Creation,

אַחֵר חֲצוֹת כְּאֲשֶׁר נִכְנָס אֲדָה"ר בְּגֵן עֵדֶן וְנִתְעַלּוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת עוֹד

after midday, when Adam entered the Garden of Eden and the Worlds ascended further,

וְהָיָה מִגִּיעַ הָעֲשִׂיָּה עַד סִיּוּם הִי' רֵאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּהִבְרִיָּאָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

so that the World of Asiyah reached the bottom of the first ten *sefirot* of what is currently Beriah,

והד' ראשונות דהעשיה עלו ג"כ באצילות ונכללו הם בהאור הנגזר
ממש

and the first four *sefirot* of Asiyah also rose into Atzilut and merged into the hidden light there.

אך הו' תחתונות דהעשיה נשארו עדין למטה מאצילות

However, the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah still remained below Atzilut,

ובמקום הו' ראשונות דהבריאה של עתה ששם הוא אינו האור
הגנוז ממש אלא רק הארתו

in the place of the first six *sefirot* of Beriah as it is currently, where the actual *ohr haganuz* itself does not illuminate, only its radiance.

ועי"ז היו אלו הו' תחתונות דהעשיה בסוד עץ הדעת

By means of all this, these six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah constituted the mystery of *Etz haDa'at* the Tree of Knowledge.

ונתן כ"ז לאדה"ר לתקנם ולהעלותם ג"כ להאצילות

All this was handed to Adam to rectify and elevate into Atzilut,

ולהמשיך את האור הגנוז העקרי למטה ג"כ וכנ"ז

and draw down the main *ohr haganuz* below as well, not just its radiance, as mentioned above and thus rectify the *kelipot* there.

אך לא די שלא תקן אלא שקלקל והוריד את כל העולמות כלם

But not only did he not rectify in the manner outlined – he ruined the situation and caused all of the worlds to fall lower.

וְהָיָה אֲפֻשְׁרִית וְסִבַּת הַחֲטָא ע"י שֶׁהָיָה אֵז מְצִיאת הַקְּלָפוֹת ג"כ
עכ"פ כנ"ל

The possibility for and cause of that sin was that the *kelipot* were also present in any event, as explained above,

וע"י הו' תחתונות דהעשיה שהיו עדין בסוד עץ הדעת כנז'

and also because the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah still constituted the mystery of *Etz haDa'at* (the Tree of Knowledge), as mentioned.

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁבִּאֲרָנוּ כ"ז בְּבִאּוֹר הַיָּטֵב בְּעֵמֶק וְאַרְכָּה בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב

All of this is explained clearly and in depth in our work *Drushei Olam haTohu* part 2,

וּבְחֵלֶק הַבִּיאּוֹרִים בְּשַׁעַר עֲקוּדִים פ"ב בְּדְרוֹשׁ עַץ הַדַּעַת שֶׁם ע"ש
וְתִמְצָא בַּעֲה"י הַכֹּל מְבֹאָר הַיָּטִיב:

and in the explanatory section of *Sh'aar haAkudim* chapter 2, in the exposition of *Etz haDa'at*. Check there, and with G-d's help you will find everything explained clearly.

וְנִחָזֵר לְהַעֲגִין כִּי הִנֵּה בְּרִיאת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ וְכָל צְבִאֵיהֶם הִנֵּה הָיָה
בְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז

Let's now return to the idea that the creation of heavens and earth and all of their hosts was all with the *ohr haganuz*,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁבְּבִרְאשִׁית רַבָּא (פ' י"ב ס' ו') אוֹתָהּ הָאֹרֶה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בָּהּ
הָעוֹלָם

as *Bereishit Rabba* (12:6) states: that light with which the world was created

אָדָם הָרָאשׁוֹן עָמַד וְהִבִּיט בָּהּ מִסּוּף הָעוֹלָם וְעַד סוּפוֹ כו' ע"ש

Adam stood and gazed with it from one end of the universe to the other.

וְהָיוּ עוֹמְדִים עִי"ז כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרֵאשִׁית כָּלָם בְּמִדְרָגָה גְבוּהָ נִעְלָה
וְנִרְאָא מְאֹד

And due to this, all of the work of Creation constituted a very lofty and tremendous level.

וּבִפְרָט אָדָם הָרָאשׁוֹן גּוֹפָה הִנָּה הוּא הָיָה לְמַעְלָה מִכָּלָם

And Adam himself in particular was superior to all of them,

וְכַמ"ש בְּפִרְקֵי דר"א פ' י"ח וּבִתְקוּנֵי זֵהָר תְּקוּן נ"ו וּבכ"מ

as *Pirkei d' R. Eliezer* chap. 18 and *Tikunei Zohar*, *Tikun 56* state.

אַךְ אַחֵר שֶׁחָטָא בְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת הִנָּה יָרַד הוּא וְכָל הַבְּרִיאָה כָּלָה

But after he transgressed with the Tree of Knowledge, he and the entire creation fell,

וְנִתְהַפְּכוּ כָּלָם מִכֶּתֶנֶת אוֹר בֹּא' לְכִתְנוֹת עוֹר בַּע' שֶׁהוּא מִשְׁכָּא
דְּחִינָא

and everything was switched from garments of light *ohr* with an *aleph* (אור) to garments of skin *ohr* with an *ayin* (עור),

כַּמ"ש בְּתַרְגוּם יוֹנָתָן שֵׁם וְכֵן בְּתְקוּנֵי זֵהָר בַּכ"מ

as *Targum Yonatan* and *Tikunei Zohar* state in a number of places.

וְהִנָּה אִזְ נִסְתַּלַּק וְנִתְעַלַּם כָּל הָאוֹר דְּשֵׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית

At that point all the light of the six days of Creation was withdrawn and concealed,

וְנִתְעַבָּה וְנִתְגַּשְׁם כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כָּלָה וְנִתְמַעַט וְנִתְצַמְצַם הָאוֹר מֵאִז
וּלְהֵלָאָה

and the entire Creation became material and corporeal, and the light became reduced and diminished from then on,

ואין אנו משתמשים עתה אלא באור הפנימי המצמצם במציאת העולמות כמו שהם עתה אחר החטא

so that currently we can utilize only the immanent light that is downgraded to the level of the worlds as they exist now, after the sin.

אבל הבריאה דששת ימי בראשית עצמן היה באמת רק בהאור הגנוז

But by contrast, creation during those six days of Creation was only by means of the *ohr haganuz*,

אלא שלא היה מתפשט האור הזה בכל מקום דהצמצום כלו

albeit that this light the *ohr haganuz* did not spread into the entire area affected by the *tzimtzum*,

כי שם נשאר מקום למדור הקלפות כנ"ל

because there remained a space for the *kelipot* to lodge, as we explained above.

וזהו שנאמר ויבדל אלהים בין האור ובין החשך

And this is the meaning of the verse (Genesis 1:4), "And *Elokim* divided between the light and the darkness"

כי משום שהאור הזה הוא בלתי גבול היה צריך לעשות הבדלה ביניהם

– because since this light the *ohr haganuz* was infinite, it was necessary to make a division between them between the *ohr haganuz* and the constricted light,

שלא יתפשט למטה ג"כ ע"י שהוא בלתי גבול

so that it the *ohr haganuz* would not spread down below as well because it was without limitation and would naturally spread into the place of the *kelipot* as well.

וְהָיָה נִשְׁאָר זֶה שִׁיתָקוּן ע"י אָדָם וְכֵנִז'

And this constricted light remained, to be rectified by Adam, as mentioned.

וְהָיָה לָנוּ עכ"פ כִּי כָל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלוּ הִנֵּה הָיָה רַק בְּהָאוֹר הַדְּבִלְתִּי
גְּבוּל אֶלָּא שֶׁע"י הַחֲטָא נִסְתַּלַּק וְנִגְנַז

In any event, we have it that the entire Creation was exclusively with the infinite light, which was withdrawn due to the sin.

וְכֵן עַד"ז גְּלוּיָו ית"ש בְּנִתְיִנֵּת הַתּוֹרָה הִנֵּה הָיָה ג"כ בְּהָאוֹר הַגָּנוּז

Similarly, at the giving of the Torah, His revelation was also that of the *ohr haganuz*,

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר אֲנִי אֱמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם וְכַמ"ש בְּעִבּוּדָה זָרָה ה' ע"א
וְע' בְּזוּה"ק ס"פ יִתְרוּ

and therefore the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "You are angelic, children of the Most High" as the Talmud *Avodah Zara 5a* opines: Said Reish Lakish, "Israel did not receive the Torah other than to prevent the Angel of Death from ruling over us."

אֶלָּא שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה נֶתָן לָהֶם עַדִּין בְּהַחֲלִיט וְהָיָה נִתְעַכֵּב עַד הַלּוּחוֹת
הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת

But it was not given to them completely as yet, and matters waited until the first Tablets would be given to them, which was only after they heard the Ten Commandments.

וְאֵלוּ שֶׁזָּכִינוּ לַהֲלוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת הָיָה חֲזוֹר לָהֶם הָאוֹר הַגָּנוּז
דְּשִׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרִאשִׁית

Had we been worthy of the first Tablets, the *ohr haganuz* from the six days of Creation would have been returned to us,

וְהָיָה מִתְתָּקֵן מֵאִז כָּל הָעוֹלָם כְּלוּ ג"כ כְּמוֹ קֶדֶם הַחֲטָא

and the entire world would have been rectified as well – to the way it was before the sin.

וְהָיָה הָיָה לְפִי"ז הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָהּ רַק כְּאוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת

Accordingly, the revelation of the entire Torah would have been like the light of Atzilut,

אֲשֶׁר עָלֶיהָ אָמְרוּ עֲבו"ז ג' ע"ב שֶׁהַקַּב"ה יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק בְּתוֹרָה

regarding which the Sages state in Tractate *Avodah Zara* 3b that the blessed Holy One 'sits and occupies Himself with Torah.'

וְהוּא הָיָה ג'כ עֲבוֹדַת אֲדָה"ר קֹדֶם הַחֲטָא כִּי אֵלּוּלָא הַחֲטָא

And this was also Adam's Divine service prior to the sin, for if not for the sin,

הָיָה נִתֵּן הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָהּ לְאֲדָה"ר וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיִּנָּחֶהוּ בְּגֵן עֵדֶן לְעֲבֹדָה
וּלְשִׁמְרָהּ

the Torah would have been given to Adam, which is why it states (Genesis 2:15) "And He placed him in the Garden of Eden to work it and to guard it", which the *Tikunei Zohar* 62b explains as referring to the positive commandments and the prohibitions of the Torah.

וְהַתּוֹרָה דְּאַצִּילוֹת הִיא כְּלָהּ עַל סוּד הַיְחוד לַיְחוד הַנֶּאֱצָלִים זב"ז
וְכֻלָּם בָּאִין סוּף בְּיַחְדָּא שְׁלִים

The Torah of Atzilut is entirely about the secret of *yichud*¹ – to unify various emanated aspects one with the other, and all of them with the *Ein Sof*, the blessed Infinite One

ע' זוה"ק מְקַץ קצ"ט ב' וּתְרוּמָה קס"ה ב' וְאַתְחַנֵּן רס"ג א' בְּרַע"מ
(שם)

(see *Zohar: Miketz* 199b; *Terumah* 165b; *V'etchanan* 263a, *Raya Mehemna*).

וְזֶהוּ ג' כ סוד עבודת הספירות שאמר הראב"ד בספר יצירה פ"ב
משנה א'

This is also the Divine service associated with the *sefirot* as explained by the Ra'avad in *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:1.

וְעַד דְּבָרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר הָעֶקְדִּים פ"ג אות ה' ובספר הדע"ה ח"ב דרוש ד'
ענף כ"ו

See our exposition in *Sha'ar haAkudim* 3:5, and in *Sefer Drushei Olam HaTohu* section 2, 2:26.

אך ע"י חטא העגל שלא זכו להלוחות הראשונות הנה חזר ונסתם
מהם כל האור הזה

But due to the sin of the golden calf they were not worthy of the first Tablets, and all of that light was once again sealed off to them,

ונתלבש כל התורה בלה בנשאים ולבושים דהעוה"ז

and the Torah became clothed in matters and garments of this world,

ונקרא מעתה תורת הבריאָה כי הרי היא מתלבשת בלבושין
דהעולמות ב"ע

and was called from then on 'the Torah of Beriah' since it became clothed in garments of the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

והיא מיסד מעתה על הטוב והרע שבהם

The 'Torah of Beriah' is now focused² on the good and evil **within them** within the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

לשמור מהרע שבהם ולעשות את הטוב שהם כל המצוות מעשיות

guarding against the evil in them, and promoting the good in them, via all the positive commandments

שֶׁהֵם נַעֲשִׂים בְּלֶמַס רַק בְּגוֹי וְנַפֶּשׁ דִּהְיוּהוּ"ז עֲצָמוֹ

which can all be performed only with a body and soul in this world itself, but not in the World to Come.***

וְהֵם הָעֲשֵׂה וְלֹא תַעֲשֶׂה כִּי כָל הַמִּצְוֹת ל"ת הֵם בְּלֶמַס לְשֹׁמֵר
וּלְהִרְחִיק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ

These are the injunctions and prohibitions, because the purpose of all the prohibitive commandments are all in order to guard against and distance a person

מִכָּל מָה שֵׁישׁ לְהִרְעֵ אַחִיזָה וְנִגִּיעָה בּוֹ

from anything to which evil is attached or touches.

וְע"ד שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיִּגַּע בְּכַף יָרְכוֹ עַל כֵּן לֹא יֹאכְלוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כּו'

For example, the verse (Genesis 32:26, 33) that states "And he the angel touched the socket of his hip... Therefore the Children of Israel do not eat the sinew of the hip-socket to this day..."

וְזֶהוּ הַטַּעַם לְכָל הַטִּמְאוֹת וְהָאֲסוּרִין שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה כַּמ"ש הַגֶּךָ"א
בְּתִקּוּנִים מ"א סע"א וְע' בְּזוֹה"ק וַיִּשְׁלַח ק"ע ע"ב וְקע"א ע"ב

And this is the reason behind prohibiting contact with all the impure and things forbidden by the Torah, as the GRA writes in Tikunim 41a. See also Zohar, Vayishlach 170b, 171b.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן כ"ב שֶׁכָּל הַל"ת הֵם נִכְלָלִים בְּהַדְיָבוֹר
לֹא יִהְיֶה לָךְ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים עַל פְּנֵי

And this is also what they said in the Tikunim, Tikun 22 – that all the prohibitions are included in the second utterance of the Ten Commandments "You shall not recognize the gods of others in My Presence" (Exodus 20:2).

כִּי בְּלֶמַס הֵם לְשֹׁמֵר וּלְהִרְחִיק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ מִמָּה שֵׁישׁ לְהִרְעֵ אַחִיזָה
וְנִגִּיעָה בָּהֶם

This is because the purpose of all of them is in order to guard against and for a person to distance himself from anything to which evil is attached or touches.

וְנִשְׁמְרוּ אוֹתָם כָּל־אֶזְמוֹתֵי הַלֵּל וְדָלָא יְהִיָּה לָךְ

And by guarding against all of them, then he fulfills the prohibition of "You shall not recognize the gods of others..."

וְכִן לְהִפָּךְ בְּמַצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה כִּי כָל־הֵם לְהַמְשִׁיךְ עַל עֲצָמוֹ אוֹר קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ
שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה וְאַלְהוּתוֹ עָלָיו

And the opposite is true of the positive commandments – for all of them draw down upon a person the holy light of the blessed Holy One and His Godliness,

וְנִמְצָא כִּי בְּקִיּוֹם הַמ"ע מְקִיִּים מ"ש אֲנֹכִי ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ

so that by discharging the positive commandments, one fulfills the verse (Exodus 20:2) "I am the Lord your God..."

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר בְּתִקּוּנֵי שֵׁם ע"א ע"ב כִּי כָל הַמ"ע הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּאַנְכִי

And this is why it states in Tikunim there p. 71b that all the positive commandments are all included in "I am the Lord your God..."

כִּי הֵם כָּל־פְּרָטִים בְּמֶה לְהַמְשִׁיךְ עַל עֲצָמוֹ אֱלֹהוּתוֹ וּמַלְכוּתוֹ
וְקְדֻשָּׁתוֹ ית"ש

– because all of the positive commandments are specific means by which to draw down His blessed Godliness and Sovereignty and Holiness upon himself.

וּמִשּׁוּם כָּל זֶה הֵנָּה נִתְּלַבֵּשׁ הַתּוֹרָה בְּנוֹשָׁאִים וּלְבוּשִׁים דְּהַעוּה"ז לְפִי
מִצִּיאוֹתָהּ אֲשֶׁר יֵרֶדָה אַחֵר הַחֹטָא

And because of all this the Torah is clothed in matters and in garments pertaining to this world as it exists after its descent due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge.

וּמִיָּסֵד הַתּוֹרָה מַעֲתָה עַל הַטּוֹב וְרַע טָהוֹר טָמֵא אָסוּר מִתּוֹר מִכָּשֶׁר
פָּסוּל חַיֵּב זָכָאִי

So now the Torah is focused on good and evil, spiritually pure and impure, prohibited and permitted, valid and invalid, guilty and innocent,

לְהַתְּרֹחַק מִהַטְּמָאָה וְהָרַע וּלְהַתְּקָרֵב וּלְהַדְבִּיק לְכָל הַטּוֹב טָהוֹר
וְקָדוֹשׁ

in order to distance a person from spiritual impurity and evil, and draw him closer to cleave to the good, the spiritually pure and the holy.

וְעוֹמֵד הַתּוֹרָה מַעֲתָה לְפָנֵינוּ רַק בְּצוּרַת תּוֹרַת הָאָדָם הַתַּחֲתוֹן
דִּהְעוּה"ז

The Torah stands before us now only in the form of the Torah of man below in this world,

וְכֵן כָּל שְׂכָרָה וְעִנְשָׁה הַגְּלוּיִם בָּהֶם כָּלָם ג"כ רַק מִהְעוּה"ז

and similarly the rewards and punishments revealed in it are also only those that pertain to this world.

וְהוּא עֲנִין הַכָּרַת וְאַבְדּוֹ הַנֶּאֱמָר בָּהֶם וְכֵן"ל בְּכָל עֵמֶק הַדְּבָרִים
שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לָעֵיל

This is the matter of excision and destruction mentioned earlier and examined in depth as expounded above.

אֲמָנָם כָּל הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הַזֶּה הֵן דִּהְתּוֹרָה וְהֵן דִּהֶבְרִיָּאָה

However, all of this 'cloaking' – whether in the Torah or in Creation –

הָרִי הוּא הַכָּל רַק ע"י הַחֲטָא וְהוּא רַק מֵעַת הַחֲטָא עַד שִׁיגִיעַ עַת
הַתְּקוּן דְּקֶזֶז הַיָּמִין

is only a result of sin the sins of Adam and Eve and the Tree of Knowledge, and the sin of the golden calf **and only from the time of the sin and on, until the time of the Tikun at the End of Days.**

כִּי ע"י הַחֲטָא דַּעַץ הַדַּעַת נִתְגַּשְׁמָה וְנִתְעַכְרָה הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה

Due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge the entire creation became more corporeal and sullied,

וְע"י חֲטָא הָעֵגֶל נִתְלַבֵּשׁ וְנִתְגַּשֵּׁם הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה

and due to the sin of the golden calf the entire Torah became cloaked in mundane and worldly matters³

וְאִין אָנוּ מְשַׁתְּמָשִׁים מֵעֵתָּה אֲלָא רַק בְּהָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמְּמַעֵט
שֶׁבְּשִׁנְיָהֶם אֲשֶׁר נִתְצַמְצַם לְפִי הַגּוּף וְהַלְבוּשׁ שֶׁבֵּהֶם

so that now we make use only of the *ohr hapenimi*, the lesser of the two levels of light, as the *ohr* which is constricted according to the body and garment in which it is clothed.

אֲבָל עֲקָרֹן וּיְסוּדֹן שֶׁבִּתְחִלָּה הָרִי הָיָה בְּשִׁנְיָהֶם

But initially the primary and fundamental aspect of both of them

רַק בְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז וּבְהָאֹר הַזֶּה שֶׁם הוּא סוּד בְּרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

was only the *ohr haganuz*, and in this *ohr* was the secret of the covenant of the Patriarchs and Israel,

אֲשֶׁר סִבְתּוֹ הִיא נוֹרָא וְנֶעְלָם מְאֹד וְכַמ"ש בְּמִלְאֲכֵי א'

the reason for which is awe-inspiring and very shrouded in mystery, as the verse states in Malachi 1:2-3

אֶהְבֵּתִי אֶתְכֶם אָמַר ה' וְאָמַרְתֶּם בְּמָה אֶהְבֵּתָנוּ הֲלֹא אִךְ עָשׂוּ
לִיעֲקֹב נָאֻם ה' וְאֶהֱבֶה אֶת יַעֲקֹב. וְאֵת עָשׂוּ שְׁנֵאתִי...

'I loved you, says God.' But if you say, 'How have you loved us?' How do we know that your love is for *us*, and not merely by virtue of the righteousness of the Patriarchs?⁴ God declares, **'Wasn't Esau the brother of Jacob, yet I loved Jacob, and Esau I despised...'** even though he too was the son of Isaac and the grandson of Abraham.

וְאָמַר הָאֲרִיז"ל בְּסוּף סֵפֶר אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שָׁקֶל כֶּסֶף

The Arizal said about this at the end of the work *Arba Me'ot Shekel Kesef*

שֶׁהַכּוֹנֵן הוּא עַל שְׂרָשָׁם אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה שָׁשָׁם הוּא שְׂרָשׁ שְׁנֵיהֶם קִדָּשׁ
קִדָּשִׁים

that the intention of the verse cited above is regarding their root above – there the root of both of them is the holy of holies.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הֲלֹא אַח עָשׂוּ לִיעֶקֶב נָאֻם ה' וּבְשְׂרָשָׁם לְמַעַלָּה הָרִי הֵם
שְׁנֵיהֶם שְׂוִים וְעַכ"ז וְאוֹהֵב אֶת יַעֲקֹב

And this is what the verse states – God declares, 'Wasn't Esau the brother of Jacob...?' for in their root above both of them are equal, yet despite this, 'I loved Jacob.'

וְכֵן בְּנִחְמִיָּה ט' אֶתָּה הוּא ה' הָאֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתָּ בְּאַבְרָם כו'

And similarly a verse in Nehemiah 9:7 states: 'You are God, the Lord who chose Abram...'

וְהָרִי אָמַר אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתָּ שֶׁהוּא רַק בְּבַחֲרִירָה וְרָצוֹן גַּם זֹלַת וְקִדְּם
מַעֲשָׂיו הַטּוֹבִים

Note that it states 'You... chose' – for it is only by way of choice and will that He chose Abram, aside from and prior to his good deeds.

וְכֵן בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ כ"ד כֹּה אָמַר ה' אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֶבֶר הִנָּהוּ יָשְׁבוּ
אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מֵעוֹלָם תָּרַח אָבִי אֲבִרָהָם וְאַבִּי נָחוֹר כו'

And similarly in Joshua 24:2-3: Thus said God, the Lord of Israel: 'Your forefathers – Terach, the father of Abraham and the father of Nachor, always dwelt on the other side of the river, and they served the gods of others.

וְאָקַח אֶת אֲבִיכֶם אֶת אַבְרָהָם כֹּ' הָרִי אָמַר וְאָקַח שֶׁהוּא מוֹרָה ג"כ
שֶׁהָיָה הַלְקִיחָהּ רַק בְּרָצוֹן גַּם זֹלַת מַעֲשֵׂיו הַטּוֹבִים

'But I took your forefather Abraham...' Note that it states 'I took' indicating that this was only because He so willed, aside from his Abraham's good deeds.

וְאָמַר עוֹד וְאַרְבֶּ אֶת זַרְעוֹ וְאֶתֵּן לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק כֹּ'

The verse continues 'And I multiplied his seed and I gave him Isaac...'

וְאָמְרוּ עַל זֶה בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם פְּסָחִים פ"י הִלְכָה ה' וְאַרְבֶּ כְּתִיב (חֶסֶר ה')

Regarding this it states in the Talmud Yerushalmi, *Pesachim* 10:5 it is written as וְאַרְבֶּ without the ה'. It should be written as וְאַרְבָּה with the letter *hai* at the end of the word.

נַעֲשִׂיתִי לוֹ אוֹרֵב אֵין חֲטָא מִתֵּן לִיה אֵין זָכָה מִתֵּן לִיה

The reason it is written without the *hai* is to suggest that I became his guarantor אָרַב – if he did not sin a son would be given to him, and even if he was not worthy a son would still be given to him.

וּר"ל שֶׁהָיִיתִי מַסְתַּכֵּל וְאוֹרֵב עָלָיו לִתֵּן לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק וּלְהַרְבּוֹת אֶת
זַרְעוֹ

Meaning to say, I gazed upon him and was his guarantor to give him Isaac, and to multiply his descendants,

בֵּין אִם חֲטָא הָיִיתִי נוֹתֵן לוֹ בֵּין אִם זָכָה הָיִיתִי נוֹתֵן לוֹ

whether he sinned or not, I would grant this to him, or whether he was worthy thereof or not, I would grant this to him.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ כִּי עָקֵר לְקִיחַת הָאֲבוֹת וַיִּשְׂרָאֵל

All of this is as we said: the primary aspect of taking i.e. choosing the Patriarchs and Israel

מֶה שֶׁלָּקַח אוֹתָם הַקֹּב"ה אֵלָיו וּבָחַר בָּהֶם לְקַדְּשָׁהּ בְּקִדְּשׁוֹ
בְּעֲבוּדָתוֹ וּבְתוֹרָתוֹ

– that the blessed Holy One took them to Himself and chose them to sanctify them with His holiness, His service, and His Torah –

הוּא הַכֹּל רַק בְּסוּד שֶׁרֶשׁ הַבְּרִית וְלֹא בְּזָכוֹת

is all exclusively due to the secret of the Covenant, not due to merit.

וְגַם כָּל הַזְכוּת גּוֹפָה הוּא ג' כ' רַק מִסּוּד הַבְּרִית וּמִי שֶׁאִינוּ בְּבְרִית
הִנֵּה כָּל זְכוּתָם אֵינָם זְכוּתִים כָּלֵל

And even merit itself also emerges only from the secret of the Covenant, so that the 'merits' of one who is not part of the Covenant are not merits at all,

כִּי אֵינָם פּוֹעֲלִים לְמַעַלָּה מֵאוּמָּה וּמִמִּילָא הוּא שָׁאִין שׁוּם זְכוּת
לְמַטָּה ג' כ'

because they have no effect above at all, and thus inevitably they bear no merit below either.

וְכָל בְּרִית הִנֵּה הוּא מִכָּרַח שִׁיתְקִים וְלָכֵן כָּל מִי שֶׁהוּא בְּבְרִית הִנֵּה
יִתְקִים בּוֹ כָּל פְּעֻלַּת הַזְכוּת עכ"פ

Now every Covenant must of necessity be fulfilled, and therefore, for one who is part of the Covenant, the effect of merit will perforce endure,

ע"פ סִיבּוּבִים מִסִּבּוּבִים שׁוֹנִים אֲשֶׁר יֵסַד גְּדֹל הָעֲצָה וְרַב הָעֲלִילָה
י"ת"ש

by one means or another, as established by the One who is 'great in counsel and mighty in deed' (Jeremiah 32:19), may His Name be blessed.

ועי"ז הנה יזכו כל ישראל כלם לאור ולהאיר באור פני מלך חיים לעולמי עד

In this way all of Israel without exception will be worthy of illumination and to illuminate others forever with light of the living King's countenance.

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו לעיל שגם כל אור הפנימי המצמצם

This is according to what we stated above, that all the immanent constricted *ohr hapenimi*

הנה הוא יוצא ונמשך רק מהאור המקיף והרי הוא עצמו רק תמצית הארה מהאור הגנוז אשר הוא יסוד כל הבריאה כלה

emerges from and is drawn down exclusively from the transcendent light of the *ohr hamakif*, which is itself only the distillation of a radiance from the *ohr haganuz*, which is the foundation of the entire Creation.

ולכן כל מה שנעשה בו הנה הוא ג"כ רק לתכלית היסוד הראשון

And therefore everything that is done with it is also only for the purpose of this first fundamental, the *ohr haganuz*.

אלא משום שהוא רק תמצית ממנו הנה נעלם כל הנהגתו מעיני כל חי איך שמגיע גם הוא רק לתכלית אור הגנוז העקרי.

But because the immanent constricted *ohr* is merely a distillation thereof, how He conducts matters exclusively for the sake of the *ohr haganuz*, which is the primary goal, is concealed from the view of all living creatures.

אבל עכ"פ הוא כי כל הנהגתו של עתה היא ג"כ לעולם רק לתכלית זה

In any event, all of His conduct at present is also always exclusively for this purpose.

וּמִתְנַהֵג הַקֹּב"ה עִם יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּדַרְכִּים מְדֻרָּכִים שׁוֹנִים הֵן בַּעֲוֹה"ז

And the blessed Holy One acts towards Israel in many different ways, both in this world

וְהֵן בְּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר מִיתָה כְּדִי לְקַיֵּם בָּהֶם סוּד הַבְּרִית

and in the World of Souls after death, in order to fulfill with them the mystery of the Covenant

אֲשֶׁר הוּא אִי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁישְׁתַּנֶּה וְעִי"ז יִזְכּוּ כָּלֶם עַכ"פּ לְהַאֲוֹר הַגָּנוּז
בְּלִי חֲסוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם

which is impossible to change, and through this, no matter what, all of them without exception will merit the *ohr haganuz*.

אֲךְ הַסֵּפֶה בְּזֶה הִנֵּה הוּא נֶעְלָם עֲתָה מֵעֵינַי כָּל חַי וְכִמוּ שֶׁאִמְרוּ
לְעֵיל

But the reason for this is hidden for now from the eyes of any living creature, as we noted above,

שְׁגָם עֵינֵי הַזְכוּת הוּא תְלוּי ג"כ רַק בְּסוּד הַבְּרִית כִּי מִי שֶׁאִינוּ בְּבְרִית
הוּא אִינוּ בְּזְכוּת כָּלֶל

so that even when it comes to merit, that too is dependent only upon the secret of the Covenant, for one who is not part of the Covenant has no merit at all.

וְהִרִי הִנֵּה סוּד הַבְּרִית נֶעְלָם מְאֹד וְהִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּסוּד מָה שֶׁאִמְרוּ

Thus the mystery of the Covenant is very concealed, and it is exclusively the secret of what the Sages declared:

קב"ה וְאוֹרֵיָתָא וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִתְקַשְּׁרִין דָּא בְּדָא כַּמ"ש בַּפ' אַחֲרֵי ע"ג א'
וְע"ש ע"ב וְדִי בְּזֶה:

the blessed Holy One, the Torah and Israel are bound to one another, as it states in Zohar *parshat Acharei* p. 73a. Let this suffice regarding the matter.

Footnotes

1. *Yichud* is the unification of supernal elements in (and by) one's mystical devotions in prayer and/or mitzvah performance. [↩](#)
2. The literal translation is 'based,' but that may give the impression that the foundation of Torah is good and evil, which the *Baal HaLeshem* clearly points out is not the case. [↩](#)
3. 'Worldly' in the sense of physicalized, corporeal, material. [↩](#)
4. Malbim [↩](#)

Chapter 11 — The essence of the hidden light is supernatural and above that of the revelation of the hidden light

וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִתְּבוּנָן בְּזֶה אָנוּ רוֹאִין כִּי ע"ד שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שְׂרָאשִׁית הַבְּרִיאָה
וְהַתְּחִלָּתָה הִנֵּה הָיָה בְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז

When we contemplate this matter, we see a similarity to what we noted regarding the inception and the beginning of Creation – which was by means of the *Ohr Haganuz* the Hidden Light,

וְהוּא יְסוּדָה הָעֶקְרִי אֲשֶׁר אֵלָיו תֵּחָזֵר לְבִסּוּף

which is the primary foundation to which it will return in the end.

וְכֵן נִתְּיַנֵּת הַחֲנוּכָה בַּתְּחִלָּתָה שֶׁהֵם הַדְּבָרוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנִית הָיָה ג"כ
מֵאֹר הַגָּנוּז

And likewise, when the Torah was given initially, in the form of the Ten Commandments, the first two were also from the *Ohr Haganuz*.

וְכֵן תִּתְּגַלֶּה לְעֵתִיד בְּכָל עֶקְרָה כַּמ"ש בַּפ' בְּהַעֲלֵתָךְ קנ"ב א'

So too, in the future, the entire root of *Ohr Haganuz* will be revealed, as the *Zohar* states in *parshat Behalotecha* p. 152a.

עד"ז הוּא ג"כ כִּי רִאשִׁית מְצִיאת הָאֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה ג"כ רַק
בְּהֶאֱרַת אֹר הַגָּנוּז

This is also similar to what transpired at the very beginning of the existence of the Patriarchs and the Israelites – which was also from the radiance of the *Ohr Haganuz*.

כִּי הָיָה מְצִיאוֹתָם שְׁלֹא מִן הַטֶּבַע וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַטֶּבַע לְגַמְרִי

For their existence was not natural, but completely transcended the natural world.

כִּי מִצִּיאת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ ע"ה וְלִדְתּוֹ הָיָה שְׁלֹא מִן הַטֶּבֶעַ כִּי נוֹלַד
מִבִּיאָה כְּזוֹ אֲשֶׁר ע"פ טֵבַע אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְאִשָּׁה לְהִתְעַבֵּר כָּלֵל מִבִּיאָה
כָּזֶה

Our Patriarch Abraham's existence and his birth were not natural, since he was born from a union that according to nature could not possibly have enabled a woman to become pregnant,

וכמ"ש האריז"ל בלקוטי תורה איוב וכן בספר הגלגולים פרק נ' דף
ס"ז דפוס פרעמישלא. וע"ש הסוד והטעם בזה. וע' רמב"ן ויקרא
י"ח פסוק י"ט.

as the Arizal writes in *Likutei Torah, Iyov* and in *Sefer Hagilgulim* chap. 50 p. 67 in the Premishlan edition. See there the esoteric explanation

and reason for it. See also Ramban, *Vayikra* 18:19.

וְכֵן אַבְרָהָם וְשָׂרָה וַיִּצְחָק וְרִבְקָה כֻּלָּן עֲקוּרִים הָיוּ כמ"ש בִּיבְמוֹת
ס"ד א'

In addition, Avraham and Sarah, and Isaac and Rebecca were all barren, as the Talmud *Yevamot* 64a states.

וְכֵן רָחֵל וְלֵאָה שְׁנֵיהֶן עֲקֻרוֹת הָיוּ כִּי גַם לֵאָה הִיְתָה עֲקָרָה כמ"ש
בְּאֵגֶדֶת בְּרֵאשִׁית פ' נ"ב

Similarly, Rachel and Leah were also barren – even Leah was barren initially, as it states in the *Aggadata, Bereishit* ch. 52.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיֵּרָא ה' כִּי שְׁנוּאָה לֵאָה וַיִּפְתַּח אֶת רִחְמָהּ וּכמ"ש
בב"ר ר"פ ע"א

This is why the verse (*Bereishit* 29:31) states, "And Hashem saw that Leah was shunned, so He opened her womb" – as *Bereishit Rabba* 71 states.

וְהָיָה הַיָּהּ מְצִיאת הָאֲבוֹת וְהַשְּׁבֵטִים שֶׁלֹּא מִן הַטֶּבַע כָּלֵל

Thus the existence of the Patriarchs and the Tribes was not natural at all.

וְכֵן בְּרִדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמִצְרַיִם וְנַעֲשׂוּ שָׁם לְשִׁשִּׁים רְבֹא שֶׁהוּא מִסְפָּר
מִסְגָּל וּמִיַּחַד לְקַבֵּלַת הַתּוֹרָה

Similarly, the Israelites descended into Egypt as a family group numbering only 70 souls and became a large nation of 600,000 – a special and unique number¹ – who received the Torah,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמַכִּילְתָּא יִתְרוֹ בְּפָסוּק וְהָיוּ נִכְנִיִּים לַיּוֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי
שָׁאֵם הָיָה חֹסֶר אֶחָד מֵהֶם לֹא הָיוּ כְּדָאֵי לְקַבֵּל

as it states in *Mechilta, Yitro*, on the verse (*Shemot* 19:11) "Let them be ready on the third day..." upon which the *Mechilta* comments: If even one of them was missing, they would not have been worthy of receiving the Torah.

וְכֵן הוּא בַּב"ר פ' ע' סִימָן מ' וְדִבְרִים רַבָּא פ' ז' סִימָן ח'.

A similar statement is found in *Bereishit Rabba* chap. 70 para. 40, and in *Devarim Rabba* chap. 7 para. 8.

הָרִי מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ לְמִסְפָּר רַב כְּזֶה בְּמִשְׁךְ רַד"ו שָׁנָה מֵע' נֶפֶשׁ לִס'
רְבֹא הַגְּבָרִים לְבַר מִטָּף

That they became a nation of such a large number in a span of 210 years – 600,000 men alone, excluding children from only 70 souls,

וּבְמַכִּילְתָּא שָׁם אָמַר ר' עֲקִיבָא שֶׁהוּא לְבַד נָשִׁים וְזָקֵנִים

and the *Mechilta* states in the name of Rabbi Akiva that this excluded women and the elderly –

וְהוּא כִּמּוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּבָא בִּתְרָא קכ"א ע"ב שֶׁהַמִּסְפָּר דִּס' רְבֹא הוּא
מִכ' עַד ס'

and as our Sages state in *Bava Batra* 121b that the 600,000 included only men between the ages of 20–60.

ובשמות רבא ריש פ' מ"ב אָמְרוּ כִּי הָיוּ ס' רְבּוּא שֶׁל זָקֵנִים וְכֵן ס'
רְבּוּא שֶׁל בָּחוּרִים וְכֵן שֶׁל נְעָרִים וְכֵן שֶׁל נָשִׁים

In *Shemot Rabba* beginning of chap. 42 the Sages state that there were 600,000 elders, 600,000 young men, and 600,000 male youths and a similar number of women!

וּבְתַרְגּוּם יוֹנָתָן שְׁמוֹת י"ב ל"ז אָמַר כִּי הָטַף הָיָה ה' לֶכ"א וְהָיוּ הָטַף
לְבַד ש' רְבּוּא

***Targum Yonatan* (*Shemot* 12:37) states that each family had five babies, and there were 600,000 babies alone!**

וְהָיָה מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ מֵעַ' נֶפֶשׁ לְמִסְפָּר רַב וְעֲצוּם כִּזְהוּ בְּמִשְׁךְ רַד"ו שָׁנָה
הָיָה הוּא לְמַעַלָּה מִהַטָּבַע לְגַמְרִי

Whatever the calculation – that 70 souls became such a huge number in the space of 210 years – it's way beyond the natural order,

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁהָאֲרִיךְ בִּזְהוּ בְּסִפְרֵי נִפְלְאוֹת ה'

as the work "*Niflao't Hashem*" discusses at length.

וְהָיָה לָנוּ כִּי מְצִיאת הָאֲבוֹת וְהַשְּׁבָעִים וַיִּשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה שְׁלֹא מִן הַטָּבַע
וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַטָּבַע לְגַמְרִי

Thus it is that the existence of the Patriarchs and the 70 souls of Israel was way beyond the natural order.

וְכֵן עַד"ז כָּל הַהִנְהָגָה שֶׁבָּהֶם שֶׁהֵם הַנְּסִים נִגְלִים דְּגֵאֲלַת מִצְרַיִם
וְשֶׁבְּמִדְבָּר

And similarly, the entire manner in which they the Israelites were guided – by means of open miracles at the time of the Exodus from Egypt and in the Sinai desert –

שְׁהִיָּה הַכֹּל אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר וְהִיָּה כ"ז ג"כ שֶׁלֹּא בְּזָכוֹת רַק בְּבְרִית

for everything was totally Divine intervention, and none of it was due to their merits but rather because of the Covenant,

וּכְמ"ש יִחְזָקָאֵל מ"ז רַבְּבָה כְּצֻמָּח הַשָּׂדֶה נִתְּתִיךָ וְתִרְבִּי וְתִגְדְּלִי כו'
וְאֵת עָרֶם וְעָרְיָה כו'

As the verses in *Yechezkel* 16:7–8 attest: "I made you as numerous as the plants of the field; you increased and grew... but you were naked and bare... i.e. without *mitzvot*"2****

וְאֶשְׁבַּע לָךְ וְאָבֹא בְּבְרִית אִתְּךָ כו' וְתִהְיֶי לִי

and I took an oath to you and entered into a covenant with you... and you became Mine."

וְהָרִינוּ מִכ"ז כִּי כָל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעִיל מִתְקַוְּתָנוּ הָעֲתִידָה שֶׁהוּא
כָּל תְּקוּנַת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל

What we conclude from all this is what we stated above regarding our future hopes, the hopes and longings of all Israel,

שֶׁהִיא יִתְקַיֵּם בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלֵם עכ"פ כִּי הוּא מְסוּד אֹר הַמְּקִיף

which will be fulfilled for every Jew, since it is the secret of the *ohr makif* the Divine revelation that is too lofty to be clothed in the vessels of the *sefirot* and therefore remains in a state of 'resting upon them' or enveloping **them** rather than being vested within them. See above *Sha'ar* 6:3.

אֲשֶׁר כָּל גְּלוּי אֹרֹו וּפְעֻלָּתוֹ הוּא לְמַעְלָה מִן הַטָּבַע וּלְמַעְלָה מִן
הַמַּדָּה

This *ohr makif* is revealed and acts in a manner that transcends nature, and transcends limitations.

כָּבֵד הִיָּה זֶה לְעוֹלָמִים וְאֲדָרְבָּה הוּא כִּי הוּא הִיָּה יְסוּד כָּל הַבְּרִיָּאָה
כָּלֹו וְיְסוּד כָּל מְצִיאת הָאֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

This revelation of the *ohr makif* already happened throughout the ages; to the contrary, it was the very foundation of the entire Creation, and was the fundamental factor in the existence of the Patriarchs and Israel.

וּכְבֹּד הַתְּחִיל הָאוֹר הַזֶּה לְהִתְגַּלֵּה לָנוּ בְּמַתָּן תּוֹרָה

And this *ohr* began to be revealed to us when we were given the Torah,

וּבְזֶהֱר אֹרֹו גָּאֲלָנוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְכֵן הִלְכָנוּ לְאוֹרֹו כָּל הַמָּ' שָׁנָה בְּמַדְבָּר
עַד כְּבוֹשׁ הָאָרֶץ

and with the radiance of this *ohr* He redeemed us from Egypt, and we traveled with its light all 40 years in the desert, until the Land was conquered.

כִּי כָּל זֶהֱר אֹרֹו שֶׁהָאִיר אָז בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה רַק ע"י מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה

For the entire radiance of this light that illuminated the Israelites at that time was only through Moshe Rabeinu, peace be upon him,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עָלָיו וַתֵּרָא אוֹתוֹ כִּי טוֹב הוּא וְהוּא מְאֹד הִגָּנוּז הַנֶּאֱמַר עָלָיו
וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב

regarding whom the verse (*Shemot* 2:2) states, "and she saw that he was good," for the house became filled with light (*Sotah* 12a; Rashi). This was from the concealed light about which the verse (*Bereishit* 1:4) states, "And G-d saw that the light was good" and He concealed it for the righteous in the future,³

וּכְמ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק שְׁמוֹת י"א ב' ופ' בְּרֵאשִׁית ל"א ע"ב ע"ש

as it states in the *Zohar II Shemot* p. 11b; and *Zohar I Bereishit* p. 31b. See there.

וְכַשְׁנִסְתָּלַק מֹשֶׁה הָזֵר הָאוֹר וְנִתְעַלַּם וְלָכֵן וְלֹא יָדַע אִישׁ אֶת קִבְרָתוֹ
מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא מִהָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנָז. ע' זוֹה"ק יִתְרוֹ פ"ט רע"א.

When Moshe passed on that *ohr* once again became hidden, and thus "no one knows his burial place to this day" (*Devarim* 34:6), because it is from the light that was concealed. See *Zohar II, Yitro* 89a.

אך לעתיד לבוא הנה נאמר מה שהיה הוא שיהיה שר"ת משה

But regarding the future, the verse (*Kohelet* 1:9) states, "That which was, will be" – where the initial letters of these words form the name Moshe,⁴

כי הוא היה גואל ראשון והוא יהיה גואל אחרון וכמ"ש בתקונים
תקון ס"ט קל"א ע"א ובהג"ר א"ש קל"ז ע"ב דה"מ ולב"ת ע"ש

since Moshe was the first redeemer and will be the final redeemer, as the *Tikunim Tikunei Zohar Tikun* 69 p. 131a states. See GR "A there, p. 137b, beginning וּלְבַתֵּר. See there.

ולכן נאמר מיכה ז' כימי צאתך מארץ מצרים אראנו נפלאות

Therefore the Prophet Michah states (7:15), "As in the days when you left the land of Egypt, I will show you miracles,"

כי הגלוי דהאור הזה הוא כלו למעלה מהטבע וכל פעולותיו הוא
נסים נגלים

for the revelation of this *Ohr* completely transcends the natural realm, and all of its activities are revealed miracles.

וזהו מה שיסדו אפס בלתי גואלנו לימות המשיח

This is also what the Sages established in the Shabbat morning liturgy "there is nothing without You, our Redeemer, in the days of *Mashiach*...

כי יהיה כל גאולה העתידה הכל למעלה מהטבע וע"י הקב"ה לבד
ובהגלוי דהאור הגנוז.

for the entire future redemption completely transcends the natural realm, and will be enacted by the Blessed Holy One

alone, with the revelation of the hidden *ohr*.

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבְתִּי פֶּסְקָא ל"ו כִּי עִמָּךְ מְקוֹר חַיִּים בְּאוֹרְךָ
נִרְאָה אֹר.

And so is stated in *Pesikta Rabbati* 36 on the verse (*Tehillim* 36:10) "with You is the source of life; by Your light we will see light" –

אֵיזָה אֹר שְׁכֵנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִצָּפָה זֶה אֹרֹו שֶׁל מְשִׁיחַ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיֵּרָא
אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאֹר כִּי טוֹב שֶׁהוּא הָאֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז.

regarding this the *Pesikta* asks: Which is the *ohr* that the Congregation of Israel yearns for? This is the light of *Mashiach*, regarding which it states (*Bereishit* 1:4), "And G-d saw that the light was good" – this is the concealed light.

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה גְּאֻלַּת מִצְרַיִם ע"י הַקֵּב"ה לְבַד וְכַמ"ש בְּעַל הַגָּדָה
וְיוֹצִיאֵנוּ ה' מִמִּצְרַיִם לֹא ע"י מַלְאָךְ וְלֹא ע"י שְׁלִיחַ

Just as it was in the days of the redemption from Egypt, where the Blessed Holy One acted alone, as the *Haggadah* declares, "G-d took us out of Egypt – not by means of an angel and not by means of an emissary.

כִּי גַם מָה שֶׁהָיָה נַעֲשֶׂה ע"י מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן הָיָה ג"כ רַק אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוֹר
וְלֹא בְכֹחַ אֲנוּשֵׁי כָּלֵל

For what was achieved by Moshe and Aaron was also completely an act of the Divine; not by the power of man at all.

כִּי הָרִי מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה כָּל מִימֵי מִצְרַיִם לָדָם ע"י שְׁהָרִים אַהֲרֹן אֶת
הַמַּטֶּה וַיַּךְ אֶת הַמַּיִם אֲשֶׁר בַּיָּאֵר

That all the water in Egypt turned to blood when Aaron raised his staff and struck the waters of the Nile River –

הָרִי לֹא הָיָה זֶה מִכֹּחַ אֲנוּשֵׁי כָּלֵל וְעַד"ז כָּל הַמַּכּוֹת כָּלָם.

is something not at all within the capacity of a human being to achieve. The same applies to all the plagues.

וְכֵן קָרִיעַת יַם סוּף שֶׁהָיָה ע"י שְׁהָרִים מֹשֶׁה אֶת הַמַּטֵּה וְנָטָה יָדוֹ עַל הַיָּם

Similarly, the splitting of the sea took place after Moshe raised his staff and stretched his arm out over the sea –

הָרִי לֹא הָיָה כ"ז מִכַּחַ אֲנוֹשִׁי כָּלֵל וְהָיָה הַכֹּל אֱלֹהוֹת לְבַד

none of this was in the power of a human being to achieve; it was all a Divine feat exclusively.

וְמָה גַם כִּי עָקַר הַגָּאֵלָה שֶׁהָיָה ע"י מַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת הָרִי לֹא הָיָה בְּזֶה שׁוּם מַגָּע יָד מִמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה אֶלָּא מֵהַקֵּב"ה בְּכַבּוּדוֹ וּבְעֶצְמוֹ

And particularly in view of the fact that the redemption was primarily the result of the plague of the firstborn, in which Moshe Rabeinu had no hand at all; rather, it came exclusively from the holy Blessed One Himself.

וְהָרִי אָמַר בְּעַל הַגָּדָה הֵיטִיב וַיּוֹצִיאֵנוּ ה' מִמִּצְרַיִם לֹא ע"י מַלְאָךְ וְלֹא ע"י שְׁלִיחַ

The author of the *Passover Hagaddah* expressed this well in the statement that "G-d Himself took us out of Egypt – not by means of an angel and not by means of an emissary.

וְכֵן יְהִיָּה גָאֵלָה הָעֲתִידָה וְכַמ"ש כִּימֵי צֵאתְךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם אֲרָאֵנוּ נִפְלְאוֹת

And so too regarding the future redemption, as the verse (*Micha* 7:15) states: "As in the days when you left the land of Egypt, I will show you miracles."

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁיִּסְדְּדוּ אֶפֶס בְּלִתְךָ גּוֹאֲלֵנוּ לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ.

This is also what the Sages established in the Shabbat morning liturgy "there is nothing without You, our Redeemer, in the

days of *Mashiach*,

וְאָמְרוּ בְּבִרְכוֹת סַפ"א כִּי כָּל הַנִּסִּים דְּגָאֵלְת מִצְרַיִם יִהְיוּ טָפֵל
לְהַנִּסִּים דְּגָאוּלָּה הָעֵתִידָה.

Furthermore, the Sages declared in Talmud *Berachot* end of ch. 1 that all of the miracles of the Redemption from Egypt will be inferior to the miracles that will take place in the future redemption.

וְע' בְּקִהְלֵת רַבָּא פ"א בְּפָסוּק אֵין זְכוּרֹן לְרַאשׁוֹנִים כו' ע"ש.

– see *Kohelet Rabba* ch. 1:11 on the verse "There is no recollection of former times..." See there.

וְכֵן כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה גְּאֵלְת מִצְרַיִם גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהָיוּ הִלְלוּ עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹז'
וְהִלְלוּ כו'

And just as with the Redemption from Egypt, where there were idol-worshippers among the Israelites,⁵ just as there were among the Egyptians,

כֵּן גְּאֵלָה הָעֵתִידָה גַּם בְּדוֹר שֶׁכֻּלּו חַיִּב.

so too, with the future Redemption, and even if the entire generation will be unworthy.

וְעַד"ז בְּעֵנִין הַתְּגִלוֹת הַתּוֹרָה אָמְרוּ בְּקִהְלֵת רַבָּא פ' י"א בְּפָסוּק כִּי
אִם שָׁנִים הַרְבֵּה יִחְיֶה.

A similar statement is made by the Sages in *Kohelet Rabba* ch. 11 on the verse (11:8) "Even as a man lives many years..."

תּוֹרָה שֶׁאָדָם לָמַד בַּעוּה"ז הֶבֶל הִיא לִפְנֵי תוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ.

upon which the Sages comment: The Torah a person learns in this world is insignificant⁶ compared with the Torah of Mashiach.

וְע' תִּנְחוּמָא פ' תְּבוּאָה וּבִאֲוִתִּיּוֹת דְּר' עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ז' ע"ש עוֹד בְּזָה.

See also *Midrash Tanchuma, Tavo and Otiyot d'Rabbi Akiva* 7 regarding this matter.

וכ"ז הוא כי עקר אור הגנוז יתגלה רק לעתיד ולכן יהיה אז עקר כל הנסים ועקר הגלוי דאור התורה:

Now all of this is primarily because the *ohr haganuz* the concealed light will be revealed only in the future; therefore the greatest miracles and the primary revelation of the light of Torah will take place then.

והנה אור הגנוז הוא אורא עלאה אורא דלא אתפס נהורא דרדל"א

Now this *ohr haganuz* is referred to in *Zohar Chadash* (70a, 73a, 74a**⁷**) as 'the upper exosphere' in the Kabbalistic sense, i.e. spiritual light (or illumination) that is not yet manifested as spiritual light, and the 'exosphere' that cannot be comprehended, the light of RADL"A⁸ the beginning that is not and cannot be known, the innermost dimension of *Keter*,

דאתגנז ברישא דא"א וממנו הוא כל החזקתא שהם התר"כ עמודי אור

that is concealed within the uppermost aspect of *Arich Anpin*. The lower aspects of *keter* we can relate to, and from there emerge all aspects of clear light⁹ which are the 620 pillars of light that emerge from *keter*.¹⁰

אשר שם הוא סוד ברית אבות וישראל והוא שרש דכל המקיפין שהם מאירים בלתי גבול ולמעלה מן המדה.

Therein is the mystery of the Covenant Hashem made with the Patriarchs and with Israel, and that is the root of all the aspects of *makifim* illuminations that are not clothed within the *sefirot* or the Worlds that illuminate without limitations and transcend any calibration.

וְלַעֲתִיד יִתְיַחַד כָּל אוֹר מְקִיף בְּאוֹר פְּנִימִי וּבְסוּד הַכְּתוּב תְּהִלִּים ע"ד
אֶתְהָ רִצְצַת רָאשֵׁי לִוְיָתָן... אֶתְהָ בְּקַעַת מַעֲיָן וְנֶחֱל

In the future all the aspects of the non-manifested *ohr makif* will merge with the internalized *ohr penimi*, as in the mystical explanation of the verses in *Tehillim* 74:14–15 "You crushed the heads of the Leviathan¹¹... You split open fountain and stream..."

וְכֵן בִּישְׁעֶיהָ מ"א אֶפְתַּח עַל שְׁפִיִּים נְהָרוֹת וּבִתְוֹךְ בְּקַעֲוֹת מַעֲיָנוֹת

Similarly in *Isaiah* 41:18 "I will open up rivers on the hilltops and springs in the midst of valleys..."

כִּי יִזְדַּכְּכוּ הַכֵּלִים וְיִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל צִמְצוּם

since the vessels will be refined or purified and the entire *tzimtzum* the constriction that led to the creation of finite worlds will be nullified,

וְיִתְיַחַד כָּל אוֹר פְּנִימִי בְּהִמְקִיף שְׁלוֹ וַיֵּאָר הַכֹּל בְּלִי חֶק וּגְבוּל.

and the *ohr pnimi* will unite with its *ohr makif* and everything will be illuminated without restrictions and limitations.

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל כִּי מִשְׁרָשָׁם הָיָה אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי עִם אוֹר
הַמְקִיף אוֹר אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ

This is as we stated above, that in their root the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif* are actually one light,

אֲלֹא שְׁאוֹתוֹ הַחֶלֶק אוֹר אֲשֶׁר נִכְנַס מִבְּפָנִים הוּא נִתְצַמְצַם ע"י הַגּוֹף
וְכָלִי

only that the aspect of the light that enters into i.e. is vested in the created worlds is restricted by the body and vessel of those created beings,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִי"ז הָאו"פ עִם הָאוֹר הַמְקִיף לְשָׁנִי מִיָּנִי אוֹרוֹת וְלִתְכוּנוֹת
שׁוֹנוֹת

so that the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif* become two types of light, with differing characteristics.

אָבֶל פֿאַשר יתגלה אור המקיף בתוקף אורו ויזדכך עי"ז כל העבֿית
דהגוף וכלי

But when the *ohr hamakif* becomes revealed in all its potency and all the coarseness of the body and vessels becomes refined,

אז לא יהיה עוד שום הפסק בין אור הפנימי לאור המקיף ויחזרו
להיות לאור אחד ממש

then there will be no disruption between the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif*, and they will return to become a single light in actuality.

ויאירו שניהם בלי חק וגבול כלל שהוא למעלה מהטבע לגמרי
ולמעלה מן המדה לגמרי.

Both of them will shine forth without restriction and limitation – something transcending nature completely and way beyond calibration.

והנה נתבאר מדברינו ג"כ כי אור הנסיי הוא באמת יסוד כל
הבריאה כלה

Thus we have explained that this miraculous *ohr* the *ohr haganuz* is in fact the foundation of the entire Creation,

אלא שנגנז ונתעלם ע"י החטא דעהד"ע [דעץ הדעת] וכמ"ש בב"ר
פ' י"א ופ' י"ב

but was hidden away and concealed due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, as *Bereishit Rabba* chaps. 11, 12 explains.

ואז נתצמצם לכל חקי וגבולי הטבע

Only then was the light constricted by all of the restrictions and limitations of nature.

אך היא תלויה ברצונו ית"ש וברצותו חוגג וברצותו ממוגג

Nevertheless, all of this depends upon His blessed Will as the Yom Kippur liturgy¹²** states, "Like molten glass in the hand of the glassblower – he shapes it at will and dissolves it at will" –**

והם כל הנסים הנגלים אשר הם מהאור דבלתי גבול שהוא האור
הגנוז

this alludes to **all the revealed miracles that derive from the infinite light, which is the *ohr haganuz* the concealed light**

אשר הוא היה יסוד העולם בעצם ובראשונה

which was in essence the foundation of the world from the outset,

וכמו שנאמר ויאמר אלהים יהי אור ויהי אור וירא אלהים את
האור כי טוב

as the verses (*Bereishit* 1:3–4) state, "And G-d said there shall be light, and there was light," and "G-d saw that the light was good..."

והוא נברא קדם בריאת שמים וארץ כמו שכתוב עוטה אור
כשלמה ואח"כ נוטה שמים כריעה, וכמ"ש בשמות רבא פ' ט"ו
סימן כ"ב ע"ש.

This light was created before He created the heavens and earth, as the verse (*Tehillim* 104:2) states, "He donned the light like a cloak" and only afterwards, "He spread out the heavens like a curtain" (ibid.), as *Shemot Rabba* 15:22 states. See there.

ובזה מבאר כל מה שהפליגו החוקרים בענין הנסים

This provides the answer to the investigations of the philosophers regarding miracles (how they came to be) –

כי אדרבה הוא שאור הנסיי הוא יסוד העולם שבתחלה

since, to the contrary, this miraculous *ohr* is the foundation of the universe from the outset,

וְהָאֲרָכְנוּ בְּזֶה בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כְּלָל ב' וְשֵׁם כְּלָל י"ט וּבכ"מ מִדְּבָרֵינוּ

as we discuss at length in *Sefer Haklalim*, *klal 2*, *klal 19* and in a number of other places in our works.

וְכֵן יִחְזֹר הוּא לְהָאִיר וּלְהַתְגַּלֵּה לְעֵת קֵץ הַיָּמִין וְבוֹ יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל
כָּלֶם לְכָל תְּקוּנוֹת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל בּב"א:

This light will return to illuminate and become revealed at the end of days, and all of Israel will be worthy of that which the Jewish People have always hoped and yearned for, speedily in our days!

Footnotes

1. See *Megaleh Amukot*, *Ofen* 186 that this refers to the 600,000 soul-roots of the Jewish people that corresponds precisely to the 600,000 letters in the Torah. Now although there are only 304,805 letters, the 600,000 includes vowel letters that are not included in the text, but are implied in the pronunciation of the word (e.g. a *yud* for a *chirik*, a *vav* for a *kubutz*, etc). Furthermore, the letters of the name ישראל spell out יש ששים רבוא אותיות לתורה – there are 600,000 letters in the Torah. [↩](#)
2. *Mechilta d'Rabbi Yishmael* 12:6. And therefore they were given two *mitzvot* – *brit milah* and the *Pesach* offering (ibid.) [↩](#)
3. Talmud *Chagigah* 12a. [↩](#)
4. *Sha'ar Hagilgulim*, *Intro* – משה = שיהיה הוא שיהיה = 38. [↩](#)
5. See *Zohar II*, 170b. [↩](#)

6. Literally "hot air", nothing [↩](#)
7. In the Margolios print. [↩](#)
8. [↩](#) רדל"א = רישא דלא ידע, ודלא איתיידע [↩](#)
9. See *Zohar I*, 42b; *Zohar III* 128b. The Arizal explains that the חיוורתא (literally 'white light') is the whiteness of the 'skull' of *Arich Anpin* (see *Eitz Chaim* 13:5, *Mahadura Tinyana*). [↩](#)
10. The gematria of *keter* is 620, corresponding to the 620 letters of the Ten Commandments (*Baal HaTurim Shemot* 20:13; see Rashi *Shemot* 24:12). These 620 pillars of light represent the elicitation of those aspects of *keter* from which the 613 *mitzvot* of the Torah and the 7 *mitzvot* of the rabbis (= 620) emerge (see Rabbi David Vital's *Keter Torah*, cited in the Rama's *Torat haOlah* 3:38; *Shela*, *Yitro* (*Torah Ohr* 12). [↩](#)
11. Referring to Pharaoh and his ministers (Metzudat David). [↩](#)
12. In the lyric [↩](#) כִּי הִנֵּה כְּחֹמֶר [↩](#)